

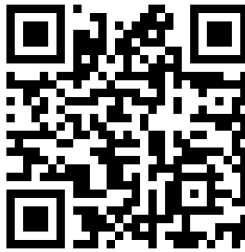
Phaedo

ΦΑΙΔΩΝ

Plato

translated by David Horan

Plato Scroll · **plato-scroll.com**



Scan to read online, free and offline
plato-scroll.com/s/phae/

57a

EC: Were you yourself there with Socrates on the day he drank the poison in the prison, Phaedo,¹ or did you hear about it from someone else?

ΕΧ. αὐτός, ὦ Φαίδων, παρεγένου Σωκράτει ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ ἢ τὸ φάρμακον ἔπιεν ἐν τῷ δεσμωτηρίῳ, ἢ ἄλλου του ἤκουσας; ΦΑΙΔ. αὐτός, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες. ΕΧ. τί οὖν δὴ ἐστὶν ἅττα εἶπεν ὁ ἀνὴρ πρὸ τοῦ θανάτου; καὶ πῶς ἐτελεύτα; ἡδέως γὰρ ἂν ἐγὼ ἀκούσαιμι. καὶ γὰρ οὔτε τῶν πολιτῶν Φλειασίων οὐδεὶς πάνυ τι ἐπιχωριάζει τὰ νῦν Ἀθήναζε, οὔτε τις ξένος ἀφ' ἱκταὶ χρόνου συχνοῦ

PH: I was there myself, Echecrates.²

EC: Well then, what did the man say before his death? And how did he die? I would love to hear about this. The fact is, no one from Phlius tends to visit Athens much these days, nor has any visitor come from there for quite a while, someone who could give us a definite account of those events, apart from saying that he drank the poison and died. They had nothing to say about anything else.

57b

PH: So did you not even find out the details of the way the trial unfolded?

ἐκεῖθεν ὅστις ἂν ἡμῖν σαφές τι ἀγγεῖλαι οἶός τ' ἦν περὶ τούτων, πλήν γε δὴ ὅτι φάρμακον πιὼν ἀποθάνοι· τῶν δὲ ἄλλων οὐδὲν εἶχεν φράζειν.

58a

EC: Yes, someone did report these events to us, and we were surprised that although the trial took place some time ago, he was evidently put to death much more recently. Why did that happen, Phaedo?

ΦΑΙΔ. οὐδὲ τὰ περὶ τῆς δίκης ἄρα ἐπύθεσθε ὃν τρόπον ἐγένετο; ΕΧ. ναί, ταῦτα μὲν ἡμῖν ἠγγεῖλέ τις, καὶ ἐθαυμάζομέν γε ὅτι πάλαι γενομένης αὐτῆς πολλῷ ὕστερον φαίνεται ἀποθανών. τί οὖν ἦν τοῦτο, ὦ Φαίδων; ΦΑΙΔ. τύχη τις αὐτῷ, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, συνέβη· ἔτυχεν γὰρ τῇ προτεραίᾳ τῆς δίκης ἢ πρύμνα ἐστεμμένη τοῦ πλοίου ὃ εἰς Δῆλον Ἀθηναῖοι

πέμπουσιν. EX. τοῦτο δὲ δὴ τί ἐστίν; ΦΑΙΔ. τοῦτ' ἔστι τὸ πλοῖον, ὡς φασιν Ἀθηναῖοι, ἐν ᾧ Θησεύς ποτε εἰς Κρήτην τοὺς δις ἑπτὰ ἐκείνους ὥχετο

PH: In his case, it was the result of a coincidence, Echecrates. It so happened that the prow of the ship which the Athenians send to Delos was crowned the day before the trial.

58b

EC: And what ship is this?

ἄγων καὶ ἔσωσέ τε καὶ αὐτὸς ἐσώθη. τῷ οὖν Ἀπόλλωνι ἠὔξαντο ὡς λέγεται τότε, εἰ σωθεῖεν, ἐκάστου ἕτους θεωρίαν ἀπάξειν εἰς Δῆλον· ἦν δὴ αἰεὶ καὶ νῦν ἔτι ἐξ ἐκείνου κατ' ἐνιαυτὸν τῷ θεῷ πέμπουσιν. ἐπειδὴ οὖν ἄρζωνται τῆς θεωρίας, νόμος ἐστὶν αὐτοῖς ἐν τῷ χρόνῳ τούτῳ καθαρεύειν τὴν πόλιν καὶ δημοσίᾳ μηδένα ἀποκτείνουσαι, πρὶν ἂν εἰς Δῆλόν τε ἀφίκηται τὸ πλοῖον καὶ πάλιν δεῦρο· τοῦτο δ' ἐνίστε ἐν πολλῷ χρόνῳ γίγνεται, ὅταν τύχῃσιν ἄνεμοι ἀπολαβόντες

PH: It is the ship on which, according to the Athenians, Theseus once travelled to Crete bringing the “twice seven” young people, and he saved them and saved himself.³ Now, it is said that they vowed to Apollo, there and then, to send a sacred expedition to Delos every year if they were saved. Accordingly, every year since then, including this year, they send an expedition to honour the god. Now, they have a law that once they begin the expedition, the city is to be kept pure during that period, and no one may be executed by the authorities until the ship has arrived at Delos and returned once more, and on occasion, whenever the winds happen to detain them, this takes a lot of time. The sacred expedition begins once the priest of Apollo crowns the prow of the ship, and this happened, as I said, the day before the trial took place. That is why Socrates had so much time in prison between the trial and his death.

58c

EC: Yes, but what about the circumstances of the actual death, Phaedo? What did people say and how did they behave? Which of his friends

were present with him? Or did the authorities not allow them to be there, and did he die bereft of friends?

αὐτούς. ἀρχὴ δ' ἐστὶ τῆς θεωρίας ἐπειδὴν ὁ ἱερεὺς τοῦ Ἀπόλλωνος στέψῃ τὴν πρύμναν τοῦ πλοίου· τοῦτο δ' ἔτυχεν, ὥσπερ λέγω, τῇ προτεραίᾳ τῆς δίκης γεγονός. διὰ ταῦτα καὶ πολὺς χρόνος ἐγένετο τῷ Σωκράτει ἐν τῷ δεσμωτηρίῳ ὁ μεταξὺ τῆς δίκης τε καὶ τοῦ θανάτου. EX. τί δὲ δὴ τὰ περὶ αὐτὸν τὸν θάνατον, ὦ Φαίδων; τί ἦν τὰ λεχθέντα καὶ πραχθέντα, καὶ τίνες οἱ παραγενόμενοι τῶν ἐπιτηδείων τῷ ἀνδρὶ; ἢ οὐκ εἶων οἱ ἄρχοντες παρεῖναι, ἀλλ' ἔρημος ἐτελεύτα φίλων;

PH: Not at all. A number of them were present, quite a number, in fact.

EC: Then try to recount all the details to us as clearly as possible, provided you have the time.

58d

PH: Well, I do have the time and I shall try to give you an account. Yes, indeed, being reminded of Socrates is always the greatest delight of all to me, whether I speak of him myself or hear about him from someone else.

ΦΑΙΔ. οὐδαμῶς, ἀλλὰ παρῆσάν τινες, καὶ πολλοί γε. EX. ταῦτα δὴ πάντα προθυμήθητι ὡς σαφέστατα ἡμῖν ἀπαγγεῖλαι, εἰ μὴ τίς σοι ἀσχολία τυγχάνει οὔσα. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλὰ σχολάζω γε καὶ πειράσομαι ὑμῖν διηγῆσασθαι· καὶ γὰρ τὸ μεμνησθαι Σωκράτους καὶ αὐτὸν λέγοντα καὶ ἄλλου ἀκούοντα ἔμοιγε αἰεὶ πάντων ἡδιστον. EX. ἀλλὰ μὴν, ὦ Φαίδων, καὶ τοὺς ἀκουσομένους γε τοιούτους ἐτέρους ἔχεις; ἀλλὰ πειρῶ ὡς ἂν δύνῃ ἀκριβέστατα διεξελθεῖν πάντα. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ μὴν ἔγωγε θαυμάσια ἔπαθον παραγενόμενος. οὔτε γὰρ ὡς θανάτῳ παρόντα με ἀνδρὸς ἐπιτηδείου ἕλεος εἰσῆει· εὐδαίμων γὰρ μοι ἀνὴρ ἐφαίνετο, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, καὶ τοῦ τρόπου καὶ τῶν λόγων, ὡς ἀδεῶς καὶ γενναίως ἐτελεύτα, ὥστε μοι ἐκεῖνον παρίστασθαι μὴδ' εἰς Ἄιδου ἰόντα ἄνευ θείας μοίρας ἰέναι, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐκεῖσε ἀφικόμενον εὖ πράξειν εἴπερ τις πώποτε καὶ ἄλλος. ΦΑΙΔ. διὰ δὴ ταῦτα οὐδὲν πάνυ μοι ἔλεινόν εἰσῆει, ὡς εἰκὸς ἂν δόξειεν εἶναι παρόντι πένθει, οὔτε αὖ ἡδονὴ ὡς ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ ἡμῶν ὄντων ὥσπερ εἰώθεμεν — καὶ γὰρ οἱ λόγοι τοιοῦτοί

τινες ἦσαν — ἀλλ' ἀτεχνῶς ἄτοπόν τί μοι πάθος παρῆν καὶ τις ἀήθης κρᾶσις ἀπὸ τε τῆς ἡδονῆς συγκεκραμένη ὁμοῦ καὶ ἀπὸ τῆς λύπης, ἐνθυμουμένῳ ὅτι αὐτίκα ἐκεῖνος ἔμελλε τελευτᾶν. καὶ πάντες οἱ παρόντες σχεδόν τι οὕτω διεκείμεθα, τοτὲ μὲν γελῶντες, ἐνίστε δὲ δακρύοντες, εἰς δὲ ἡμῶν καὶ διαφερόντως, Ἀπολλόδωρος —

EC: In that case, Phaedo, you have listeners who are like-minded, so try to recount everything as precisely as you can.

PH: Well, I myself had a strange feeling while I was there, for I did not experience the usual pity of someone present at the death of a friend. Indeed, he himself appeared happy to me, Echecrates, both in his manner and in his words, so fearlessly and nobly did he meet his end. I was convinced he was not going to Hades without a divine portion and, indeed, that he would fare well even when he arrived there, if anyone ever does. These are the reasons I did not feel much of the pity which would seem to be expected of someone on a sad occasion. Nor again, did I feel the pleasure which is usual when we are engaged in philosophy, and our discussions were indeed of that kind. Instead, I had an utterly unusual feeling – a strange mixture combining pleasure and a like measure of pain – at the realisation that Socrates was going to pass away soon. And all those present were in much the same state, laughing at one moment and crying at the next, Apollodorus more than any of us. I presume you know the man and his character.

58e

EC: I do, of course.

PH: Well, he was completely overcome, and I was troubled myself, as were the others.

EC: Who else was present, Phaedo?

59b

PH: Of native Athenians, Apollodorus himself was present, and also Critobulus and his father, along with Hermogenes, Epigenes, Aeschines and Antisthenes. And there was Ctesippus the Paeonian, Menexenus, and some other Athenians.⁴ Plato, I believe, was ill.

οἶσθα γάρ που τὸν ἄνδρα καὶ τὸν τρόπον αὐτοῦ. EX. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΦΑΙΔ. ἐκεῖνός τε τοίνυν παντάπασιν οὕτως εἶχεν, καὶ αὐτὸς ἔγωγε ἐτεταράγμην καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι. EX. ἔτυχον δέ, ὦ Φαίδων, τίνες παραγενόμενοι; ΦΑΙΔ. οὗτός τε δὴ ὁ Ἀπολλόδωρος τῶν ἐπιχωρίων παρῆν καὶ Κριτόβουλος καὶ ὁ πατήρ αὐτοῦ καὶ ἔτι Ἑρμογένης καὶ Ἐπιγένης καὶ Αἰσχίνης καὶ Ἀντισθένης· ἦν δὲ καὶ Κτήσιππος ὁ Παιανιεύς καὶ Μενέξενος καὶ ἄλλοι τινὲς τῶν ἐπιχωρίων. Πλάτων δὲ οἶμαι ἡσθένει. EX. ξένοι δέ τινες παρῆσαν;

EC: Were there any visitors present?

PH: Yes, Simmias of Thebes, Cebes and Phaidondes. And from Megara there was Euclides and Terpsion.⁵

59c

EC: What about Cleombrotus and Aristippus?⁶ Were they there?

ΦΑΙΔ. ναί, Σιμμίας τέ γε ὁ Θηβαῖος καὶ Κέβης καὶ Φαιδώνδης καὶ Μεγαρόθεν Εὐκλείδης τε καὶ Τερψίων. EX. τί δέ; Ἀρίστιππος καὶ Κλεόμβροτος παρεγένοντο; ΦΑΙΔ. οὐ δῆτα· ἐν Αἰγίνῃ γὰρ ἐλέγοντο εἶναι. EX. ἄλλος δέ τις παρῆν; ΦΑΙΔ. σχεδόν τι οἶμαι τούτους παραγενέσθαι. EX. τί οὖν δῆ; τίνες φῆς ἦσαν οἱ λόγοι; ΦΑΙΔ. ἐγώ σοι ἐξ ἀρχῆς πάντα πειράσομαι διηγῆσασθαι. αἰὲ γὰρ δὴ καὶ τὰς πρόσθεν ἡμέρας εἰώθεμεν φοιτᾶν καὶ ἐγώ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι παρὰ τὸν Σωκράτη, συλλεγόμενοι ἔωθεν εἰς τὸ δικαστήριον ἐν ᾧ καὶ ἡ δίκη ἐγένετο· πλησίον γὰρ ἦν τοῦ δεσμωτηρίου. περιεμένομεν οὖν ἐκάστοτε ἕως ἀνοιχθεῖν τὸ δεσμωτήριον, διατρίβοντες μετ' ἀλλήλων, ἀνέωγετο γὰρ οὐ πρῶ· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἀνοιχθεῖν, εἰσῆμεν παρὰ τὸν Σωκράτη καὶ τὰ πολλὰ διημερεύομεν μετ' αὐτοῦ. καὶ δὴ καὶ τότε πρωαίτερον συνελέγημεν· τῇ γὰρ προτεραίᾳ ἡμέρᾳ

PH: Actually, they were not. In fact, they were said to have been on Aegina.

59d

EC: And was anyone else there?

PH: I think that is just about everyone who was present.

EC: In that case, will you tell us what discussions took place?

PH: I shall try to recount everything to you from the beginning.

59d

Now, I myself and the others had always been in the habit of going to visit Socrates on the previous days, gathering at daybreak at the court where the trial took place, for this was near the prison. Every day we used to wait and converse with one another until the prison was opened, as it did not open early, and once it was opened, we would go in to Socrates and spend most of the day with him. We actually met earlier that morning because on the previous day, after we left the prison in the evening, we found out that the ship had returned from Delos, so we encouraged one another to get to our usual meeting place as early as possible next morning.

59e

When we arrived, the doorkeeper came out as usual to answer us, and he told us to wait and not to go in until he called us.

WA: “The Eleven⁷ are unchaining Socrates, and are giving instructions about how he is to die today.”

59e

Now, it did not take him long before he returned and bade us enter. In we went and took in the scene: Socrates, just released from his bonds, and Xanthippe,⁸ I am sure you know her, sitting beside him holding his little child. Once Xanthippe saw us, she cried out and said the sort of thing women usually say,

ἐπειδὴ ἐξήλθομεν ἐκ τοῦ δεσμοτηρίου ἐσπέρας, ἐπυθόμεθα ὅτι τὸ πλοῖον ἐκ Δήλου ἀφιγμένον εἴη. παρηγγείλαμεν οὖν ἀλλήλοις ἥκειν ὡς πρωαῖτατα εἰς τὸ εἰωθός. καὶ ἤκομεν καὶ ἡμῖν ἐξελθὼν ὁ θυρωρός, ὅσπερ εἰώθει ὑπακούειν, εἶπεν περιμένειν καὶ μὴ πρότερον παρίεναι ἕως ἂν αὐτὸς κελεύσῃ λύουσι γάρ, ἔφη, οἱ ἔνδεκα Σωκράτη καὶ παραγγέλλουσιν ὅπως ἂν τῇδε τῇ ἡμέρᾳ τελευτᾷ. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐ πολὺν δ' οὖν χρόνον ἐπισχὼν ἤκεν καὶ ἐκέλευεν ἡμᾶς εἰσιέναι. εἰσιόντες οὖν

60a

XA: “O Socrates, your friends will be speaking to you now for the very last time, and you to them.”

60a

Then Socrates glanced towards Crito and said,

S: “Have someone take her home, Crito.”

60a

And some of Crito’s people led her away, crying and beating her breast, while Socrates sat up in the bed, bent his leg, rubbed it with his hand, and said as he was rubbing it,

κατελαμβάνομεν τὸν μὲν Σωκράτη ἄρτι λελυμένον, τὴν δὲ Ξανθίππην — γινώσκεις γάρ — ἔχουσάν τε τὸ παιδίον αὐτοῦ καὶ παρακαθημένην. ὡς οὖν εἶδεν ἡμᾶς ἡ Ξανθίππη, ἀνηυφήμησέ τε καὶ τοιαῦτ’ ἅττα εἶπεν, οἷα δὴ εἰώθασιν αἱ γυναῖκες, ὅτι ὦ Σώκρατες, ὕστατον δὴ σε προσεροῦσι νῦν οἱ ἐπιτήδριοι καὶ σὺ τούτους. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης βλέψας εἰς τὸν Κρίτωνα, ὦ Κρίτων, ἔφη, ἀπαγέτω τις αὐτὴν οἴκαδε. καὶ ἐκείνην μὲν ἀπῆγόν τινες τῶν τοῦ Κρίτωνος βοῶσάν

60b

S: “Gentlemen, this thing which people call pleasure seems to be so strange. It is so extraordinarily related to pain, though this appears to be its opposite, for the two tend not to come to a person at the same time. Yet if someone pursues one and obtains it, he is almost always compelled to take the other, as though the two were joined to a single head. And it seems to me that if Aesop⁹ had thought about this, he would have made up a fable that the god wished to reconcile their strife, but as he was unable to do so he fastened their heads together, and that is why when one arises in someone the other also follows after it. It seems that is what just happened to me. After the pain in my leg on account of the chain, the pleasure now appears to follow.”

τε καὶ κοπτομένην· ὁ δὲ Σωκράτης ἀνακαθιζόμενος εἰς τὴν κλίνην συνέκαμψέ τε τὸ σκέλος καὶ ἐξέτριψε τῇ χειρί, καὶ τρίβων ἅμα, ὡς ἄτοπον, ἔφη, ὦ ἄνδρες, ἔοικέ τι εἶναι τοῦτο ὃ καλοῦσιν οἱ ἄνθρωποι ἡδὺ ὡς θαυμασίως πέφυκε πρὸς τὸ δοκοῦν ἐναντίον εἶναι, τὸ λυπηρόν,

τὸ ἅμα μὲν αὐτῷ μὴ ἠέλειν παραγίγνεσθαι τῷ ἀνθρώπῳ, ἐὰν δέ τις διώκῃ τὸ ἕτερον καὶ λαμβάνῃ, σχεδόν τι ἀναγκάζεσθαι αἰεὶ λαμβάνειν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον, ὥσπερ ἐκ μιᾶς κορυφῆς ἡμμένον

60c

CE: Then Cebes took this up and said, “By Zeus, it is just as well you jogged my memory, Socrates. A number of people have been asking me about your compositions, the setting of Aesop’s fables to verse and the hymn to Apollo. In fact, Evenus¹⁰ also asked me recently what exactly you had in mind, since you composed these works on arriving in prison, even though you had not composed anything before then. Now, if you would like me to have an answer for Evenus, tell me what I should say whenever he asks me again, for I know very well that he will ask.”

δύ’ ὄντε. καί μοι δοκεῖ, ἔφη, εἰ ἐνενόησεν αὐτὰ Αἴσωπος, μῦθον ἂν συνθεῖναι ὥς ὁ θεὸς βουλόμενος αὐτὰ διαλλάξαι πολεμοῦντα, ἐπειδὴ οὐκ ἐδύνατο, συνῆψεν εἰς ταῦτόν αὐτοῖς τὰς κορυφάς, καὶ διὰ ταῦτα ᾧ ἂν τὸ ἕτερον παραγένηται ἐπακολουθεῖ ὕστερον καὶ τὸ ἕτερον. ὥσπερ οὖν καὶ αὐτῷ μοι ἔοικεν· ἐπειδὴ ὑπὸ τοῦ δεσμοῦ ἦν ἐν τῷ σκέλει τὸ ἀλγεινόν, ἤκειν δὴ φαίνεται ἐπακολουθοῦν τὸ ἡδύ. ὁ οὖν Κέβης ὑπολαβὼν, νῆ τὸν Δία, ᾧ Σώκρατες, ἔφη, εὖ γ’ ἐποίησας ἀναμνήσας με. περὶ γάρ τοι τῶν

60d

S: “Tell him the truth, Cebes,” he replied. “I did not compose these works with a view to rivalling him or his poems. No, I knew that would not be easy. Rather, I was testing out the meaning of certain dreams and clearing my conscience in case they were, perhaps, instructing me to make music in the usual sense. Now, the dreams went something like this... the same one often came to me during the course of my life, sometimes in one guise, sometimes in another, but always saying the same thing. ‘Socrates,’ it said, ‘make music and work at it.’ On previous occasions, I assumed it was encouraging and exhorting me to do what I was already doing, just as people call upon runners to run. So I thought the dream was exhorting me to do what I was already doing – namely,

to make music – since philosophy is the greatest music, and I was already engaged in that. But once the trial was over and the festival of the god was preventing my execution, it seemed important not to ignore the dream but to act upon it in case it might, perhaps, be instructing me to make music in the popular sense of the word. Indeed, it seemed safer not to depart until I had cleared my conscience by composing these works in obedience to the dream. So I first composed something for the god whose festival season it was, and after that I realised that a poet needs to compose stories rather than factual accounts if he is actually going to be a poet, and that I myself was no storyteller. So I took whatever stories were to hand, the fables of Aesop which I know, and turned the first ones I came upon into verse. So Cebes, tell this to Evenus and bid him farewell, and bid him pursue me as quickly as possible if he is of sound mind. I am departing today, it seems, for the people of Athens have given their command.”

ποιημάτων ὧν πεποίηκας ἐντείνας τοὺς τοῦ Αἰσώπου λόγους καὶ τὸ εἰς τὸν Ἀπόλλω προοίμιον καὶ ἄλλοι τινές με ἤδη ἤροντο, ἀτὰρ καὶ Εὐηνος πρῶην, ὅτι ποτὲ διανοηθεὶς, ἐπειδὴ δεῦρο ἦλθες, ἐποίησας αὐτά, πρότερον οὐδὲν πώποτε ποιήσας. εἰ οὖν τί σοι μέλει τοῦ ἔχειν ἐμὲ Εὐήνω ἀποκρίνασθαι ὅταν με αὐθις ἐρωτᾷ — εὖ οἶδα γὰρ ὅτι ἐρήσεται — εἰπὲ τί χρὴ λέγειν. λέγε τοίνυν, ἔφη, αὐτῷ, ὃ Κέβης, τάληθῃ, ὅτι οὐκ ἐκείνῳ βουλόμενος οὐδὲ τοῖς ποιήμασιν αὐτοῦ ἀντίτεχνος

60e

Si: And Simmias said, “What an instruction to give to Evenus, Socrates! I have met the man many times already, and from what I know of him he will never be persuaded by your request, not willingly anyway.”

εἶναι ἐποίησα ταῦτα — ἤδη γὰρ ὡς οὐ ῥάδιον εἶη — ἀλλ’ ἐνυπνίων τινῶν ἀποπειρώμενος τί λέγοι, καὶ ἀφοσιούμενος εἰ ἄρα πολλάκις ταύτην τὴν μουσικὴν μοι ἐπιτάττοι ποιεῖν. ἦν γὰρ δὴ ἅττα τοιάδε· πολλάκις μοι φοιτῶν τὸ αὐτὸ ἐνύπνιον ἐν τῷ παρελθόντι βίῳ, ἄλλοτ’ ἐν ἄλλῃ ὄψει φαινόμενον, τὰ αὐτὰ δὲ λέγον, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔφη, μουσικὴν ποιεῖ καὶ ἐργάζου. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ ἐγὼ ἔν γε τῷ πρόσθεν χρόνῳ ὅπερ ἔπραττον τοῦτο

ὕπελάμβανον αὐτό μοι παρακελεύεσθαι τε καὶ ἐπικελεύειν, ὥσπερ οἱ τοῖς θεοῦσι διακελευόμενοι, καὶ ἔμοι οὕτω τὸ ἐνύπνιον ὅπερ ἔπραττον τοῦτο ἐπικελεύειν, μουσικὴν ποιεῖν, ὡς φιλοσοφίας μὲν οὔσης μεγίστης μουσικῆς, ἔμοῦ δὲ τοῦτο πράττοντος. νῦν δ' ἐπειδὴ ἡ τε δίκη ἐγένετο καὶ ἡ τοῦ θεοῦ ἐορτὴ διεκώλυέ με ἀποθνήσκειν, ἔδοξε χρῆναι, εἰ ἄρα πολλάκις μοι προστάττοι τὸ ἐνύπνιον ταύτην τὴν δημῶδη μουσικὴν ποιεῖν, μὴ ἀπειθῆσαι αὐτῷ ἀλλὰ ποιεῖν· ἀσφαλέστερον γὰρ εἶναι μὴ ἀπιέναι πρὶν ἀφοσιώσασθαι ποιήσαντα ποιήματα καὶ πιθόμενον τῷ ἐνυπνίῳ. οὕτω δὴ πρῶτον μὲν εἰς τὸν θεὸν ἐποίησα οὗ ἦν ἡ παροῦσα θυσιᾶ· μετὰ δὲ τὸν θεόν, ἐννοήσας ὅτι τὸν ποιητὴν δέοι, εἵπερ μέλλοι ποιητὴς εἶναι, ποιεῖν μύθους ἀλλ' οὐ λόγους, καὶ αὐτὸς οὐκ ἦ μυθολογικός, διὰ ταῦτα δὴ οὐς προχείρους εἶχον μύθους καὶ ἡπιστάμην τοὺς Αἰσώπου, τούτων ἐποίησα οἷς πρῶτοις ἐνέτυχον. ταῦτα οὖν, ὦ Κέβης, Εὐήνω φράζε, καὶ ἐρρῶσθαι καί, ἂν σωφρονῇ, ἐμὲ διώκειν ὡς τάχιστα.

S: “Why not?” he replied. “Is Evenus not a philosopher?”

Si: “Well, I think he is,” said Simmias.

61c

S: “Then Evenus will indeed be willing, and so will anyone who engages in this activity in a worthy manner. However, he will not do violence to himself, for this, they say, is not lawful.”

61c

And as he was saying this, he placed his feet on the ground and then conducted the rest of the discussion seated in that manner. So Cebes asked him,

61c

CE: “Socrates, what do you mean by ‘it is not lawful to do violence to himself’ and that a philosopher should be willing to follow someone who is dying?”

ἅπειμι δέ, ὡς ἔοικε, τήμερον· κελεύουσι γὰρ Ἀθηναῖοι. καὶ ὁ Σιμμίας, οἷον παρακελεύῃ, ἔφη, τοῦτο, ὦ Σώκρατες, Εὐήνω. πολλὰ γὰρ ἤδη ἐντετύχηκα τῷ ἀνδρί· σχεδὸν οὖν ἐξ ὧν ἐγὼ ῥῆσθαι οὐδ' ὅπωςτιοῦν

σοι ἐκὼν εἶναι πείσεται. τί δέ; ἢ δ' ὅς, οὐ φιλόσοφος Εὐήνος; ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. ἐθελήσει τοίνυν καὶ Εὐήνος καὶ πᾶς ὅτῳ ἀξίως τούτου τοῦ πράγματος μέτεστιν. οὐ μέντοι ἴσως βιάσεται αὐτόν· οὐ γάρ φασι θεμιτὸν εἶναι. καὶ ἅμα λέγων ταῦτα καθῆκε

S: “What is this, Cebes? Have you and Simmias not heard about such matters through your association with Philolaus?”¹¹

CE: “Not in any detail, Socrates.”

61d

S: “Well, I too am recounting what I have heard about these issues. However, I will not begrudge you an account of whatever I happen to have heard. For it is perhaps especially appropriate for someone about to depart to the next world to consider the sojourn there and tell stories about what we think it will be like. Indeed, what else could one do until the time when the sun sets?”

τὰ σκέλη ἐπὶ τὴν γῆν, καὶ καθεζόμενος οὕτως ἤδη τὰ λοιπὰ διελέγετο. ἦρετο οὖν αὐτόν ὁ Κέρβης· πῶς τοῦτο λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸ μὴ θεμιτὸν εἶναι ἑαυτὸν βιάζεσθαι, ἐθέλειν δ' ἂν τῷ ἀποθνήσκοντι τὸν φιλόσοφον ἔπεσθαι; τί δέ, ὦ Κέρβης; οὐκ ἀκηκόατε σύ τε καὶ Σιμμίας περὶ τῶν τοιούτων Φιλολάῳ συγγεγονότες; οὐδέν γε σαφές, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ ἐγὼ ἐξ ἀκοῆς περὶ αὐτῶν λέγω· ἃ μὲν οὖν τυγχάνω ἀκηκοὺς φθόνος οὐδεὶς λέγειν. καὶ γὰρ ἴσως

61e

CE: “Socrates, on what precise basis is it said not to be lawful for someone to kill themselves? I have also heard Philolaus saying what you have just said when he was living among us, and I have heard from a number of others since that one should not do this. But I have never yet heard anything clear concerning these issues from anyone.”

καὶ μάλιστα πρέπει μέλλοντα ἐκεῖσε ἀποδημεῖν διασκοπεῖν τε καὶ μυθολογεῖν περὶ τῆς ἀποδημίας τῆς ἐκεῖ, ποίαν τινὰ αὐτὴν οἰόμεθα εἶναι· τί γὰρ ἂν τις καὶ ποιοῖ ἄλλο ἐν τῷ μέχρι ἡλίου δυσμῶν χρόνῳ; κατὰ τί δὴ οὖν ποτε οὐ φασι θεμιτὸν εἶναι αὐτόν ἑαυτὸν ἀποκτείνουσι, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἤδη γὰρ ἔγωγε, ὅπερ νυνδὴ σὺ ἤρου, καὶ Φιλολάου

ἤκουσα, ὅτε παρ' ἡμῖν διητᾶτο, ἤδη δὲ καὶ ἄλλων τινῶν, ὡς οὐ δέοι τοῦτο ποιεῖν· σαφὲς δὲ περὶ αὐτῶν οὐδενὸς πώποτε οὐδὲν ἀκήκοα.

62a

S: “Then you should bestir yourself,” he said, “for perhaps then you will actually hear. However, it may perhaps seem surprising to you that this situation alone, in contrast to all others, admits of no exceptions and is never like other personal circumstances. Sometimes, for some people, it is better to be dead than to be alive. But if they are better off dead, perhaps it seems surprising to you that it is unholy for those very people themselves to act beneficially towards themselves, rather than waiting for another to perform that service.”

62a

And Cebes smiled gently and exclaimed in his own dialect,

ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλὰ προθυμεῖσθαι χρή, ἔφη· τάχα γὰρ ἂν καὶ ἀκούσαις. ἴσως μέντοι θαυμαστόν σοι φανεῖται εἰ τοῦτο μόνον τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάντων ἀπλοῦν ἐστίν, καὶ οὐδέποτε τυγχάνει τῷ ἀνθρώπῳ, ὥσπερ καὶ τᾶλλα, ἔστιν ὅτε καὶ οἷς βέλτιον ὂν τεθνάναι ἢ ζῆν, οἷς δὲ βέλτιον τεθνάναι, θαυμαστόν ἴσως σοι φαίνεται εἰ τούτοις τοῖς ἀνθρώποις μὴ ὅσιον αὐτοὺς ἑαυτοὺς εὖ ποιεῖν, ἀλλὰ ἄλλον δεῖ περιμένειν εὐεργέτην. καὶ ὁ Κέβης ἡρέμα ἐπιγελάσας, Ἰττω Ζεὺς, ἔφη, τῇ αὐτοῦ φωνῇ εἰπών.

CE: “Zeus be my witness!”

62b

S: “Yes, indeed,” said Socrates, “it may sound illogical when expressed in that way. However, in spite of that, perhaps it does make some sense. The account about these matters, uttered in secret, declares that we humans are under guardianship and people should not free themselves from it or run away. This seems important to me, though it is not easy to understand. In any case, Cebes, I do think this is well expressed. The gods are our guardians and we humans are among the possessions of the gods. Do you not think so too?”

καὶ γὰρ ἂν δόξειεν, ἔφη ὁ Σωκράτης, οὕτω γ' εἶναι ἄλογον· οὐ μέντοι ἀλλ' ἴσως γ' ἔχει τινὰ λόγον. ὁ μὲν οὖν ἐν ἀπορρήτοις λεγόμενος περὶ

αὐτῶν λόγος, ὡς ἔν τινι φρουρᾷ ἔσμεν οἱ ἄνθρωποι καὶ οὐ δεῖ δὴ ἑαυτὸν ἐκ ταύτης λύειν οὐδ' ἀποδιδράσκειν, μέγας τέ τίς μοι φαίνεται καὶ οὐ ῥάδιος διιδεῖν· οὐ μέντοι ἀλλὰ τόδε γέ μοι δοκεῖ, ὦ Κέβης, εὖ λέγεσθαι, τὸ θεοὺς εἶναι ἡμῶν τοὺς ἐπιμελουμένους καὶ ἡμᾶς τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἔν τῶν κτημάτων τοῖς θεοῖς εἶναι. ἢ σοὶ οὐ δοκεῖ οὕτως; ἔμοιγε, φησὶν ὁ Κέβης.

CE: “I do, indeed,” said Cebes.

62c

S: “Well, then,” said he, “if one of your own possessions were to kill itself, with no indication from you that you wanted it dead, would you not be angry with it? And would you not punish it if you could do so?”

οὐκοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς, καὶ σὺ ἂν τῶν σαυτοῦ κτημάτων εἴ τι αὐτὸ ἑαυτὸ ἀποκτείνουσι, μὴ σημῆναντός σου ὅτι βούλει αὐτὸ τεθνάναι, χαλεπαίνεις ἂν αὐτῷ καί, εἴ τινα ἔχοις τιμωρίαν, τιμωροῖο ἄν; πάνυ γ', ἔφη. ἴσως τοίνυν ταύτη οὐκ ἄλογον μὴ πρότερον αὐτὸν ἀποκτείνουσι δεῖν, πρὶν ἀνάγκην τινὰ θεὸς ἐπιπέμψῃ, ὥσπερ καὶ τὴν νῦν ἡμῖν παροῦσαν. ἀλλ' εἰκός, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, τοῦτό γε φαίνεται. ὁ μέντοι νυνδὴ ἔλεγες, τὸ τοὺς φιλοσόφους ῥαδίως ἂν ἐθέλειν

CE: “Very much so,” he replied.

S: “Perhaps then, in this sense, it is not illogical to say that someone should not kill themselves until a god sends some necessity, such as my present predicament.”

62d

CE: “Well,” said Cebes, “that appears reasonable anyway. However, when you said just now that the wish to die comes readily to philosophers, that, dear Socrates, sounded strange, especially if what we were saying just now is reasonable, that the god is our guardian and we are his possessions. For it does not make sense for the wisest folk to be untroubled on departing from this care in which the gods, the very best guardians of beings, watch over them. For I presume they will not believe that they will take better care of themselves once they are free. Now, an unreasonable person might think that he should flee from his

master, and he would not figure out that one should not flee from the good but should stay as long as possible, and so he might make an unreasonable escape. However, the reasonable person would presumably desire to be constantly in the presence of someone better than himself. So on this basis, Socrates, the situation is likely to be the opposite of what you just said: it is appropriate for the wise to be troubled at the prospect of death and for the foolish to rejoice.”

ἀποθνήσκειν, ἔοικεν τοῦτο, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀτόπῳ, εἴπερ ὁ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν εὐλόγως ἔχει, τὸ θεόν τε εἶναι τὸν ἐπιμελούμενον ἡμῶν καὶ ἡμᾶς ἐκείνου κτήματα εἶναι. τὸ γὰρ μὴ ἀγανακτεῖν τοὺς φρονιμωτάτους ἐκ ταύτης τῆς θεραπείας ἀπρόντας, ἐν ᾗ ἐπιστατοῦσιν αὐτῶν οἵπερ ἄριστοί εἰσιν τῶν ὄντων ἐπιστάται, θεοί, οὐκ ἔχει λόγον· οὐ γάρ που αὐτός γε αὐτοῦ οἴεται ἄμεινον ἐπιμελήσεσθαι ἐλεύθερος γενόμενος. ἀλλ’ ἀνόητος μὲν ἄνθρωπος τάχ’ ἂν οἰηθείη ταῦτα, φευκτέον εἶναι ἀπὸ τοῦ δεσπότη, καὶ οὐκ ἂν λογίζοιτο ὅτι οὐ δεῖ ἀπὸ γε τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ φεύγειν ἀλλ’ ὅτι μάλιστα παραμένειν, διὸ ἀλογίστως ἂν φεύγοι· ὁ δὲ νοῦν ἔχων ἐπιθυμοῖ που ἂν αἰεὶ εἶναι παρὰ τῷ αὐτοῦ βελτίονι. καίτοι οὕτως, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸναντίον εἶναι εἰκὸς ἢ ὁ νυνδὴ ἐλέγετο· τοὺς μὲν γὰρ φρονίμους ἀγανακτεῖν ἀποθνήσκοντας πρέπει, τοὺς δὲ ἄφρονας χαίρειν. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀκούσας οὖν ὁ Σωκράτης ἡσθῆναι τέ μοι ἔδοξε τῇ τοῦ

63a

Now, I thought Socrates was pleased with Cebes’ analysis, and he looked at us and said,

63a

S: “Cebes is always scrutinising some argument or other and is not very willing to be persuaded as soon as someone makes any assertion.”

63a

Si: Then Simmias said, “Well, on this occasion anyway, I believe that Cebes has a point. For why would people who are truly wise wish to flee from masters who are better than themselves, and take their leave of them so readily? And Cebes seems to be directing his argument at

you because you are going so readily, leaving us and those good rulers whom, you agree, are gods.”

κέβητος πραγματεία, καὶ ἐπιβλέψας εἰς ἡμᾶς, αἰεῖ τοι, ἔφη, ὁ Κέβης λόγους τινὰς ἀνερευνᾷ, καὶ οὐ πάνυ εὐθέως ἐθέλει πείθεσθαι ὅτι ἂν τις εἴπῃ. καὶ ὁ Σιμμίας, ἀλλὰ μήν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, νῦν γέ μοι δοκεῖ τι καὶ αὐτῷ λέγειν Κέβης· τί γὰρ ἂν βουλόμενοι ἄνδρες σοφοὶ ὡς ἀληθῶς δεσπότης ἀμείνους αὐτῶν φεύγοιεν καὶ ῥαδίως ἀπαλλάττοντο αὐτῶν; καὶ μοι δοκεῖ Κέβης εἰς σὲ τείνειν τὸν λόγον, ὅτι οὕτω ῥαδίως φέρεις καὶ ἡμᾶς ἀπολείπων καὶ ἄρχοντας ἀγαθοὺς, ὡς αὐτὸς ὁμολογεῖς, θεοὺς.

63b

S: “What you are saying is fair,” he replied, “for I think you mean that I must defend myself against these charges as if I were in a court of law.”

SI: “Yes, very much so,” said Simmias.

63b

S: “Come on, then,” he said, “and I shall try to conduct my defence more persuasively in front of you than I did in front of the jurors. Indeed, Simmias and Cebes, if I did not believe, firstly, that I would be going to various wise and good gods, and secondly, to men who have died, better men than those who are here, I would be wrong to be untroubled by death.

δίκαια, ἔφη, λέγετε· οἶμαι γὰρ ὑμᾶς λέγειν ὅτι χρή με πρὸς ταῦτα ἀπολογήσασθαι ὥσπερ ἐν δικαστηρίῳ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. φέρε δὴ, ἢ δ' ὅς, πειραθῶ πιθανώτερον πρὸς ὑμᾶς ἀπολογήσασθαι ἢ πρὸς τοὺς δικαστάς. ἐγὼ γάρ, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, εἰ μὲν μὴ ὥμην ἤξειν πρῶτον μὲν παρὰ θεοὺς ἄλλους σοφοὺς τε καὶ ἀγαθοὺς, ἔπειτα καὶ παρ' ἀνθρώπους τετελευτηκότας ἀμείνους τῶν ἐνθάδε, ἡδίκουν ἂν οὐκ ἀγανακτῶν τῷ θανάτῳ· νῦν δὲ εὖ ἴστε ὅτι παρ'

63c

S: “Now, although I am hoping to arrive among good men, please note that I would not assert this very confidently. However, rest assured that if I were to assert anything else of this sort with confidence, I would also say that I am going to gods who are perfectly good masters.

So on this basis I am not so troubled by all this, but am quite hopeful that there is something for those who have died, and, as the ancient saying puts it, ‘at least it is much better for those who are good than for those who are bad’.”

ἄνδρας τε ἐλπίζω ἀφίξεσθαι ἀγαθούς — καὶ τοῦτο μὲν οὐκ ἂν πάνυ δισχυρισαίμην — ὅτι μέντοι παρὰ θεοὺς δεσπότης πάνυ ἀγαθούς ἦξειν, εὖ ἴστε ὅτι εἴπερ τι ἄλλο τῶν τοιούτων δισχυρισαίμην ἂν καὶ τοῦτο. ὥστε διὰ ταῦτα οὐχ ὁμοίως ἀγανακτῶ, ἀλλ’ εὐελπίς εἰμι εἶναι τι τοῖς τετελευτηκόσι καί, ὥσπερ γε καὶ πάλαι λέγεται, πολὺ ἄμεινον τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς ἢ τοῖς κακοῖς. τί οὖν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, ὦ Σώκρατες; αὐτὸς ἔχων τὴν διάνοιαν ταύτην ἐν νῶ ἔχεις ἀπιέναι, ἢ κἂν ἡμῖν μεταδοίης;

63d

SI: “What now, Socrates?” said Simmias. “Do you intend to depart keeping this understanding to yourself or would you be prepared to share it with us? For it seems to me that this is something good to be shared with us too, and at the same time it will act as your defence if you persuade us of what you are saying.”

63d

S: “In that case, I shall try,” he said. “But first, I think Crito here wanted to speak a while ago. Let’s ask him what he wants.”

κοινὸν γὰρ δὴ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ καὶ ἡμῖν εἶναι ἀγαθὸν τοῦτο, καὶ ἅμα σοι ἡ ἀπολογία ἔσται, ἐὰν ἅπερ λέγεις ἡμᾶς πείσης. ἀλλὰ πειράσομαι, ἔφη. πρῶτον δὲ Κρίτωνα τόνδε σκεψώμεθα τί ἐστὶν ὃ βούλεσθαί μοι δοκεῖ πάλαι εἰπεῖν. τί δέ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη ὁ Κρίτων, ἄλλο γε ἢ πάλαι μοι λέγει ὁ μέλλων σοι δώσειν τὸ φάρμακον ὅτι χρή σοι φράζειν ὥς ἐλάχιστα διαλέγεσθαι; φησὶ γὰρ θερμαίνεσθαι μᾶλλον διαλεγομένους, δεῖν δὲ οὐδὲν τοιοῦτον προσφέρειν

CR: “Socrates,” said Crito, “it is just that the man who is going to give you the poison has been saying to me for some time that you should be told to converse as little as possible, for he says that people who converse become more heated, and this sort of thing should be avoided before the poison is to be administered. Otherwise, people who do this

are sometimes compelled to drink the poison twice or even three times.”

63e

S: And Socrates replied, “Do not mind him; just let him attend to his own duty and give the poison twice, and, if necessary, three times.”

CR: “Yes, I was quite sure you would say that,” said Crito, “but he has been bothering me about these things for some time.”

63e

S: “Let him be,” Socrates replied. “And instead, I now want to present an argument to you jurors as to why it seems likely to me that a man who has really spent his life in philosophy is confident when facing death, and is hopeful that he will obtain enormous benefits in the next world once he dies. Of course, Simmias and Cebes, I shall now try to explain how this might be the case. For most people are likely to be unaware that those who engage properly in philosophy are themselves in pursuit of nothing except dying and being dead. Now, if this is true, it would surely be strange for someone who was eager all his life for this alone to be troubled when he actually attained what he had pursued so eagerly for so long.”

τῷ φαρμάκῳ· εἰ δὲ μή, ἐνίστε ἀναγκάζεσθαι καὶ δις καὶ τρίς πίνειν τοὺς τι τοιοῦτον ποιοῦντας. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης, ἔα, ἔφη, χαίρειν αὐτόν· ἀλλὰ μόνον τὸ ἑαυτοῦ παρασκευάζετω ὡς καὶ δις δώσων, ἐὰν δὲ δέῃ, καὶ τρίς. ἀλλὰ σχεδὸν μὲν τι ἤδη, ἔφη ὁ Κρίτων· ἀλλὰ μοι πάλαι πράγματα παρέχει. ἔα αὐτόν, ἔφη. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλ' ὑμῖν δὴ τοῖς δικασταῖς βούλομαι ἤδη τὸν λόγον ἀποδοῦναι, ὥς μοι φαίνεται εἰκότως ἀνὴρ τῷ ὄντι ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ διατρίψας τὸν βίον θαρρεῖν μέλλων

64a

Then Simmias laughed and said,

64a

SI: “By Zeus, Socrates, I am not really in laughing humour just now, but you have made me laugh. Yes, I believe that most people, on hearing this, would think you have made a very good point about

philosophers, and our own people would agree emphatically that those who engage in philosophy really do have a longing for death, and that this is the fate they deserve to suffer! They are quite aware of that.”

ἀποθανεῖσθαι καὶ εὐελπὶς εἶναι ἐκεῖ μέγιστα οἴεσθαι ἀγαθὰ ἐπειδὴν τελευτήσῃ. πῶς ἂν οὖν δὴ τοῦθ' οὕτως ἔχοι, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, ἐγὼ πειράσομαι φράσαι. κινδυνεύουσι γὰρ ὅσοι τυγχάνουσιν ὀρθῶς ἀπτόμενοι φιλοσοφίας λεληθέναι τοὺς ἄλλους ὅτι οὐδὲν ἄλλο αὐτοὶ ἐπιτηδεύουσιν ἢ ἀποθνήσκειν τε καὶ τεθνάναι. εἰ οὖν τοῦτο ἀληθές, ἄτοπον δήπου ἂν εἴη προθυμεῖσθαι μὲν ἐν παντὶ τῷ βίῳ μηδὲν ἄλλο ἢ τοῦτο, ἡκοντος δὲ δὴ αὐτοῦ ἀγανακτεῖν ὃ πάλαι προθυμοῦντό τε καὶ ἐπετήδευον. καὶ ὁ Σιμμίας γελάσας, νῆ τὸν Δία, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες,

64b

S: “And in a sense, Simmias, what they are saying would be true, except for their claim that they are aware. For they are unaware of the way in which true philosophers desire death, or the sense in which they deserve to die, or what kind of death it is. Indeed, we should just speak among ourselves”, he said, “and bid farewell to those fellows. Do we think that death is something?”

οὐ πάνυ γέ με νυνδὴ γελασεῖοντα ἐποίησας γελάσαι. οἶμαι γὰρ ἂν τοὺς πολλοὺς αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἀκούσαντας δοκεῖν εὖ πάνυ εἰρησθαι εἰς τοὺς φιλοσοφοῦντας — καὶ συμφάναι ἂν τοὺς μὲν παρ' ἡμῖν ἀνθρώπους καὶ πάνυ — ὅτι τῷ ὄντι οἱ φιλοσοφοῦντες θανατῶσι, καὶ σφᾶς γε οὐ λεληθάσιν ὅτι ἄξιοί εἰσιν τοῦτο πάσχειν. καὶ ἀληθῆ γ' ἂν λέγοιεν, ὦ Σιμμία, πλὴν γε τοῦ σφᾶς μὴ λεληθέναι. λέληθεν γὰρ αὐτοὺς ἥ τε θανατῶσι καὶ ἥ ἄξιοί εἰσιν θανάτου καὶ οἷου θανάτου οἱ ὥς ἀληθῶς φιλόσοφοι.

Si: “Very much so,” replied Simmias.

S: “Is it anything other than the separation of the soul from the body? And is this what it is to be dead? The body is separated from the soul and is just by itself, while the soul, having been separated from the body, is just by itself? Is death anything other than this?”

SI: “It is nothing but this,” he replied.

64c

S: “Now, good man, consider whether your views are the same as mine. Indeed, from these, I believe we shall come to know more about the issues we are investigating. Does it appear to you that a person who loves wisdom would be serious about such so-called pleasures as eating and drinking?”

εἵπωμεν γάρ, ἔφη, πρὸς ἡμᾶς αὐτούς, χαίρειν εἰπόντες ἐκείνοις· ἡγούμεθα τι τὸν θάνατον εἶναι; πάννυ γε, ἔφη ὑπολαβὼν ὁ Σιμμίας. ἄρα μὴ ἄλλο τι ἢ τὴν τῆς ψυχῆς ἀπὸ τοῦ σώματος ἀπαλλαγὴν; καὶ εἶναι τοῦτο τὸ τεθνάναι, χωρὶς μὲν ἀπὸ τῆς ψυχῆς ἀπαλλαγὴν αὐτὸ καθ’ αὐτὸ τὸ σῶμα γεγονέναι, χωρὶς δὲ τὴν ψυχὴν ἀπὸ τοῦ σώματος ἀπαλλαγεῖσαν αὐτὴν καθ’ αὐτὴν εἶναι; ἄρα μὴ ἄλλο τι ἢ ὁ θάνατος ἢ τοῦτο; οὐκ, ἀλλὰ τοῦτο, ἔφη. σκέψαι δὴ, ὦγαθέ, ἐὰν ἄρα καὶ σοὶ συνδοκῇ ἅπερ ἐμοί·

64d

SI: “Not in the least, Socrates,” replied Simmias.

ἐκ γὰρ τούτων μᾶλλον οἶμαι ἡμᾶς εἴσεσθαι περὶ ὧν σκοποῦμεν. φαίνεται σοι φιλοσόφου ἀνδρὸς εἶναι ἐσπουδακέναι περὶ τὰς ἡδονὰς καλουμένας τὰς τοιάσδε, οἷον σιτίων τε καὶ ποτῶν; ἥκιστα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. τί δὲ τὰς τῶν ἀφροδισίων; οὐδαμῶς. τί δὲ τὰς ἄλλας τὰς περὶ τὸ σῶμα θεραπείας; δοκεῖ σοι ἐντίμους ἡγεῖσθαι ὁ τοιοῦτος; οἷον ἱματίων διαφερόντων κτήσεις καὶ ὑποδημάτων καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους καλλωπισμοὺς τοὺς περὶ τὸ σῶμα πότερον τιμᾶν δοκεῖ σοι ἢ ἀτιμάζειν,

S: “What about sexual pleasures?”

SI: “Not at all.”

S: “And what about the other indulgences associated with the body? Do you think people of this sort would regard them as valuable? I mean, would they value the acquisition of distinctive clothing or shoes and

other adornments of the body, or do you think they would disregard them and partake of them only to the extent really necessary?"

64e

SI: "I think the true philosopher would disregard them."

καθ' ὅσον μὴ πολλὴ ἀνάγκη μετέχειν αὐτῶν; ἀτιμάζειν ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ἔφη, ὃ γε ὡς ἀληθῶς φιλόσοφος. οὐκοῦν ὅλως δοκεῖ σοι, ἔφη, ἢ τοῦ τοιούτου πραγματεία οὐ περὶ τὸ σῶμα εἶναι, ἀλλὰ καθ' ὅσον δύναται ἀφεστάναι αὐτοῦ, πρὸς δὲ τὴν ψυχὴν τετράφθαι; ἔμοιγε. ΦΑΙΔ. ἄρ' οὖν πρῶτον μὲν ἐν τοῖς τοιούτοις δῆλός ἐστιν ὁ

S: "Don't you think," he said, "in general, that the preoccupation of such a person is not about the body, but is directed away from it as much as possible, and turned towards the soul?"

SI: "I do indeed."

65a

S: "So is it obvious, in the first place, that in such matters the philosopher exceeds all others in freeing the soul, as much as possible, from communion with the body?"

φιλόσοφος ἀπολύων ὅτι μάλιστα τὴν ψυχὴν ἀπὸ τῆς τοῦ σώματος κοινωνίας διαφερόντως τῶν ἄλλων ἀνθρώπων; φαίνεται. καὶ δοκεῖ γέ που, ὦ Σιμμία, τοῖς πολλοῖς ἀνθρώποις ᾧ μὴδὲν ἡδὺ τῶν τοιούτων μὴδὲ μετέχει αὐτῶν οὐκ ἄξιον εἶναι ζῆν, ἀλλ' ἐγγύς τι τείνειν τοῦ τεθνάναι ὁ μὴδὲν φροντίζων τῶν ἡδονῶν αἱ διὰ τοῦ σώματός εἰσιν. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ἀληθῆ λέγεις. τί δὲ δὴ περὶ αὐτὴν τὴν τῆς φρονήσεως κτῆσιν; πότερον ἐμπόδιον τὸ σῶμα ἢ οὐ, ἐάν τις αὐτὸ ἐν τῇ ζητήσει

SI: "So it appears."

S: "And it seems to most people, I presume, Simmias, that someone to whom nothing of this sort is pleasant, and who does not partake thereof, does not deserve to be alive, and that a person who thinks nothing of the pleasures which derive from the body is well-nigh dead."

SI: “Yes, what you are saying is certainly true.”

65b

S: “But what about the acquisition of wisdom itself? Is the body an impediment or not if it is brought along to assist in the search? My question goes something like this: do sight and hearing afford men any truth? Or is there truth in the sort of things even the poets are constantly repeating to us, that we neither see nor hear anything accurately? And, indeed, if these two bodily senses are neither accurate nor clear, it would be idle to consider the others, for they are all somehow inferior to these two, or doesn’t it seem so to you?”

κοινωνὸν συμπαραλαμβάνη; οἷον τὸ τοιόνδε λέγω· ἄρα ἔχει ἀλήθειάν τινα ὄψις τε καὶ ἀκοή τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ἢ τά γε τοιαῦτα καὶ οἱ ποιηταὶ ἡμῖν ἀεὶ θρυλοῦσιν, ὅτι οὐτ’ ἀκούομεν ἀκριβὲς οὐδὲν οὔτε ὀρώμεν; καίτοι εἰ αὗται τῶν περὶ τὸ σῶμα αἰσθήσεων μὴ ἀκριβεῖς εἰσιν μηδὲ σαφεῖς, σχολῇ αἱ γε ἄλλαι· πᾶσαι γάρ που τούτων φαυλότεραί εἰσιν. ἢ σοὶ οὐ δοκοῦσιν; πάνυ μὲν οὔν, ἔφη. πότε οὔν, ἢ δ’ ὅς, ἢ ψυχὴ τῆς ἀληθείας ἄπτεται; ὅταν μὲν γὰρ μετὰ τοῦ σώματος ἐπιχειρῇ τι σκοπεῖν, δῆλον ὅτι τότε ἐξαπατᾶται ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ.

SI: “It does seem so to me.”

65c

S: “So when does the soul encounter the truth? For whenever it attempts to contemplate anything in conjunction with the body, in that case it is obviously deceived by the body.”

SI: “What you say is true.”

S: “Well, isn’t it in reasoning rather than anywhere else that any of the things that are, become obvious to it?”

SI: “Yes.”

65c

S: “But presumably, then, the soul reasons most beautifully whenever nothing else bothers it, neither hearing nor sight nor pain nor any pleasure, and it is just by itself to the greatest extent possible, bids the

body farewell, has as little communion and contact with it as it can, and reaches towards what is.”

ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ἄρ’ οὖν οὐκ ἐν τῷ λογίζεσθαι εἴπερ που ἄλλοθι κατάδηλον αὐτῇ γίγνεται τι τῶν ὄντων; ναί. λογίζεται δέ γέ που τότε κάλλιστα, ὅταν αὐτὴν τούτων μηδὲν παραλυπῇ, μήτε ἀκοὴ μήτε ὄψις μήτε ἀλγηδὼν μηδὲ τις ἡδονή, ἀλλ’ ὅτι μάλιστα αὐτὴ καθ’ αὐτὴν γίγνηται ἕως αὖ χαίρειν τὸ σῶμα, καὶ καθ’ ὅσον δύναται μὴ κοινωνοῦσα αὐτῷ μηδ’ ἀπτομένη ὀρέγεται τοῦ ὄντος. ἔστι ταῦτα. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἐνταῦθα ἢ τοῦ φιλοσόφου ψυχὴ μάλιστα

SI: “This is so.”

65d

S: “Then, is it here too that the soul of the philosopher shows most disregard for the body, flees from it, and strives to be just by itself?”

SI: “So it appears.”

S: “But Simmias, what about this? Do we say that there is something just itself, or nothing is?”

SI: “By Zeus, we do indeed say that there is.”

S: “And something is beautiful and is itself good?”

SI: “How could there not be?”

S: “Now, have you ever yet seen anything of this kind with your eyes?”

SI: “Not at all.”

65d

S: “But have you ever contacted them through the body by means of any other sense? And I am referring to all of them, for example, size, health, strength and all the others. In short, I am speaking of the being of them all, what each of them happens to be. Can the very truth of them be contemplated by means of the body? Or is it the case that whoever is best and most diligently prepared to understand each of these, in itself, is the person who will come closest to the knowledge of them?”

ἀτιμάζει τὸ σῶμα καὶ φεύγει ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ, ζητεῖ δὲ αὐτὴ καθ’ αὐτὴν γίγνεσθαι; φαίνεται. τί δὲ δὴ τὰ τοιάδε, ὦ Σιμμία; φαμέν τι εἶναι δίκαιον αὐτὸ ἢ οὐδέν; φαμέν μέντοι νῆ Δία. καὶ αὖ καλόν γέ τι καὶ ἀγαθόν; πῶς δ’ οὐ; ἤδη οὖν πώποτε τι τῶν τοιούτων τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς εἶδες; οὐδαμῶς, ἦ δ’ ὅς. ἀλλ’ ἄλλη τινὶ αἰσθήσει τῶν διὰ τοῦ σώματος ἐφήψω αὐτῶν; λέγω δὲ περὶ πάντων, οἷον μεγέθους πέρι, ὑγιείας, ἰσχύος, καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἐνὶ λόγῳ ἀπάντων τῆς οὐσίας ὃ

Si: “Yes, certainly.”

65e

S: “Now, wouldn’t a person undertake this with the utmost purity if he were to make his approach to each of them with the mind alone to the greatest possible extent? Without introducing sight into the mental activity, or dragging in any other sense perception whatsoever along with the reasoning, but making use of the mind just by itself, without admixture, wouldn’t he take up the hunt for each of the things that are, as free as possible from eyes and ears and, in effect, from all that is bodily, for this disturbs the soul and does not allow it to acquire truth and wisdom whenever it communes with the body? Won’t this person, Simmias, and no other, attain what is?”

τυγχάνει ἕκαστον ὃν ἄρα διὰ τοῦ σώματος αὐτῶν τὸ ἀληθέστατον θεωρεῖται, ἢ ὧδε ἔχει· ὃς ἂν μάλιστα ἡμῶν καὶ ἀκριβέστατα παρασκευάσῃται αὐτὸ ἕκαστον διανοηθῆναι περὶ οὗ σκοπεῖ, οὗτος ἂν ἐγγύτατα ᾖ τοῦ γινῶναι ἕκαστον; πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΦΑΙΔ. ἄρ’ οὖν ἐκεῖνος ἂν τοῦτο ποιήσῃεν καθαρώτατα ὅστις ὅτι μάλιστα αὐτῇ τῇ διανοίᾳ ᾖ ἐφ’ ἕκαστον, μήτε τιν’ ὄψιν παρατιθέμενος ἐν τῷ διανοεῖσθαι μήτε τινὰ ἄλλην

66a

Si: “Socrates, what you are saying is extraordinarily true,” replied Simmias.

66a

S: “Then,” he said, “the genuine philosophers must form a particular opinion based upon these conclusions so that they say something of

this sort to one another: ‘Yes, a sort of narrow path seems to be leading us on to side with reason in the enquiry, because as long as we have the body, and our soul is compounded with such badness, we shall never satisfactorily obtain what we desire, and this we say is the truth. Indeed, the body brings countless distractions upon us just because it needs sustenance. What is more, if any illnesses befall it, they impede our hunt for what is. And the body also fills us with loves, desires, fears, a whole range of imaginings, and a lot of foolishness, so that, as they say, and it really is true, we never ever acquire any wisdom at all through its agency. And in fact, it is only the body and its desires which bring about wars, insurrections and fighting. For all wars arise on account of the possession of wealth, and we are compelled to acquire wealth because of the body, as we are slaves in its service. And because of all these factors, we become too busy to engage in philosophy. Worst of all, even if we do get time, free from its demands, and turn towards some philosophic enquiry, the body keeps intruding into the enquiry in all sorts of ways, bringing tribulation and agitation, and confounding us so that we are unable to see truth clearly because of it. But, in fact, this argument has shown us that if we are ever going to have pure knowledge of anything, we must be quit of the body and behold the objects themselves, with the soul itself. We claim to be lovers of wisdom, and we shall obtain what we desire and what we claim to love, when we die, as the argument indicates, but not while we are alive.

αἴσθησιν ἐφέλκων μηδεμίαν μετὰ τοῦ λογισμοῦ, ἀλλ’ αὐτῇ καθ’ αὐτήν εἰλικρινεῖ τῇ διανοίᾳ χρώμενος αὐτὸ καθ’ αὐτὸ εἰλικρινὲς ἕκαστον ἐπιχειροῖ θηρεύειν τῶν ὄντων, ἀπαλλαγεῖς ὅτι μάλιστα ὀφθαλμῶν τε καὶ ὠτῶν καὶ ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν σύμπαντος τοῦ σώματος, ὡς ταράττοντος καὶ οὐκ ἐῶντος τὴν ψυχὴν κτήσασθαι ἀλήθειάν τε καὶ φρόνησιν ὅταν κοινωνῇ; ἄρ’ οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν, ὃ Σιμμία, εἴπερ τις καὶ ἄλλος ὁ τευξόμενος τοῦ ὄντος; ὑπερφυῶς, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, ὡς ἀληθῆ λέγεις, ὃ Σώκρατες. οὐκοῦν ἀνάγκη, ἔφη, ἐκ πάντων τούτων παρίστασθαι δόξαν τοιάνδε τινὰ τοῖς γνησίως φιλοσόφοις, ὥστε καὶ πρὸς ἀλλήλους

τοιαῦτα ἄττα λέγειν, ὅτι κινδυνεύει τοι ὥσπερ ἀτραπὸς τις ἐκφέρειν ἡμᾶς μετὰ τοῦ λόγου ἐν τῇ σκέψει, ὅτι, ἕως ἂν τὸ σῶμα ἔχωμεν καὶ συμπεφυρμένη ᾗ ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ μετὰ τοιούτου κακοῦ, οὐ μὴ ποτε κτησώμεθα ἱκανῶς οὗ ἐπιθυμοῦμεν· φαμέν δὲ τοῦτο εἶναι τὸ ἀληθές. μυρίας μὲν γὰρ ἡμῖν ἀσχολίας παρέχει τὸ σῶμα διὰ τὴν ἀναγκαίαν τροφήν· ἔτι δέ, ἂν τινες νόσοι προσπέσωσιν, ἐμποδίζουσιν ἡμῶν τὴν τοῦ ὄντος θήραν. ἐρώτων δὲ καὶ ἐπιθυμιῶν καὶ φόβων καὶ εἰδώλων παντοδαπῶν καὶ φλυαρίας ἐμπύμπλησιν ἡμᾶς πολλῆς, ὥστε τὸ λεγόμενον ὡς ἀληθῶς τῷ ὄντι ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ οὐδὲ φρονῆσαι ἡμῖν ἐγγίγνεται οὐδέποτε οὐδέν. καὶ γὰρ πολέμους καὶ στάσεις καὶ μάχας οὐδὲν ἄλλο παρέχει ἢ τὸ σῶμα καὶ αἱ τούτου ἐπιθυμίαι. διὰ γὰρ τὴν τῶν χρημάτων κτῆσιν πάντες οἱ πόλεμοι γίνονται, τὰ δὲ χρήματα ἀναγκαζόμεθα κτᾶσθαι διὰ τὸ σῶμα, δουλεύοντες τῇ τούτου θεραπείᾳ· καὶ ἐκ τούτου ἀσχολίαν ἄγομεν φιλοσοφίας περὶ διὰ πάντα ταῦτα. τὸ δ’ ἔσχατον πάντων ὅτι, ἐάν τις ἡμῖν καὶ σχολὴ γένηται ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ καὶ τραπώμεθα πρὸς τὸ σκοπεῖν τι, ἐν ταῖς ζητήσεσιν αὐτὸ πανταχοῦ παραπίπτον θόρυβον παρέχει καὶ ταραχὴν καὶ ἐκπλήττει, ὥστε μὴ δύνασθαι ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ καθορᾶν τάληθές. ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι ἡμῖν δέδεικται ὅτι, εἰ μέλλομέν ποτε καθαρῶς τι εἴσεσθαι,

66e

S: “Indeed, if it is impossible to know anything purely whilst accompanied by the body, there are two possibilities. Either it is impossible to acquire the knowledge at all, or it happens after death, for then, and not until then, will the soul be just by itself, separate from the body. And while we are living in the body, in this way we shall, it seems, be closest to acquiring knowledge when we have the least interaction and communion with it, only what is absolutely necessary and are not contaminated with its nature, but purify ourselves from it, until God himself releases us. And in this way, being pure and liberated from the foolishness of the body, we are likely to be with those who are like this, and we shall know all that is pure through ourselves alone. And this, I daresay, is the truth: that the impure has no contact with the pure for that would not be lawful.’ I

believe, Simmias, that this is the sort of thing which all those with a proper love of learning will think and say to each other. Is that how it seems to you?"

ἀπαλλακτέον αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτῇ τῇ ψυχῇ θεατέον αὐτὰ τὰ πράγματα· καὶ τότε, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἡμῖν ἔσται οὗ ἐπιθυμοῦμέν τε καὶ φαμεν ἐρασταὶ εἶναι, φρονήσεως, ἐπειδὴν τελευτήσωμεν, ὡς ὁ λόγος σημαίνει, ζῶσιν δὲ οὐ. ΦΑΙΔ. εἰ γὰρ μὴ οἷόν τε μετὰ τοῦ σώματος μηδὲν καθαρῶς γινῶναι, δυοῖν θάτερον, ἢ οὐδαμοῦ ἔστιν κτήσασθαι τὸ εἰδέναι ἢ τελευτήσασιν· τότε γὰρ αὐτὴ καθ' αὐτὴν ἡ ψυχὴ ἔσται χωρὶς τοῦ σώματος, πρότερον δ' οὐ. καὶ ἐν ᾧ ἂν ζῶμεν, οὕτως, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐγγυτάτῳ ἐσόμεθα τοῦ εἰδέναι, ἐὰν ὅτι μάλιστα μηδὲν ὁμιλῶμεν τῷ σώματι μηδὲ κοινωνῶμεν, ὅτι μὴ πᾶσα ἀνάγκη, μηδὲ ἀναπιμπλώμεθα τῆς τούτου φύσεως, ἀλλὰ καθαρεύωμεν ἀπ' αὐτοῦ, ἕως ἂν ὁ θεὸς αὐτὸς ἀπολύσῃ ἡμᾶς· καὶ οὕτω μὲν καθαροὶ ἀπαλλαττόμενοι τῆς τοῦ σώματος ἀφροσύνης, ὡς τὸ εἶκός μετὰ τοιούτων τε ἐσόμεθα καὶ γνωσόμεθα δι' ἡμῶν

67b

SI: "More than anything, Socrates."

67b

S: "Therefore," said Socrates, "if this is all true, my friend, there is great hope that when someone arrives where I am going, there, if anywhere, they fully attain that objective which has given rise to so much endeavour in our lives so far. So this departure which is now forced upon me offers good hope for any man who believes he has prepared his mind, which has, in a sense, been purified."

αὐτῶν πᾶν τὸ εἰλικρινές, τοῦτο δ' ἐστὶν ἴσως τὸ ἀληθές· μὴ καθαρῷ γὰρ καθαροῦ ἐφάπτεσθαι μὴ οὐ θεμιτὸν ἦ. τοιαῦτα οἶμαι, ᾧ Σιμμία, ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι πρὸς ἀλλήλους λέγειν τε καὶ δοξάζειν πάντας τοὺς ὀρθῶς φιλομαθεῖς. ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι οὕτως; παντός γε μᾶλλον, ᾧ Σώκρατες. οὐκοῦν, ἔφη ὁ Σωκράτης, εἰ ταῦτα ἀληθῆ, ᾧ ἑταῖρε, πολλὴ ἐλπίς ἀφικομένῳ οἷ ἐγὼ πορεύομαι, ἐκεῖ ἱκανῶς, εἴπερ που ἄλλοθι,

κτήσασθαι τοῦτο οὐ ἔνεκα ἢ πολλή πραγματεία ἡμῖν ἐν τῷ παρελθόντι βίῳ γέγονεν, ὥστε ἥ γε

SI: “Yes, certainly,” said Simmias.

67c

S: “But does not this purification turn out to be just what we said it was in the earlier discussion: the separation of soul from body to the greatest extent possible; getting soul accustomed to gathering itself together, and collecting itself from all parts of the body, to dwell just by itself as best it can, both in its present situation and hereafter; being set free from the body as though from bonds?”

ἀποδημία ἡ νῦν μοι προστεταγμένη μετὰ ἀγαθῆς ἐλπίδος γίγνεται καὶ ἄλλῳ ἀνδρὶ ὃς ἡγεῖται οἱ παρεσκευάσθαι τὴν διάνοιαν ὥσπερ κεκαθαρμένην. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, κάθαρσις δὲ εἶναι ἄρα οὐ τοῦτο συμβαίνει, ὅπερ πάλαι ἐν τῷ λόγῳ λέγεται, τὸ χωρίζειν ὅτι μάλιστα ἀπὸ τοῦ σώματος τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ ἐθίσει αὐτὴν καθ’ αὐτὴν πανταχόθεν ἐκ τοῦ σώματος συναγεῖρεσθαι τε καὶ ἀθροίζεσθαι, καὶ οἰκεῖν κατὰ τὸ δυνατόν καὶ ἐν τῷ νῦν παρόντι καὶ ἐν τῷ

67d

SI: “Yes, certainly.”

ἔπειτα μόνην καθ’ αὐτήν, ἐκλυομένην ὥσπερ ἐκ δεσμῶν ἐκ τοῦ σώματος; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν τοῦτό γε θάνατος ὀνομάζεται, λύσις καὶ χωρισμὸς ψυχῆς ἀπὸ σώματος; παντάπασί γε, ἢ δ’ ὅς. λύειν δέ γε αὐτήν, ὥς φαμεν, προθυμοῦνται ἀεὶ μάλιστα καὶ μόνοι οἱ φιλοσοφοῦντες ὀρθῶς, καὶ τὸ μελέτημα αὐτὸ τοῦτό ἐστιν τῶν φιλοσόφων, λύσις καὶ χωρισμὸς ψυχῆς ἀπὸ σώματος· ἢ οὐ; φαίνεται. οὐκοῦν, ὅπερ ἐν ἀρχῇ ἔλεγον, γελοῖον ἂν εἴη ἄνδρα

S: “And isn’t this how death is described, a freeing and separation of soul from body?”

SI: “Entirely so.”

S: “And we are saying that it is only those who engage in philosophy correctly who are always most eager to free the soul. This is the

particular practice of the philosophers; the freeing and separating of soul from body. Is this so?”

SI: “So it appears.”

67e

S: “So, as I said in the beginning, it would be ridiculous for a man who prepares himself throughout life by being as close to death as possible, and who lives accordingly, to be troubled at the arrival of his own death.”

SI: “Ridiculous, of course.”

67e

S: “So, in fact, Simmias,” he said, “those who engage properly in philosophy practise dying and, of all people, death is least fearful to them. Reflect upon this. If they are indeed at variance with the body in every way, and they wish to have soul just by itself, but they are fearful and troubled when this happens, wouldn’t that be very irrational? Shouldn’t they be glad to go to a place where there is hope that those who arrive there, freed from association with their former adversary, will attain that which they have loved throughout their lives, and what they have loved is wisdom? When humans’ loved ones, wives or sons, have died, many people have been prepared to go after them willingly into Hades, led by the hope of seeing their loved ones, and of being with them there. So, if someone actually loves wisdom and has a firm hold of this same hope that he will attain no wisdom worth mentioning anywhere else but in Hades, will he be troubled when he is dying? Won’t he be glad to go there? Surely he must think so, my friend, if he is in fact a philosopher, for he will hold strongly to the view that there, and nowhere else, will he attain wisdom in its purity. And if this is the case, then as we said before, it would be highly irrational for such a person to fear death.”

παρασκευάζονθ' ἑαυτὸν ἐν τῷ βίῳ ὅτι ἐγγυτάτῳ ὄντα τοῦ τεθνάναι οὕτῳ ζῆν, κἄπειθ' ἤκοντος αὐτῷ τούτου ἀγανακτεῖν; γελοῖον· πῶς δ' οὐ; τῷ ὄντι ἄρα, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία, οἱ ὁρθῶς φιλοσοφοῦντες ἀποθνήσκειν

μελετῶσι, καὶ τὸ τεθνάναι ἥκιστα αὐτοῖς ἀνθρώπων φοβερὸν. ἐκ τῶνδε δὲ σκόπει. ΦΑΙΔ. εἰ γὰρ διαβέβληνται μὲν πανταχῇ τῷ σώματι, αὐτὴν δὲ καθ' αὐτὴν ἐπιθυμοῦσι τὴν ψυχὴν ἔχειν, τούτου δὲ γιγνομένου εἰ φοβοῖντο καὶ ἀγανακτοῖεν, οὐ πολλὴ ἂν ἀλογία εἴη, εἰ μὴ ἄσμενοι ἐκεῖσε ἴοιεν, οἱ ἀφικομένοις ἐλπίς ἐστίν οὗ διὰ βίου ἥρων τυχεῖν — ἥρων δὲ φρονήσεως — ὧς τε διεβέβληντο, τούτου ἀπηλλάχθαι συνόντος αὐτοῖς; ἢ ἀνθρωπίνων μὲν παιδικῶν καὶ γυναικῶν καὶ ὑέων ἀποθανόντων πολλοὶ δὴ ἐκόντες ἠθέλησαν εἰς Ἄιδου μετελθεῖν, ὑπὸ ταύτης ἀγόμενοι τῆς ἐλπίδος, τῆς τοῦ ὄψεσθαι τε ἐκεῖ ὧν ἐπεθύμουν καὶ συνέσεσθαι φρονήσεως δὲ ἄρα τις τῷ ὄντι ἐρῶν, καὶ λαβὼν σφόδρα τὴν αὐτὴν ταύτην ἐλπίδα, μηδαμοῦ ἄλλοθι ἐντεύξεσθαι αὐτῇ

68b

St: “Very much so, by Zeus.”

68b

S: “Therefore, do you have sufficient evidence”, said Socrates, “that a man whom you see grieving when he is going to die is no lover of wisdom, but a lover of the body? The same person also turns out to be a money-lover, or a lover of honour, one or the other or both.”

ἀξίως λόγου ἢ ἐν Ἄιδου, ἀγανακτήσει τε ἀποθνήσκων καὶ οὐχ ἄσμενος εἴσιν αὐτόσε; οἶεσθαί γε χρεῖ, ἐὰν τῷ ὄντι γε ἦ, ὃ ἐταῖρε, φιλόσοφος· σφόδρα γὰρ αὐτῷ ταῦτα δόξει, μηδαμοῦ ἄλλοθι καθαρῶς ἐντεύξεσθαι φρονήσει ἀλλ' ἢ ἐκεῖ. εἰ δὲ τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει, ὅπερ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, οὐ πολλὴ ἂν ἀλογία εἴη εἰ φοβοῖτο τὸν θάνατον ὁ τοιοῦτος; πολλὴ μὲντοι νῆ Δία, ἢ δ' ὅς. οὐκοῦν ἱκανὸν σοι τεκμήριον, ἔφη, τοῦτο ἀνδρός, ὃν ἂν ἴδῃς ἀγανακτοῦντα μέλλοντα ἀποθανεῖσθαι, ὅτι οὐκ ἄρ'

68c

St: “Indeed,” he said, “the situation is just as you describe.”

ἦν φιλόσοφος ἀλλὰ τις φιλοσώματος; ὁ αὐτὸς δέ που οὗτος τυγχάνει ὧν καὶ φιλοχρήματος καὶ φιλότιμος, ἥτοι τὰ ἕτερα τούτων ἢ ἀμφοτέρα. πάνυ, ἔφη, ἔχει οὕτως ὡς λέγεις. ἄρ' οὖν, ἔφη, ὧς Σιμμία, οὐ καὶ ἡ ὀνομαζομένη ἀνδρεία τοῖς οὕτω διακειμένοις μάλιστα προσήκει; πάντως δήπου, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἡ σωφροσύνη, ἦν καὶ οἱ πολλοὶ

ὀνομάζουσι σωφροσύνην, τὸ περὶ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας μὴ ἐπτοῆσθαι ἀλλ' ὀλιγώρως ἔχειν καὶ κοσμίως, ἃρ' οὐ τούτοις μόνοις προσήκει, τοῖς μάλιστα τοῦ σώματος ὀλιγωροῦσιν τε καὶ ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ ζῶσιν; ἀνάγκη, ἔφη. εἰ γὰρ ἐθέλεις, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἐννοῆσαι τήν γε τῶν ἄλλων ἀνδρείαν τε καὶ σωφροσύνην, δόξει σοι εἶναι ἄτοπος. πῶς δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες; οἶσθα, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὅτι τὸν θάνατον ἡγοῦνται πάντες οἱ ἄλλοι τῶν μεγάλων κακῶν; καὶ μάλ', ἔφη. οὐκοῦν φόβῳ μειζόνων κακῶν ὑπομένουσιν αὐτῶν οἱ ἀνδρεῖοι τὸν θάνατον, ὅταν ὑπομένωσιν; ἔστι ταῦτα. τῷ δεδιέναι ἄρα καὶ δέει ἀνδρεῖοί εἰσι πάντες πλὴν οἱ φιλόσοφοι· καίτοι ἄλογόν γε δέει τινὰ καὶ δειλίᾳ ἀνδρεῖον εἶναι.

S: “Well, Simmias, doesn’t what we refer to as courage belong mainly to those with a philosophic disposition?”

Si: “Entirely so.”

S: “And sound-mindedness too, sound-mindedness as most people describe it, not being aroused in the face of desires but being frugal and orderly. Doesn’t this belong only to those who show least regard for the body and spend their lives in philosophy?”

Si: “It must.”

68d

S: “Now, if you wish to consider the courage and sound-mindedness of other people, it will seem unusual to you.”

Si: “In what way, Socrates?”

S: “You know that everyone else regards death as one of the great evils?”

Si: “Very much so.”

S: “And don’t the courageous among them submit to death, whenever they do so, from fear of greater evils?”

Si: “That is what happens.”

68d

S: “So apart from the philosophers, everyone is courageous due to fear and terror. However, it is quite illogical to be courageous due to terror and cowardice.”

Si: “It certainly is.”

68e

S: “And what about those among them who are orderly? Aren’t they in the same predicament, namely that they are sound-minded due to a certain lack of restraint? Indeed, we say that this is impossible, but nevertheless this is what their foolish sound-mindedness turns out to be like. They are afraid of being deprived of certain pleasures, so, out of desire for these pleasures, they refrain from other pleasures because they are controlled by these pleasures. However, being ruled by pleasure is what they call lack of restraint, but it now turns out that they control pleasures because they themselves are controlled by other pleasures. This is like what was just referred to: they are, in a way, sound-minded due to lack of restraint.”

πάνυ μὲν οὖν. τί δὲ οἱ κόσμιοι αὐτῶν; οὐ ταῦτόν τοῦτο πεπόνθασιν· ἀκολασίᾳ τινὶ σῶφρονές εἰσιν; καίτοι φαμέν γε ἀδύνατον εἶναι, ἀλλ’ ὅμως αὐτοῖς συμβαίνει τούτῳ ὅμοιον τὸ πάθος τὸ περὶ ταύτην τὴν εὐήθη σωφροσύνην· φοβούμενοι γὰρ ἑτέρων ἡδονῶν στερηθῆναι καὶ ἐπιθυμοῦντες ἐκείνων, ἄλλων ἀπέχονται ὑπ’ ἄλλων κρατούμενοι. ΦΑΙΔ. καίτοι καλοῦσί γε ἀκολασίαν

Si: “So it seems.”

69a

S: “Bless you, Simmias, I suspect that when it comes to excellence, this trading is not right, exchanging pleasures for pleasures, pains for pains, fear for fear and greater for less as if they were coins. No, there is only one proper coin for which all these must be exchanged, and that is wisdom, and everything should really be bought and sold for this and in conjunction with this. And courage, sound-mindedness, justice and in short, true excellence, should accompany wisdom, whether pleasures, fears and everything else of that sort be present or absent.

But if these are exchanged for one another unaccompanied by wisdom, won't such excellence be a shadowy image, which is actually slavish and devoid of anything sound or true? But the true is, in fact, a purification from everything of that sort, and sound-mindedness, justice, courage, and wisdom itself are purifications. And it seems that those who established our mysteries¹² were no ordinary folk, but in fact they said long ago, in riddling language, that whoever arrived in Hades uninitiated and imperfect will lie in the mire, while someone who has been purified and perfected when he arrives there will dwell with the gods. For as they say in the mysteries,

τὸ ὑπὸ τῶν ἡδονῶν ἄρχεσθαι, ἀλλ' ὅμως συμβαίνει αὐτοῖς κρατουμένοις ὑφ' ἡδονῶν κρατεῖν ἄλλων ἡδονῶν. τοῦτο δ' ὁμοίον ἐστὶν ᾧ νυνδὴ ἐλέγετο, τῷ τρόπον τινὰ δι' ἀκολασίαν αὐτοὺς σεσωφρονίσθαι. ἔοικε γάρ. ὦ μακάριε Σιμμία, μὴ γὰρ οὐχ αὕτη ἢ ἡ ὀρθὴ πρὸς ἀρετὴν ἀλλαγὴ, ἡδονὰς πρὸς ἡδονὰς καὶ λύπας πρὸς λύπας καὶ φόβον πρὸς φόβον καταλλάττεσθαι, καὶ μεῖζω πρὸς ἐλάττω ὥσπερ νομίσματα, ἀλλ' ἢ ἐκεῖνο μόνον τὸ νόμισμα ὀρθόν, ἀντὶ οὗ δεῖ πάντα ταῦτα καταλλάττεσθαι, φρόνησις, καὶ τούτου μὲν πάντα καὶ μετὰ τούτου ὠνούμενά τε καὶ πιπρασκόμενα τῷ ὄντι ἢ καὶ ἀνδρεία καὶ σωφροσύνη καὶ δικαιοσύνη καὶ συλλήβδην ἀληθῆς ἀρετὴ, μετὰ φρονήσεως, καὶ προσγιγνομένων καὶ ἀπογιγνομένων καὶ ἡδονῶν καὶ φόβων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων πάντων τῶν τοιούτων· χωριζόμενα δὲ φρονήσεως καὶ ἀλλαττόμενα ἀντὶ ἀλλήλων μὴ σκιαγραφία τις ἢ ἡ τοιαύτη ἀρετὴ καὶ τῷ ὄντι ἀνδραποδώδης τε καὶ οὐδὲν ὑγιὲς οὐδ' ἀληθὲς ἔχει, τὸ δ' ἀληθὲς τῷ ὄντι ἢ

69c

S: The thyrsus bearers are many But the Bacchae are few.¹³

κάθαρσίς τις τῶν τοιούτων πάντων καὶ ἡ σωφροσύνη καὶ ἡ δικαιοσύνη καὶ ἀνδρεία, καὶ αὕτη ἡ φρόνησις μὴ καθαρμός τις ἢ. καὶ κινδυνεύουσι καὶ οἱ τὰς τελετὰς ἡμῖν οὗτοι καταστήσαντες οὐ φαῦλοί τινες εἶναι, ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι πάλαι αἰνίττεσθαι ὅτι ὃς ἂν ἀμύητος καὶ ἀτέλεστος εἰς Ἄιδου ἀφίκηται ἐν βορβόρῳ κείσεται, ὁ δὲ κεκαθαρμένος τε καὶ

τετελεσμένος ἐκεῖσε ἀφικόμενος μετὰ θεῶν οἰκήσει. εἰσὶν γὰρ δὴ, ὥς φασιν οἱ περὶ τὰς τελετάς, ναρθηκοφόροι

69d

S: “And the Bacchae are, in my view, none other than those who have properly engaged in philosophy. And so, throughout my life, unstintingly and to the best of my ability, I have been eager in every way to become one of them. But whether I have been eager in the right way and whether we have achieved anything, that I shall know for certain quite soon when I arrive there, if it be god’s will. That is how it seems to me.

69d

S: “Now, Simmias and Cebes,” said he, “thus do I make my case that it is reasonable to bear without difficulty or tribulation my departure from yourselves and the rulers of this place, for I believe that I shall encounter rulers there who are just as good as these, and companions too. So, if I am any more persuasive towards you with this defence than I was to the Athenian jurors, all would be well.”

μὲν πολλοί, βάκχοι δέ τε παῦροι· οὗτοι δ’ εἰσὶν κατὰ τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν οὐκ ἄλλοι ἢ οἱ πεφιλοσοφηκότες ὀρθῶς. ὦν δὴ καὶ ἐγὼ κατὰ γε τὸ δυνατόν οὐδὲν ἀπέλιπον ἐν τῷ βίῳ ἀλλὰ παντὶ τρόπῳ προθυμήθην γενέσθαι· εἰ δ’ ὀρθῶς προθυμήθην καὶ τι ἡνύσαμεν, ἐκεῖσε ἐλθόντες τὸ σαφές εἰσόμεθα, ἂν θεὸς ἐθέλῃ, ὀλίγον ὕστερον, ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ. ταῦτ’ οὖν ἐγώ, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, ἀπολογοῦμαι, ὥς εἰκότως ὑμᾶς τε ἀπολείπων καὶ τοὺς ἐνθάδε δεσπότας οὐ χαλεπῶς φέρω οὐδ’ ἀγανακτῶ, ἡγούμενος κακεῖ οὐδὲν ἦττον ἢ ἐνθάδε δεσπότης τε ἀγαθοῖς ἐντεύξεσθαι καὶ ἐταίροις τοῖς δὲ πολλοῖς ἀπιστίαν παρέχει· εἴ τι οὖν ὑμῖν πιθανώτερός εἰμι ἐν τῇ ἀπολογίᾳ ἢ τοῖς Ἀθηναίων δικασταῖς, εὖ ἂν ἔχοι. ΦΑΙΔ. εἰπόντος δὴ τοῦ Σωκράτους ταῦτα, ὑπολαβὼν ὁ Κέβης ἔφη· ὦ Σώκρατες, τὰ μὲν ἄλλα ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ καλῶς λέγεσθαι, τὰ δὲ περὶ τῆς ψυχῆς πολλὴν ἀπιστίαν παρέχει τοῖς ἀνθρώποις μή, ἐπειδὴν ἀπαλλαγῇ τοῦ σώματος, οὐδαμοῦ ἔτι ἦ, ἀλλ’ ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ διαφθείρηται τε καὶ ἀπολλύηται ἢ ἂν ὁ ἄνθρωπος ἀποθνήσκῃ, εὐθὺς ἀπαλλαττομένη τοῦ σώματος, καὶ ἐκβαίνουσα ὥσπερ

πνεῦμα ἢ καπνὸς διασκεδασθεῖσα οἷχεται διαπτομένη καὶ οὐδὲν ἔτι οὐδαμοῦ ἦ. ἐπεὶ, εἴπερ εἴη που αὐτὴ καθ' αὐτὴν συνηθροισμένη καὶ ἀπηλλαγμένη τούτων τῶν κακῶν ὧν σὺ νυνδὴ διῆλθες, πολλὴ ἂν εἴη ἐλπίς καὶ καλή, ὦ

69e

Once Socrates had said all this, Cebes responded by saying,

69e

CE: “Socrates, it seems to me at least, that in general what you have said is excellent, but what you said about the soul brings up a lot of doubt in people lest it may no longer be anywhere, once it is quit of the body. They believe that it is destroyed and perishes on the very day a person dies, as soon as it is separated from the body, and going forth, dispersed like breath or smoke, it takes flight, is gone and is no longer anywhere at all. However, if the soul were, in fact, just by itself, gathered together, freed from those evils you described just now, there would be a great and beautiful hope, Socrates, that what you are saying is true. But it will probably require no small amount of gentle persuasion to prove that after the person dies the soul exists and possesses some power and wisdom.”

70b

S: “What you say is true, Cebes,” said Socrates. “But what are we to do? Would you like us to converse about this very topic, on the question of whether this is likely to be the case or not?”

Σώκρατες, ὡς ἀληθὴ ἐστὶν ἃ σὺ λέγεις· ἀλλὰ τοῦτο δὴ ἴσως οὐκ ὀλίγης παραμυθίας δεῖται καὶ πίστεως, ὡς ἔστι τε ψυχὴ ἀποθανόντος τοῦ ἀνθρώπου καὶ τινα δύναμιν ἔχει καὶ φρόνησιν. ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις, ὁ Σωκράτης, ὧ Κέβης· ἀλλὰ τί δὴ ποιῶμεν; ἢ περὶ αὐτῶν τούτων βούλει διαμυθολογῶμεν, εἴτε εἰκὸς οὕτως ἔχειν εἴτε μή; ἐγὼ γοῦν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, ἡδέως ἂν ἀκούσαιμι ἥντινα δόξαν ἔχεις περὶ αὐτῶν. οὐκ οὐ γὰρ ἂν οἶμαι, ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Σωκράτης, εἰπεῖν τινα νῦν ἀκούσαντα, οὐδ' εἰ κωμωδοποιὸς εἴη, ὡς ἀδολεσχῶ καὶ οὐ περὶ προσηκόντων τοὺς λόγους ποιοῦμαι. εἰ οὖν δοκεῖ, χρὴ διασκοπεῖσθαι. σκεψώμεθα δὲ αὐτὸ τῇδε πρὶν, εἴτ' ἄρα ἐν Αἰδου εἰσὶν αἱ ψυχαὶ τελευτησάντων τῶν ἀνθρώπων εἴτε

καὶ οὐ. παλαιὸς μὲν οὖν ἔστι τις λόγος οὗ μεμνήμεθα, ὡς εἰσὶν ἐνθένδε ἀφικόμενοι ἐκεῖ, καὶ πάλιν γε δεῦρο ἀφικνοῦνται καὶ γίνονται ἐκ τῶν τεθνεώτων· καὶ εἰ τοῦθ' οὕτως ἔχει, πάλιν γίγνεσθαι ἐκ τῶν ἀποθανόντων τοὺς ζῶντας, ἄλλο τι ἢ εἶεν

CE: “I, for my part, would be glad to hear what opinion you hold on these issues,” replied Cebes.

70c

S: “Well,” said Socrates, “I do not think anyone who heard us now, even if he were a comic poet, would say that I am being verbose and I am constructing arguments which are of no relevance. So if you see fit, we should examine the matter in detail.

70c

S: “Let us consider whether the souls of people who have died are in Hades or not, in the following manner. There is an ancient story, which we remember, that the souls exist in the other world having arrived there from this world, and they arrive back here again, coming into being from those who have died. Now, if this is the case, that the living come into being from those who have died, must not our souls be there, for they could not come into being again if they were not there? And if it actually becomes evident that the living come into being from nothing else than from those who have died, this constitutes an adequate proof that these things are so. But if this is not the case, another argument would be required.”

70d

CE: “Yes, certainly,” said Cebes.

ἂν αἱ ψυχαὶ ἡμῶν ἐκεῖ; οὐ γὰρ ἂν που πάλιν ἐγίνοντο μὴ οὔσαι, καὶ τοῦτο ἱκανὸν τεκμήριον τοῦ ταῦτ' εἶναι, εἰ τῷ ὄντι φανερόν γίγνοιτο ὅτι οὐδαμῶθεν ἄλλοθεν γίνονται οἱ ζῶντες ἢ ἐκ τῶν τεθνεώτων· εἰ δὲ μὴ ἔστι τοῦτο, ἄλλου ἂν του δέοι λόγου. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης. μὴ τοίνυν κατ' ἀνθρώπων, ἦ δ' ὅς, σκόπει μόνον τοῦτο, εἰ βούλει ῥᾶον μαθεῖν, ἀλλὰ καὶ κατὰ ζώων πάντων καὶ φυτῶν, καὶ συλλήβδην ὅσα περ ἔχει γένεσιν περὶ πάντων

70e

S: “Then, if you wish to understand this more easily, do not consider human beings alone, but all animals and plants and, in short, anything which comes to be. Let us see whether any of them which happen to have an opposite comes into being from those opposites. Beauty is presumably opposite to ugliness, just is opposite to unjust, and there are thousands more examples. So let us consider this: whether anything which has an opposite must come into being from nothing else but its own opposite. For instance, whenever something becomes greater, presumably it must have been lesser before and became greater afterwards.”

ἴδωμεν ἄρ' οὕτωςί γίγνεται πάντα, οὐκ ἄλλοθεν ἢ ἐκ τῶν ἐναντίων τὰ ἐναντία, ὅσοις τυγχάνει ὃν τοιοῦτόν τι, οἷον τὸ καλὸν τῷ αἰσχυρῷ ἐναντίον που καὶ δίκαιον ἀδίκῳ, καὶ ἄλλα δὴ μυρία οὕτως ἔχει. τοῦτο οὖν σκεψώμεθα, ἄρα ἀναγκαῖον ὅσοις ἔστι τι ἐναντίον, μηδαμόθεν ἄλλοθεν αὐτὸ γίγνεσθαι ἢ ἐκ τοῦ αὐτῷ ἐναντίου. οἷον ὅταν μεῖζόν τι γίγνηται, ἀνάγκη που ἐξ ἐλάττονος ὄντος πρότερον ἔπειτα μεῖζον γίγνεσθαι; ναί. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐκοῦν κἂν ἔλαττον γίγνηται, ἐκ μεῖζονος ὄντος πρότερον

CE: “Yes.”

71a

S: “And if it becomes lesser, does it not become lesser having previously been greater?”

ὑστερον ἔλαττον γενήσεται; ἔστιν οὕτω, ἔφη. καὶ μὴν ἐξ ἰσχυροτέρου γε τὸ ἀσθενέστερον καὶ ἐκ βραδυτέρου τὸ θάττον; πάνυ γε. τί δέ; ἂν τι χειρὸν γίγνηται, οὐκ ἐξ ἀμείνονος, καὶ ἂν δικαιότερον, ἐξ ἀδικωτέρου; πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ἱκανῶς οὖν, ἔφη, ἔχομεν τοῦτο, ὅτι πάντα οὕτω γίγνεται, ἐξ ἐναντίων τὰ ἐναντία πράγματα; πάνυ γε. τί δ' αὖ; ἔστι τι καὶ τοιόνδε ἐν αὐτοῖς, οἷον μεταξὺ ἀμφοτέρων πάντων τῶν ἐναντίων δυοῖν ὄντοιν δύο γενέσεις,

CE: “That is so.”

S: “And indeed, from the stronger comes the weaker and from the slower the quicker?”

CE: “Yes, certainly.”

S: “What about this, doesn’t worse come into being from better and the more just from the more unjust?”

CE: “How could it be otherwise?”

S: “Do we understand this sufficiently now, that everything comes into being in this way, opposite things arising from opposites?”

CE: “Yes, certainly.”

71b

S: “What about this further question? Is there something of this sort, something in between all these pairs of opposites, which is twofold? Are there two processes, one going from one extreme to the other, and a second going in the opposite direction? For there is increase and decrease in between something greater and something lesser, and, accordingly, do we refer to one as increasing and the other as decreasing?”

CE: “Yes.”

71b

S: “Doesn’t this happen in all cases, separation and combination, cooling and heating? And even if we sometimes do not use the names, must it not, in fact, always be like this: that they are generated from one another, and there is generation into one another?”

ἀπὸ μὲν τοῦ ἑτέρου ἐπὶ τὸ ἕτερον, ἀπὸ δ’ αὖ τοῦ ἑτέρου πάλιν ἐπὶ τὸ ἕτερον· μείζονος μὲν πράγματος καὶ ἐλάττονος μεταξὺ αὖξῆσις καὶ φθίσις, καὶ καλοῦμεν οὕτω τὸ μὲν αὐξάνεσθαι, τὸ δὲ φθίνειν; ναί, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν καὶ διακρίνεσθαι καὶ συγκρίνεσθαι, καὶ ψύχεσθαι καὶ θερμαίνεσθαι, καὶ πάντα οὕτω, κἂν εἰ μὴ χρώμεθα τοῖς ὀνόμασιν ἐνιαχοῦ, ἀλλ’ ἔργῳ γοῦν πανταχοῦ οὕτως ἔχειν ἀναγκαῖον, γίνεσθαι

τε αὐτὰ ἐξ ἀλλήλων γένεσίν τε εἶναι ἑκατέρου εἰς ἄλληλα; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἦ δ' ὅς.

CE: “Certainly.”

71c

S: “What about this?” he said. “Is there an opposite of being alive, just as being awake is the opposite of being asleep?”

τί οὖν; ἔφη, τῷ ζῆν ἐστὶ τι ἐναντίον, ὥσπερ τῷ ἐγρηγορέναι τὸ καθεύδειν; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη. τί; τὸ τεθνάναι, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν ἐξ ἀλλήλων τε γίγνεται ταῦτα, εἴπερ ἐναντία ἐστίν, καὶ αἱ γενέσεις εἰσὶν αὐτοῖν μεταξύ δύο δυοῖν ὄντων; πῶς γὰρ οὐ; τὴν μὲν τοίνυν ἑτέραν συζυγίαν ὦν νυνδὴ ἔλεγον ἐγὼ σοι, ἔφη, ἐρῶ, ὁ Σωκράτης, καὶ αὐτὴν καὶ τὰς γενέσεις· σὺ δέ μοι τὴν ἑτέραν. λέγω δὲ τὸ μὲν καθεύδειν, τὸ δὲ ἐγρηγορέναι, καὶ ἐκ τοῦ καθεύδειν τὸ ἐγρηγορέναι γίγνεσθαι καὶ

CE: “There is, of course,” he replied.

S: “What is it?”

CE: “Being dead.”

71d

S: “Don’t these come into being from one another since they are opposites, and, as there are two of them, aren’t there two processes in between them?”

CE: “There must be.”

71d

S: “Then,” said Socrates, “I shall describe to you one pairing which we just referred to and its processes too, and you should then describe the other one to me. So I say that there is ‘being asleep’ and ‘being awake’, and from being asleep arises being awake, and from being awake arises being asleep, and the processes between the two are falling asleep and waking up. Is that enough for you,” he said, “or not?”

ἐκ τοῦ ἐγρηγορέναι τὸ καθεύδειν, καὶ τὰς γενέσεις αὐτοῖν τὴν μὲν καταδραθάνειν εἶναι, τὴν δ' ἀνεγείρεσθαι. ἰκανῶς σοι, ἔφη, ἦ οὐ; πάνυ

μὲν οὖν. λέγε δὴ μοι καὶ σύ, ἔφη, οὕτω περὶ ζωῆς καὶ θανάτου. οὐκ ἐναντίον μὲν φῆς τῷ ζῆν τὸ τεθνάναι εἶναι; ἔγωγε. γίγνεσθαι δὲ ἐξ ἀλλήλων; ναί. ἐξ οὖν τοῦ ζῶντος τί τὸ γιγνόμενον; τὸ τεθνηκός, ἔφη. τί δέ, ἢ δ' ὅς, ἐκ τοῦ τεθνεώτος; ἀναγκαῖον, ἔφη, ὁμολογεῖν ὅτι τὸ ζῶν. ἐκ τῶν τεθνεώτων ἄρα, ὦ Κέβης, τὰ ζῶντά τε καὶ οἱ ζῶντες γίνονται; φαίνεται, ἔφη. εἰσὶν ἄρα, ἔφη, αἱ ψυχαὶ ἡμῶν ἐν Ἄιδου. ἔοικεν. οὐκοῦν καὶ τοῖν γεγεσέοιν τοῖν περὶ ταῦτα ἢ γ' ἐτέρα σαφὴς οὕσα τυγχάνει; τὸ γὰρ ἀποθνήσκειν σαφὲς δήπου, ἢ οὐ; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη. πῶς οὖν, ἢ δ' ὅς, ποιήσομεν; οὐκ ἀνταποδώσομεν τὴν ἐναντίαν γένεσιν, ἀλλὰ ταύτη χωλὴ ἔσται ἢ φύσις; ἢ ἀνάγκη ἀποδοῦναι τῷ ἀποθνήσκειν ἐναντίαν τινὰ γένεσιν; πάντως που, ἔφη. τίνα ταύτην; τὸ ἀναβιώσκεσθαι. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐκοῦν, ἢ δ' ὅς, εἴπερ ἔστι τὸ ἀναβιώσκεσθαι, ἐκ τῶν

CE: “It is certainly enough.”

71e

S: “Then, describe life and death to me on this basis. Don’t you say that being alive is the opposite of being dead?”

CE: “I do, indeed.”

S: “And do they arise from one another?”

CE: “Yes.”

S: “Then, what is generated from the living?”

CE: “The dead.”

S: “And what is generated from the dead?”

CE: “I have to admit that it is the living.”

S: “So, Cebes, do those who are alive, and anything that is alive, come into being from those who have died?”

CE: “It appears so,” he replied.

S: “So in Hades our souls are.”

CE: “So it seems.”

71e

S: “Now, of the two processes involved here, one at any rate is evident, for dying is surely an evident process, is this so?”

CE: “Yes, certainly”

72a

S: “Well,” he asked, “how shall we proceed? If we do not balance this with an opposite process, then won’t nature be one-legged in this respect? Isn’t it necessary to assign some process which is the opposite of dying?”

τεθνεώτων ἂν εἴη γένεσις εἰς τοὺς ζῶντας αὕτη, τὸ ἀναβιώσκεισθαι; πάνυ γε. ὁμολογεῖται ἄρα ἡμῖν καὶ ταύτη τοὺς ζῶντας ἐκ τῶν τεθνεώτων γεγονέναι οὐδὲν ἥττον ἢ τοὺς τεθνεώτας ἐκ τῶν ζώντων, τούτου δὲ ὄντος ἱκανόν που ἐδόκει τεκμήριον εἶναι ὅτι ἀναγκαῖον τὰς τῶν τεθνεώτων ψυχὰς εἶναί που, ὅθεν δὴ πάλιν γίνεσθαι. δοκεῖ μοι, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐκ τῶν ὁμολογημένων ἀναγκαῖον οὕτως ἔχειν. ἰδὲ τοίνυν οὕτως, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, ὅτι οὐδ’ ἀδίκως ὁμολογήκαμεν, ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ. εἰ γὰρ μὴ αἰεὶ ἀνταποδιδοίη τὰ

CE: “Absolutely.”

S: “What process is this?”

CE: “Coming to life again.”

S: “Now, if there is such a thing as coming to life again, would not the coming to life again be the generation of those who are alive, from those who have died?”

CE: “Certainly.”

S: “So, we agree that the living come into being from the dead in this way, just as much as the dead come from the living; and since this is the case, it seems there is sufficient proof that the souls of the dead necessarily exist somewhere, and they come into being once more, from there.”

72b

CE: “It seems to me, Socrates,” he said, “that based upon what has been agreed, this must be the case.”

72b

S: “Well, if you look at it this way, I think you will see that what we have agreed is right. For if the various processes did not always correspond to one another as if they were going around in a circle, but the generation was always in a straight line, only from something to its opposite, and it never turned back to the other again or went in the other direction, you know that everything would finally have the same form, suffer the same fate, and would stop coming into being.”

CE: “What do you mean?” he asked.

72b

S: “It is not difficult to understand what I mean,” he said. “For instance, if there were a process of falling asleep, on the one hand, without any corresponding process of awakening from sleep, you know everything would eventually make Endymion¹⁴ look insignificant, and his great sleep would be of no account because everyone else would be the same as him, asleep. And if everything was combined and nothing was separated, the statement of Anaxagoras¹⁵ that ‘all things were together’ would soon be fulfilled. By the same argument, dear Cebes, if everything which ever partakes of life were to die, and the dead were to remain in that condition once they had died, without coming back to life again, isn’t it totally inevitable that eventually everything would be dead, and nothing would be alive? For if the living were to come into being from other sources, and the living, for their part, were to die, is there any way to avoid everything being consumed by death?”

ἕτερα τοῖς ἑτέροις γιγνόμενα, ὥσπερὶ κύκλῳ περιόντα, ἀλλ’ εὐθεὶά τις εἶη ἡ γένεσις ἐκ τοῦ ἑτέρου μόνον εἰς τὸ καταντικρὺ καὶ μὴ ἀνακάμπτει πάλιν ἐπὶ τὸ ἕτερον μηδὲ καμπὴν ποιοῖτο, οἷσθ’ ὅτι πάντα τελευτῶντα τὸ αὐτὸ σχῆμα ἂν σχοίη καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ πάθος ἂν πάθοι καὶ παύσαιτο γιγνόμενα; πῶς λέγεις; ἔφη. οὐδὲν χαλεπόν, ἦ δ’ ὅς, ἐννοῆσαι ὃ λέγω·

ἀλλ' οἷον εἰ τὸ καταδαρθάνειν μὲν εἴη, τὸ δ' ἀνεγείρεσθαι μὴ ἀνταποδοιδίῃ γιγνόμενον ἐκ τοῦ καθεύδοντος, οἷσθ' ὅτι τελευτῶντα πάντ' ἂν λήρον τὸν Ἐνδυμίωνα ἀποδείξειεν καὶ οὐδαμοῦ ἂν φαίνοιτο διὰ τὸ καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ταῦτ' ἐκείνῳ πεπονθέναι, καθεύδειν. κἂν εἰ συγκρίνοιτο μὲν πάντα, διακρίνοιτο δὲ μή, ταχὺ ἂν τὸ τοῦ Ἀναξαγόρου γεγονὸς εἴη, ὁμοῦ πάντα χρήματα. ὡσαύτως δέ, ὧ φίλε Κέβης, καὶ εἰ ἀποθνήσκοι μὲν πάντα ὅσα τοῦ ζῆν μεταλάβοι, ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἀποθάνοι, μένοι ἐν τούτῳ τῷ σχήματι τὰ τεθνεῶτα καὶ μὴ πάλιν ἀναβιώσκοιτο, ἄρ' οὐ πολλὴ ἀνάγκη τελευτῶντα πάντα

72d

CE: “I do not think so at all, Socrates,” replied Cebes. “Yes, it seems to me that what you are saying is entirely true.”

72d

S: “Yes, Cebes,” he said, “that is how it seems to me. It is truer than any account, and we are not deceived when we agree with all this. Yes, there is, in fact, also a process of coming back to life again, the living do come into being from those who have died, and the souls of those who have died exist.”

τεθνάναι καὶ μηδὲν ζῆν; εἰ γὰρ ἐκ μὲν τῶν ἄλλων τὰ ζῶντα γίγνοιτο, τὰ δὲ ζῶντα θνήσκοι, τίς μηχανὴ μὴ οὐχὶ πάντα καταναλωθῆναι εἰς τὸ τεθνάναι; οὐδὲ μία μοι δοκεῖ, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, ὧ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ μοι δοκεῖς παντάπασιν ἀληθῆ λέγειν. ἔστιν γάρ, ἔφη, ὧ Κέβης, ὡς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, παντὸς μᾶλλον οὕτω, καὶ ἡμεῖς αὐτὰ ταῦτα οὐκ ἐξαπατῶμενοι ὁμολογοῦμεν, ἀλλ' ἔστι τῷ ὄντι καὶ τὸ ἀναβιώσκεσθαι καὶ ἐκ τῶν τεθνεώτων τοὺς ζῶντας γίγνεσθαι καὶ τὰς τῶν τεθνεώτων ψυχὰς

72e

CE: “And indeed,” Cebes said in response, “if that argument, Socrates, which you are in the habit of recounting so frequently, is true, then according to that, learning for us is nothing other than recollection, and on this basis we must presumably have learned at some previous time what we are now remembering. But this would be impossible unless our soul was somewhere before it took on this human form. So, in this way too, the soul seems to be something immortal.”

εἶναι καὶ ταῖς μέν γε ἀγαθαῖς ἄμεινον εἶναι, ταῖς δὲ κακαῖς κάκιον. καὶ μὴν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης ὑπολαβών, καὶ κατ' ἐκεῖνόν γε τὸν λόγον, ὧ Σώκρατες, εἰ ἀληθὴς ἐστίν, ὃν σὺ εἴωθας θαμὰ λέγειν, ὅτι ἡμῖν ἡ μάθησις οὐκ ἄλλο τι ἢ ἀνάμνησις τυγχάνει οὕσα, καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον ἀνάγκη που ἡμᾶς ἐν προτέρῳ τινὶ χρόνῳ μεμαθηκέναι ἃ νῦν ἀναμνησκομέθα. ΦΑΙΔ. τοῦτο δὲ

73a

SI: Simmias interjected and said, “Cebes, what proofs have we for these claims? Please remind me, for I do not remember them very well at present.”

73a

CE: “Well,” said Cebes, “one excellent argument is this: if people are asked questions and someone questions them properly, the people, of themselves, describe everything as it is. However, if knowledge and a correct account were not within them, they would not have been able to do this. What is more, if someone shows them diagrams or the like, you have the clearest evidence that this is the case.”

ἀδύνατον, εἰ μὴ ἦν που ἡμῖν ἡ ψυχὴ πρὶν ἐν τῷδε τῷ ἀνθρωπίνῳ εἶδει γενέσθαι· ὥστε καὶ ταύτῃ ἀθάνατον ἡ ψυχὴ τι ἔοικεν εἶναι. ἀλλὰ, ὧ Κέβης, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας ὑπολαβών, ποῖαί τούτων αἱ ἀποδείξεις; ὑπόμνησόν με· οὐ γὰρ σφόδρα ἐν τῷ παρόντι μέμνημαι. ἐνὶ μὲν λόγῳ, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, καλλίστῳ, ὅτι ἐρωτώμενοι οἱ ἄνθρωποι, ἐάν τις καλῶς ἐρωτᾷ, αὐτοὶ λέγουσιν πάντα ἣ ἔχει — καίτοι εἰ μὴ ἐτύγχανεν αὐτοῖς ἐπιστήμη ἐνοῦσα καὶ ὀρθὸς λόγος, οὐκ ἂν οἷοί τ' ἦσαν τοῦτο ποιῆσαι — ἔπειτα

73b

S: “And,” said Socrates, “as you are not quite persuaded by this, Simmias, let us see whether you will agree if you consider it as follows. Do you actually doubt that what we call learning is recollection?”

73b

SI: “I do not doubt it,” said Simmias, “but I want to undergo the very process the argument is describing; I want to be reminded. From Cebes’

attempt at the argument, I almost remember it already and I am persuaded. Nevertheless, I would now like to hear how you propose to deal with it.”

ἐάν τις ἐπὶ τὰ διαγράμματα ἄγῃ ἢ ἄλλο τι τῶν τοιούτων, ἐνταῦθα σαφέστατα κατηγορεῖ ὅτι τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει. εἰ δὲ μὴ ταύτη γε, ἔφη, πείθῃ, ὦ Σιμμία, ὁ Σωκράτης, σκέψαι ἂν τῆδὲ πῇ σοι σκοπούμενῳ συνδόξῃ. ἀπιστεῖς γὰρ δὴ πῶς ἡ καλουμένη μάθησις ἀνάμνησίς ἐστιν; ἀπιστῶ μὲν σοι ἔγωγε, ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Σιμμίας, οὐ, αὐτὸ δὲ τοῦτο, ἔφη, δέομαι παθεῖν περὶ οὗ ὁ λόγος, ἀναμνησθῆναι. καὶ σχεδόν γε ἐξ ὧν Κέβης ἐπεχείρησε λέγειν ἤδη μέμνημαι καὶ πείθομαι· οὐδὲν μεντὰν ἦττον ἀκούοιμι νῦν πῇ σὺ ἐπεχείρησας λέγειν.

73c

S: “It goes like this,” he said. “We agree, of course, that if someone is to be reminded of something, he must have known that very thing on a previous occasion.”

Si: “Certainly,” he replied.

73c

S: “Now, do we also agree that whenever knowledge arises in a particular manner, it is recollection? What manner am I referring to? Well, if someone, having seen something or heard it or acquired some other perception of it, were to know not only that thing, but if he also thought of something else, something the knowledge of which was not the same but different, would we be right to say that he recollected whatever it was that he thought of?”

τῆδ' ἔγωγε, ἦ δ' ὅς. ὁμολογοῦμεν γὰρ δήπου, εἴ τίς τι ἀναμνησθήσεται, δεῖν αὐτὸν τοῦτο πρότερόν ποτε ἐπίστασθαι. πάνυ γ', ἔφη. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ τόδε ὁμολογοῦμεν, ὅταν ἐπιστήμη παραγίγνηται τρόπῳ τοιούτῳ, ἀνάμνησιν εἶναι; λέγω δὲ τίνα τρόπον; τόνδε. ἐάν τίς τι ἕτερον ἢ ἰδὼν ἢ ἀκούσας ἢ τινα ἄλλην αἴσθησιν λαβὼν μὴ μόνον ἐκεῖνο γνῶ, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἕτερον ἐννοήσῃ οὗ μὴ ἡ αὐτὴ ἐπιστήμη ἀλλ' ἄλλη, ἄρα οὐχὶ τοῦτο δικαίως λέγομεν ὅτι ἀνεμνήσθη, οὗ τὴν ἔννοιαν ἔλαβεν; πῶς λέγεις; οἷον τὰ τοιαῦδε· ἄλλη που ἐπιστήμη ἀνθρώπου καὶ λύρας. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;

οὐκοῦν οἴσθα ὅτι οἱ ἐρασταί, ὅταν ἴδωσιν λύραν ἢ ἱμάτιον ἢ ἄλλο τι οἷς τὰ παιδικὰ αὐτῶν εἶωθε χρῆσθαι, πάσχουσι τοῦτο· ἔγνωσάν τε τὴν λύραν καὶ ἐν τῇ διανοίᾳ ἔλαβον τὸ εἶδος τοῦ παιδὸς οὗ ἦν ἡ λύρα; τοῦτο δέ ἐστιν ἀνάμνησις· ὥσπερ γε καὶ Σιμμίαν τις ἰδὼν πολλάκις κέβητος ἀνεμνήσθη, καὶ ἄλλα που μυρία τοιαῦτ' ἂν εἴη. μυρία μέντοι νῆ Δία, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας.

73d

SI: “What do you mean?”

S: “Something like this. Presumably the knowledge of man and of lyre are different.”

SI: “How could they not be?”

73d

S: “You know that whenever lovers see a lyre or a garment or anything else which a favourite was in the habit of using, their experience is as follows. They recognise the lyre and they apprehend in their mind the figure of the boy who owns the lyre, and this is recollection, as when someone who has seen Simmias is often reminded of Cebes, and presumably there would be thousands of other examples of that sort.”

73e

SI: “Yes, by Zeus, thousands,” said Simmias.

οὐκοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς, τὸ τοιοῦτον ἀνάμνησις τίς ἐστι; μάλιστα μέντοι ὅταν τις τοῦτο πάθῃ περὶ ἐκεῖνα ἃ ὑπὸ χρόνου καὶ τοῦ μὴ ἐπισκοπεῖν ἤδη ἐπετέλεστο; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη. τί δέ; ἦ δ' ὅς· ἔστιν ἵππον γεγραμμένον ἰδόντα καὶ λύραν γεγραμμένην ἀνθρώπου ἀναμνησθῆναι, καὶ Σιμμίαν ἰδόντα γεγραμμένον κέβητος ἀναμνησθῆναι; πάνυ γε. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐκοῦν καὶ Σιμμίαν ἰδόντα γεγραμμένον αὐτοῦ Σιμμίου ἀναμνησθῆναι;

S: “Isn’t that sort of thing a recollection, particularly when the experience relates to things which have already been forgotten through time and lack of consideration?”

SI: “Yes, certainly,” he replied.

S: “What about this?” he asked. “Isn’t it possible to be reminded of a man on seeing a picture of a horse, or a picture of a lyre, or to be reminded of Cebes on seeing a picture of Simmias?”

SI: “Very much so.”

S: “And isn’t it possible to be reminded of Simmias on seeing a picture of Simmias?”

SI: “It is, indeed.”

74a

S: “So, doesn’t it follow from all this that there is recollection arising from likes, but also from unlikes?”

SI: “It follows.”

S: “But whenever someone recollects anything from like things, isn’t there something else that must occur to him? Won’t he recognise whether or not the thing lacks anything in respect of its likeness to whatever he is recollecting?”

SI: “He must,” replied Simmias.

74a

S: “Well,” he said, “consider if this is how these matters stand. We say, I presume, that there is something equal, not of wood to wood, or stone to stone, or anything else of that sort, but the equal itself, something different besides all these. May we say that there is such a thing or not?”

ἔστι μέντοι, ἔφη. ἄρ’ οὖν οὐ κατὰ πάντα ταῦτα συμβαίνει τὴν ἀνάμνησιν εἶναι μὲν ἄφ’ ὁμοίων, εἶναι δὲ καὶ ἀπὸ ἀνομοίων; συμβαίνει. ἀλλ’ ὅταν γε ἀπὸ τῶν ὁμοίων ἀναμνησκηταί τις τι, ἄρ’ οὐκ ἀναγκαῖον τόδε προσπᾶσχειν, ἐννοεῖν εἴτε τι ἐλλείπει τοῦτο κατὰ τὴν ὁμοιότητα εἴτε μὴ ἐκείνου οὐκ ἀνεμνήσθη; ἀνάγκη, ἔφη. σκόπει δὴ, ἦ δ’ ὅς, εἰ ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχει. φαμέν πού τι εἶναι ἴσον, οὐ ξύλον λέγω ξύλῳ οὐδὲ λίθον λίθῳ οὐδ’ ἄλλο τῶν τοιούτων οὐδέν, ἀλλὰ παρὰ ταῦτα πάντα ἕτερόν τι, αὐτὸ τὸ ἴσον· φῶμέν τι εἶναι ἢ μὴδέν;

74b

SI: “Indeed, let us say most certainly that there is. It is amazing, by Zeus.”

S: “And do we know what it is?”

SI: “Certainly,” he replied.

74b

S: “From where did we obtain the knowledge of this? Isn’t it as we just said? From seeing pieces of wood or stone or other equals, we have brought that equal to mind from these, and that is different from these. Or does it not appear different to you? Think about this too, as follows. Do not equal pieces of wood and stone, being the same, sometimes appear equal to one thing but not to another?”

φῶμεν μέντοι νῆ Δί', ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, θαυμαστῶς γε. ἦ καὶ ἐπιστάμεθα αὐτὸ ὃ ἔστιν; πάνυ γε, ἦ δ' ὅς. πόθεν λαβόντες αὐτοῦ τὴν ἐπιστήμην; ἄρ' οὐκ ἐξ ὧν νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, ἢ ξύλα ἢ λίθους ἢ ἄλλα ἅττα ἰδόντες ἴσα, ἐκ τούτων ἐκεῖνο ἐνενοήσαμεν, ἕτερον ὄν τούτων; ἢ οὐχ ἕτερόν σοι φαίνεται; σκόπει δὲ καὶ τῇδε. ἄρ' οὐ λίθοι μὲν ἴσοι καὶ ξύλα ἐνίστε ταῦτά ὄντα τῷ μὲν ἴσα φαίνεται, τῷ δ' οὐ; πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

SI: “Yes, certainly.”

74c

S: “What about this? Did the equals themselves ever appear unequal to you, or equality to be inequality?”

SI: “Not yet anyway, Socrates.”

S: “Then these equals, and the equal itself, are not the same.”

SI: “Not at all, Socrates, not according to me.”

74c

S: “And yet,” he said, “from these equals, which are different from that equal, the knowledge of equality has nevertheless come into your mind and been apprehended.”

SI: “What you say is very true,” he said.

74c

S: “Isn’t it either like them or unlike them?”

Si: “Certainly.”

74c

S: “But that makes no difference,” he said. “As long as you see one thing and bring something else to mind from this observation, be it like or unlike, recollection must have taken place.”

τί δέ; αὐτὰ τὰ ἴσα ἔστιν ὅτε ἄνισά σοι ἐφάνη, ἢ ἡ ἰσότης ἀνισότης; οὐδεπώποτε γε, ὦ Σώκρατες. οὐ ταῦτὸν ἄρα ἐστίν, ἢ δ’ ὅς, ταῦτά τε τὰ ἴσα καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ ἴσον. οὐδαμῶς μοι φαίνεται, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἐκ τούτων γ’, ἔφη, τῶν ἴσων, ἐτέρων ὄντων ἐκείνου τοῦ ἴσου, ὅμως αὐτοῦ τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἐννενόηκας τε καὶ εἴληφας; ἀληθέστατα, ἔφη, λέγεις. οὐκοῦν ἢ ὁμοίου ὄντος τούτοις ἢ ἀνομοίου; πάνυ γε. διαφέρει δέ γε, ἢ δ’ ὅς, οὐδέν· ἕως ἂν ἄλλο ἰδὼν ἀπὸ

Si: “Yes, certainly.”

74d

S: “What about this?” he said. “Is our experience somewhat as follows in relation to what is in the pieces of wood and in the equals we mentioned just now? Do they appear just as equal to us as the equal just by itself, or do they lack something of that on account of being something that is like the equal, or do they lack nothing?”

74d

Si: “They are considerably lacking,” he replied.

74d

S: “Do we not agree that whenever someone sees something and thinks, ‘what I now see is aiming to be like something else among things that are, however, it lacks something and is unable to be quite like that, instead it is inferior’, presumably someone who recognises this must have had prior knowledge of that which he says it has come to resemble, and of which it is falling short?”

ταύτης τῆς ὀψεως ἄλλο ἐννοήσης, εἴτε ὁμοιον εἴτε ἀνόμοιον, ἀναγκαῖον, ἔφη, αὐτὸ ἀνάμνησιν γεγενέσθαι. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. τί δέ; ἢ δ’ ὅς·

ἢ πάσχομέν τι τοιοῦτον περὶ τὰ ἐν τοῖς ξύλοις τε καὶ οἷς νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν τοῖς ἴσοις; ἄρα φαίνεται ἡμῖν οὕτως ἴσα εἶναι ὥσπερ αὐτὸ τὸ ὃ ἔστιν, ἢ ἐνδεῖ τι ἐκείνου τῷ τοιοῦτον εἶναι οἷον τὸ ἴσον, ἢ οὐδέν; καὶ πολὺ γε, ἔφη, ἐνδεῖ. οὐκοῦν ὁμολογοῦμεν, ὅταν τίς τι ἰδὼν ἐννοήσῃ ὅτι βούλεται μὲν τοῦτο ὃ νῦν ἐγὼ ὀρῶ εἶναι οἷον ἄλλο τι τῶν ὄντων, ἐνδεῖ δὲ καὶ οὐ δύναται τοιοῦτον εἶναι ἴσον οἷον ἐκεῖνο, ἀλλ' ἔστιν φαυλότερον, ἀναγκαῖόν που τὸν τοῦτο ἐννοοῦντα τυχεῖν προειδότα ἐκεῖνο ᾧ φησιν αὐτὸ προσεικέναι μὲν, ἐνδεεστέως δὲ ἔχειν; ἀνάγκη. τί οὖν; τὸ τοιοῦτον πεπόνθαμεν καὶ ἡμεῖς ἢ οὐ περὶ τε τὰ ἴσα καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ ἴσον; παντάπασί γε. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀναγκαῖον ἄρα ἡμᾶς προειδέναι τὸ ἴσον πρὸ ἐκείνου τοῦ

SI: “He must.”

74e

S: “Well now, is this also our experience in relation to the equals and the equal itself, or is it not?”

SI: “Entirely so.”

75a

S: “Then we must have had prior knowledge of the equal before that occasion when we first saw the equals and realised that these are all striving to be like the equal but attain it in a deficient manner.”

SI: “This is so.”

75a

S: “But then do we also agree that it is recognised, and can only be recognised from seeing, touching, or one of the other senses? I am saying that these are all the same.”

χρόνου ὅτε τὸ πρῶτον ἰδόντες τὰ ἴσα ἐννεοήσαμεν ὅτι ὀρέγεται μὲν πάντα ταῦτα εἶναι οἷον τὸ ἴσον, ἔχει δὲ ἐνδεεστέως. ἔστι ταῦτα. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ τόδε ὁμολογοῦμεν, μὴ ἄλλοθεν αὐτὸ ἐννενοηκέναι μηδὲ δυνατόν εἶναι ἐννοῆσαι ἀλλ' ἢ ἐκ τοῦ ἰδεῖν ἢ ἅψασθαι ἢ ἐκ τινος ἄλλης τῶν αἰσθήσεων· ταῦτόν δὲ πάντα ταῦτα λέγω. ταῦτόν γάρ ἔστιν, ὃ

Σώκρατες, πρὸς γε ὃ βούλεται δηλῶσαι ὁ λόγος. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ ἔκ γε τῶν αἰσθήσεων δεῖ ἐννοῆσαι ὅτι

SI: “Yes, Socrates, they are the same, in the context of what this argument is trying to show.”

75b

S: “Well, in any event, we must have recognised from sense perceptions, that all perceptible equals are striving towards what equal is, and are deficient with respect to it. Or how would we express this?”

SI: “In that way.”

75b

S: “Then, before we began to see and hear and use the other senses, I presume we must have acquired knowledge of what the equal itself is if we are to refer the equals perceived through the senses to that equal and recognise that everything of this sort endeavours to be like that, but is inferior to it.”

πάντα τὰ ἐν ταῖς αἰσθήσεσιν ἐκείνου τε ὀρέγεται τοῦ ὃ ἔστιν ἴσον, καὶ αὐτοῦ ἐνδεέστερά ἐστιν· ἢ πῶς λέγομεν; οὕτως, πρὸ τοῦ ἄρα ἄρξασθαι ἡμᾶς ὁρᾶν καὶ ἀκούειν καὶ τᾶλλα αἰσθάνεσθαι τυχεῖν ἔδει που εἰληφότας ἐπιστήμην αὐτοῦ τοῦ ἴσου ὅτι ἔστιν, εἰ ἐμέλλομεν τὰ ἐκ τῶν αἰσθήσεων ἴσα ἐκεῖσε ἀνοίσειν, ὅτι προθυμεῖται μὲν πάντα τοιαῦτ’ εἶναι οἷον ἐκεῖνο, ἔστιν δὲ αὐτοῦ φαυλότερα. ἀνάγκη ἐκ τῶν προειρημένων, ὦ Σώκρατες. οὐκοῦν γενόμενοι εὐθύς ἐωρῶμεν τε καὶ ἠκούομεν καὶ τὰς ἄλλας αἰσθήσεις εἶχομεν; πάνυ γε.

SI: “That must follow from what we said before, Socrates.”

75c

S: “Didn’t we see and hear and use the other senses as soon as we were born?”

SI: “Certainly.”

S: “Then we must have acquired the knowledge of the equal before we acquired the senses. Is that what we are saying?”

SI: “Yes.”

S: “So, apparently we must have acquired this knowledge before we were born.”

SI: “So it seems.”

75c

S: “Therefore, if we were born possessing this knowledge, having acquired it before birth, then is it not the case that before we were born, and at birth, we knew not only the equal, and the more and the less, but everything of that sort too? Indeed, this argument is no more concerned with the equal than with beauty itself, good itself, justice, holiness, and as I say, everything to which we apply the term ‘what it is’, both in the enquiries when we ask questions, and in the responses when we answer them. In which case, we must have acquired the knowledge of all these before birth.”

ἔδει δέ γε, φαμέν, πρὸ τούτων τὴν τοῦ ἴσου ἐπιστήμην εἰληφέναι; ναί. πρὶν γενέσθαι ἄρα, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἀνάγκη ἡμῖν αὐτὴν εἰληφέναι. ἔοικεν. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὲν λαβόντες αὐτὴν πρὸ τοῦ γενέσθαι ἔχοντες ἐγενόμεθα, ἠπιστάμεθα καὶ πρὶν γενέσθαι καὶ εὐθὺς γενόμενοι οὐ μόνον τὸ ἴσον καὶ τὸ μείζον καὶ τὸ ἔλαττον ἀλλὰ καὶ σύμπαντα τὰ τοιαῦτα; οὐ γὰρ περὶ τοῦ ἴσου νῦν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν μᾶλλον τι ἢ καὶ περὶ αὐτοῦ τοῦ καλοῦ καὶ αὐτοῦ τοῦ

75d

SI: “That is it.”

75d

S: “And if after we have acquired it we have not forgotten it every time, we must always be born with the knowledge and live with the knowledge throughout our lives. For that is what knowing is, the retention of knowledge, without loss, once it has been acquired. For we do refer to forgetting as the loss of knowledge, do we not, Simmias?”

ἀγαθοῦ καὶ δικαίου καὶ ὁσίου καί, ὅπερ λέγω, περὶ πάντων οἷς ἐπισφραγιζόμεθα τὸ αὐτὸ ὃ ἔστι καὶ ἐν ταῖς ἐρωτήσεσιν ἐρωτῶντες καὶ

ἐν ταῖς ἀποκρίσεσιν ἀποκρινόμενοι. ὥστε ἀναγκαῖον ἡμῖν τούτων πάντων τὰς ἐπιστήμας πρὸ τοῦ γενέσθαι εἰληφέναι. ἔστι ταῦτα. καὶ εἰ μὲν γε λαβόντες ἐκάστοτε μὴ ἐπιλελήσμεθα, εἰδότας αἰεὶ γίγνεσθαι καὶ αἰεὶ διὰ βίου εἰδέναι· τὸ γὰρ εἰδέναι τοῦτ' ἔστιν, λαβόντα του ἐπιστήμην ἔχειν καὶ μὴ ἀπολωλέκεναι· ἢ οὐ τοῦτο λήθην λέγομεν, ὧ Σιμμία, ἐπιστήμης ἀποβολήν; πάντως δήπου, ἔφη, ὧ Σώκρατες. εἰ δέ γε οἶμαι λαβόντες πρὶν γενέσθαι γιγνόμενοι ἀπωλέσαμεν, ὕστερον δὲ ταῖς αἰσθήσεσι χρώμενοι περὶ αὐτὰ ἐκείνας ἀναλαμβάνομεν τὰς ἐπιστήμας ἄς ποτε καὶ πρὶν εἶχομεν, ἄρ' οὐχ ὃ καλοῦμεν μανθάνειν οἰκείαν ἂν ἐπιστήμην ἀναλαμβάνειν εἴη; τοῦτο δέ που ἀναμιμνήσκεσθαι λέγοντες ὀρθῶς ἂν λέγοιμεν; πάνυ γε. ΦΑΙΔ.

75e

SI: “Entirely so, Socrates, of course,” he replied.

75e

S: “On the other hand, I presume that if we acquired knowledge before birth and lost it in the process of birth, but later on, by using the senses in this regard, we re-acquired the knowledge we previously possessed, then what we call learning would be a re-acquisition of our own knowledge. And wouldn’t we be right to call this recollection?”

76a

SI: “Certainly.”

76a

S: “In fact, this was shown to be possible: that once we perceive something by sight or hearing, or apprehend it with some other sense, it is possible to bring something else to mind from this, something we have forgotten, something associated with it, which may be like it or unlike it. Consequently, as I say, there are two possibilities: either we were born knowing these things, and we all know them throughout life, or else later those who we say are learning are merely remembering, and in that case learning would be recollection.”

δυνατὸν γὰρ δὴ τοῦτό γε ἐφάνη, αἰσθόμενόν τι ἢ ἰδόντα ἢ ἀκούσαντα ἢ τινα ἄλλην αἴσθησιν λαβόντα ἕτερόν τι ἀπὸ τούτου ἐννοῆσαι ὃ

ἐπελέληστο, ὃ τοῦτο ἐπλησίαζεν ἀνόμοιον ὃν ἢ ὃ ὅμοιον· ὥστε, ὅπερ λέγω, δυοῖν θάτερα, ἥτοι ἐπιστάμενοί γε αὐτὰ γεγόναμεν καὶ ἐπιστάμεθα διὰ βίου πάντες, ἢ ὕστερον, οὓς φαμεν μανθάνειν, οὐδὲν ἀλλ' ἢ ἀναμιμνήσκονται οὗτοι, καὶ ἡ μάθησις ἀνάμνησις ἂν εἴη. καὶ μάλα δὴ οὕτως ἔχει, ὃ Σώκρατες. πότερον οὖν αἰρή, ὃ Σιμμία; ἐπισταμένους ἡμᾶς γεγονέναι,

Si: “Yes, indeed, Socrates, that’s how things stand.”

76b

S: “Well, which will you choose, Simmias? Were we born with the knowledge or do we recollect later on what had previously been known?”

Si: “I cannot choose just now, Socrates.”

S: “What about this? Can you make a choice and form an opinion about the following? Would somebody who knows be able to give an account of what is known or not?”

Si: “Yes, this must be so, Socrates,” he replied.

76b

S: “And do you think that everyone can give an account of the matters we have just been talking about?”

ἢ ἀναμιμνήσκεσθαι ὕστερον ὢν πρότερον ἐπιστήμην εἰληφότες ἡμεν; οὐκ ἔχω, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐν τῷ παρόντι ἐλέσθαι. τί δέ; τόδε ἔχεις ἐλέσθαι, καὶ πῇ σοι δοκεῖ περὶ αὐτοῦ; ἀνὴρ ἐπιστάμενος περὶ ὧν ἐπίσταται ἔχει ἂν δοῦναι λόγον ἢ οὐ; πολλὴ ἀνάγκη, ἔφη, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἢ καὶ δοκοῦσί σοι πάντες ἔχειν διδόναι λόγον περὶ τούτων ὧν νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν; βουλοίμην μεντᾶν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας· ἀλλὰ πολὺ μᾶλλον φοβοῦμαι μὴ αὔριον τηνικάδε οὐκέτι ἢ ἀνθρώπων οὐδεὶς ἀξίως οἶός τε τοῦτο ποιῆσαι.

76c

Si: “I wish they could,” said Simmias, “but I am very much afraid that this time tomorrow there will no longer be a single person who can do this in a worthy manner.”

S: “So it does not seem to you, Simmias, that everyone knows this?”

Si: “Not at all.”

S: “Then are they recollecting what was previously learned?”

Si: “They must be.”

S: “When did our souls acquire the knowledge of these things? For, evidently, it was not the very moment at which we were being born human beings.”

Si: “Of course not.”

S: “So it was before then.”

Si: “Yes.”

76c

S: “So, Simmias, even before then, our souls were there, prior to being in human form without bodies, and possessed wisdom.”

οὐκ ἄρα δοκοῦσί σοι ἐπίστασθαί γε, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία, πάντες αὐτά; οὐδαμῶς. ἀναμνησκονται ἄρα ἃ ποτε ἔμαθον; ἀνάγκη. πότε λαβοῦσαι αἱ ψυχαὶ ἡμῶν τὴν ἐπιστήμην αὐτῶν; οὐ γὰρ δὴ ἀφ’ οὗ γε ἄνθρωποι γεγόναμεν. οὐ δῆτα. πρότερον ἄρα. ναί. ἦσαν ἄρα, ὦ Σιμμία, αἱ ψυχαὶ καὶ πρότερον, πρὶν εἶναι ἐν ἀνθρώπου εἶδει, χωρὶς σωμάτων, καὶ φρόνησιν εἶχον. εἰ μὴ ἄρα ἅμα γιγνόμενοι λαμβάνομεν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ταύτας τὰς ἐπιστήμας; οὗτος γὰρ λείπεται ἔτι ὁ χρόνος.

76d

Si: “Unless we acquire knowledge of these at the time we are being born, Socrates, for that particular occasion still remains for consideration.”

76d

S: “So be it, my friend. But is there some different occasion when we lose it? For we have just agreed that we are not born possessing this knowledge. So do we lose it at the very time we acquire it? Or can you suggest some other time?”

Si: “Not at all, Socrates. I was talking nonsense without realising it.”

76d

S: “Well, Simmias, is this how matters stand with us? If, on the one hand, as we are constantly repeating, there is beauty and good, and all being of that kind, and we refer everything from the senses to this being, rediscovering what existed previously, and is our own, and we compare these to this, then just as surely as these exist so also must our souls exist before we were born. But on the other hand, if these do not exist, this argument would have proceeded differently. So is that how matters stand, is there an equal necessity that these exist and that our souls exist before we are born, and if these do not exist, neither do those?”

εἶεν, ὦ ἑταῖρε· ἀπόλλυμεν δὲ αὐτὰς ἐν ποίῳ ἄλλῳ χρόνῳ; — οὐ γὰρ δὴ ἔχοντές γε αὐτὰς γιγνόμεθα, ὡς ἄρτι ὠμολογήσαμεν — ἢ ἐν τούτῳ ἀπόλλυμεν ἐν ᾧ περ καὶ λαμβάνομεν; ἢ ἔχεις ἄλλον τινὰ εἰπεῖν χρόνον; οὐδαμῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ ἔλαθον ἑμαυτὸν οὐδὲν εἰπών. ἄρ’ οὖν οὕτως ἔχει, ἔφη, ἡμῖν, ὦ Σιμμία; εἰ μὲν ἔστιν ἃ θρυλοῦμεν ἀεὶ, καλὸν τέ τι καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ πᾶσα ἡ τοιαύτη οὐσία, καὶ ἐπὶ ταύτην τὰ ἐκ τῶν αἰσθήσεων πάντα ἀναφέρομεν,

76e

Si: “Socrates, it certainly seems to me that the necessity is the same,” said Simmias, “and the argument has taken refuge, quite beautifully, in the conclusion that the soul’s existence before we were born is just as certain as the existence of the being you are now describing. For nothing is so clear to me as the fact that all such things, beauty, good and all the others you just mentioned, exist. Nothing could be more certain and, in my view, this has been adequately proven.”

υἰάρχουσαν πρότερον ἀνευρίσκοντες ἡμετέραν οὖσαν, καὶ ταῦτα ἐκεῖνη ἀπεικάζομεν, ἀναγκαῖον, οὕτως ὥσπερ καὶ ταῦτα ἔστιν, οὕτως καὶ τὴν ἡμετέραν ψυχὴν εἶναι καὶ πρὶν γεγονέναι ἡμᾶς· εἰ δὲ μὴ ἔστι ταῦτα, ἄλλως ἂν ὁ λόγος οὗτος εἰρημένος εἴη; ἄρ’ οὕτως ἔχει, καὶ ἴση ἀνάγκη ταῦτά τε εἶναι καὶ τὰς ἡμετέρας ψυχὰς πρὶν καὶ ἡμᾶς γεγονέναι, καὶ εἰ μὴ ταῦτα, οὐδὲ τάδε; ΦΑΙΔ. ὑπερφυῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη ὁ

Σιμμίας, δοκεῖ μοι ἡ αὐτὴ ἀνάγκη εἶναι, καὶ εἰς καλὸν γε καταφεύγει ὁ λόγος εἰς

77a

S: “And what about Cebes?” said Socrates. “For it is also necessary to persuade Cebes.”

77a

Si: “In my view, it is enough for him too,” replied Simmias. “However, he is the most obstinate of men when it comes to incredulity in the face of arguments. Now, I believe he has been adequately persuaded that our soul existed before we were born, but whether the soul will continue to exist after we die seems unproven even to me, Socrates. Rather, the point made by Cebes still stands, the fear of the multitude that once a person dies, the soul is dispersed, and this is the end of its being. For why could it not arise and be constituted from some other source and exist before it arrives in human form? But once it has arrived and then departed, couldn’t it too then come to an end and be destroyed?”

τὸ ὁμοίως εἶναι τὴν τε ψυχὴν ἡμῶν πρὶν γενέσθαι ἡμᾶς καὶ τὴν οὐσίαν ἣν σὺ νῦν λέγεις. οὐ γὰρ ἔχω ἔγωγε οὐδὲν οὕτω μοι ἐναργὲς ὢν ὡς τοῦτο, τὸ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτ’ εἶναι ὡς οἶόν τε μάλιστα, καλὸν τε καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ἃ σὺ νυνδὴ ἔλεγες· καὶ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ ἱκανῶς ἀποδέδεικται. τί δὲ δὴ Κέβητι; ἔφη ὁ Σωκράτης· δεῖ γὰρ καὶ Κέβητα πείθειν. ἱκανῶς, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, ὡς ἔγωγε οἶμαι· καίτοι καρτερώτατος ἀνθρώπων ἐστὶν πρὸς τὸ ἀπιστεῖν τοῖς λόγοις. ἀλλ’ οἶμαι οὐκ ἐνδεῶς τοῦτο πεπεῖσθαι αὐτόν, ὅτι πρὶν γενέσθαι ἡμᾶς ἦν ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ εἰ μέντοι καὶ ἐπειδὰν ἀποθάνωμεν ἔτι ἔσται, οὐδὲ αὐτῷ μοι δοκεῖ, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀποδεδεῖχθαι, ἀλλ’ ἔτι ἐνέστηκεν ὁ νυνδὴ Κέβης ἔλεγε, τὸ τῶν πολλῶν, ὅπως μὴ ἅμα ἀποθνήσκοντος τοῦ ἀνθρώπου διασκεδάννυνται ἡ ψυχὴ καὶ αὐτῇ τοῦ εἶναι τοῦτο τέλος ᾗ. τί γὰρ κωλύει γίγνεσθαι μὲν αὐτὴν καὶ συνίστασθαι ἄλλοθὲν ποθεν καὶ εἶναι πρὶν καὶ εἰς ἀνθρώπειον σῶμα ἀφικέσθαι, ἐπειδὰν δὲ ἀφίκηται καὶ ἀπαλλάττηται τούτου, τότε καὶ αὐτὴν τελευτᾶν καὶ διαφθείρεσθαι;

77c

CE: “You expressed that well, Simmias,” said Cebes. “It seems as if what has been proven is half of what is required, that our soul existed before we were born. But it is necessary to add a proof that after we die, it will exist no less than before birth, if the proof is to be complete.”

77c

S: “Well, Simmias and Cebes, that has been proven already,” said Socrates, “provided you combine this argument and the one we agreed upon before this, the one about all the living being born from the dead, into the same argument. For if the soul also exists previously, and it must come to life and come into being from nowhere else but from death and dying, surely it must exist after death since it has to be born again? So the proof you require has already been given. Nevertheless, I think that you and Simmias would also love to pursue this argument even further, and you are afraid, like children, lest, in truth, the wind will blow the soul away and scatter it when it departs from the body, especially if someone happens to die, not on a calm day, but during a strong gale.”

εὖ λέγεις, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία, ὁ Κέβης. φαίνεται γὰρ ὥσπερ ἡμῖς ἀποδεδειχθαι οὗ δεῖ, ὅτι πρὶν γενέσθαι ἡμᾶς ἢ ἡμῶν ἢ ψυχὴ, δεῖ δὲ προσποδεῖξαι ὅτι καὶ ἐπειδὴ ἀποθάνωμεν οὐδὲν ἦττον ἔσται ἢ πρὶν γενέσθαι, εἰ μέλλει τέλος ἢ ἀπόδειξις ἔξειν. ἀποδέδεικται μὲν, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, ὁ Σωκράτης, καὶ νῦν, εἰ θέλετε συνθεῖναι τοῦτόν τε τὸν λόγον εἰς ταῦτόν καὶ ὃν πρὸ τούτου ὡμολογήσαμεν, τὸ γίνεσθαι πᾶν τὸ ζῶν ἐκ τοῦ τεθνεῶτος. εἰ γὰρ ἔστιν μὲν ἡ ψυχὴ καὶ πρότερον, ἀνάγκη δὲ αὐτῇ εἰς τὸ ζῆν ἰούσῃ τε καὶ γιγνομένη μηδαμῶθεν ἄλλοθεν ἢ ἐκ θανάτου καὶ τοῦ τεθάναι γίνεσθαι, πῶς οὐκ ἀνάγκη αὐτὴν καὶ ἐπειδὴ ἀποθάνῃ εἶναι, ἐπειδὴ γε δεῖ αὐτῇ αὐτὴν γίνεσθαι; ἀποδέδεικται μὲν οὖν ὅπερ λέγετε καὶ νῦν. ὅμως δέ μοι δοκεῖς σύ τε καὶ Σιμμίας ἡδέως ἂν καὶ τοῦτον διαπραγματεύσασθαι τὸν λόγον ἔτι μᾶλλον, καὶ δεδιέναι τὸ τῶν παίδων, μὴ ὡς ἀληθῶς ὁ ἄνεμος αὐτὴν ἐκβαίνουσιν ἐκ τοῦ σώματος διαφυσᾷ

77e

CE: Cebes laughed at this, and said, “Try to reassure us, Socrates, as if we were afraid. We are not really afraid, but perhaps there is some child within us who is afraid of such things. So try to persuade him not to fear death, as he fears monsters.”

77e

S: “Then,” said Socrates, “you should sing charms to him every day until this has been charmed away.”

καὶ διασκεδάννυσιν, ἄλλως τε καὶ ὅταν τύχη τις μὴ ἐν νηνεμίᾳ ἀλλ' ἐν μεγάλῳ τινὶ πνεύματι ἀποθνήσκων. καὶ ὁ Κέβης ἐπιγελάσας, ὡς δεδιότων, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, πειρῶ ἀναπεῖθαι· μᾶλλον δὲ μὴ ὡς ἡμῶν δεδιότων, ἀλλ' ἴσως ἔνι τις καὶ ἐν ἡμῖν παῖς ὅστις τὰ τοιαῦτα φοβεῖται. τοῦτον οὖν πειρῶ μεταπεῖθαι μὴ δεδιέναι τὸν θάνατον ὥσπερ τὰ μορμολύκεια. ἀλλὰ χρή, ἔφη ὁ Σωκράτης, ἐπάδειν αὐτῷ ἐκάστης ἡμέρας ἕως ἄν ἐξεπάσῃτε. ΦΑΙΔ.

78a

CE: “Now, Socrates,” he said, “where are we going to get a good singer of such charms, since you are leaving us?”

78a

S: “Greece is well populated, Cebes, and there are surely many good men there, and the non-Greek peoples are numerous too, so you should search all these thoroughly in pursuit of such a singer of charms, sparing neither money nor effort, for there is no better way to spend your money than on this. But you should also search with one another for you are unlikely to find anyone more capable of doing this than yourselves.”

πόθεν οὖν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, τῶν τοιούτων ἀγαθὸν ἐπώδον ληψόμεθα, ἐπειδὴ σύ, ἔφη, ἡμᾶς ἀπολείπεις; πολλὴ μὲν ἡ Ἑλλάς, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, ἐν ἣ ἔννεοί που ἀγαθοὶ ἄνδρες, πολλὰ δὲ καὶ τὰ τῶν βαρβάρων γένη, οὓς πάντας χρή διερευνᾶσθαι ζητοῦντας τοιοῦτον ἐπώδον, μήτε χρημάτων φειδομένους μήτε πόνων, ὡς οὐκ ἔστιν εἰς ὅτι ἂν εὐκαιρότερον ἀναλίσκοιτε χρήματα. ζητεῖν δὲ χρή καὶ αὐτοὺς μετ' ἀλλήλων· ἴσως γὰρ

ἂν οὐδὲ ῥαδίως εὔροιτε μᾶλλον ὑμῶν δυναμένους τοῦτο ποιεῖν. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μὲν δή, ἔφη, ὑπάρξει, ὁ Κέβης· ὅθεν δὲ

78b

CE: “Very well,” said Cebes, “this shall be done. However, we should resume the discussion from where we left off, if that is acceptable to you.”

S: “Of course it is acceptable. Why wouldn’t it be?”

CE: “Well spoken,” he said.

78b

S: “In that case,” said Socrates, “should we ask ourselves a question like this: to what sort of thing does the fate of being scattered belong, and for what sort of thing should we fear this fate, and what sort of thing escapes it? Then should we go on to investigate which of the two is soul, and on this basis be confident or fearful for our own soul.”

ἀπελίπομεν ἐπ’ ἀνέλθωμεν, εἴ σοι ἡδομένῳ ἐστίν. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἡδομένῳ γε· πῶς γὰρ οὐ μέλλει; καλῶς, ἔφη, λέγεις. οὐκοῦν τοιόνδε τι, ἧ δ’ ὅς ὁ Σωκράτης, δεῖ ἡμᾶς ἀνερέσθαι ἑαυτούς, τῷ ποίῳ τινὶ ἄρα προσήκει τοῦτο τὸ πάθος πάσχειν, τὸ διασκεδάννυσθαι, καὶ ὑπὲρ τοῦ ποίου τινὸς δεδιέναι μὴ πάθῃ αὐτό, καὶ τῷ ποίῳ τινὶ οὐ· καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο αὖ ἐπισκέψασθαι πότερον ἢ ψυχὴ ἐστίν, καὶ ἐκ τούτων θαρρεῖν ἢ δεδιέναι ὑπὲρ τῆς ἡμετέρας ψυχῆς; ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις.

CE: “What you say is true,” he said.

78c

S: “Now, doesn’t it belong to something which has been compounded, and which is by nature a compound, to suffer this fate and to be broken up in the same way it was compounded? But if there is anything which is un-compounded, it belongs to this alone, if anything, not to suffer such a fate.”

CE: “I think this is true,” said Cebes.

78c

S: “Now, the things which are always the same and unchanging are most likely to be the un-compounded things, while those which are constantly changing and never the same are those which are compounded. Is this so?”

ἄρ' οὖν τῷ μὲν συντεθέντι τε καὶ συνθέτῳ ὄντι φύσει προσήκει τοῦτο πάσχειν, διαιρεθῆναι ταύτῃ ἥπερ συνετέθη· εἰ δέ τι τυγχάνει ὃν ἀσύνθετον, τούτῳ μόνῳ προσήκει μὴ πάσχειν ταῦτα, εἴπερ τῷ ἄλλῳ; δοκεῖ μοι, ἔφη, οὕτως ἔχειν, ὁ Κέβης. οὐκοῦν ἅπερ αἰεὶ κατὰ ταῦτά καὶ ὡσαύτως ἔχει, ταῦτα μάλιστα εἰκὸς εἶναι τὰ ἀσύνθετα, τὰ δὲ ἄλλοτ' ἄλλως καὶ μηδέποτε κατὰ ταῦτά, ταῦτα δὲ σύνθετα; ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ οὕτως. ἴωμεν δὴ, ἔφη, ἐπὶ ταῦτά ἐφ' ἅπερ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν

CE: “Well, it seems so to me, anyway.”

78d

S: “Then let us go”, he said, “to the same things we discussed earlier. Is the being itself, whose existence we give an account of through question and answer, always unchanging and the same, or is it constantly changing? The equal itself, the good itself, that which each itself is, and ‘what is’, do these ever admit any change whatsoever? Or does that which each of them always is, since it is uniform just by itself, remain the same and unchanging and never admit any alteration in any respect?”

CE: “It must remain unchanging and the same, Socrates,” said Cebes.

78d

S: “And what about the many beautiful things, such as people or garments or anything else of that sort, or the many equals, or anything else bearing the same name as those unchanging things? Do these remain the same, or in total contrast to those are they almost never ever the same as themselves or one another in any respect at all?”

λόγῳ. αὐτὴ ἡ οὐσία ἧς λόγον δίδομεν τοῦ εἶναι καὶ ἐρωτῶντες καὶ ἀποκρινόμενοι, πότερον ὡσαύτως αἰεὶ ἔχει κατὰ ταῦτά ἢ ἄλλοτ' ἄλλως; αὐτὸ τὸ ἴσον, αὐτὸ τὸ καλόν, αὐτὸ ἕκαστον ὃ ἔστιν, τὸ ὄν, μὴ ποτε

μεταβολὴν καὶ ἡντινοῦν ἐνδέχεται; ἢ ἀεὶ αὐτῶν ἕκαστον ὃ ἔστι, μονοειδὲς ὃν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό, ὡσαύτως κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχει καὶ οὐδέποτε οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς ἀλλοίωσιν οὐδεμίαν ἐνδέχεται; ὡσαύτως, ἔφη, ἀνάγκη, ὁ Κέβης, κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχειν, ὦ Σώκρατες. τί δὲ τῶν πολλῶν καλῶν, οἷον ἀνθρώπων ἢ ἵππων ἢ

78e

CE: “Yes, that is the way they are,” said Cebes. “They never remain the same.”

78e

S: “Now, these you can touch and see and perceive with the other senses. However, there is nothing else by which you could ever apprehend the unchanging things, except the reasoning of the mind, but such things are unseen and are not visible. Is this so?”

ἱματίων ἢ ἄλλων ὠντινωνοῦν τοιούτων, ἢ ἴσων ἢ καλῶν ἢ πάντων τῶν ἐκείνοις ὁμωνύμων; ἄρα κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχει, ἢ πᾶν τούναντίον ἐκείνοις οὔτε αὐτὰ αὐτοῖς οὔτε ἀλλήλοις οὐδέποτε ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδαμῶς κατὰ ταῦτά; οὕτως αὖ, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, ταῦτα οὐδέποτε ὡσαύτως ἔχει. ΦΑΙΔ.

CE: “What you are saying is entirely true,” he replied.

79a

S: “Then would you like us to propose two kinds of things that are, one visible, the other not visible?”

οὐκοῦν τούτων μὲν κἂν ἄψαιο κἂν ἴδοις κἂν ταῖς ἄλλαις αἰσθήσεσιν αἰσθοιο, τῶν δὲ κατὰ ταῦτα ἐχόντων οὐκ ἔστιν ὅτω ποτ' ἂν ἄλλω ἐπιλάβοιο ἢ τῷ τῆς διανοίας λογισμῷ, ἀλλ' ἔστιν αἰδῆ τὰ τοιαῦτα καὶ οὐχ ὁράτά; παντάπασιν, ἔφη, ἀληθῆ λέγεις. θῶμεν οὖν βούλει, ἔφη, δύο εἶδη τῶν ὄντων, τὸ μὲν ὁρατόν, τὸ δὲ αἰδές; θῶμεν, ἔφη. καὶ τὸ μὲν αἰδὲς ἀεὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ἔχον, τὸ δὲ ὁρατὸν μηδέποτε κατὰ ταῦτά; καὶ τοῦτο, ἔφη, θῶμεν.

CE: “Let us propose that.”

S: “And does that which is not visible always remain the same, while the visible is never the same?”

CE: “We should propose this too.”

S: “Come then,” he said, “do we ourselves consist of anything other than body and soul?”

CE: “Nothing else.”

79b

S: “Now, which kind do we say the body most resembles and to which is it most akin?”

φέρει δὴ, ἢ δ' ὅς, ἄλλο τι ἡμῶν αὐτῶν τὸ μὲν σῶμά ἐστι, τὸ δὲ ψυχὴ; οὐδὲν ἄλλο, ἔφη. ποτέρῳ οὖν ὁμοιότερον τῷ εἶδει φαμὲν ἂν εἶναι καὶ συγγενέστερον τὸ σῶμα; παντί, ἔφη, τοῦτό γε δῆλον, ὅτι τῷ ὁρατῷ. τί δὲ ἡ ψυχὴ; ὁρατὸν ἢ αἰδές; οὐχ ὑπ' ἀνθρώπων γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἡμεῖς γε τὰ ὁρατὰ καὶ τὰ μὴ τῇ τῶν ἀνθρώπων φύσει ἐλέγομεν· ἢ ἄλλῃ τινὶ οἶει; τῇ τῶν ἀνθρώπων. τί οὖν περὶ ψυχῆς λέγομεν; ὁρατὸν ἢ ἀόρατον εἶναι; οὐχ ὁρατόν. αἰδές ἄρα; ναί. ὁμοιότερον ἄρα ψυχὴ σώματος ἐστὶν τῷ αἰδεῖ, τὸ δὲ τῷ ὁρατῷ. πᾶσα ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκρατες. οὐκοῦν καὶ τόδε πάλαί ἐλέγομεν, ὅτι ἡ ψυχὴ, ὅταν μὲν τῷ σώματι προσχρῆται εἰς τὸ σκοπεῖν τι ἢ διὰ τοῦ ὁρᾶν ἢ διὰ τοῦ ἀκούειν ἢ δι' ἄλλης τινὸς αἰσθήσεως — τοῦτο γὰρ ἐστὶν τὸ διὰ τοῦ σώματος, τὸ δι' αἰσθήσεως σκοπεῖν τι — τότε μὲν ἔλκεται ὑπὸ τοῦ σώματος εἰς τὰ οὐδέποτε κατὰ ταῦτ' ἔχοντα, καὶ αὐτὴ πλανᾶται καὶ ταράττεται καὶ εἰλιγγιᾷ ὥσπερ μεθύουσα, ἅτε τοιούτων ἐφαπτομένη; πάνυ γε.

CE: “It is obvious to everyone that it resembles the visible kind.”

S: “What about the soul? Is it visible or invisible?”

CE: “It cannot be seen by humans anyway, Socrates.”

S: “But surely we meant visible and invisible in the context of the nature of human beings? Or do you think otherwise?”

CE: “No, the context is the nature of human beings.”

S: “Now, what do we say about the soul? That it is visible or that it is invisible?”

CE: “It is not visible.”

S: “So it is invisible then?”

CE: “Yes.”

S: “So the soul is more like the invisible than the body is, while the body is more like the visible.”

CE: “Yes, Socrates, it absolutely must be.”

79c

S: “Well have we not said this before? Whenever the soul makes use of the body to consider anything, either through sight or through hearing or through any other sense – for consideration through the body means considering anything through the senses – then the soul is dragged by the body to things which never remain the same. It wanders, is confused, and it is dizzy as though drunk because it is in contact with things of that sort.”

CE: “Yes, indeed.”

79d

S: “But whenever it considers just by itself, the soul departs to another realm, to the pure, eternal, immortal and unchanging. And since it is akin to this, it is constantly in its presence, whenever it is just by itself and allowed to be so. Then the soul ceases its wandering, associates with these, and remains always the same and unchanging because it is in contact with things of that sort. And this condition of the soul is called wisdom.”

ὅταν δέ γε αὐτὴ καθ' αὐτὴν σκοπῇ, ἐκεῖσε οἴχεται εἰς τὸ καθαρὸν τε καὶ αἰεὶ ὄν καὶ ἀθάνατον καὶ ὡσαύτως ἔχον, καὶ ὡς συγγενὴς οὖσα αὐτοῦ αἰεὶ μετ' ἐκείνου τε γίννεται, ὅταν περ αὐτὴ καθ' αὐτὴν γέννηται καὶ ἐξῇ αὐτῇ, καὶ πέπαυταί τε τοῦ πλάνου καὶ περὶ ἐκεῖνα αἰεὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ὡσαύτως ἔχει, ἅτε τοιούτων ἐφαπτομένη καὶ τοῦτο αὐτῆς τὸ πάθημα

φρόνησις κέκληται; παντάπασιν, ἔφη, καλῶς καὶ ἀληθῆ λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ποτέρῳ οὖν αὖ σοι δοκεῖ τῷ εἶδει καὶ ἐκ τῶν πρόσθεν καὶ ἐκ

CE: “What you are saying is entirely beautiful and true, Socrates,” he said.

79e

S: “Well then, from what we have already said and are now saying, which of the two kinds does the soul seem to you to resemble, and to which is it more akin?”

79e

CE: “Socrates,” he replied, “I think that anyone, even the slowest learner, would agree, based upon this approach, that the soul is completely and, in every respect, more like that which always remains the same, rather than that which does not.”

τῶν νῦν λεγομένων ψυχὴ ὁμοιότερον εἶναι καὶ συγγενέστερον; πᾶς ἂν μοι δοκεῖ, ἢ δ’ ὅς, συγχωρῆσαι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐκ ταύτης τῆς μεθόδου, καὶ ὁ δυσμαθέστατος, ὅτι ὅλῳ καὶ παντὶ ὁμοιότερόν ἐστι ψυχὴ τῷ αἰεὶ ὡσαύτως ἔχοντι μᾶλλον ἢ τῷ μὴ. τί δὲ τὸ σῶμα; τῷ ἐτέρῳ. ΦΑΙΔ. ὅρα δὴ καὶ τῇδε ὅτι ἐπειδὴν ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ὥσι ψυχὴ καὶ

S: “What about the body?”

CE: “It is more like the other kind.”

80a

S: “Now, look at it this way. Once soul and body are together, nature directs the body to serve and be ruled, and the soul to rule and dominate. And in these respects again, which of them do you think is like the divine and which like the mortal? Or don’t you think the divine is naturally fitted to rule and to lead, and the mortal to be ruled and to serve?”

σῶμα, τῷ μὲν δουλεύειν καὶ ἄρχεσθαι ἢ φύσις προστάττει, τῇ δὲ ἄρχειν καὶ δεσπόζειν· καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα αὖ πότερόν σοι δοκεῖ ὁμοιον τῷ θείῳ εἶναι καὶ πότερον τῷ θνητῷ; ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι τὸ μὲν θεῖον οἷον ἄρχειν τε καὶ ἡγεμονεύειν πεφυκέναι, τὸ δὲ θνητὸν ἄρχεσθαι τε καὶ δουλεύειν;

ἔμοιγε. ποτέρῳ οὖν ἡ ψυχὴ ἔοικεν; δῆλα δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι ἡ μὲν ψυχὴ τῷ θείῳ, τὸ δὲ σῶμα τῷ θνητῷ. σκοπεῖ δὴ, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, εἰ ἐκ πάντων τῶν εἰρημένων

CE: “Yes, I do.”

S: “Then, which of them does the soul resemble?”

CE: “It is obvious, Socrates, that the soul resembles the divine, while the body resembles the mortal.”

80b

S: “Then consider this, Cebes,” he said. “From everything that has been said, are we to conclude that the soul is most like the divine, immortal, single in form and indissoluble, which is known by reason and always remains unchanging and the same as itself? And is the body, on the other hand, most like the human, mortal, unreasoning, multiform and dissoluble, which never remains the same as itself? Do we have anything to say which contradicts this, dear Cebes, anything which says that this is not the case?”

CE: “We have nothing.”

80b

S: “Well then, this being the case, doesn’t it belong to the body to be readily dissolved, while the soul, for its part, is entirely indissoluble or almost so?”

τάδε ἡμῖν συμβαίνει, τῷ μὲν θείῳ καὶ ἀθανάτῳ καὶ νοητῷ καὶ μονοειδεῖ καὶ ἀδιαλύτῳ καὶ αἰὶ ὡσαύτως κατὰ ταῦτά ἔχοντι ἑαυτῷ ὁμοιότατον εἶναι ψυχῇ, τῷ δὲ ἀνθρωπίνῳ καὶ θνητῷ καὶ πολυειδεῖ καὶ ἀνοήτῳ καὶ διαλυτῷ καὶ μηδέποτε κατὰ ταῦτά ἔχοντι ἑαυτῷ ὁμοιότατον αὖ εἶναι σῶμα. ἔχομέν τι παρὰ ταῦτα ἄλλο λέγειν, ὦ φίλε Κέβης, ἢ οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει; οὐκ ἔχομεν. τί οὖν; τούτων οὕτως ἐχόντων ἄρ’ οὐχὶ σῶματι μὲν ταχὺ διαλύεσθαι προσήκει, ψυχῇ δὲ αὖ τὸ παράπαν ἀδιαλύτῳ εἶναι ἢ ἐγγύς τι τούτου;

80c

CE: “How could it be otherwise?”

80c

S: “Now, you realise”, he said, “that when a person dies, his visible part, the body, lying in the visible realm, the thing we call a corpse, is prone to dissolution, decomposition and dispersal. But none of these processes happens immediately; instead, it endures for quite a long time, and if someone dies while the body is in good condition and at the right time of life, it lasts even longer. Indeed, once the body has shrunk and has been embalmed as the Egyptians embalm them, it remains almost entire for a considerable period of time, and even when it decays, some parts of the body, bones and sinews and everything of that sort, are virtually immortal. Isn’t this so?”

πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ἐννοεῖς οὖν, ἔφη, ἐπειδὴν ἀποθάνῃ ὁ ἄνθρωπος, τὸ μὲν ὁρατὸν αὐτοῦ, τὸ σῶμα, καὶ ἐν ὁρατῷ κείμενον, ὃ δὴ νεκρὸν καλοῦμεν, ᾧ προσήκει διαλύεσθαι καὶ διαπίπτειν καὶ διαπνεῖσθαι, οὐκ εὐθὺς τούτων οὐδὲν πέπονθεν, ἀλλ’ ἐπεικῶς συχνὸν ἐπιμένει χρόνον, ἐὰν μὲν τις καὶ χαριέντως ἔχων τὸ σῶμα τελευτήσῃ καὶ ἐν τοιαύτῃ ὥρᾳ, καὶ πάνυ μάλα συμπεσὼν γὰρ τὸ σῶμα καὶ ταριχευθέν, ὥσπερ οἱ ἐν Αἰγύπτῳ ταριχευθέντες, ὀλίγου ὅλον μένει ἀμήχανον ὅσον χρόνον,

CE: “Yes.”

80d

S: “But does the soul, the unseen, go to another noble, pure and unseen place of this sort, a true Hades, alongside the good and wise god, whither, God willing, my own soul should go? Is something of this sort, endowed with such a nature, dispersed and destroyed as soon as it departs from the body, as most people say? Far from it, dear Cebes and Simmias. No, the outcome is much more like the following. If the soul were to depart whilst pure, dragging nothing belonging to the body with it, because the soul had no willing communion with it in life but shunned it, and gathered itself into itself because that is its constant practice, then this is nothing but the proper practice of philosophy, and the true practice of dying without reluctance. Or would this not be the practice of death?”

ἔνια δὲ μέρη τοῦ σώματος, καὶ ἂν σαπῇ, ὅστ᾽ τε καὶ νεῦρα καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα πάντα, ὅμως ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν ἀθάνατά ἐστιν· ἢ οὐ; ναί. ἡ δὲ ψυχὴ ἄρα, τὸ αἰδές, τὸ εἰς τοιοῦτον τόπον ἕτερον οἰχόμενον γενναῖον καὶ καθαρὸν καὶ αἰδῇ, εἰς Ἄιδου ὥς ἀληθῶς, παρὰ τὸν ἀγαθὸν καὶ φρόνιμον θεόν, οἷ, ἂν θεὸς θέλῃ, αὐτίκα καὶ τῇ ἐμῇ ψυχῇ ἰτέον, αὕτη δὲ δὴ ἡμῖν ἡ τοιαύτη καὶ οὕτω πεφυκυῖα ἀπαλλαττομένη τοῦ σώματος εὐθὺς διαπεφύσεται καὶ ἀπόλῳεν, ὥς φασιν οἱ πολλοὶ ἄνθρωποι; πολλοῦ γε δεῖ, ὦ φίλε Κέβης τε καὶ Σιμμία, ἀλλὰ πολλῷ μᾶλλον ὧδ' ἔχει· ἐὰν μὲν καθαρὰ ἀπαλλάττεται, μηδὲν τοῦ σώματος συνεφέλκουσα, ἅτε οὐδὲν κοινωνοῦσα αὐτῷ ἐν τῷ βίῳ ἐκοῦσα εἶναι, ἀλλὰ φεύγουσα αὐτὸ καὶ συνηθροισμένη αὐτῇ εἰς ἑαυτήν, ἅτε μελετῶσα ἀεὶ τοῦτο — τὸ δὲ οὐδὲν ἄλλο ἐστὶν ἢ ὁρθῶς φιλοσοφοῦσα καὶ τῷ ὄντι

81a

CE: “Entirely so.”

81a

S: “Once it is in this condition, will the soul not journey to that which is like it, to the unseen, the divine, immortal and wise, and on arrival will blessedness not be its lot, being released from wandering and stupidity, fears and wild passions and the other evils of the human condition? Then, as they say of the initiated, the soul truly spends the rest of the time with the gods. Should we describe it like this, Cebes, or in a different way?”

τεθνάναι μελετῶσα ῥαδίως· ἢ οὐ τοῦτ' ἂν εἴη μελέτη θανάτου; ΦΑΙΔ. παντάπασί γε. οὐκοῦν οὕτω μὲν ἔχουσα εἰς τὸ ὅμοιον αὐτῇ τὸ αἰδές ἀπέρχεται, τὸ θεῖον τε καὶ ἀθάνατον καὶ φρόνιμον, οἷ ἀφικομένη ὑπάρχει αὐτῇ εὐδαίμονι εἶναι, πλάνης καὶ ἀνοίας καὶ φόβων καὶ ἀγρίων ἐρώτων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων κακῶν τῶν ἀνθρωπείων ἀπηλλαγμένη, ὥσπερ δὲ λέγεται κατὰ τῶν μεμνημένων, ὥς ἀληθῶς τὸν λοιπὸν χρόνον μετὰ θεῶν διάγουσα; οὕτω φῶμεν, ὦ Κέβης, ἢ ἄλλως; οὕτω νῆ Δία, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης.

CE: “In this way, by Zeus,” replied Cebes.

81b

S: “But if, on the other hand, it departs from the body, sullied and impure, because the soul constantly associates with it, serving it and loving it and being enchanted by it through desires and pleasures, so that nothing seems to be true except what has bodily form, what one can touch and see, eat or drink, or use for sexual gratification, while anything obscure to the eyes and unseen, known by reason and apprehended by philosophy, is something it tends to hate, fear and shun, do you think that a soul in such a condition will depart pure, just by itself?”

ἐὰν δέ γε οἷμαι μεμιασμένη καὶ ἀκάθαρτος τοῦ σώματος ἀπαλλάττηται, ἅτε τῷ σώματι ἀεὶ συνοῦσα καὶ τοῦτο θεραπεύουσα καὶ ἐρῶσα καὶ γοητευομένη ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ ὑπὸ τε τῶν ἐπιθυμιῶν καὶ ἡδονῶν, ὥστε μηδὲν ἄλλο δοκεῖν εἶναι ἀληθές ἀλλ’ ἢ τὸ σωματοειδές, οὗ τις ἂν ἄψαιτο καὶ ἴδοι καὶ πίοι καὶ φάγοι καὶ πρὸς τὰ ἀφροδίσια χρήσαιτο, τὸ δὲ τοῖς ὅμμασι σκοτῶδες καὶ αἰδές, νοητὸν δὲ καὶ φιλοσοφία αἰρετόν, τοῦτο δὲ εἰθισμένη μισεῖν τε καὶ τρέμειν καὶ φύγειν, οὕτω

CE: “Not at all,” he replied.

81c

S: “Rather, when interpenetrated by that which has bodily form, I think this familiarity and association with the body forces the soul to adopt its nature due to the constant association and great concern with the physical.”

CE: “Yes, certainly.”

81c

S: “Well then, my friend, we must accept that this element is burdensome, heavy, earthy and visible. And, indeed, the kind of soul which possesses this is weighed down and dragged once more into the visible realm through fear of Hades and the unseen, and as the story goes, prowls about memorials and tombs, where indeed some shadowy apparitions of souls have actually been seen. These are the visible images of souls of this kind, souls which were not set free in a pure

condition but partaking of the visible, and that is why they can be seen.”

δὴ ἔχουσιν οἷσι ψυχὴν αὐτὴν καθ’ αὐτὴν εἰλικρινῇ ἀπαλλάξεσθαι; οὐδ’ ὁπωστιοῦν, ἔφη. ἀλλὰ καὶ διειλημμένην γε οἶμαι ὑπὸ τοῦ σωματοειδοῦς, ὃ αὐτῇ ἡ ὁμιλία τε καὶ συνουσία τοῦ σώματος διὰ τὸ ἀεὶ συνεῖναι καὶ διὰ τὴν πολλὴν μελέτην ἐνεποίησε σύμφυτον; πάνυ γε. ἐμβριθεὶς δέ γε, ὦ φίλε, τοῦτο οἶεσθαι χρή εἶναι καὶ βαρὺ καὶ γεῶδες καὶ ὁρατόν· ὃ δὴ καὶ ἔχουσα ἡ τοιαύτη ψυχὴ βαρύνεται τε καὶ ἔλκεται πάλιν εἰς τὸν ὁρατὸν τόπον φόβῳ τοῦ αἰδοῦς τε καὶ Ἰδίου, ὥσπερ λέγεται, περὶ τὰ

CE: “Quite likely, Socrates.”

81d

S: “Yes, Cebes, and it is also likely that these are the souls not of good but of degenerate folk, who are compelled to wander about such places to pay the penalty for their former way of life which was bad. And they wander until they are bound once more in a body by the desire belonging to the bodily form, their close consort. And quite likely, they are bound in such habits as they have practised during life.”

μνήματά τε καὶ τοὺς τάφους κυλινδουμένη, περὶ ἃ δὴ καὶ ὥφθη ἅττα ψυχῶν σκιοειδῆ φαντάσματα, οἷα παρέχονται αἱ τοιαῦται ψυχαὶ εἶδωλα, αἱ μὴ καθαρῶς ἀπολυθεῖσαι ἀλλὰ τοῦ ὁρατοῦ μετέχουσαι, διὸ καὶ ὀρῶνται. εἰκὸς γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰκὸς μέντοι, ὦ Κέβης, καὶ οὐ τί γε τὰς τῶν ἀγαθῶν αὐτὰς εἶναι, ἀλλὰ τὰς τῶν φαύλων, αἱ περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἀναγκάζονται πλανᾶσθαι δίκην τίνουσαι τῆς προτέρας τροφῆς κακῆς οὔσης, καὶ μέχρι γε τούτου πλανῶνται, ἕως ἂν τῇ

CE: “What sort of habits do you mean, Socrates?”

81e

S: “For instance, those who have practised gluttony, insolence or drunkenness, rather than avoiding these at all costs, are likely to take on the forms of donkeys or beasts of that sort. Or do you not think so?”

τοῦ συνεπακολουθοῦντος, τοῦ σωματοειδοῦς, ἐπιθυμίᾳ πάλιν ἐνδεθῶσιν εἰς σῶμα ἐνδοῦνται δέ, ὥσπερ εἰκός, εἰς τοιαῦτα ἦθη ὅποι' ἄττ' ἂν καὶ μεμελετηκυῖαι τύχωσιν ἐν τῷ βίῳ. τὰ ποῖα δὴ ταῦτα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκратες; οἷον τοὺς μὲν γαστριμαργίας τε καὶ ὕβρεις καὶ φιλοποσίας μεμελετηκότας καὶ μὴ διηυλαβημένους εἰς τὰ τῶν ὄνων γένη

CE: “What you are saying is certainly very likely.”

82a

S: “While those who have preferred injustice, tyranny and robbery take on the forms of wolves, hawks and kites. Or where else should we say such souls go?”

CE: “Into creatures of this sort, of course,” said Cebes.

S: “And obviously each of the others would take their course based upon the similarities of their concern.”

CE: “Yes, that is obvious. How could it be otherwise?”

82a

S: “Will the happiest among them not take the best course, those who have pursued civil and social virtue which they call sound-mindedness and justice, born of habit and concern but devoid of philosophy and of reason?”

καὶ τῶν τοιούτων θηρίων εἰκός ἐνδύεσθαι. ΦΑΙΔ. ἢ οὐκ οἶει; πάνυ μὲν οὖν εἰκός λέγεις. τοὺς δέ γε ἀδικίας τε καὶ τυραννίδας καὶ ἀρπαγὰς προτετιμηκότας εἰς τὰ τῶν λύκων τε καὶ ἱεράκων καὶ ἰκτίνων γένη ἢ ποῖ ἂν ἄλλοσέ φαμεν τὰς τοιαύτας ἰέναι; ἀμέλει, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, εἰς τὰ τοιαῦτα. οὐκοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς, δῆλα δὴ καὶ τᾶλλα ἢ ἂν ἕκαστα ἴοι κατὰ τὰς αὐτῶν ὁμοιότητος τῆς μελέτης; δῆλον δὴ, ἔφη πῶς δ' οὐ; οὐκοῦν εὐδαιμονέστατοι, ἔφη, καὶ τούτων εἰσὶ καὶ εἰς βέλτιστον τόπον ἰόντες οἱ τὴν δημοτικὴν καὶ πολιτικὴν

CE: “In what sense are they happiest?”

82b

S: “Because it is likely that these people return once more to this sort of sociable or gentle class, perhaps as bees, wasps or ants, or even into

the human race again, and from them moderate people are born.”

CE: “Quite likely.”

82b

S: “However, no one but the lover of knowledge, one who has practised philosophy and departs in an entirely pure condition, is allowed to attain the race of gods. And these are the reasons, Simmias my friend, and you too Cebes, why those who love wisdom aright abstain from all of the desires of the body and resist them and do not give themselves over to them. It is not because they fear poverty or loss of property, like most people who love wealth; nor again do they refrain from them because they are afraid of dishonour, or a reputation for depravity, like the lovers of power and reputation.”

ἀρετὴν ἐπιτετηδευκότες, ἣν δὴ καλοῦσι σωφροσύνην τε καὶ δικαιοσύνην, ἐξ ἔθους τε καὶ μελέτης γεγονυῖαν ἄνευ φιλοσοφίας τε καὶ νοῦ; πῇ δὴ οὗτοι εὐδαιμονέσονται; ὅτι τούτους εἰκός ἐστιν εἰς τοιοῦτον πάλιν ἀφικνεῖσθαι πολιτικὸν καὶ ἡμέρον γένος, ἢ που μελιτῶν ἢ σφηκῶν ἢ μυρμηκῶν, καὶ εἰς ταῦτόν γε πάλιν τὸ ἀνθρώπινον γένος, καὶ γίγνεσθαι ἐξ αὐτῶν ἄνδρας μετρίους. εἰκός. εἰς δέ γε θεῶν γένος μὴ φιλοσοφήσαντι καὶ παντελῶς καθαρῶ ἀπιόντι οὐ θέμις ἀφικνεῖσθαι ἀλλ’ ἢ τῷ φιλομαθεῖ. ἀλλὰ τούτων ἕνεκα, ὧς ἔταίρε Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, οἱ ὁρθῶς φιλόσοφοι ἀπέχονται τῶν κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἐπιθυμιῶν ἀπασῶν καὶ καρτεροῦσι καὶ οὐ παραδιδόασιν αὐταῖς ἑαυτούς, οὐ τι οἰκοφθορίαν τε καὶ πενίαν φοβούμενοι, ὥσπερ οἱ πολλοὶ καὶ φιλοχρήματοι· οὐδὲ αὖ ἀτιμίαν τε καὶ ἀδοξίαν μοχθηρίας δεδιότες, ὥσπερ οἱ φίλαρχοί τε καὶ φιλότιμοι, ἔπειτα ἀπέχονται αὐτῶν. οὐ γὰρ ἂν πρέποι, ἔφη, ὧς Σώκρατες, ὁ Κέβης.

82d

CE: “Indeed, Socrates, that would not be appropriate,” said Cebes.

82d

S: “It certainly would not, by Zeus,” he said. “For in fact, Cebes, those with any concern for their own soul who do not live their lives fashioning bodies bid farewell to these fellows and do not follow the

same path as people who do not know where they are going. They do not believe that they themselves should act in opposition to philosophy and the liberation and purifying process it affords, so they turn and follow philosophy wherever it may lead.”

οὐ μέντοι μὰ Δία, ἥ δ' ὅς. τοιγάρτοι τούτοις μὲν ἅπασιν, ὧ Κέβης, ἐκεῖνοι οἷς τι μέλει τῆς ἐαυτῶν ψυχῆς ἀλλὰ μὴ σώματι πλάττοντες ζῶσι, χαίρειν εἰπόντες, οὐ κατὰ ταῦτα πορεύονται αὐτοῖς ὥς οὐκ εἰδόντι ὅπῃ ἔρχονται, αὐτοὶ δὲ ἡγούμενοι οὐ δεῖν ἐναντία τῇ φιλοσοφίᾳ πράττειν καὶ τῇ ἐκείνης λύσει τε καὶ καθαριῶ ταύτῃ δὴ τρέπονται ἐκείνῃ ἐπόμενοι, ἢ ἐκείνῃ ὑφηγεῖται. πῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἐγὼ ἔρω, ἔφη. γιγνώσκουσι γάρ, ἥ δ' ὅς, οἱ φιλομαθεῖς

CE: “How does this happen, Socrates?”

82e

S: “I shall tell you,” he said. “Those who love knowledge realise that when philosophy takes the soul in hand, it is literally fettered within the body, glued to it, and the soul is compelled to view things that are through the body, as if it were a prison, rather than viewing them itself, through itself. The soul is wallowing in total ignorance, and philosophy discerns the most ingenious aspect of the prison, that it works by means of desires, so that the actual prisoner may be the greatest accomplice in his imprisonment. Now, as I was saying, the lovers of knowledge realise that when philosophy takes their soul in hand in such a condition as this, it exhorts the soul gently and tries to set it free, pointing out that enquiry by means of the eyes is fraught with deceit, and that enquiry by means of the ears and the other senses is also deceptive.

ὅτι παραλαβοῦσα αὐτῶν τὴν ψυχὴν ἢ φιλοσοφία ἀτεχνῶς διαδεδεμένη ἐν τῷ σώματι καὶ προσκεκολλημένην, ἀναγκαζομένην δὲ ὥσπερ διὰ εἶργμοῦ διὰ τούτου σκοπεῖσθαι τὰ ὄντα ἀλλὰ μὴ αὐτὴν δι' αὐτῆς, καὶ ἐν πάσῃ ἀμαθίᾳ κυλινδουμένην, καὶ τοῦ εἶργμοῦ τὴν δεινότητα κατιδοῦσα ὅτι δι' ἐπιθυμίας ἐστίν, ὥς ἂν μάλιστα αὐτὸς ὁ δεδεμένος συλλήπτωρ εἴῃ τοῦ δεδέσθαι, ΦΑΙΔ. — ὅπερ οὖν λέγω,

γιγνώσκουσιν οἱ φιλομαθεῖς ὅτι οὕτω παραλαβοῦσα ἡ φιλοσοφία ἔχουσιν αὐτῶν τὴν ψυχὴν ἡρέμα παραμυθεῖται καὶ λύνει ἐπιχειρεῖ, ἐνδεικνυμένη ὅτι ἀπάτης μὲν μεστή ἡ διὰ τῶν ὁμμάτων σκέψις, ἀπάτης δὲ ἡ διὰ τῶν ὥτων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων αἰσθήσεων, πείθουσα δὲ ἐκ τούτων μὲν ἀναχωρεῖν, ὅσον μὴ ἀνάγκη αὐτοῖς χρῆσθαι, αὐτὴν δὲ εἰς αὐτὴν συλλέγεσθαι καὶ ἀθροίζεσθαι παρακελευομένη, πιστεύειν δὲ μηδενὶ ἄλλῳ ἀλλ’

83b

S: “Philosophy persuades the soul to withdraw from the senses and use them only as much as necessary, imploring it to collect and gather itself into itself, trust nothing else except its own self, and what it can cognise just by itself, about things that are, just by themselves. The soul should not believe that what it considers by any other means, things that are different in different circumstances, are true. These are known by the senses and are visible, but what soul sees is known by reason and is unseen by the senses.

83b

S: “Now, the soul of the true philosopher does not think that this liberation should be resisted, and accordingly it refrains from pleasures and desires, pains and fears, as much as it is able to, realising that whenever people experience intense pleasure, pain, fear or desire, the extent of the evil which afflicts them as a consequence is not what they think it is. It is not disease or some financial loss born of desire. No, it is the greatest and most extreme evil of all, this they experience and do not realise it.”

ἡ αὐτὴν αὐτῇ, ὅτι ἂν νοήσῃ αὐτὴ καθ’ αὐτὴν αὐτὸ καθ’ αὐτὸ τῶν ὄντων· ὅτι δ’ ἂν δι’ ἄλλων σκοπῇ ἐν ἄλλοις ὃν ἄλλο, μηδὲν ἡγεῖσθαι ἀληθές· εἶναι δὲ τὸ μὲν τοιοῦτον αἰσθητόν τε καὶ ὁρατόν, ὃ δὲ αὐτὴ ὁρᾷ νοητόν τε καὶ αἰδέξ. ταύτῃ οὖν τῇ λύσει οὐκ οἰομένη δεῖν ἐναντιοῦσθαι ἢ τοῦ ὥς ἀληθῶς φιλοσόφου ψυχῇ οὕτως ἀπέχεται τῶν ἡδονῶν τε καὶ ἐπιθυμιῶν καὶ λυπῶν καὶ φόβων καθ’ ὅσον δύναται, λογιζομένη ὅτι, ἐπειδάν τις σφόδρα ἡσθῇ ἢ φοβηθῇ ἢ λυπηθῇ ἢ ἐπιθυμήσῃ, οὐδὲν τοσοῦτον κακὸν ἔπαθεν ἅπ’

83c

CE: “What is this evil, Socrates?” said Cebes.

83c

S: “That whilst experiencing intense pleasure or pain, the soul of every person is compelled to believe that whatever is mainly responsible for the experience is completely evident and entirely true, when this is not the case. And these are, for the most part, visible, aren’t they?”

αὐτῶν ὧν ἂν τις οἰηθείη, οἷον ἢ νοσήσας ἢ τι ἀναλώσας διὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας, ἀλλ’ ὃ πάντων μέγιστόν τε κακῶν καὶ ἔσχατόν ἐστι, τοῦτο πᾶσχει καὶ οὐ λογίζεται αὐτό. τί τοῦτο, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἔφη ὁ Κέβης. ὅτι ψυχὴ παντὸς ἀνθρώπου ἀναγκάζεται ἅμα τε ἡσθῆναι σφόδρα ἢ λυπηθῆναι ἐπὶ τῷ καὶ ἡγεῖσθαι περὶ ὃ ἂν μάλιστα τοῦτο πάσχη, τοῦτο ἐναργέστατόν τε εἶναι καὶ ἀληθέστατον, οὐχ οὕτως ἔχον· ταῦτα δὲ μάλιστα τὰ ὁρατὰ ἢ οὐ; πάνυ γε.

CE: “Yes, certainly.”

83d

S: “Is not the soul completely fettered by the body, in this experience?”

CE: “In what way?”

83d

S: “Because each pleasure and pain has a sort of nail which fastens and pins the soul to the body and makes it corporeal, fancying that whatever the body declares to be true is true. For I believe the soul is compelled to become like the body in manner and in nurture because it shares the body’s opinions and it delights in the same things. And it can never enter Hades in a pure condition, but it always departs contaminated with the body, so that it quickly falls into another body and grows there like a seed that is sown. Accordingly, the soul has no share in the company of the divine, the pure, and the unitary.”

οὐκοῦν ἐν τούτῳ τῷ πάθει μάλιστα καταδεῖται ψυχὴ ὑπὸ σώματος; πῶς δῆ; ὅτι ἐκάστη ἡδονὴ καὶ λύπη ὥσπερ ἦλον ἔχουσα προσηλοῖ αὐτὴν πρὸς τὸ σῶμα καὶ προσπερονᾷ καὶ ποιεῖ σωματοειδῆ, δοξάζουσιν αὐτὰ ἀληθῆ εἶναι ἅπερ ἂν καὶ τὸ σῶμα φῇ, ἐκ γὰρ τοῦ ὁμοδοξεῖν τῷ σώματι

καὶ τοῖς αὐτοῖς χαίρειν ἀναγκάζεται οἶμαι ὁμότροπός τε καὶ ὁμότροφος γίγνεσθαι καὶ οἷα μηδέποτε εἰς Ἄιδου καθαρῶς ἀφικέσθαι, ἀλλὰ ἀεὶ τοῦ σώματος ἀναπλέα ἐξίέναι, ὥστε ταχὺ πάλιν πίπτειν εἰς

83e

CE: “What you are saying is very true, Socrates,” said Cebes.

83e

S: “Now, Cebes, that is why those who love knowledge aright are orderly and courageous, and not for the reasons that most people give. Or do you think it is?”

ἄλλο σῶμα καὶ ὥσπερ σπειρομένη ἐμφύεσθαι, καὶ ἐκ τούτων ἄμοιρος εἶναι τῆς τοῦ θεοῦ τε καὶ καθαρῶ καὶ μονοειδοῦς συνουσίας. ἀληθέστατα, ἔφη, λέγεις, ὁ Κέβης, ὃ Σώκρατες. τούτων τοίνυν ἔνεκα, ὃ Κέβης, οἱ δικαίως φιλομαθεῖς κόσμιοί εἰσι καὶ ἀνδρεῖοι, οὐχ ὧν οἱ πολλοὶ ἔνεκά φασιν· ἢ σὺ οἶει; ΦΑΙΔ.

84a

CE: “I certainly do not.”

84a

S: “No indeed, the soul of the person who loves wisdom would reason as we have described and would never deign to use philosophy to free itself, and then, once free, give itself over again to pleasure and pain, fetter itself once more, and perform the endless task of Penelope,¹⁶ weaving some web in the opposite direction. Instead, the soul maintains serenity in the face of these, following reason and abiding always in that, beholding what is true and divine and beyond opinion, and being nourished by these. It thinks it should live in this way while it remains alive, and when it dies, arriving among its own kindred and kind, be released from the evils of humanity. Now, there is no danger, Simmias and Cebes, that a soul, nourished in this way, will be afraid once it has practised this, afraid that it may be dispersed on departure from the body, be blown away by the wind, take flight, and no longer be anywhere at all.”

οὐ δῆτα ἔγωγε. οὐ γάρ· ἀλλ' οὕτω λογίσαιτ' ἂν ψυχὴ ἀνδρὸς φιλοσόφου, καὶ οὐκ ἂν οἰηθείη τὴν μὲν φιλοσοφίαν χρῆναι αὐτὴν λύειν, λυούσης δὲ ἐκείνης, αὐτὴν παραδιδόναι ταῖς ἡδοναῖς καὶ λύπαις ἑαυτὴν πάλιν αὖ ἐγκαταδεῖν καὶ ἀνήνυτον ἔργον πράττειν Πηνελόπης τινὰ ἐναντίως ἰστὸν μεταχειριζομένης, ἀλλὰ γαλήνην τούτων παρασκευάζουσα, ἐπομένη τῷ λογισμῷ καὶ αἰὲν ἐν τούτῳ οὔσα, τὸ ἀληθὲς καὶ τὸ θεῖον καὶ τὸ ἀδόξαστον θεωμένη καὶ ὑπ' ἐκείνου τρεφομένη, ζῆν τε οἴεται οὕτω δεῖν ἕως ἂν ζῇ, καὶ ἐπειδὴν τελευτήσῃ, εἰς τὸ συγγενὲς καὶ εἰς τὸ τοιοῦτον ἀφικομένη ἀπηλλάχθαι τῶν ἀνθρωπίνων κακῶν. ἐκ δὲ τῆς τοιαύτης τροφῆς οὐδὲν δεινὸν μὴ φοβηθῇ, ταῦτα δ' ἐπιτηδεύσασα, ὧ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, ὅπως μὴ διασπασθεῖσα ἐν τῇ ἀπαλλαγῇ τοῦ σώματος ὑπὸ τῶν ἀνέμων διαφυσηθεῖσα καὶ διαπτομένη οἴχηται καὶ οὐδὲν ἔτι οὐδαμοῦ ᾗ.

84c

Now, there was silence for quite some time after Socrates had said all this, and it looked as if he himself was reflecting on the discussion which had concluded, and so too were most of us. But Simmias and Cebes were conversing with one another in whispers. When Socrates noticed them, he asked,

84c

S: “What is this? Perhaps you think that these arguments have been poorly presented. Of course, they still afford many grounds for suspicion and points of attack, if someone really intends to scrutinise them properly. Now, if you are considering some other issue, then I have nothing to say. However, if some aspect of these arguments is perplexing you, do not hesitate to state it and scrutinise it yourselves if, in your view, it could have been better formulated. And what is more, you should include me in the discussion if you think you might make better progress with my involvement.”

σιγὴ οὖν ἐγένετο ταῦτα εἰπόντος τοῦ Σωκράτους ἐπὶ πολὺν χρόνον, καὶ αὐτός τε πρὸς τῷ εἰρημένῳ λόγῳ ᾗν ὁ Σωκράτης, ὡς ἰδεῖν ἐφαίνετο, καὶ ἡμῶν οἱ πλεῖστοι· Κέβης δὲ καὶ Σιμμίας σμικρὸν πρὸς ἀλλήλῳ διελεγέσθην. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης ἰδὼν αὐτῷ ἤρετο, τί; ἔφη, ὑμῖν τὰ

λεχθέντα μῶν μὴ δοκεῖ ἐνδεῶς λέγεσθαι; πολλάς γὰρ δὴ ἔτι ἔχει ὑποψίας καὶ ἀντιλαβάς, εἴ γε δὴ τις αὐτὰ μέλλει ἱκανῶς διεξιέναι. εἰ μὲν οὖν τι ἄλλο σκοπεῖσθον, οὐδὲν λέγω· εἰ δέ τι περὶ τούτων ἀπορεῖτον, μηδὲν ἀποκνήσητε καὶ αὐτοὶ εἰπεῖν καὶ

84d

SI: And Simmias said, “In fact, Socrates, to tell you the truth, both of us have been perplexed for some time, one urging the other on and telling him to ask you a question, as we wanted to hear your response. However, we were reluctant to make any trouble, in case it might be unpleasant for you because of the present misfortune.”

84d

When he heard this, Socrates laughed gently, and said,

84d

S: “Oh dear, Simmias, I shall certainly have difficulty in persuading other people that I do not regard my present predicament as a misfortune, when I cannot even persuade you two. Instead, you are afraid that I am more ill-tempered now than I have been all my life. And apparently you think I am less of a prophet than the swans who sing throughout their lives but sing most of all, and most beautifully, once they realise that they must die, rejoicing because they are about to enter the company of the god whom they are serving.

διελθεῖν, εἴ πῃ ὑμῖν φαίνεται βέλτιον ἂν λεχθῆναι, καὶ αὖ καὶ ἐμὲ συμπαραλαβεῖν, εἴ τι μᾶλλον οἴεσθε μετ’ ἐμοῦ εὐπορήσειν. καὶ ὁ Σιμμίας ἔφη· καὶ μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, τάλητῃ σοι ἔρω. πάλαι γὰρ ἡμῶν ἑκάτερος ἀπορῶν τὸν ἕτερον προωθεῖ καὶ κελεύει ἐρέσθαι διὰ τὸ ἐπιθυμεῖν μὲν ἀκοῦσαι, ὀκνεῖν δὲ ὄχλον παρέχειν, μὴ σοι ἀηδὲς ἢ διὰ τὴν παροῦσαν συμφορὰν. καὶ ὃς ἀκούσας ἐγέλασέν τε ἡρέμα καὶ φησιν· Βαβαί, ὦ Σιμμία· ἢ που χαλεπῶς ἂν τοὺς ἄλλους ἀνθρώπους πείσαιμι ὥς οὐ συμφορὰν ἡγοῦμαι τὴν παροῦσαν τύχην, ὅτε γε μηδ’ ὑμᾶς δύναμαι πείθειν, ἀλλὰ φοβεῖσθε μὴ δυσκολώτερόν τι νῦν διάκειμαι ἢ ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν βίῳ· καί, ὥς ἔοικε, τῶν κύκνων δοκῶ φαυλότερος ὑμῖν εἶναι τὴν μαντικὴν, οἱ ἐπειδὰν αἰσθωνται ὅτι δεῖ αὐτοὺς ἀποθανεῖν, ἄδοντες καὶ ἐν

85a

S: “But human beings, on account of their own fear of death, utter falsehoods even about the swans, and say that they sing their song of departure in sorrow, lamenting their death. They do not appreciate that no bird ever sings when it is hungry or cold or suffering any other distress, not even the nightingale or the swallow or the hoopoe, birds which are actually said to be singing lamentations in sorrow. But neither these nor the swans appear to me to be singing in sorrow. I think, rather, that because they are birds of Apollo, swans have prophetic powers, and foreseeing all the good of Hades, they sing and are more delighted on that day than they ever were before. And I myself believe that I am their fellow servant, devoted to the same god, possessing a prophetic power from the lord which is no less than theirs, and I am no more distressed than they are to depart this life. So on that account, you should say or ask anything you want, for as long as the eleven officers of the Athenians allow it.”

τῷ πρόσθεν χρόνῳ, τότε δὴ πλεῖστα καὶ κάλλιστα ἄδουσι, γεγηθότες ὅτι μέλλουσι παρὰ τὸν θεὸν ἀπιέναι οὐπὲρ εἰσι θεράποντες. ΦΑΙΔ. οἱ δ' ἄνθρωποι διὰ τὸ αὐτῶν δέος τοῦ θανάτου καὶ τῶν κύκνων καταψεύδονται, καὶ φασιν αὐτοὺς θρηνοῦντας τὸν θάνατον ὑπὸ λύπης ἐξάδειν, καὶ οὐ λογίζονται ὅτι οὐδὲν ὄρνειν ἄδει ὅταν πεινῇ ἢ ῥιγῶ ἢ τινα ἄλλην λύπην λυπῇται, οὐδὲ αὐτὴ ἢ τε ἀηδῶν καὶ χελιδῶν καὶ ὁ ἔποψ, ἃ δὴ φασι διὰ λύπην θρηνοῦντα ἄδειν. ἀλλ' οὔτε ταῦτά μοι φαίνεται λυπούμενα ἄδειν οὔτε οἱ κύκνοι, ἀλλ' ἅτε οἶμαι τοῦ Ἀπόλλωνος ὄντες, μαντικοὶ τέ εἰσι καὶ προειδότες τὰ ἐν ᾿Αΐδου ἀγαθὰ ἄδουσι καὶ τέρπονται ἐκείνην τὴν ἡμέραν διαφερόντως ἢ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν χρόνῳ. ἐγὼ δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς ἡγοῦμαι ὁμόδουλός τε εἶναι τῶν κύκνων καὶ ἱερὸς τοῦ αὐτοῦ θεοῦ, καὶ οὐ χεῖρον ἐκείνων τὴν μαντικὴν ἔχειν παρὰ τοῦ δεσπότου, οὐδὲ δυσθυμότερον αὐτῶν τοῦ βίου ἀπαλλάττεσθαι. ἀλλὰ τούτου γ' ἔνεκα λέγειν τε χρή καὶ ἐρωτᾶν ὅτι ἂν βούλησθε, ἕως ἂν Ἀθηναίων ἐῷσιν ἄνδρες ἑνδεκα. καλῶς, ἔφη, λέγεις, ὁ Σιμμίας· καὶ ἐγὼ τέ σοι ἐρῶ ὃ

85c

SI: “That is beautifully expressed,” said Simmias, “and I shall tell you what is perplexing me, and Cebes will, in turn, say why he does not accept what has been said. It seems to me, Socrates, and perhaps to you too, that definite knowledge of such matters is either impossible or extremely difficult in this life. That said, however, it is a very faint-hearted person who does not scrutinise the arguments about these matters in every manner possible, without giving up until totally exhausted by the enquiry. For we should proceed on these issues in one of two ways, either learn or discover how matters stand, or if this is impossible, then adopt the best and most unassailable argument of humankind, climb on board that, as if it were a raft in a perilous sea, and sail upon it through life, unless one can travel on a more secure vessel, some divine word, safely and free from danger. What is more, I will not be ashamed to ask a question now, in view of what you are saying, nor shall I blame myself later on because I did not say what I am now thinking. Indeed, Socrates, when I consider what has been said, either from my own perspective or from Cebes’ perspective, the account does not appear entirely adequate.”

ἀπορῶ, καὶ αὖ ὁδε, ἥ οὐκ ἀποδέχεται τὰ εἰρημένα. ἐμοὶ γὰρ δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, περὶ τῶν τοιούτων ἴσως ὥσπερ καὶ σοὶ τὸ μὲν σαφὲς εἰδέναι ἐν τῷ νῦν βίῳ ἢ ἀδύνατον εἶναι ἢ παγχάλεπόν τι, τὸ μέντοι αὖ τὰ λεγόμενα περὶ αὐτῶν μὴ οὐχὶ παντὶ τρόπῳ ἐλέγχειν καὶ μὴ προαφίστασθαι πρὶν ἂν πανταχῇ σκοπῶν ἀπείπῃ τις, πάνυ μαλθακοῦ εἶναι ἀνδρός· δεῖν γὰρ περὶ αὐτὰ ἔν γέ τι τούτων διαπράξασθαι, ἢ μαθεῖν ὅπῃ ἔχει ἢ εὐρεῖν ἢ, εἰ ταῦτα ἀδύνατον, τὸν γοῦν βέλτιστον τῶν ἀνθρωπίνων λόγων λαβόντα καὶ δυσεξελεγκτότατον, ἐπὶ τούτου ὀχοῦμενον ὥσπερ ἐπὶ σχεδίας κινδυνεύοντα διαπλεῦσαι τὸν βίον, εἰ μὴ τις δύναιτο ἀσφαλέστερον καὶ ἀκινδυνότερον ἐπὶ βεβαιότερου ὀχήματος, ἢ λόγου θεοῦ τινός, διαπορευθῆναι. καὶ δὴ καὶ νῦν ἔγωγε οὐκ ἐπαισχυνθήσομαι ἐρέσθαι, ἐπειδὴ καὶ σὺ ταῦτα λέγεις, οὐδ’ ἐμαυτὸν αἰτιάσομαι ἐν ὑστέρῳ χρόνῳ ὅτι νῦν οὐκ εἶπον ἅ μοι δοκεῖ. ἐμοὶ γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπειδὴ καὶ πρὸς ἐμαυτὸν καὶ πρὸς τόνδε σκοπῶ τὰ εἰρημένα, οὐ πάνυ φαίνεται ἱκανῶς εἰρηῆσθαι.

85e

S: And Socrates said, “Perhaps this appearance is true, my friend, but you should explain in what way the account is inadequate.”

85e

Si: “It seems to me inadequate,” Simmias said, “in this sense. Someone might propose the very same argument in relation to attunement and a lyre and its strings, saying that the attunement is indeed an unseen, non-physical, entirely beautiful and divine element in the tuned lyre, while the lyre itself and its strings are, by contrast, physical objects with physical form. They are compounds, which are earthly and akin to the mortal. So when someone breaks the lyre, or cuts and severs the strings, if someone were to maintain the same argument as you, he would say that this attunement must still exist and cannot have perished because there would be no way the lyre could still exist with its strings severed, strings that are mortal in nature, while the attunement, which is similar in nature and akin to the divine and immortal, perishes before the mortal perishes. He would claim, rather, that the attunement itself must somehow still exist, and the wood and strings must rot away first before anything happens to that. And in fact, Socrates, I think you yourself are aware that this is the sort of thing we actually take the soul to be. It is as if our body is tempered and held together by hot and cold, dry and moist, and the like, and that our soul is a blend and attunement of these very elements once they are properly mixed with one another in a measured way.

καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης, ἴσως γάρ, ἔφη, ὦ ἑταῖρε, ἀληθῆ σοι φαίνεται· ἀλλὰ λέγε ὅπῃ δὴ οὐχ ἰκανῶς. ΦΑΙΔ. ταύτη ἔμοιγε, ἥ δ' ὅς, ἥ δὴ καὶ περὶ ἀρμονίας ἂν τις καὶ λύρας τε καὶ χορδῶν τὸν αὐτὸν τοῦτον λόγον εἴποι, ὡς ἡ μὲν ἀρμονία ἀόρατον καὶ ἀσώματον καὶ πάγκαλόν τι καὶ θεῖόν ἐστιν ἐν τῇ ἡρμοσμένῃ λύρᾳ, αὐτὴ δ' ἡ λύρα καὶ αἱ χορδαὶ σώματά τε καὶ σωματοειδῆ καὶ σύνθετα καὶ γεώδη ἐστὶ καὶ τοῦ θνητοῦ συγγενῆ. ἐπειδὴν οὖν ἡ κατάξῃ τις τὴν λύραν ἢ διατέμῃ καὶ διαρρήξῃ τὰς χορδὰς, εἴ τις δισχυρίζοιτο τῷ αὐτῷ λόγῳ ὥσπερ σύ, ὡς ἀνάγκη ἔτι εἶναι τὴν ἀρμονίαν ἐκείνην καὶ μὴ ἀπολωλέναι — οὐδεμία γὰρ μηχανὴ ἂν εἴη τὴν

μὲν λύραν ἔτι εἶναι διερρωγυῖων τῶν χορδῶν καὶ τὰς χορδὰς θνητοειδεῖς οὐσας, τὴν δὲ ἀρμονίαν ἀπολωλέναι τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ τε καὶ ἀθανάτου ὁμοφυῇ τε καὶ συγγενῇ, προτέραν τοῦ θνητοῦ ἀπολομένην — ἀλλὰ φαίη ἀνάγκη ἔτι που εἶναι αὐτὴν τὴν ἀρμονίαν, καὶ πρότερον τὰ ξύλα καὶ τὰς χορδὰς κατασαπῆσθαι πρὶν τι ἐκείνην παθεῖν — καὶ γὰρ οὖν, ὧ Σώκρατες, οἶμαι ἔγωγε καὶ αὐτόν σε τοῦτο ἐντεθυμῆσθαι, ὅτι τοιοῦτόν τι μάλιστα ὑπολαμβάνομεν τὴν ψυχὴν εἶναι, ὥσπερ ἐντεταμένον τοῦ σώματος ἡμῶν καὶ συνεχομένου ὑπὸ θερμοῦ καὶ ψυχροῦ καὶ ξηροῦ καὶ ὑγροῦ καὶ τοιούτων τινῶν, κρᾶσιν εἶναι καὶ ἀρμονίαν

86c

Si: “Now, if the soul happens to be an attunement, it is obvious that whenever the body is relaxed beyond measure or is strained by diseases or other evils, the soul, even though it is utterly divine, must perish immediately, just like the other attunements in sounds or in any manufactured objects. And what remains of each body must last for a long time until it is either burned up or rots away.

αὐτῶν τούτων τὴν ψυχὴν ἡμῶν, ἐπειδὴν ταῦτα καλῶς καὶ μετρίως κρατῇ πρὸς ἄλληλα — εἰ οὖν τυγχάνει ἡ ψυχὴ οὐσα ἀρμονία τις, δῆλον ὅτι, ὅταν χαλασθῇ τὸ σῶμα ἡμῶν ἀμέτρως ἢ ἐπιταθῇ ὑπὸ νόσων καὶ ἄλλων κακῶν, τὴν μὲν ψυχὴν ἀνάγκη εὐθὺς ὑπάρχει ἀπολωλέναι, καίπερ οὐσαν θειοτάτην, ὥσπερ καὶ αἱ ἄλλαι ἀρμονίαι αἵ τ’ ἐν τοῖς φθόγγοις καὶ ἐν τοῖς τῶν δημιουργῶν ἔργοις πᾶσι, τὰ δὲ λείψανα τοῦ σώματος ἐκάστου πολὺν χρόνον παραμένειν,

86d

Si: “So consider this, how shall we respond to this argument if someone asserts that the soul, being a blend of elements in the body, is the first thing to perish in what we call death?”

86d

Socrates, as he did so often, stared openly, smiled, and said,

86d

S: “Simmias is making a fair point. Now, if anyone here is more resourceful than I am, why do they not respond to him for he does actually seem to be coming to terms with the argument quite well? However, before we respond, I think it is useful to hear first what further objection Cebes is raising about the argument. That will give us time to decide what we shall say, and then, once we have heard them both, we shall agree with them if their objections seem to ring true in any way, and if not, then we shall proceed to defend the argument at that stage. So come on, Cebes,” he said, “speak up. What else was bothering you?”

ἕως ἄν ἡ κατακαυθῇ ἡ κατασαπῇ — ὅρα οὖν πρὸς τοῦτον τὸν λόγον τί φήσομεν, ἐάν τις ἀξιοῖ κρᾶσιν οὔσαν τὴν ψυχὴν τῶν ἐν τῷ σώματι ἐν τῷ καλουμένῳ θανάτῳ πρώτην ἀπόλλυσθαι. διαβλέψας οὖν ὁ Σωκράτης, ὥσπερ τὰ πολλὰ εἰώθει, καὶ μειδιάσας, δίκαια μέντοι, ἔφη, λέγει ὁ Σιμμίας. εἰ οὖν τις ὑμῶν εὐπορώτερος ἐμοῦ, τί οὐκ ἀπεκρίνατο; καὶ γὰρ οὐ φαύλως ἔοικεν ἀπομένῳ τοῦ λόγου. δοκεῖ μέντοι μοι χρῆναι πρὸ τῆς ἀποκρίσεως ἔτι πρότερον κέβητος ἀκοῦσαι τί αὐτὸς ὁδε ἐγκαλεῖ τῷ λόγῳ, ἵνα χρόνου ἐγγενομένου βουλευσώμεθα τί ἐροῦμεν, ἔπειτα δὲ ἀκούσαντας ἢ συγχωρεῖν αὐτοῖς ἐάν τι δοκῶσι προσάδειν, ἐὰν δὲ μή, οὕτως ἤδη υπερδικεῖν τοῦ λόγου. ἀλλ’ ἄγε, ἦ δ’ ὅς, ὦ Κέβης, λέγε, τί ἦν τὸ σὲ αὐτὸν θράττον ἀπιστίαν παρέχει. λέγω δὴ, ἦ δ’ ὅς ὁ Κέβης. ΦΑΙΔ. ἐμοὶ γὰρ φαίνεται ἔτι ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ ὁ λόγος εἶναι, καί, ὅπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐλέγομεν,

87a

CE: “Speak I shall,” said Cebes, “for it appears to me that the argument is still in the same predicament and is open to the same objection we stated previously. I will not retract the argument that our soul existed even before it entered this form, as this has been elegantly and, if it is no exaggeration to say so, quite thoroughly proven. However, the argument that it still exists, somehow, after we die, does not seem to me to have been proven. I do not accept Simmias’ point that the soul is less strong and less enduring than the body, for I think it is far superior in all these respects. So, the argument might ask me, ‘Why are

you still incredulous when you can see that the weaker part still exists after the person dies? Do you not accept that the more enduring part must still survive at that particular time?"

ταὐτὸν ἔγκλημα ἔχειν. ὅτι μὲν γὰρ ἦν ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ καὶ πρὶν εἰς τόδε τὸ εἶδος ἔλθεῖν, οὐκ ἀνατίθεται μὴ οὐχὶ πάνυ χαριέντως καί, εἰ μὴ ἐπαχθές ἐστὶν εἰπεῖν, πάνυ ἱκανῶς ἀποδεδεῖχθαι. ὥς δὲ καὶ ἀποθανόντων ἡμῶν ἔτι που ἔστιν, οὗ μοι δοκεῖ τῆδε. ὥς μὲν οὐκ ἰσχυρότερον καὶ πολυχρονιώτερον ψυχὴ σώματος, οὐ συγχωρῶ τῇ Σιμμίου ἀντιλήψει· δοκεῖ γάρ μοι πᾶσι τούτοις πάνυ πολὺ διαφέρειν. τί οὖν, ἂν φαίη ὁ λόγος, ἔτι ἀπιστεῖς, ἐπειδὴ ὀρᾷς ἀποθανόντος τοῦ ἀνθρώπου τό γε ἀσθενέστερον ἔτι ὄν; τὸ δὲ πολυχρονιώτερον οὐ δοκεῖ σοι ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι ἔτι σώζεσθαι ἐν τούτῳ τῷ χρόνῳ; πρὸς δὲ τοῦτο τόδε ἐπίσκεψαι, εἴ τι λέγω· εἰκόνας γάρ τινος, ὥς ἔοικεν, κἀγὼ ὥσπερ Σιμμίας δέομαι. ἐμοὶ γὰρ δοκεῖ ὁμοίως λέγεσθαι ταῦτα ὥσπερ ἂν τις περὶ ἀνθρώπου ὑφάντου πρεσβύτου ἀποθανόντος λέγοι τοῦτον τὸν λόγον, ὅτι οὐκ ἀπόλωλεν ὁ ἄνθρωπος ἀλλ' ἔστι που σῶς, τεκμήριον δὲ παρέχοιτο θοῖμάτιον ὃ ἡμπείχετο αὐτὸς ὑφηνάμενος ὅτι ἐστὶ σῶν καὶ οὐκ ἀπόλωλεν, καὶ εἴ τις ἀπιστοίῃ αὐτῷ, ἀνερωτώῃ πότερον πολυχρονιώτερόν ἐστι τὸ γένος ἀνθρώπου ἢ ἱματίου ἐν χρεῖα τε ὄντος καὶ φορουμένου, ἀποκριναμένου δὴ τινος ὅτι πολὺ τὸ τοῦ ἀνθρώπου, οἷοιτο ἀποδεδεῖχθαι ὅτι παντὸς ἄρα μᾶλλον ὃ γε ἄνθρωπος σῶς ἐστίν, ἐπειδὴ τό γε ὀλιγοχρονιώτερον οὐκ ἀπόλωλεν. τὸ δ' οἶμαι, ὦ Σιμμίας, οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει· σκόπει γὰρ καὶ σὺ ἃ λέγω. πᾶς γὰρ ἂν ὑπολάβοι ὅτι εὖηθες λέγει ὁ τοῦτο λέγων· ὁ γὰρ ὑφάντης οὗτος πολλὰ κατατρίψας τοιαῦτα ἱμάτια καὶ ὑφηνάμενος ἐκείνων μὲν ὕστερος ἀπόλωλεν πολλῶν

87b

CE: "Now, determine whether my response to this makes any sense. Indeed, just like Simmias, it seems I shall also need to use an image. For I think that what is being said is quite like the following argument about an old man, a weaver, who has died. Someone might say that the man has not perished but is somehow alive and well, and they might offer the garment he used to wear and which he had woven himself, as

evidence, because it is safe and sound and has not perished. And if anyone was unconvinced by this, he might ask them whether a human being is longer lasting than a garment he uses and wears, and having received the answer that the person is much longer lasting, he might think he had proved that the person is alive and well since the less enduring object has not perished. But I do not think that this is the case, Simmias, so consider what I am about to say. Everyone would appreciate that this is a ridiculous argument to propose, because this weaver, having woven and worn out many such garments, has perished after them, although there were many. However, I presume he perished before the last of them and a man is not in any degree inferior to, or weaker than, a garment on that account.

87d

CE: “Now, I think the soul’s relation to the body would admit the same comparison, and anyone who uses these very arguments in that context would appear to me to be speaking reasonably, because the soul is long lasting, while the body is weaker and less enduring. He would argue that in fact each of the souls wears out numerous bodies, especially if it lives for many years, for if the body is in flux and is perishing while the person is still alive, then the soul is constantly weaving anew whatever has been worn away. Yet when the soul perishes, it must be wearing the last garment it wove, and it must perish before that one, and that one alone. And with the perishing of the soul, the body would demonstrate its natural weakness at that stage and would quickly rot away and be gone.

όντων, τοῦ δὲ τελευταίου οἶμαι πρότερος, καὶ οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον τούτου ἔνεκα ἀνθρώπος ἐστὶν ἱματίου φαυλότερον οὐδ’ ἀσθενέστερον. τὴν αὐτὴν δὲ ταύτην οἶμαι εἰκόνα δέξαιτ’ ἂν ψυχὴ πρὸς σῶμα, καὶ τις λέγων αὐτὰ ταῦτα περὶ αὐτῶν μέτρι’ ἂν μοι φαίνοιτο λέγειν, ὥς ἡ μὲν ψυχὴ πολυχρόνιον ἐστὶ, τὸ δὲ σῶμα ἀσθενέστερον καὶ ὀλιγοχρονιώτερον· ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἂν φαίη ἐκάστην τῶν ψυχῶν πολλὰ σώματα κατατρίβειν, ἄλλως τε καὶ πολλὰ ἔτη βιώ — εἰ γὰρ ῥέοι τὸ σῶμα καὶ ἀπολλύοιτο ἔτι ζώντος τοῦ ἀνθρώπου, ἀλλ’ ἡ ψυχὴ αἰεὶ τὸ

κατατριβόμενον ἀνυφαίνοι — ἀναγκαῖον μεντὰν εἶη, ὅποτε ἀπολλύοιτο ἡ ψυχὴ, τὸ τελευταῖον ὕφασμα τυχεῖν αὐτὴν ἔχουσαν καὶ τούτου μόνου προτέραν ἀπόλλυσθαι, ἀπολομένης δὲ τῆς ψυχῆς τότε ἤδη τὴν φύσιν τῆς ἀσθενείας ἐπιδεικνύοι τὸ σῶμα καὶ ταχὺ σαπὲν διοίχοιτο. ΦΑΙΔ. ὥστε τούτω τῷ λόγῳ οὕτω ἄξιον πιστεύσαντα θαρρεῖν ὥς

88a

CE: “Accordingly, we should not yet deem this argument worthy of belief and be confident that our soul will still exist after we die. For suppose we were to make even more concessions to this disputant than you suggest, and grant to him that our soul exists, not only in the interval before our birth, but concede that there is no reason why, in some cases, it should not still exist even after we die, and continue to exist, and be born and die again many times, as the soul is so strong by nature that it can withstand being born many times. Yet having granted this, we would still not accept that the soul is unaffected during its multiple births, and that it will not come to an end during one of the particular deaths and perish completely. But he would reply that no one has ever known the particular death and the particular dissolution of the body which brings destruction to the soul, since it is impossible for any of us to be aware of it. And if this is the case, it is not appropriate for anyone to have confidence in the face of death, a confidence which is not unreasonable unless he can prove that the soul is completely immortal and indestructible. Otherwise, anyone who is about to die must be in constant fear on behalf of his own soul, lest it perish utterly during its present separation from the body.”

ἐπειδὴν ἀποθάνωμεν ἔτι που ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ ἔστιν. εἰ γὰρ τις καὶ πλέον ἔτι τῷ λέγοντι ἢ ἂν σὺ λέγεις συγχωρήσειεν, δοὺς αὐτῷ μὴ μόνον ἐν τῷ πρὶν καὶ γενέσθαι ἡμᾶς χρόνῳ εἶναι ἡμῶν τὰς ψυχάς, ἀλλὰ μηδὲν κωλύειν καὶ ἐπειδὴν ἀποθάνωμεν ἐνίων ἔτι εἶναι καὶ ἔσεσθαι καὶ πολλάκις γενήσεσθαι καὶ ἀποθανεῖσθαι αὐθις — οὕτω γὰρ αὐτὸ φύσει ἰσχυρὸν εἶναι, ὥστε πολλάκις γιγνομένην ψυχὴν ἀντέχειν — δοὺς δὲ ταῦτα ἐκεῖνο μηκέτι συγχωροῖ, μὴ οὐ πονεῖν αὐτὴν ἐν ταῖς πολλαῖς γενέσεσιν καὶ τελευτῶσάν γε ἔν τινι τῶν θανάτων παντάπασιν

ἀπόλλυσθαι, τοῦτον δὲ τὸν θάνατον καὶ ταύτην τὴν διάλυσιν τοῦ σώματος ἢ τῇ ψυχῇ φέρει ὄλεθρον μηδένα φαίη εἰδέναι — ἀδύνατον γὰρ εἶναι ὁτῶοῦν αἰσθῆσθαι ἡμῶν — εἰ δὲ τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει, οὐδενὶ προσήκει θάνατον θαρροῦντι μὴ οὐκ ἀνοήτως θαρρεῖν, ὃς ἂν μὴ ἔχη ἀποδειξαι ὅτι ἔστι ψυχὴ παντάπασιν ἀθάνατόν τε καὶ ἀνώλεθρον· εἰ δὲ μή, ἀνάγκην εἶναι ἀεὶ τὸν μέλλοντα ἀποθανεῖσθαι δεδιέναι ὑπὲρ τῆς αὐτοῦ ψυχῆς μὴ ἐν τῇ νῦν τοῦ σώματος διαζεύξει παντάπασιν ἀπόληται.

88c

Now, when the rest of us had heard them saying all this, we became unsettled, as we confessed to one another afterwards, because having been strongly persuaded by the previous argument, Simmias and Cebes now seemed to be disturbing us once more and casting us into doubt, not only in relation to the earlier discussion but also in relation to matters we would discuss later on. We feared that we might not be worthy judges of anything, or even that the issues themselves might be subject to doubt.

88c

EC: By the gods, Phaedo, I have sympathy for you. In fact, when I heard you saying this just now, I started thinking to myself, ‘What argument can we still believe in? The argument presented by Socrates was highly persuasive, but now its credibility has collapsed.’ In fact this argument that our soul is an attunement is extraordinarily captivating to me now, and it always has been, and when you mention this it reminds me that I hold these views already. And I really need some other argument to convince me once more, from the beginning, that the soul of a dying man does not die along with him. So tell me, by Zeus, how did Socrates pursue the argument? And what about the man himself, did he show any sign of being upset like the rest of you, or did he defend the argument calmly? And did he defend it adequately, or were there deficiencies? Tell us everything as precisely as you can.

πάντες οὖν ἀκούσαντες εἰπόντων αὐτῶν ἀηδῶς διετέθημεν, ὥς ὕστερον ἐλέγομεν πρὸς ἀλλήλους, ὅτι ὑπὸ τοῦ ἔμπροσθεν λόγου

σφόδρα πεπεισμένους ἡμᾶς πάλιν ἐδόκουν ἀναταράξαι καὶ εἰς ἀπιστίαν καταβαλεῖν οὐ μόνον τοῖς προειρημένοις λόγοις, ἀλλὰ καὶ εἰς τὰ ὕστερον μέλλοντα ῥηθήσεσθαι, μὴ οὐδενὸς ἄξιοι εἶμεν κριταὶ ἢ καὶ τὰ πράγματα αὐτὰ ἄπιστα ἦ. ΕΧ. νῆ τοὺς θεοὺς, ὦ Φαίδων, συγγνώμην γε ἔχω ὑμῖν. καὶ γὰρ αὐτόν με νῦν ἀκούσαντά σου τοιοῦτόν τι λέγειν πρὸς ἑμαυτὸν ἐπέρχεται· τίνι οὖν ἔτι πιστεύσομεν λόγῳ; ὥς γὰρ σφόδρα πιθανὸς ὢν, ὃν ὁ Σωκράτης ἔλεγε λόγον, νῦν εἰς ἀπιστίαν καταπέπτωκεν. θαυμαστῶς γάρ μου ὁ λόγος οὗτος ἀντιλαμβάνεται καὶ νῦν καὶ αἰεί, τὸ ἁρμονίαν τινὰ ἡμῶν εἶναι τὴν ψυχὴν, καὶ ὥσπερ ὑπέμνησέν με ῥηθεὶς ὅτι καὶ αὐτῷ μοι ταῦτα προυδέδοκτο. καὶ πάνυ δέομαι πάλιν ὥσπερ ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἄλλου τινὸς λόγου ὅς με πείσει ὥς τοῦ ἀποθανόντος οὐ συναποθνήσκει ἡ ψυχὴ. λέγε οὖν πρὸς Διὸς πῇ ὁ Σωκράτης μετήλθε τὸν λόγον; καὶ πότερον

88e

PH: Well now, Echecrates, I had been amazed by Socrates many times before, but I was never as delighted as I was in his company at that moment. The fact that the man had something to say was not really anything unusual, but I was most amazed: firstly, at the pleasant, gracious and admiring way he accepted the argument of the young men; also by how keenly he discerned how we had been affected by their arguments; and finally by how well he cured us, rallied us as if we were fleeing in defeat, and turned us around to follow him and examine the argument together.

κάκεϊνος, ὥσπερ ὑμᾶς φῆς, ἔνδηλός τι ἐγένετο ἀχθόμενος ἢ οὐ, ἀλλὰ πράως ἐβοήθει τῷ λόγῳ; ἢ καὶ ἱκανῶς ἐβοήθησεν ἢ ἐνδεῶς; πάντα ἡμῖν δίελθε ὥς δύνασαι ἀκριβέστατα. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ μήν, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, πολλάκις θαυμάσας Σωκράτη οὐ πώποτε μᾶλλον ἠγάσθην ἢ τότε παραγενόμενος. τὸ μὲν οὖν ἔχειν ὅτι λέγοι ἐκεῖνος ἴσως οὐδὲν ἄτοπον· ἀλλὰ ἔγωγε μάλιστα ἐθαύμασα αὐτοῦ πρῶτον μὲν τοῦτο, ὥς ἡδέως καὶ εὐμενῶς καὶ ἀγαμένως τῶν νεανίσκων τὸν λόγον ἀπεδέξατο, ἔπειτα ἡμῶν ὥς ὀξέως ἦσθετο ὃ 'πεπόνθεμεν ὑπὸ τῶν λόγων, ἔπειτα ὥς εὖ ἡμᾶς ἰάσατο καὶ ὥσπερ πεφευγότας καὶ ἡττημένους ἀνεκαλέσατο καὶ προύτρεψεν πρὸς τὸ παρῆπεσθαί τε καὶ συσκοπεῖν τὸν λόγον. ΕΧ. πῶς δῆ; ΦΑΙΔ. ἐγὼ ἐρῶ.

ἔτυχον γὰρ ἐν δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ καθήμενος παρὰ τὴν κλίνην ἐπὶ χαμαιζήλου τινός, ὃ δὲ ἐπὶ πολὺ ὑψηλοτέρου ἢ ἐγώ. καταψήσας οὖν μου τὴν κεφαλὴν καὶ συμπίεσας τὰς ἐπὶ τῷ αὐχένι τρίχας — εἰώθει γάρ, ὅποτε τύχοι, παίζειν μου εἰς τὰς τρίχας — Αὔριον δὴ, ἔφη, ἴσως, ὦ Φαίδων, τὰς καλὰς ταύτας κόμας ἀποκερῆ. ἔοικεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Σώκρατες. οὐκ, ἂν γε ἐμοὶ πείθῃ. ἀλλὰ τί; ἦν δ' ἐγώ. τήμερον, ἔφη, κἀγὼ τὰς ἐμὰς καὶ σὺ ταύτας, ἐάνπερ γε ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος τελευτήσῃ καὶ μὴ δυνώμεθα αὐτὸν ἀναβιώσασθαι.

EC: How did he do this?

PH: I shall tell you.

89b

I was sitting to the right of Socrates on a small stool beside the bed and he was seated much higher up than me. He stroked my head and gathered up the hair around my neck, for he was accustomed, on occasion, to play with my hair.

89b

S: “Tomorrow,” he said, “perhaps you will cut off these beautiful locks, Phaedo.”

PH: “Quite likely, Socrates,” I replied.

S: “Not if you let me persuade you.”

PH: “What would happen then?” I said.

89c

S: “I will cut my hair today,” he said, “and you will cut these locks if our argument meets its end and we prove unable to bring it back to life. And if I were you and the argument got away from me, I would take an oath, just like the Argives,¹⁷ not to let my hair grow until I had defeated the arguments of Simmias and Cebes in a fresh battle.”

καὶ ἔγωγ' ἂν, εἰ σὺ εἶην καὶ με διαφεύγοι ὁ λόγος, ἔνορκον ἂν ποιησαίμην ὥσπερ Ἀργεῖοι, μὴ πρότερον κομήσειν, πρὶν ἂν νικήσω ἀναμαχόμενος τὸν Σιμμίου τε καὶ Κέβητος λόγον. ἀλλ', ἦν δ' ἐγώ, πρὸς δύο λέγεται οὐδ' ὁ Ἡρακλῆς οἶός τε εἶναι. ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐμέ, ἔφη, τὸν

Ἰόλεων παρακάλει, ἕως ἔτι φῶς ἐστίν. παρακαλῶ τοίνυν, ἔφην, οὐχ ὥς Ἡρακλῆς, ἀλλ' ὥς Ἰόλεως τὸν Ἡρακλῆ. οὐδὲν διοίσει, ἔφη. ἀλλὰ πρῶτον εὐλαβηθῶμέν τι πάθος μὴ πάθωμεν. τὸ ποῖον; ἦν δ' ἐγώ.

PH: “But,” said I, “they say that even Heracles could not do battle against two.”

S: “Then,” said he, “call upon me, your Iolaus,¹⁸ so long as it is still daylight.”

PH: “Yes, I shall call upon you,” I said, “but I am no Heracles; I am Iolaus calling upon Heracles.”

S: “It will make no difference,” he said, “but first let us beware that a particular misfortune does not befall us.”

PH: “What?” I asked.

89d

S: “Let us not become haters of discourse,” he said, “just as some people become haters of humanity, for there is no greater evil that could befall a person than developing a hatred of discourse. But hatred of discourse and hatred of humanity both arise in the same manner. The hatred of humanity arises from placing a strong trust in someone without any experience and believing the person to be entirely true, sound and trustworthy, but finding a little later that he is evil and untrustworthy. And if this happens again with someone else, and the man has this experience frequently, especially with people he regards as his closest acquaintances and best friends, he ends up being buffeted so often that he hates everyone and believes that no one is in any way sound at all. Or have you never noticed this happening before?”

μὴ γενώμεθα, ἦ δ' ὅς, μισόλογοι, ὥσπερ οἱ μισάνθρωποι γιγνόμενοι: ὥς οὐκ ἔστιν, ἔφη, ὅτι ἂν τις μεῖζον τούτου κακὸν πάθοι ἢ λόγους μισήσας. γίγνεται δὲ ἐκ τοῦ αὐτοῦ τρόπου μισολογία τε καὶ μισανθρωπία. ἢ τε γὰρ μισανθρωπία ἐνδύεται ἐκ τοῦ σφόδρα τινὶ πιστεῦσαι ἄνευ τέχνης, καὶ ἡγήσασθαι παντάσῃ γε ἀληθῆ εἶναι καὶ ὑγιῆ καὶ πιστὸν τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἔπειτα ὀλίγον ὕστερον εὑρεῖν τοῦτον πονηρόν τε καὶ

ἄπιστον, καὶ αὐθις ἕτερον· καὶ ὅταν τοῦτο πολλάκις πάθῃ τις καὶ ὑπὸ τούτων μάλιστα οὓς ἂν ἡγήσαιο

PH: “I have indeed,” I replied.

89e

S: “Now,” he said, “is this not shameful, and is it not obvious that such a person is attempting to deal with humanity without any experience in human affairs? For presumably, if he had any skill when he dealt with them, he would have realised how matters stand, that those who are extremely good and those who are extremely evil are both rare, while those in between are many.”

οἰκειοτάτους τε καὶ ἑταιροτάτους, τελευτῶν δὴ θαμὰ προσκρούων μισεῖ τε πάντας καὶ ἡγεῖται οὐδενὸς οὐδὲν ὑγιὲς εἶναι τὸ παράπαν. ἢ οὐκ ᾔσθησαι σύ πω τοῦτο γιγνόμενον; πάνυ γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ. οὐκοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς, αἰσχρὸν, καὶ δῆλον ὅτι ἄνευ τέχνης τῆς περὶ ἀνθρώπεια ὁ τοιοῦτος χρῆσθαι ἐπεχείρει τοῖς ἀνθρώποις; ΦΑΙΔ. εἰ γάρ που μετὰ τέχνης ἐχρήτο, ὥσπερ ἔχει οὕτως

PH: “What do you mean?” I asked.

90a

S: “Take extremely large and small things as an example. Do you think there is anything rarer than finding an extremely large or extremely small man or dog or any other animal? And does not the same also apply to quick and slow, ugly and beautiful, white and black? Have you not noticed that in all such cases the utmost extremes are rare and few, while those in between are plentiful and numerous?”

ἂν ἡγήσαιο, τοὺς μὲν χρηστοὺς καὶ πονηροὺς σφόδρα ὀλίγους εἶναι ἑκατέρους, τοὺς δὲ μεταξὺ πλείστους. πῶς λέγεις; ἔφην ἐγώ. ὥσπερ, ἦ δ' ὅς, περὶ τῶν σφόδρα σμικρῶν καὶ μεγάλων· οἷε τι σπανιώτερον εἶναι ἢ σφόδρα μέγαν ἢ σφόδρα σμικρὸν ἐξευρεῖν ἄνθρωπον ἢ κύνα ἢ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν; ἢ αὖ ταχὺν ἢ βραδὺν ἢ αἰσχρὸν ἢ καλὸν ἢ λευκὸν ἢ μέλανα; ἢ οὐχὶ ᾔσθησαι ὅτι πάντων τῶν τοιούτων τὰ μὲν ἄκρα τῶν ἐσχάτων σπάνια καὶ ὀλίγα, τὰ δὲ μεταξὺ ἄφθονα καὶ πολλά; πάνυ γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ.

PH: “Yes, indeed,” I replied.

90b

S: “Do you not think”, he asked, “that if a competition in badness were instituted, very few people would prove to belong in the first rank?”

οὐκοῦν οἶε, ἔφη, εἰ πονηρίας ἀγὼν προτεθείη, πάνυ ἂν ὀλίγους καὶ ἐνταῦθα τοὺς πρώτους φανῆναι; εἰκὸς γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ. εἰκὸς γάρ, ἔφη. ἀλλὰ ταύτη μὲν οὐχ ὅμοιοι οἱ λόγοι τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ἀλλὰ σοῦ νυνδὴ προάγοντος ἐγὼ ἐφεσπόμεν, ἀλλ' ἐκείνῃ, ἦ, ἐπειδάν τις πιστεύσῃ λόγῳ τινὶ ἀληθεῖ εἶναι ἄνευ τῆς περὶ τοὺς λόγους τέχνης, κᾶπειτα ὀλίγον ὕστερον αὐτῷ δόξῃ ψευδῆς εἶναι, ἐνίστε μὲν ὦν, ἐνίστε δ' οὐκ ὦν, καὶ αὖθις ἕτερος καὶ ἕτερος — καὶ μάλιστα δὴ οἱ

PH: “Quite likely,” I replied.

90c

S: “Likely indeed,” he said, “but arguments are not similar to people in this respect. No, you gave a lead just now and I followed it. The similarity shows itself rather when someone who lacks any skill in relation to arguments believes a particular argument to be true, and then a little later the argument seems to him to be false, and sometimes this is the case and sometimes it is not, and this happens again and again. And you know that those who have spent a lot of time in disputatious arguments finally decide that they have become the wisest of men, that they alone have realised that there is nothing sound or certain either in the things themselves, or in the arguments, but that all of the things that are, are literally being turned upwards and downwards, as if they were in the strong tides of the Euripus, never constant for a moment.”

PH: “Yes, certainly,” I replied, “what you are saying is true.”

90c

S: “Now, Phaedo,” he said, “would it not be a sad situation if there were, in fact, some true and certain argument that was capable of being understood, and yet, through encounter with some arguments of this sort, the kind which seem true one moment and false the next, a man

were to blame not himself or his own lack of skill, but was finally in such pain that he gladly pushed the blame away from himself, onto the arguments, and spent the rest of his life from then on hating and reviling arguments, and was deprived of the truth and knowledge of things that are?”

περὶ τοὺς ἀντιλογικοὺς λόγους διατρίψαντες οἷσθ' ὅτι τελευτῶντες οἴονται σοφώτατοι γεγονέναι καὶ κατανενοηκέναι μόνοι ὅτι οὔτε τῶν πραγμάτων οὐδενὸς οὐδὲν ὑγιὲς οὐδὲ βέβαιον οὔτε τῶν λόγων, ἀλλὰ πάντα τὰ ὄντα ἀτεχνῶς ὥσπερ ἐν Εὐρίπῳ ἄνω κάτω στρέφεται καὶ χρόνον οὐδένα ἐν οὐδενὶ μένει. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἀληθῆ λέγεις. οὐκοῦν, ὦ Φαίδων, ἔφη, οἰκτρὸν ἂν εἴη τὸ πάθος, εἰ ὄντος δὴ τινος ἀληθοῦς καὶ βεβαίου λόγου καὶ δυνατοῦ κατανοῆσαι, ἔπειτα διὰ τὸ παραγίγνεσθαι τοιοῦτοις τισὶ λόγοις, τοῖς αὐτοῖς τοτὲ μὲν δοκοῦσιν ἀληθέσιν εἶναι, τοτὲ δὲ μή, μὴ ἑαυτόν τις αἰτιῶτο μηδὲ τὴν ἑαυτοῦ ἀτεχνίαν, ἀλλὰ τελευτῶν διὰ τὸ ἀλγεῖν ἄσμενος ἐπὶ τοὺς λόγους ἀφ' ἑαυτοῦ τὴν αἰτίαν ἀπόσαιο καὶ ἤδη τὸν λοιπὸν βίον μισῶν τε καὶ λαιδορῶν τοὺς λόγους διατελοῖ, τῶν δὲ ὄντων τῆς ἀληθείας τε καὶ ἐπιστήμης στέρηθείη. νῆ τὸν Δία, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, οἰκτρὸν δῆτα. πρῶτον μὲν τοίνυν, ἔφη, τοῦτο εὐλαβηθῶμεν, καὶ μὴ

PH: “Yes, by Zeus,” I replied, “a sad situation indeed.”

90e

S: “Well,” he said, “first and foremost we should guard carefully against this, and never allow into our souls the notion that no arguments are sound. Instead, it is much better to accept that we are not yet in a sound condition ourselves, and that we should take courage and be eager to attain a sound condition, you and the others, for the sake of the rest of your lives, and I for the sake of death itself. Yes, I am unlikely to retain a philosophical approach to this particular issue under the present circumstances, but like highly uneducated folk I may become keen on victory. For whenever such people are debating about something, they do not consider what the argument is about and the status of that. Instead they are eager that whatever they themselves

have proposed be accepted by those who are present, and I think that I differ from them only to this extent at present; I am not eager, except incidentally, that what I am saying should seem true to the people here, but that it should seem as true as possible to me. For I reckon, dear friend, and you should note how greedy I am, that if what I am saying happens to be true, it is really good to be persuaded by it. But if, in fact, there is nothing for people who have died, then in this interval before my own death I shall still be less bothersome to the company with my lamentations, and my ignorance will not persist to the last, for that would have been terrible, but it will come to an end quite soon.”

παρίωμεν εἰς τὴν ψυχὴν ὡς τῶν λόγων κινδυνεύει οὐδὲν ὑγιὲς εἶναι, ἀλλὰ πολὺ μᾶλλον ὅτι ἡμεῖς οὕτω ὑγιῶς ἔχομεν, ἀλλὰ ἀνδριστεῖον καὶ προθυμητέον ὑγιῶς ἔχειν, σοὶ μὲν οὖν καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις καὶ τοῦ ἔπειτα βίου παντὸς ἕνεκα, ἐμοὶ δὲ αὐτοῦ ἕνεκα τοῦ θανάτου, ὡς κινδυνεύω ἔγωγε ἐν τῷ παρόντι περὶ αὐτοῦ τούτου οὐ φιλοσόφως ἔχειν ἀλλ' ὥσπερ οἱ πάνυ ἀπαίδευτοι φιλονίκως. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ γὰρ ἐκεῖνοι ὅταν περὶ τοῦ ἀμφισβητῶσιν, ὅπῃ μὲν ἔχει περὶ ὧν ἂν ὁ λόγος ἦ οὐ φροντίζουσιν, ὅπως δὲ ἂν αὐτοὶ ἔθεντο ταῦτα δόξει τοῖς παροῦσιν, τοῦτο προθυμοῦνται. καὶ ἐγὼ μοι δοκῶ ἐν τῷ παρόντι τοσοῦτον μόνον ἐκείνων διοίσειν· οὐ γὰρ ὅπως τοῖς παροῦσιν ἂν ἐγὼ λέγω δόξει ἀληθῆ εἶναι προθυμήσομαι, εἰ μὴ εἴη πάρεργον, ἀλλ' ὅπως αὐτῷ ἐμοὶ ὅτι μάλιστα δόξει οὕτως

91b

S: “Well, Simmias and Cebes, I am now fully prepared to embark upon the discussion. You, however, if you take my advice, should pay little regard to Socrates, and much more regard to the truth, and if I actually seem to you to be saying anything true then you should agree, but if not, you should resist with every possible argument, being careful lest in my eagerness I deceive both myself and yourselves at the same time, and depart like a bee leaving my sting behind.

ἔχειν. λογίζομαι γάρ, ὦ φίλε ἑταῖρε — θέασαι ὡς πλεονεκτικῶς — εἰ μὲν τυγχάνει ἀληθὴ ὄντα ἃ λέγω, καλῶς δὴ ἔχει τὸ πεισθῆναι· εἰ δὲ μηδὲν ἐστὶ τελευτήσαντι, ἀλλ' οὖν τοῦτόν γε τὸν χρόνον αὐτὸν τὸν πρὸ τοῦ θανάτου ἦττον τοῖς παροῦσιν ἀηδὴς ἔσομαι ὁδυρόμενος, ἢ δὲ ἄνοιά μοι αὕτη οὐ συνδιατελεῖ — κακὸν γάρ ἂν ἦν — ἀλλ' ὀλίγον ὕστερον ἀπολεῖται. παρεσκευασμένος δὴ, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, οὕτως ἔρχομαι ἐπὶ τὸν λόγον· ὑμεῖς μέντοι, ἂν ἐμοὶ πείθησθε, σμικρὸν φροντίσαντες Σωκράτους, τῆς δὲ ἀληθείας πολὺ μᾶλλον, ἐὰν μὲν τι ὑμῖν δοκῶ ἀληθὲς λέγειν, συνομολογήσατε, εἰ δὲ μή, παντὶ λόγῳ ἀντιτείνετε, εὐλαβούμενοι ὅπως μὴ ἐγὼ ὑπὸ προθυμίας ἅμα ἐμαυτὸν τε καὶ ὑμᾶς ἐξαπατήσας, ὥσπερ μέλιττα τὸ κέντρον ἐγκαταλιπὼν οἰχήσομαι. ἀλλ' ἰτέον, ἔφη. πρῶτόν με ὑπομνήσατε ἃ ἐλέγετε, ἐὰν μὴ φαίνωμαι μεμνημένος. Σιμμίας μὲν γάρ, ὡς ἐγώ μαι, ἀπιστεῖ τε καὶ φοβεῖται μὴ ἡ ψυχὴ ὅμως καὶ θειότερον καὶ κάλλιον ὢν τοῦ σώματος προαπολλύηται ἐν ἀρμονίας εἶδει οὕσα· Κέβης δέ μοι ἔδοξε τοῦτο μὲν ἐμοὶ συγχωρεῖν, πολυχρονιώτερόν γε εἶναι ψυχὴν σώματος, ἀλλὰ τόδε ἄδηλον παντί, μὴ πολλὰ δὴ σώματα καὶ πολλάκις κατατρίψασα ἡ ψυχὴ τὸ τελευταῖον σῶμα καταλιποῦσα νῦν αὕτη ἀπολλύηται, καὶ ἥ αὐτὸ τοῦτο θάνατος, ψυχῆς ὄλεθρος, ἐπεὶ σῶμά γε αἰεὶ ἀπολλύμενον οὐδὲν παύεται. ἄρα ἄλλ' ἢ ταῦτ' ἐστίν, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης, ἃ δεῖ ἡμᾶς ἐπισκοπεῖσθαι;

91c

S: “Let us proceed then,” he said. “First, the two of you should remind me of what you said, in case I have actually forgotten. Yes, I think Simmias had doubts and was afraid lest the soul, even though it is more divine and more beautiful than the body, might perish before it, as it is in a kind of attunement. I think Cebes, on the other hand, agreed with me over this, that the soul is longer lasting than the body. But he says that it is not obvious to anyone that the soul, having repeatedly worn out many bodies, will not itself perish when it leaves the last body and this may be death, the destruction of the soul, since the body is always perishing unceasingly. So, Simmias and Cebes, are these the issues we need to consider?”

91e

They both agreed that these were the issues.

91e

S: “Now, do you reject all of the previous arguments or do you accept some and reject others?”

συνωμολογείτην δὴ ταῦτ' εἶναι ἄμφω. πότερον οὖν, ἔφη, πάντας τοὺς ἔμπροσθε λόγους οὐκ ἀποδέχεσθε, ἢ τοὺς μὲν, τοὺς δ' οὐ; τοὺς μὲν, ἐφάτην, τοὺς δ' οὐ. ΦΑΙΔ. τί οὖν, ἢ δ' ὅς, περὶ ἐκείνου τοῦ λόγου λέγετε ἐν ᾧ ἔφαμεν τὴν μάθησιν ἀνάμνησιν εἶναι, καὶ τούτου οὕτως ἔχοντος ἀναγκαίως ἔχειν ἄλλοθι πρότερον ἡμῶν εἶναι τὴν

“We accept some and reject others,” they replied.

92a

S: “Well,” he said, “what do you say about the argument in which we stated that learning is recollection and, since this is the case, it necessarily follows that our soul existed elsewhere before she was imprisoned in the body?”

CE: “I found it wonderfully persuasive at the time,” said Cebes, “and I still do now, more than any argument.”

SI: “Yes, indeed,” said Simmias, “I share the same view, and I would be very surprised if I ever found myself holding a different opinion about it.”

92a

S: And Socrates said, “But you will have to hold a different opinion, my Theban friend, if you persist with the idea that an attunement is a compound entity, and the soul is an attunement constituted from the elements of the body once they are in tune. For I presume you would not accept the suggestion that an attunement may be constituted before there were the elements from which it must be composed. Or would you accept this?”

ψυχὴν, πρὶν ἐν τῷ σώματι ἐνδεθῆναι; ἐγὼ μὲν, ἔφη ὁ Κέρβης, καὶ τότε θαυμαστῶς ὥς ἐπείσθην ὑπ' αὐτοῦ καὶ νῦν ἐμμένω ὥς οὐδενὶ λόγῳ. καὶ

μήν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, καὶ αὐτὸς οὕτως ἔχω, καὶ πάνυ ἂν θαυμάζοιμι εἴ μοι περὶ γε τούτου ἄλλο ποτέ τι δόξειεν. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης, ἀλλὰ ἀνάγκη σοι, ἔφη, ὦ ξένη Θηβαῖε, ἄλλα δόξαι, ἐάνπερ μείνη ἥδε ἡ οἴησις, τὸ ἁρμονίαν μὲν εἶναι σύνθετον πρᾶγμα, ψυχὴν δὲ ἁρμονίαν τινὰ ἐκ τῶν κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἐντεταμένων συγκεῖσθαι· οὐ γάρ που ἀποδέξῃ γε

92b

SI: “Not at all, Socrates,” he said.

92b

S: “Now, are you aware,” he said, “that these are the consequences of what you propose whenever you assert that the soul exists before it enters the form and body of a human being, and on the other hand, that it is constituted from elements that do not yet exist? For your attunement and what you are comparing it to are not really alike; no, the lyre, strings and sounds come into existence first, and they are not tuned at that stage, but the attunement is established last of all, and it is first to perish. So how will this argument be harmonised with the other one, in your view?”

σαυτοῦ λέγοντος ὡς πρότερον ἦν ἁρμονία συγκεῖμένη, πρὶν ἐκεῖνα εἶναι ἐξ ὧν ἔδει αὐτὴν συντεθῆναι. ἢ ἀποδέξῃ; οὐδαμῶς, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες. αἰσθάνη οὖν, ἢ δ' ὅς, ὅτι ταῦτά σοι συμβαίνει λέγειν, ὅταν φῇς μὲν εἶναι τὴν ψυχὴν πρὶν καὶ εἰς ἀνθρώπου εἰδός τε καὶ σῶμα ἀφικέσθαι, εἶναι δὲ αὐτὴν συγκεῖμένην ἐκ τῶν οὐδέπω ὄντων; οὐ γάρ δὴ ἁρμονία γέ σοι τοιοῦτόν ἐστιν ᾧ ἀπεικάζεις, ἀλλὰ πρότερον καὶ ἡ λύρα καὶ αἱ χορδαὶ καὶ

92c

SI: “That is not possible at all,” said Simmias.

οἱ φθόγγοι ἔτι ἀνάρμοστοι ὄντες γίνονται, τελευταῖον δὲ πάντων συνίσταται ἡ ἁρμονία καὶ πρῶτον ἀπόλλυται. οὗτος οὖν σοι ὁ λόγος ἐκείνῳ πῶς συνάσεται; οὐδαμῶς, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. καὶ μήν, ἢ δ' ὅς, πρέπει γε εἴπερ τῷ ἄλλῳ λόγῳ συνωδῶ εἶναι καὶ τῷ περὶ ἁρμονίας. πρέπει γάρ, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. οὗτος τοίνυν, ἔφη, σοὶ οὐ συνωδός· ἀλλ' ὅρα

πότερον αἰρή τῶν λόγων, τὴν μάθησιν ἀνάμνησιν εἶναι ἢ ψυχὴν ἁρμονίαν; πολὺ μᾶλλον, ἔφη, ἐκεῖνον, ὃ Σώκρατες. ὁδε μὲν γάρ

S: “But surely an argument about attunement should be harmonious, if any argument should be.”

Si: “It should,” said Simmias.

S: “Then your argument is not in harmony. So decide. Which of the arguments do you prefer, that learning is recollection or that the soul is an attunement?”

92d

Si: “I much prefer the former, Socrates,” he replied. “For this occurred to me without any proof, based upon a certain likelihood and plausibility, which is why most people hold this view. However, I am conscious that arguments which construct their proof on the basis of likelihoods are imposters, and if we are not alert to them they are extremely deceptive, both in geometry and in everything else. But the argument about recollection and learning was expounded through an hypothesis which deserved acceptance. For it was said, I presume, that our soul exists before it enters the body just as surely as its being, bearing the name ‘what is’, exists. And I am convinced that I have accepted this in an appropriate and correct manner. So, for these reasons, it seems that I must not accept my own or anyone else’s assertion that soul is an attunement.”

μοι γέγονεν ἄνευ ἀποδείξεως μετὰ εἰκότος τινὸς καὶ εὐπρεπείας, ὅθεν καὶ τοῖς πολλοῖς δοκεῖ ἀνθρώποις· ἐγὼ δὲ τοῖς διὰ τῶν εἰκότων τὰς ἀποδείξεις ποιούμενοις λόγοις σύνοιδα οὓσιν ἀλαζόσιν, καὶ ἂν τις αὐτοὺς μὴ φυλάττηται, εὖ μάλα ἐξαπατῶσι, καὶ ἐν γεωμετρίᾳ καὶ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις ἅπασιν. ὁ δὲ περὶ τῆς ἀναμνήσεως καὶ μαθήσεως λόγος δι’ ὑποθέσεως ἀξίας ἀποδέξασθαι εἴρηται. ἐρρήθη γάρ που οὕτως ἡμῶν εἶναι ἢ ψυχὴ καὶ πρὶν εἰς σῶμα ἀφικέσθαι, ὥσπερ αὐτῆς ἐστὶν ἡ οὐσία ἔχουσα τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν τὴν τοῦ ὃ ἔστιν ἐγὼ δὲ ταύτην, ὡς ἑμαυτὸν πείθω, ἰκανῶς τε καὶ ὀρθῶς ἀποδέδεγμαι. ἀνάγκη οὖν μοι, ὡς ἔοικε, διὰ

ταῦτα μήτε ἑαυτοῦ μήτε ἄλλου ἀποδέχεσθαι λέγοντος ὡς ψυχὴ ἐστὶν ἁρμονία. τί δέ, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὦ Σιμμία, τῆδε; ΦΑΙΔ. δοκεῖ σοι ἁρμονία ἢ ἄλλη

93a

S: “But what about this, Simmias?” he asked. “Do you think it is natural for an attunement, or any other compound entity, to be in a different condition than the condition of the elements from which it is constituted?”

SI: “Not at all.”

93a

S: “Nor indeed, I imagine, would the compound do anything or experience anything else besides what the elements either do or experience?”

τινὶ συνθέσει προσήκειν ἄλλως πως ἔχειν ἢ ὡς ἂν ἐκεῖνα ἔχη ἐξ ὧν ἂν συγκέηται; οὐδαμῶς. οὐδὲ μὴν ποιεῖν τι, ὡς ἐγῶμαι, οὐδέ τι πάσχειν ἄλλο παρ' ἃ ἂν ἐκεῖνα ἢ ποιῇ ἢ πάσχη; συνέφη. οὐκ ἄρα ἡγεῖσθαι γε προσήκει ἁρμονίαν τούτων ἐξ ὧν ἂν συντεθῇ, ἀλλ' ἔπεσθαι. συνεδόκει. πολλοῦ ἄρα δεῖ ἐναντία γε ἁρμονία κινηθῆναι ἂν ἢ φθέγξασθαι ἢ τι ἄλλο ἐναντιωθῆναι τοῖς αὐτῆς μέρεσιν. πολλοῦ μέντοι, ἔφη. τί δέ; οὐχ οὕτως ἁρμονία πέφυκεν εἶναι ἐκάστη ἁρμονία ὡς ἂν ἀρμοσθῇ; οὐ μανθάνω, ἔφη. ἢ οὐχί, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἂν μὲν μᾶλλον ἀρμοσθῇ καὶ ἐπὶ πλέον,

He concurred.

S: “So it is natural for an attunement not to lead the elements it is composed of, but to follow them.”

He agreed.

S: “Then an attunement is quite unable to move in opposition, or sound in opposition, or be opposed in any way to its own parts.”

SI: “Yes, quite unable.”

93b

S: “What about this? Is not each attunement by nature an attunement as it has been tuned?”

SI: “I do not understand.”

S: “Well, if it had been more tuned or tuned to a greater extent, assuming that can actually happen, it would be more an attunement and an attunement to a greater extent. And if it had been less tuned or tuned to a lesser extent, it would be less an attunement and an attunement to a lesser extent.”

SI: “Yes, certainly.”

93b

S: “Now, does this also apply to the soul, so that, however slightly, one soul is more what it is than another? Is it more and to a greater extent, or less and to a lesser extent, a soul?”

εἴπερ ἐνδέχεται τοῦτο γίνεσθαι, μᾶλλον τε ἢ ἄρμονία εἶη καὶ πλείων, εἰ δ' ἥττον τε καὶ ἐπ' ἔλαττον, ἥττων τε καὶ ἐλάττων; πάνυ γε. ἢ οὖν ἔστι τοῦτο περὶ ψυχὴν, ὥστε καὶ κατὰ τὸ σμικρότατον μᾶλλον ἑτέραν ἑτέρας ψυχῆς ἐπὶ πλεόν καὶ μᾶλλον ἢ ἐπ' ἔλαττον καὶ ἥττον αὐτὸ τοῦτο εἶναι, ψυχὴν; οὐδ' ὅπως οἶσιν, ἔφη. φέρε δὴ, ἔφη, πρὸς Διός· λέγεται ψυχὴ ἢ μὲν νοῦν τε ἔχειν καὶ ἀρετὴν καὶ εἶναι ἀγαθή, ἢ δὲ ἄνοιάν τε καὶ μοχθηρίαν

SI: “Not in any way.”

93c

S: “Come on then, by Zeus,” he said, “do we say that one soul has reason and virtue and is good while another has ignorance and wickedness and is bad? And is it true to say this?”

SI: “It is true indeed.”

93c

S: “Now, what will any of those who assert that the soul is an attunement say that these things, virtue and the vice, in our souls are? Are they some further separate attunement or non-attunement? And does the attuned soul, the good one, even though it is an attunement, also have another attunement within itself, while the one that is not attuned is just itself and does not have another attunement within it?”

καὶ εἶναι κακή; καὶ ταῦτα ἀληθῶς λέγεται; ἀληθῶς μέντοι. τῶν οὖν θεμένων ψυχὴν ἀρμονίαν εἶναι τί τις φήσει ταῦτα ὄντα εἶναι ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς, τὴν τε ἀρετὴν καὶ τὴν κακίαν; πότερον ἀρμονίαν αὖτις ἀλλήν καὶ ἀναρμοστίαν; καὶ τὴν μὲν ἡρμόσθαι, τὴν ἀγαθὴν, καὶ ἔχειν ἐν αὐτῇ ἀρμονίαν οὕσην ἀλλήν ἀρμονίαν, τὴν δὲ ἀναρμοστον αὐτὴν τε εἶναι καὶ οὐκ ἔχειν ἐν αὐτῇ ἀλλήν; οὐκ ἔχω ἔγωγ', ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, εἰπεῖν δὴλον δ' ὅτι τοιαῦτ' ἄττ' ἂν λέγοι ὁ ἐκεῖνο ὑποθέμενος.

93d

Si: “I cannot tell,” said Simmias, “but whoever proposes that hypothesis would obviously be saying something of that sort.”

93d

S: “But we have already agreed that one soul is not more or less a soul than another, and this is the agreement, that one attunement is not more an attunement or an attunement to a greater extent, or less an attunement or an attunement to a lesser extent, than another one. Is this so?”

ἀλλὰ προωμολόγηται, ἔφη, μηδὲν μᾶλλον μηδ' ἥττον ἐτέραν ἐτέρας ψυχὴν ψυχῆς εἶναι· τοῦτο δ' ἔστι τὸ ὁμολόγημα, μηδὲν μᾶλλον μηδ' ἐπὶ πλέον μηδ' ἥττον μηδ' ἐπ' ἔλαττον ἐτέραν ἐτέρας ἀρμονίαν ἀρμονίας εἶναι. ἦ γάρ; πάνυ γε. τὴν δέ γε μηδὲν μᾶλλον μηδὲ ἥττον ἀρμονίαν οὔσαν μήτε μᾶλλον μήτε ἥττον ἡρμόσθαι ἔστιν οὕτως; ἔστιν. ἢ δὲ μήτε μᾶλλον μήτε ἥττον ἡρμοσμένη ἔστιν ὅτι πλέον ἢ ἔλαττον ἀρμονίας μετέχει, ἢ τὸ ἴσον; τὸ ἴσον. οὐκοῦν ψυχὴ ἐπειδὴ οὐδὲν μᾶλλον οὐδ' ἥττον ἄλλη

Si: “Yes, certainly.”

S: “And, being neither more nor less an attunement, it is neither more nor less attuned. Is this the case?”

Si: “It is.”

S: “And does that which is neither more nor less attuned partake of attunement to a greater extent, to a lesser extent, or to an equal extent?”

SI: “Equal.”

93e

S: “Now, since one soul is no more or less what it is than another one, namely a soul, then it is neither more nor less attuned.”

SI: “Quite so.”

S: “And if it is characterised in this way, it could not partake of attunement, or lack of attunement, to any greater extent, could it?”

SI: “It could not.”

S: “And what is more, if it is characterised in this way, could one soul partake of virtue or vice to a greater extent than another one, if vice is indeed a lack of attunement and virtue is an attunement?”

SI: “Not to a greater extent, no.”

93e

S: “Rather, Simmias, according to the correct argument, if soul is indeed an attunement, no soul will partake of vice. For, obviously, an attunement, being completely an attunement, would never partake of lack of attunement.”

ἄλλης αὐτὸ τοῦτο, ψυχὴ, ἐστίν, οὐδὲ δὴ μᾶλλον οὐδὲ ἥττον ἡρμოსται; οὕτω. τοῦτο δέ γε πεπονθυῖα οὐδὲν πλέον ἀναρμοστίας οὐδὲ ἀρμονίας μετέχοι ἄν; οὐ γὰρ οὐν. τοῦτο δ' αὖ πεπονθυῖα ἄρ' ἂν τι πλέον κακίας ἢ ἀρετῆς μετέχοι ἑτέρα ἑτέρας, εἴπερ ἢ μὲν κακία ἀναρμοστία, ἢ δὲ ἀρετὴ ἀρμονία εἴη; οὐδὲν πλέον. ΦΑΙΔ.

94a

SI: “No, indeed.”

S: “Nor, of course, would a soul, being completely a soul, partake of vice.”

SI: “No, how could it, based upon what we said earlier, at least.”

94a

S: “So, based upon this argument, we find that the souls of all living beings will be equally good, since souls are by nature equally what they

are, namely, souls.”

μᾶλλον δέ γέ που, ὦ Σιμμία, κατὰ τὸν ὀρθὸν λόγον κακίας οὐδεμία ψυχὴ μεθέξει, εἴπερ ἁρμονία ἐστίν· ἁρμονία γὰρ δήπου παντελῶς αὐτὸ τοῦτο οὔσα, ἁρμονία, ἀναρμοστίας οὐποτ’ ἂν μετάσχοι. οὐ μέντοι. οὐδέ γε δήπου ψυχὴ, οὔσα παντελῶς ψυχὴ, κακίας. πῶς γὰρ ἔκ γε τῶν προειρημένων; ἐκ τούτου ἄρα τοῦ λόγου ἡμῖν πᾶσαι ψυχαὶ πάντων ζώων ὁμοίως ἀγαθαὶ ἔσονται, εἴπερ ὁμοίως ψυχαὶ πεφύκασιν αὐτὸ τοῦτο, ψυχαί, εἶναι. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἤ καὶ καλῶς δοκεῖ, ἢ δ’ ὅς, οὕτω λέγεσθαι, καὶ πάσχειν

SI: “That is how it seems to me anyway, Socrates,” he said.

94b

S: “And do you think this has been well argued, and would the argument have ended up in this predicament if the hypothesis that the soul is an attunement was correct?”

SI: “Not at all,” he replied.

94b

S: “What about this?” he asked. “Of all the elements in a person, is there anything else that rules, according to you, except soul, especially if it also possesses understanding?”

ἂν ταῦτα ὁ λόγος εἰ ὀρθή ἢ ὑπόθεσις ἦν, τὸ ψυχὴν ἁρμονίαν εἶναι; οὐδ’ ὁπωστιοῦν, ἔφη. τί δέ; ἢ δ’ ὅς τῶν ἐν ἀνθρώπῳ πάντων ἔσθ’ ὅτι ἄλλο λέγεις ἄρχειν ἢ ψυχὴν ἄλλως τε καὶ φρόνιμον; οὐκ ἔγωγε. πότερον συγχωροῦσαν τοῖς κατὰ τὸ σῶμα πάθεσιν ἢ καὶ ἐναντιουμένην; λέγω δὲ τὸ τοιόνδε, οἶον καύματος ἐνόητος καὶ δίψους ἐπὶ τούναντίον ἔλκειν, τὸ μὴ πίνειν, καὶ πείνης ἐνούσης ἐπὶ τὸ μὴ ἐσθίειν, καὶ ἄλλα μυρία που ὁρῶμεν

SI: “I do not think so.”

94c

S: “Now, does it act in agreement with the affections of the body or in opposition to them? I mean, in situations where there is heat or thirst within the body, soul draws it in the opposite direction, away from

drinking, and when there is hunger, it draws the hunger away from eating, and presumably we are aware of countless other examples of the soul opposing the affections of the body. Is this not so?"

Si: "Yes, certainly."

94c

S: "Furthermore, did we not agree earlier that if the soul is an attunement, it would never strike a note in opposition to the tensions, relaxations, vibrations or any other experiences which its constituents undergo; rather, it would follow them and never act as leader?"

ἐναντιουμένην τὴν ψυχὴν τοῖς κατὰ τὸ σῶμα· ἢ οὐ; πάνυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν αὖ ὠμολογήσαμεν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν μήποτ' ἂν αὐτὴν, ἀρμονίαν γε οὔσαν, ἐναντία ἄδειν οἷς ἐπιτείνοιτο καὶ χαλῶτο καὶ ψάλλοιτο καὶ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν πάθος πάσχοι ἐκεῖνα ἐξ ὧν τυγχάνοι οὔσα, ἀλλ' ἔπεσθαι ἐκείνοις καὶ οὔποτ' ἂν ἡγεμονεύειν; ὠμολογήσαμεν, ἔφη πῶς γὰρ οὐ; τί οὖν; νῦν οὐ πᾶν τούναντίον ἡμῖν φαίνεται ἐργαζομένη, ἡγεμονεύουσά τε ἐκείνων πάντων ἐξ ὧν φησί τις αὐτὴν

Si: "We did agree," he said, "how could one disagree?"

94d

S: "But look, do we not now find the soul exemplifying behaviour which is the complete opposite, leading all these elements of which some say it is composed, opposing them throughout life in almost everything, and dominating them in every way? Sometimes it chastises them more severely with painful processes based upon gymnastics, or medicine, sometimes more gently by threatening and admonishing, talking to the desires, passions and fears as though they constituted a separate entity. I suppose it is like what Homer wrote in the *Odyssey*, where *Odysseus* says:

94d

S: He smote his breast and rebuked his heart with the words, 'Endure, my heart, you have endured far worse.'¹⁹

εἶναι, καὶ ἐναντιουμένη ὀλίγου πάντα διὰ παντὸς τοῦ βίου καὶ δεσπόζουσα πάντας τρόπους, τὰ μὲν χαλεπώτερον κολάζουσα καὶ μετ' ἀλγηδόνων, τὰ τε κατὰ τὴν γυμναστικὴν καὶ τὴν ἰατρικὴν, τὰ δὲ πραότερον, καὶ τὰ μὲν ἀπειλοῦσα, τὰ δὲ νουθετοῦσα, ταῖς ἐπιθυμίαις καὶ ὀργαῖς καὶ φόβοις ὡς ἄλλη οὕσα ἄλλω πράγματι διαλεγομένη; οἷόν που καὶ Ὅμηρος ἐν Ὀδυσσεΐᾳ πεποίηκεν, οὗ λέγει τὸν Ὀδυσσεύα· στήθος δὲ πλήξας κραδίην ἠνίπαπε μύθῳ·

94e

S: “Now, do you think he wrote this in the belief that soul is an attunement, the sort of thing which is led by the affections of the body, rather than leading them and dominating them, as it is a far more divine entity than any attunement?”

τέτλαθι δὴ, κραδίη καὶ κύντερον ἄλλο ποτ' ἔτλης. ἄρ' οἶει αὐτὸν ταῦτα ποιῆσαι διανοούμενον ὡς ἀρμονίας αὐτῆς οὔσης καὶ οἷας ἄγεσθαι ὑπὸ τῶν τοῦ σώματος παθημάτων, ἀλλ' οὐχ οἷας ἄγειν τε ταῦτα καὶ δεσπόζειν, καὶ οὔσης αὐτῆς πολὺνθειότερου τινὸς πράγματος ἢ καθ' ἀρμονίαν; νῆ Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐκ ἄρα, ὦ ἄριστε, ἡμῖν οὐδαμῇ καλῶς ἔχει ψυχὴν

SI: “By Zeus, Socrates, I do not think so.”

95a

S: “Then, my excellent friend, it is not at all appropriate for us to state that soul is an attunement, for it seems we would be disagreeing with the divine poet Homer and with ourselves.”

SI: “That is how matters stand,” he said.

95a

S: “In that case,” said Socrates, “it seems we have somehow placated the Theban goddess, Harmonia, quite well. But Cebes,” he said, “what about Cadmus,²⁰ how shall we placate him, and with what argument?”

ἀρμονίαν τινὰ φάναι εἶναι· οὔτε γὰρ ἄν, ὡς ἔοικεν, Ὀμήρῳ θείῳ ποιητῇ ὁμολογοῖμεν οὔτε αὐτοὶ ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς. ἔχει οὕτως, ἔφη. εἶεν δὴ, ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Σωκράτης, τὰ μὲν Ἀρμονίας ἡμῖν τῆς Θηβαϊκῆς ἴλεά πως, ὡς ἔοικε,

μετρίως γέγονεν· τί δὲ δὴ τὰ Κάδμου, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, πῶς ἰλασόμεθα καὶ τίνι λόγῳ; σύ μοι δοκεῖς, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, ἐξευρήσειν· τουτονὶ γοῦν τὸν λόγον τὸν πρὸς τὴν ἀρμονίαν θαυμαστῶς μοι εἶπες ὡς παρὰ δόξαν. Σιμμίου γὰρ λέγοντος ὅτε ἠπόρει, πάνυ ἐθαύμαζον

95b

CE: “I think you will find a way,” said Cebes. “At least you presented this last argument, the one about attunement, wonderfully, and contrary to what I expected. For while Simmias was describing his difficulty, I really wondered if anyone would be able to come to terms with his argument. So I thought it was remarkable when it failed to withstand the first attack of your argument. Now, I would not be at all surprised if the argument of Cadmus were to suffer the same fate.”

95b

S: “Good man,” said Socrates, “do not be boastful in case some malign influence overturns the impending argument. Anyway, God will take care of that while we, grappling like Homeric heroes, should try to find out if you are saying anything significant. And the essence of what you are looking for is this: you are asking to be shown that since our souls are indestructible and immortal, a man who loves wisdom and who is confident when he is about to die will not be demonstrating an irrational and foolish confidence by believing he is going to fare well when he gets there, better than if he died after living a different sort of life. But as for showing that the soul is strong and divine and had a previous existence before we were born as human beings, you say that all these facts may just as easily indicate not immortality, but only that the soul is long lasting and has somehow existed for a considerable period of time and has known and done a great deal. But in fact that did not make it any more immortal. Rather, this entry into a human body was the beginning of its demise, just like a disease, and the soul lives this life in suffering and finally perishes in what we call death.

εἴ τι ἔξει τις χρήσασθαι τῷ λόγῳ αὐτοῦ· πάνυ οὖν μοι ἀτόπως ἔδοξεν εὐθὺς τὴν πρώτην ἔφοδον οὐ δέξασθαι τοῦ σοῦ λόγου. ταῦτα δὲ οὐκ ἂν θαυμάσαιμι καὶ τὸν τοῦ Κάδμου λόγον εἰ πάθοι. ὡγαθέ, ἔφη ὁ

Σωκράτης, μὴ μέγα λέγε, μὴ τις ἡμῖν βασκανία περιτρέψη τὸν λόγον τὸν μέλλοντα ἔσεσθαι. ἀλλὰ δὴ ταῦτα μὲν τῷ θεῷ μελήσει, ἡμεῖς δὲ Ὀμηρικῶς ἐγγὺς ἰόντες πειρώμεθα εἰ ἄρα τι λέγεις. ἔστι δὲ δὴ τὸ κεφάλαιον ὧν ζητεῖς· ἀξιοῖς ἐπιδειχθῆναι ἡμῶν τὴν ψυχὴν ἀνώλεθρόν τε καὶ ἀθάνατον οὖσαν, εἰ φιλόσοφος ἀνὴρ μέλλων ἀποθανεῖσθαι, θαρρῶν τε καὶ ἡγούμενος ἀποθανῶν ἐκεῖ εὖ πράξειν διαφερόντως ἢ εἰ ἐν ἄλλῳ βίῳ βιοὺς ἐτελεύτα, μὴ ἀνόητόν τε καὶ ἡλίθιον θάρρος θαρρήσει. τὸ δὲ ἀποφαίνειν ὅτι ἰσχυρόν τί ἐστὶν ἡ ψυχὴ καὶ θεοειδὲς καὶ ἦν ἔτι πρότερον, πρὶν ἡμᾶς ἀνθρώπους γενέσθαι, οὐδὲν κωλύειν φῆς πάντα ταῦτα μηνύειν ἀθανασίαν μὲν μὴ, ὅτι δὲ πολυχρόνιον τέ ἐστὶν ψυχὴ καὶ ἦν που πρότερον ἀμήχανον ὅσον χρόνον καὶ ἥδει τε καὶ ἔπραττεν πολλὰ ἄττα· ἀλλὰ γὰρ

95d

S: “You also say that it makes no difference whether it enters a body once or many times, as far as the fear death holds for us is concerned. Indeed, unless he is stupid, it is appropriate for someone to be afraid when he does not know and is unable to uphold in argument that the soul is immortal. So Cebes, I think these are the sort of issues you are raising, and I am deliberately going over them again and again in case anything escapes us, or there is anything you may wish to add or retract.”

οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον ἦν ἀθάνατον, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ εἰς ἀνθρώπου σῶμα ἐλθεῖν ἀρχὴ ἦν αὐτῇ ὀλέθρου, ὥσπερ νόσος καὶ ταλαιπωρουμένη τε δὴ τοῦτον τὸν βίον ζῶη καὶ τελευτῶσά γε ἐν τῷ καλουμένῳ θανάτῳ ἀπολλύοιτο. διαφέρειν δὲ δὴ φῆς οὐδὲν εἴτε ἅπαξ εἰς σῶμα ἔρχεται εἴτε πολλάκις, πρὸς γε τὸ ἕκαστον ἡμῶν φοβεῖσθαι· προσήκει γὰρ φοβεῖσθαι, εἰ μὴ ἀνόητος εἴη, τῷ μὴ εἰδότι μηδὲ ἔχοντι λόγον διδόναι

95e

CE: “No,” said Cebes, “there is nothing I need to add or retract at the moment, and these are the issues I am raising.”

95e

Socrates paused for a long time, and he was considering something to himself.

95e

S: “Cebes,” he said, “the question you are pursuing is not trivial, for it involves comprehensive deliberation about the cause of generation and destruction. I shall recount my own experiences of these topics, if you wish. Then, if anything I say proves helpful to you with regard to the reassurance you are referring to, you may make use of it.”

ὡς ἀθάνατόν ἐστι. τοιαῦτ' ἅττα ἐστίν, οἶμαι, ὃ Κέβης, ἃ λέγεις· καὶ ἐξεπίτηδες πολλάκις ἀναλαμβάνω, ἵνα μὴ τι διαφύγη ἡμᾶς, εἴ τέ τι βούλει, προσθῆς ἢ ἀφέλῃς. καὶ ὁ Κέβης, ἀλλ' οὐδὲν ἔγωγε ἐν τῷ παρόντι, ἔφη, οὔτε ἀφελεῖν οὔτε προσθεῖναι δέομαι· ἔστι δὲ ταῦτα ἃ λέγω. ὁ οὖν Σωκράτης συχνὸν χρόνον ἐπισχὼν καὶ πρὸς ἑαυτόν τι σκεψάμενος, οὐ φαῦλον πρᾶγμα, ἔφη, ὃ Κέβης, ζητεῖς· ὅλως γὰρ δεῖ περὶ γενέσεως καὶ φθορᾶς τὴν αἰτίαν διαπραγματεύεσθαι. ΦΑΙΔ.

CE: “Well, I certainly want that,” said Cebes.

96a

S: “Then listen to what I am going to say,” he said. “When I was young, Cebes, I was extraordinarily eager for that wisdom which they call the science of nature. To me it seemed magnificent to know the causes of each thing, why each thing comes into being, why it perishes and why it is. And I was constantly changing my direction back and forth, asking, firstly: do living creatures develop when hot and cold bring about some fermentation, as some people say? Is it the blood with which we think, or is it air or fire? Or is it actually none of these but rather the brain which provides for the senses of hearing, seeing and smelling, from which arise memory and opinion and once memory and opinion have acquired stability, does knowledge arise on the basis of them? And then going on to consider their corruption, and the things that happen in the heavens and on the earth, I finally deemed myself naturally unsuited to this sort of investigation, almost useless.

ἐγὼ οὖν σοι δίδειμι περὶ αὐτῶν, ἐὰν βούλῃ, τά γε ἐμὰ πάθη ἔπειτα ἂν τί σοι χρήσιμον φαίνεται ὧν ἂν λέγω, πρὸς τὴν πειθῶ περὶ ὧν δὴ λέγεις χρήσῃ. ἀλλὰ μὴν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, βούλομαί γε. ἄκουε τοίνυν ὡς ἐροῦντος.

ἐγὼ γάρ, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, νέος ὢν θαυμαστῶς ὡς ἐπεθύμησα ταύτης τῆς σοφίας ἦν δὴ καλοῦσι περὶ φύσεως ἱστορίαν· ὑπερήφανος γάρ μοι ἐδόκει εἶναι, εἰδέναι τὰς αἰτίας ἐκάστου, διὰ τί γίγνεται ἕκαστον καὶ διὰ τί ἀπόλλυται καὶ διὰ τί ἔστι. καὶ πολλάκις ἐμαυτὸν ἄνω κάτω μετέβαλλον σκοπῶν πρῶτον τὰ τοιάδε· ἄρ' ἐπειδὴν τὸ θερμὸν καὶ τὸ ψυχρὸν σηπεδόνα τινὰ λάβῃ, ὥς τινες ἔλεγον, τότε δὴ τὰ ζῶα συντρέφεται; καὶ πότερον τὸ αἷμά ἐστιν ᾧ φρονοῦμεν, ἢ ὁ ἀήρ ἢ τὸ πῦρ; ἢ τούτων μὲν οὐδέν, ὁ δ' ἐγκέφαλός ἐστιν ὁ τὰς αἰσθήσεις παρέχων τοῦ ἀκούειν καὶ ὁρᾶν καὶ ὁσφραίνεσθαι, ἐκ τούτων δὲ γίγνοιτο μνήμη καὶ δόξα, ἐκ δὲ μνήμης καὶ δόξης λαβούσης τὸ ἡρεμεῖν, κατὰ ταῦτα γίγνεσθαι ἐπιστήμην; καὶ αὖ τούτων τὰς φθορὰς σκοπῶν, καὶ τὰ περὶ τὸν οὐρανόν

96c

S: “I will give you enough evidence as follows: before this, there were certain things I knew quite well, or so it seemed to me and to others, but later on I was so utterly blinded by this investigation that I unlearned what I previously thought that I knew about many other matters, and even about why a person grows. Before this, I thought it was obvious to everyone that this is due to eating and drinking. For from the food that is eaten, flesh is added to flesh, bone to bone, and through the same process, their own substance is also added to the other parts, and eventually the lesser bulk becomes greater and this is how the small person becomes big. That is what I thought at the time. Does that sound reasonable to you?”

τε καὶ τὴν γῆν πάθῃ, τελευτῶν οὕτως ἐμαυτῷ ἔδοξα πρὸς ταύτην τὴν σκέψιν ἀφυῆς εἶναι ὡς οὐδὲν χρήμα. τεκμήριον δέ σοι ἐρῶ ἱκανόν· ἐγὼ γάρ ἃ καὶ πρότερον σαφῶς ἠπιστάμην, ὥς γε ἐμαυτῷ καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἐδόκουν, τότε ὑπὸ ταύτης τῆς σκέψεως οὕτω σφόδρα ἐτυφλώθην, ὥστε ἀπέμαθον καὶ ταῦτα ἃ πρὸ τοῦ ᾧμην εἰδέναι, περὶ ἄλλων τε πολλῶν καὶ διὰ τί ἄνθρωπος αὐξάνεται. τοῦτο γὰρ ᾧμην πρὸ τοῦ παντὶ δῆλον εἶναι, ὅτι διὰ τὸ ἐσθίειν καὶ πίνειν· ἐπειδὴν γὰρ ἐκ τῶν σιτίων ταῖς μὲν σαρκὶ σάρκες προσγέγνυνται, τοῖς δὲ ὀστοῖς ὀστᾶ, καὶ οὕτω κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις τὰ αὐτῶν οἰκεῖα ἐκάστοις προσγένηται, τότε δὴ

τὸν ὀλίγον ὄγκον ὄντα ὕστερον πολὺν γεγονέναι, καὶ οὕτω γίγνεσθαι τὸν σμικρὸν ἄνθρωπον μέγαν. οὕτως τότε ὦμην· οὐ δοκῶ σοι μετρίως; ἔμοιγε, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης. σκέψαι δὴ καὶ τάδε ἔτι. ὦμην γὰρ ἱκανῶς μοι δοκεῖν, ὅποτε τις φαίνοιτο ἄνθρωπος παραστάς μέγας σμικρῷ μείζων

96e

CE: “To me, yes,” said Cebes.

96e

S: “Then consider this too. I used to regard it as acceptable for me to think that whenever a man standing beside a small man appears large, it is on account of the head itself that he is larger, and the same goes for horses. And it seemed even more evident to me that the ten is greater than the eight because the two is added to them, and the two cubits are greater than the one cubit because it exceeded it by half its length.”

96e

CE: “Yes, but what do you think about these matters now?” asked Cebes.

εἶναι αὐτῇ τῇ κεφαλῇ, καὶ ἵππος ἵππου· καὶ ἔτι γε τούτων ἐναργέστερα, τὰ δέκα μοι ἐδόκει τῶν ὀκτὼ πλέονα εἶναι διὰ τὸ δύο αὐτοῖς προσεῖναι, καὶ τὸ δίπηχυ τοῦ πενταίου μείζον εἶναι διὰ τὸ ἡμίσει αὐτοῦ ὑπερέχειν. νῦν δὲ δὴ, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, τί σοι δοκεῖ περὶ αὐτῶν; ΦΑΙΔ. πόρρω που, ἔφη, νῆ Δία ἐμὲ εἶναι τοῦ οἶεσθαι περὶ τούτων του τὴν αἰτίαν εἰδέναι, ὅς γε οὐκ ἀποδέχομαι ἐμαυτοῦ οὐδὲ ὡς ἐπειδὴν ἐνί τις προσθῇ ἔν, ἢ τὸ ἐν ᾧ προσετέθη δύο γέγονεν, ἢ τὸ προστεθέν, ἢ τὸ προστεθὲν καὶ ᾧ προσετέθη

97a

S: “By Zeus,” he said, “I am far from convinced that I know any of the causes of these things, when I cannot even accept for myself that whenever someone adds one to one, either the one to which it is added has become two, or that the added one and the one to which it is added became two, due to the addition of the former to the latter. For I am amazed that when each of them was apart from the other, each was

somehow one and neither then was two, and yet, once they drew near to one another, this was, in itself, somehow the cause of their becoming two, this coming together in which they are placed near one another.

διὰ τὴν πρόσθεσιν τοῦ ἑτέρου τῷ ἑτέρῳ δύο ἐγένετο· θαυμάζω γὰρ εἰ ὅτε μὲν ἐκάτερον αὐτῶν χωρὶς ἀλλήλων ἦν, ἐν ἅρᾳ ἐκάτερον ἦν καὶ οὐκ ἦσθιν τότε δύο, ἐπεὶ δ' ἐπλησίασαν ἀλλήλοις, αὕτη ἄρα αἰτία αὐτοῖς ἐγένετο τοῦ δύο γενέσθαι, ἡ σύνοδος τοῦ πλησίον ἀλλήλων τεθῆναι. οὐδέ γε ὡς ἐάν τις ἐν διασχίσει, δύναμαι ἔτι πείθεσθαι ὡς αὕτη αὖ αἰτία γέγονεν, ἡ σχίσις, τοῦ δύο γεγονέναι ἐναντία γὰρ

97b

S: “Nor can I ever persuade myself that if someone divides one, this division is itself the cause of its becoming two. For this cause of its becoming two turns out to be the opposite of the previous cause. Previously it was because they were drawn together, close to one another, and were added to each other, but now it is because they are drawn apart, and separated from each other. Neither can I ever persuade myself that I know how one arises, nor for that matter how anything else comes into being, or perishes, or is, based upon this manner of approach. No, I do not accept this at all, and instead I somehow devise an alternative manner of approach of my own.

γίνεται ἢ τότε αἰτία τοῦ δύο γίνεσθαι. τότε μὲν γὰρ ὅτι συνήγετο πλησίον ἀλλήλων καὶ προσετίθετο ἕτερον ἑτέρῳ, νῦν δ' ὅτι ἀπάγεται καὶ χωρίζεται ἕτερον ἀφ' ἑτέρου. οὐδέ γε δι' ὅτι ἐν γίνεται ὡς ἐπίσταμαι, ἔτι πείθω ἑμαυτόν, οὐδ' ἄλλο οὐδὲν ἐνὶ λόγῳ δι' ὅτι γίνεται ἢ ἀπόλλυται ἢ ἔστι, κατὰ τοῦτον τὸν τρόπον τῆς μεθόδου, ἀλλὰ τιν' ἄλλον τρόπον αὐτὸς εἰκῇ φύρω, τοῦτον δὲ οὐδαμῇ προσίεμαι. ἀλλ' ἀκούσας μὲν ποτε ἐκ βιβλίου τινός, ὡς ἔφη, Ἀναξαγόρου

97c

S: “But one day I heard someone reading from a book which he said was by Anaxagoras, which was saying that reason is what sets things in order and is the cause of everything. Now, I was pleased with this

explanation, and it somehow seemed appropriate to me that reason is the cause of all, and I decided that if this is the case then reason, as it is ordering everything, orders and arranges each thing in the best possible manner. Therefore, if someone should wish to discover the cause according to which each thing comes into being, perishes, or is, then he needs to discover the best way for that thing to be, or undergo, or enact anything at all. And so, based on this account, a person should consider nothing else about himself or about anything else, except what is most excellent and best. And then the same person necessarily knows what is worse, for the knowledge concerned with both is the same.

ἀναγιγνώσκοντος, καὶ λέγοντος ὡς ἄρα νοῦς ἐστὶν ὁ διακοσμῶν τε καὶ πάντων αἴτιος, ταύτη δὴ τῇ αἰτίᾳ ἦσθην τε καὶ ἔδοξέ μοι τρόπον τινὰ εὖ ἔχειν τὸ τὸν νοῦν εἶναι πάντων αἴτιον, καὶ ἡγησάμην, εἰ τοῦθ' οὕτως ἔχει, τὸν γε νοῦν κοσμοῦντα πάντα κοσμεῖν καὶ ἕκαστον τιθέναι ταύτη ὅπῃ ἂν βέλτιστα ἔχη· εἰ οὖν τις βούλοιτο τὴν αἰτίαν εὐρεῖν περὶ ἑκάστου ὅπῃ γίγνεται ἢ ἀπόλλυται ἢ ἔστι, τοῦτο δεῖν περὶ αὐτοῦ εὐρεῖν, ὅπῃ βέλτιστον αὐτῷ ἐστὶν ἢ εἶναι ἢ

97d

S: “As I reflected on all this, I was delighted to think I had found a teacher of the cause of the things that are, whose reasoning was in accord with my own. I thought Anaxagoras would also tell me first whether the earth was flat or round, and when he had told me that, he would also explain the cause and necessity thereof, describing what is best and why it was better for the earth to be like that. And if he said it was in the centre, he would go on to explain that it was better for it to be in the centre. And if he could clarify these issues for me, I had resolved not to long for any other kind of cause. What is more, I had resolved to conduct an enquiry into the sun and the moon and the other stars in the same manner, their speed relative to one another, their inclinations and their other characteristics, and the precise way in which it is better for each of them to behave as they do, and to undergo whatever happens to them. Indeed, once he had stated that

these are ordered by reason, I never thought he would attribute any other cause to them, except that it is best for them to be in the state they are actually in. Therefore, I thought that in assigning the cause to each of the things and to all of them together, he would go on to explain what is best for each of them, and good for all of them together. And I would not have traded these hopes for anything. No, I acquired the books eagerly and read them as quickly as I could, so that I would know the best and the worst as quickly as I could.

ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν πάσχειν ἢ ποιεῖν· ἐκ δὲ δὴ τοῦ λόγου τούτου οὐδὲν ἄλλο σκοπεῖν προσήκειν ἀνθρώπῳ καὶ περὶ αὐτοῦ ἐκείνου καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἄλλ' ἢ τὸ ἄριστον καὶ τὸ βέλτιστον. ἀναγκαῖον δὲ εἶναι τὸν αὐτὸν τοῦτον καὶ τὸ χεῖρον εἶδέναι· τὴν αὐτὴν γὰρ εἶναι ἐπιστήμην περὶ αὐτῶν. ταῦτα δὴ λογιζόμενος ἄσμενος ἠύρηκέναι ὥμην διδάσκαλον τῆς αἰτίας περὶ τῶν ὄντων κατὰ νοῦν ἐμαυτῷ, τὸν Ἀναξαγόραν, καὶ μοι φράσειν πρῶτον μὲν πότερον ἢ γῆ πλατεῖά ἐστιν ἢ στρογγύλη, ἐπειδὴ δὲ φράσειεν, ἐπεκδιηγέσθαι τὴν αἰτίαν καὶ τὴν ἀνάγκην, λέγοντα τὸ ἄμεινον καὶ ὅτι αὐτὴν ἄμεινον ἦν τοιαύτην εἶναι· καὶ εἰ ἐν μέσῳ φαίη εἶναι αὐτὴν, ἐπεκδιηγέσθαι ὡς ἄμεινον ἦν αὐτὴν ἐν μέσῳ εἶναι· καὶ εἰ μοι ταῦτα ἀποφαίνοι, παρεσκευάσμην ὡς οὐκέτι ποθεσόμενος αἰτίας ἄλλο εἶδος. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ δὴ καὶ περὶ ἡλίου οὕτω παρεσκευάσμην ὡσαύτως πευσόμενος, καὶ σελήνης καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἄστρον, τάχους τε πέρι πρὸς ἄλληλα καὶ τροπῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων παθημάτων, πῇ ποτε ταῦτ' ἄμεινόν ἐστιν ἕκαστον καὶ ποιεῖν καὶ πάσχειν ἢ πάσχει. οὐ γὰρ ἄν ποτε αὐτὸν ὥμην, φάσκοντά γε ὑπὸ νοῦ αὐτὰ κεκοσμηθαι, ἄλλην τινὰ αὐτοῖς αἰτίαν ἐπενεγκεῖν ἢ ὅτι βέλτιστον αὐτὰ οὕτως ἔχειν

98b

S: “Well, my friend, my wonderful hope was wrenched away from me when I continued with my reading and beheld a man neither having recourse to reason nor assigning to it any responsibility for the ordering of things but assigning responsibility to air and ether and water and numerous other oddities. And he seemed to me to be behaving just like someone who says that anything Socrates does is done on account of reason. But then, when he tries to state the causes

of each action I perform, he might say, firstly, that the explanation for my sitting in this place now is that my body is constituted from bones and sinews, and the bones are hard and have joints separating them from one another, while the sinews, which can be tensed and relaxed, surround the bones, as does the flesh and the skin which encloses them. Well, since the bones are dangling in their own sockets, the tightening and loosening of the sinews now enables me somehow to bend my limbs, and this is the cause of my sitting here with my legs bent. And likewise with regard to our conversation, he might also propose other causes of this sort, describing sounds, air currents, auditory experience and countless other such factors as causes, neglecting to mention the true causes, that once the Athenians had decided it was better to condemn me, I in turn decided it was indeed better for me to sit here, because it was more just to remain and submit to whatever penalty they might dictate. Since, by the dog, I am sure these bones and sinews would have been in Megara or Boeotia long ago, impelled by an opinion about what was best, if I had not thought it more just and noble to submit to whatever penalty the city might impose, rather than taking flight and running away.

ἐστὶν ὥσπερ ἔχει ἐκάστῳ οὖν αὐτῶν ἀποδιδόντα τὴν αἰτίαν καὶ κοινῇ πᾶσι τὸ ἐκάστῳ βέλτιστον ὥμην καὶ τὸ κοινὸν πᾶσιν ἐπεκδιηγῆσεσθαι ἀγαθόν· καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἀπεδόμην πολλοῦ τὰς ἐλπίδας, ἀλλὰ πάνυ σπουδῇ λαβὼν τὰς βίβλους ὡς τάχιστα οἷός τ' ἦ ἀνεγίνωσκον, ἵν' ὡς τάχιστα εἰδείην τὸ βέλτιστον καὶ τὸ χεῖρον. ἀπὸ δὲ θαυμαστῆς ἐλπίδος, ᾧ ἑταῖρε, ὥχόμεν φερόμενος, ἐπειδὴ προῖων καὶ ἀναγινώσκων ὁρῶ ἄνδρα τῷ μὲν νῶ οὐδὲν χρώμενον οὐδέ τινας αἰτίας ἐπαιτιώμενον εἰς τὸ διακοσμεῖν τὰ πράγματα, ἀέρας δὲ καὶ αἰθέρας καὶ ὕδατα αἰτιώμενον καὶ ἄλλα πολλὰ καὶ ἄτοπα. καὶ μοι ἔδοξεν ὁμοιότατον πεπονθέναι ὥσπερ ἂν εἴ τις λέγων ὅτι Σωκράτης πάντα ὅσα πράττει νῶ πράττει, κάπειτα ἐπιχειρήσας λέγειν τὰς αἰτίας ἐκάστων ὧν πράττω, λέγοι πρῶτον μὲν ὅτι διὰ ταῦτα νῦν ἐνθάδε κάθημαι, ὅτι σύγκειταί μου τὸ σῶμα ἐξ ὁσῶν καὶ νεύρων, καὶ τὰ μὲν ὁστᾶ ἐστὶν στερεὰ καὶ διαφυγὰς ἔχει χωρὶς ἀπ' ἀλλήλων, τὰ δὲ νεῦρα οἷα ἐπιτείνεσθαι

98d

S: “But to refer to such factors as causes is most absurd. And yet, if anyone were to say that without having such things as bones and sinews, and anything else I possess, I would be unable to do whatever I decide to do, he would be speaking the truth. To say, however, that I do what I do because of these, and that I also perform them on account of reason, and not on account of choosing what is best, would show a very great disregard for the argument. Imagine being unable to make the distinction between the actual cause, on the one hand, and that in the absence of which the cause would never be a cause, on the other hand. Yes, it seems to me that most people are groping about in the dark, and making use of an inappropriate name, when they refer to this as a cause. And on this basis, some place a vortex about the earth, and make the earth remain in place on account of the heavens, while others support the earth just like a flat dish resting upon air. But the power by which these are now situated in the best way that they could have been placed is a power which they neither look for nor credit with any divine strength. Instead they believe they will eventually discover some Atlas²¹ who is stronger and more immortal than this, who will do a better job of encompassing them all, and it never occurs to them that, in truth, the good and the right bind and encompass. Now, I would gladly have become the pupil of anyone at all in order to learn the precise nature of such a cause as this. However, since this was denied me and I proved unable either to find it myself or learn from someone else, would you like me, Cebes, to give an exposition of how I undertook the second sailing in search of the cause?” he asked.

καὶ ἀνίσσθαι, περιαιπέχοντα τὰ ὁστᾶ μετὰ τῶν σαρκῶν καὶ δέρματος ὃ συνέχει αὐτά· αἰωρουμένων οὖν τῶν ὁστῶν ἐν ταῖς αὐτῶν συμβολαῖς χαλῶντα καὶ συντείνοντα τὰ νεῦρα κάμπτεσθαι· που ποιεῖ οἷόν τ' εἶναι ἐμὲ νῦν τὰ μέλη, καὶ διὰ ταύτην τὴν αἰτίαν συγκαμφθεὶς ἐνθάδε κάθημαι· καὶ αὖ περὶ τοῦ διαλέγεσθαι ὑμῖν ἐτέρας τοιαύτας αἰτίας λέγοι, φωνάς τε καὶ ἀέρας καὶ ἀκοὰς καὶ ἄλλα μυρία τοιαῦτα αἰτιώμενος, ἀμελήσας τὰς ὡς ἀληθῶς αἰτίαις λέγειν, ὅτι, ἐπειδὴ Ἀθηναίοις ἔδοξε

βέλτιον εἶναι ἐμοῦ καταψηφίσασθαι, διὰ ταῦτα δὴ καὶ ἐμοὶ βέλτιον αὖ δέδοκται ἐνθάδε καθῆσθαι, καὶ δικαιότερον παραμένοντα ὑπέχουν τὴν δίκην ἢν ἂν κελεύσωσιν· ἐπεὶ νῆ τὸν κύνα, ὡς ἐγὼμαι, πάλαι ἂν ταῦτα τὰ νεῦρα καὶ τὰ ὀστέα ἢ περὶ Μέγαρα ἢ Βοιωτοὺς ἦν, ὑπὸ δόξης φερόμενα τοῦ βελτίστου, εἰ μὴ δικαιότερον ὦμην καὶ κάλλιον εἶναι πρὸ τοῦ φεύγειν τε καὶ ἀποδιδράσκειν ὑπέχουν τῇ πόλει δίκην ἦντιν' ἂν τάττη. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλ' αἷτια μὲν τὰ τοιαῦτα καλεῖν λίαν ἄτοπον· εἰ δέ τις λέγοι ὅτι ἄνευ τοῦ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἔχειν καὶ ὀστέα καὶ νεῦρα καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα ἔχω οὐκ ἂν οἷός τ' ἢ ποιεῖν τὰ δόξαντά μοι, ἀληθῆ ἂν λέγοι· ὡς μέντοι διὰ ταῦτα ποιῶ ἅ ποιῶ, καὶ ταῦτα νῶ πράττων, ἀλλ' οὐ τῇ τοῦ βελτίστου αἰρέσει, πολλὰ ἂν καὶ μακρὰ ῥαθυμία εἴη τοῦ λόγου. τὸ γὰρ μὴ διελέσθαι οἷόν τ' εἶναι ὅτι ἄλλο μὲν τί ἐστι τὸ αἷτιον τῷ ὄντι, ἄλλο δὲ ἐκεῖνο ἄνευ οὗ τὸ αἷτιον οὐκ ἂν ποτ' εἴη αἷτιον· ὃ δὴ μοι φαίνονται ψηλαφῶντες οἱ πολλοὶ ὥσπερ ἐν σκότει, ἀλλοτρίῳ ὀνόματι προσχρώμενοι, ὡς αἷτιον αὐτὸ προσαγορεύειν. διὸ δὴ καὶ ὁ μὲν τις δίνην περιτιθεὶς τῇ γῇ ὑπὸ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ μένειν δὴ ποιεῖ τὴν γῆν, ὁ δὲ ὥσπερ καρδόπῳ πλατεῖα βάθρον τὸν ἀέρα ὑπερείδει·

99c

CE: “Yes, I would like that very much,” he replied.

τὴν δὲ τοῦ ὡς οἷόν τε βέλτιστα αὐτὰ τεθῆναι δύναμιν οὕτω νῦν κεῖσθαι, ταύτην οὔτε ζητοῦσιν οὔτε τινὰ οἶονται δαιμονίαν ἰσχὺν ἔχειν, ἀλλὰ ἡγοῦνται τούτου Ἄτλαντα ἂν ποτε ἰσχυρότερον καὶ ἀθανατώτερον καὶ μᾶλλον ἅπαντα συνέχοντα ἐξευρεῖν, καὶ ὡς ἀληθῶς τὸ ἀγαθὸν καὶ δέον συνδεῖν καὶ συνέχειν οὐδὲν οἶονται. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν τῆς τοιαύτης αἰτίας ὅπῃ ποτὲ ἔχει μαθητὴς ὅτου οὖν ἥδιστ' ἂν γενοίμην· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ταύτης ἐστερήθην καὶ οὐτ' αὐτὸς εὐρεῖν οὔτε παρ' ἄλλου μαθεῖν οἷός τε ἐγενόμην, τὸν δεύτερον

99d

S: “Well, after this, since I was exhausted from studying the things that are, it seemed to me that I should beware lest I suffer the fate of those who look at the sun and study it during an eclipse. For some of them, as you know, destroy their eyes unless they study its image in water or something of that sort. I also arrived at a similar understanding, and I

was afraid that my soul might be totally blinded by looking at things with the eyes and trying to grasp them with each of the senses. So it seemed to me that I should take refuge in arguments, and study in these the truth of the things that are. Now, perhaps my comparison is in a sense inappropriate, for I do not really agree that someone who studies the things that are, through arguments, has more recourse to images than someone who studies them in actualities.

πλοῦν ἐπὶ τὴν τῆς αἰτίας ζήτησιν ἢ πεπραγμάτευμαι βούλει σοι, ἔφη, ἐπίδειξιν ποιήσωμαι, ὧ Κέρης; ὑπερφυῶς μὲν οὖν, ἔφη, ὡς βούλομαι. ἔδοξε τοίνυν μοι, ἡ δ' ὅς, μετὰ ταῦτα, ἐπειδὴ ἀπειρήκη τὰ ὄντα σκοπῶν, δεῖν εὐλαβηθῆναι μὴ πάθοιμι ὅπερ οἱ τὸν ἥλιον ἐκλείποντα θεωροῦντες καὶ σκοποῦμενοι πάσχουσιν· διαφθείρονται γάρ που ἔνιοι τὰ ὄμματα, ἐὰν μὴ ἐν ὕδατι ἢ τινι τοιούτῳ σκοπῶνται τὴν εἰκόνα αὐτοῦ. τοιοῦτόν τι καὶ ἐγὼ διανοήθην, καὶ ἔδωκα μὴ παντάπασιν τὴν ψυχὴν τυφλωθεῖν βλέπων πρὸς τὰ πράγματα τοῖς ὄμμασι καὶ ἐκάστη τῶν αἰσθήσεων ἐπιχειρῶν ἅπτεσθαι αὐτῶν. ἔδοξε δὲ μοι χρῆναι εἰς τοὺς λόγους καταφυγόντα ἐν ἐκείνοις σκοπεῖν τῶν ὄντων τὴν ἀλήθειαν. ΦΑΙΔ. ἴσως μὲν οὖν ᾧ εἰκάζω τρόπον

100a

S: “Anyway, I set about this in the following manner. In each case, I hypothesise an account which I judge to be the strongest, and I regard as true anything which seems to me to be in harmony with this, whether it concerns a cause or anything else at all, and I regard anything which does not, as untrue. But I would like to explain what I am saying to you more clearly for I do not think you understand at the moment.”

100a

CE: “No, by Zeus,” said Cebes, “not completely.”

τινὰ οὐκ ἔοικεν· οὐ γὰρ πάνυ συγχωρῶ τὸν ἐν τοῖς λόγοις σκοπούμενον τὰ ὄντα ἐν εἰκόσι μᾶλλον σκοπεῖν ἢ τὸν ἐν τοῖς ἔργοις. ἀλλ' οὖν δὴ ταύτῃ γε ὥρμησα, καὶ ὑποθέμενος ἐκάστοτε λόγον ὃν ἂν κρίνω ἔρρωμένεστατον εἶναι, ᾧ μὲν ἂν μοι δοκῇ τούτῳ συμφωνεῖν τίθημι ὡς

ἀληθῆ ὄντα, καὶ περὶ αἰτίας καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάντων ὄντων, ἃ δ' ἂν μή, ὥς οὐκ ἀληθῆ. βούλομαι δέ σοι σαφέστερον εἰπεῖν ἃ λέγω· οἶμαι γάρ σε νῦν οὐ μανθάνειν. οὐ μὰ τὸν Δία, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, οὐ σφόδρα.

100b

S: “Well, this is what I mean,” he said. “It is nothing new. No, it is just what I have been constantly repeating, both in the argument which has just been presented and on other occasions. Indeed, I am going to attempt to show you the kind of cause I have worked on, and I am going back again to topics which have been discussed repeatedly, and I am starting from those, proposing that there is beauty just by itself, and good, and largeness, and all the others. And if you grant me these and agree that they exist, I hope, from these, to show you the cause and to confirm that the soul is immortal.”

ἀλλ', ἥ δ' ὅς, ὥδε λέγω, οὐδὲν καινόν, ἀλλ' ἅπερ αἰεὶ τε ἄλλοτε καὶ ἐν τῷ παρεληλυθότι λόγῳ οὐδὲν πέπαυμαι λέγων. ἔρχομαι γὰρ δὴ ἐπιχειρῶν σοι ἐπιδείξασθαι τῆς αἰτίας τὸ εἶδος ὃ πεπραγμάτευμαι, καὶ εἶμι πάλιν ἐπ' ἐκεῖνα τὰ πολυθρύλητα καὶ ἄρχομαι ἀπ' ἐκείνων, ὑποθέμενος εἶναι τι καλὸν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ μέγα καὶ ἅλλα πάντα· ἃ εἴ μοι δίδως τε καὶ συγχωρεῖς εἶναι ταῦτα, ἐλπίζω σοι ἐκ τούτων τὴν αἰτίαν ἐπιδείξειν καὶ ἀνευρήσειν ὥς ἀθάνατον ἡ ψυχή.

100c

CE: “Well, in that case,” said Cebes, “you may assume that I grant you this and you should lose no time in proceeding with the account.”

100c

S: “Then consider the consequences of these admissions,” he said, “and whether they seem to you as they do to me. For it appears to me that, if anything else is beautiful except beauty itself, then it is beautiful because it partakes of that beauty and for no other reason. And I say the same about all the others. Do you accept this sort of cause?”

CE: “I accept it,” he replied.

100c

S: “Well, then,” he said, “I no longer understand, nor am I able to recognise those other wise causes, but if someone says to me that anything at all is beautiful because of the bright colour it has, or its shape, or anything else of that sort, I dismiss the others, for I am confused by them all. And I myself maintain, simply, plainly, and perhaps foolishly, that nothing else makes it beautiful, except the presence of that beauty or communion with it, regardless of the manner or means by which these occur, for I am not making a definite assertion about this yet. But I do assert that all beautiful things are beautiful on account of beauty. And this seems to me the safest answer to give to myself or anyone else, and once I hold to this, I believe I shall never fall. Rather, it is safe for me or anyone at all to answer that beautiful things become beautiful on account of beauty. Or does it not seem that way to you?”

ἀλλὰ μήν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, ὡς διδόντος σοι οὐκ ἂν φθάνοις περαίνων. σκόπει δὴ, ἔφη, τὰ ἐξῆς ἐκείνοις ἐάν σοι συνδοκῇ ὥσπερ ἔμοί. φαίνεται γάρ μοι, εἴ τί ἐστιν ἄλλο καλὸν πλὴν αὐτὸ τὸ καλόν, οὐδὲ δι’ ἓν ἄλλο καλὸν εἶναι ἢ διότι μετέχει ἐκείνου τοῦ καλοῦ· καὶ πάντα δὴ οὕτως λέγω. τῇ τοιᾷδε αἰτία συγχωρεῖς; συγχωρῶ, ἔφη. οὐ τοίνυν, ἦ δ’ ὅς, ἔτι μανθάνω οὐδὲ δύναμαι τὰς ἄλλας αἰτίας τὰς σοφὰς ταύτας γινώσκειν· ἀλλ’ ἐάν τις μοι λέγῃ δι’ ὅτι καλόν ἐστιν ὅτιοῦν, ἢ χρῶμα εὐανθὲς ἔχον ἢ σχῆμα ἢ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν τῶν τοιούτων, τὰ μὲν ἄλλα χαίρειν ἐῷ, — ταραττομαι γὰρ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις πᾶσι — τοῦτο δὲ ἀπλῶς καὶ ἀτέχνως καὶ ἴσως εὐήθως ἔχω παρ’ ἑμαυτῷ, ὅτι οὐκ ἄλλο τι ποιεῖ αὐτὸ καλόν ἢ ἡ ἐκείνου τοῦ καλοῦ εἴτε παρουσία εἴτε κοινωνία εἴτε ὅπῃ δὴ καὶ ὅπως προσγενομένη οὐ γὰρ ἔτι τοῦτο διισχυρίζομαι, ἀλλ’ ὅτι τῷ καλῷ πάντα τὰ καλὰ γίγνεται καλά. τοῦτο γάρ μοι δοκεῖ ἀσφαλέστατον εἶναι καὶ ἑμαυτῷ ἀποκρίνασθαι καὶ ἄλλῳ, καὶ τούτου ἐχόμενος

CE: “That is how it seems.”

100e

S: “And so, are large things large, and larger things larger on account of largeness, and smaller things smaller on account of smallness?”

ἡγοῦμαι οὐκ ἂν ποτε πεσεῖν, ἀλλ' ἀσφαλὲς εἶναι καὶ ἐμοὶ καὶ ὁτῶν ἄλλω ἀποκρίνασθαι ὅτι τῷ καλῷ τὰ καλὰ γίγνεται καλὰ· ἢ οὐ καὶ σοὶ δοκεῖ; δοκεῖ. καὶ μεγέθει ἄρα τὰ μεγάλα μεγάλα καὶ τὰ μείζω μείζω, καὶ σμικρότητι τὰ ἐλάττω ἐλάττω; ναί. ΦΑΙΔ. οὐδὲ σὺ ἄρ' ἂν ἀποδέχοιο εἰ τίς τινα φαίη ἕτερον ἑτέρου τῇ κεφαλῇ μείζω εἶναι, καὶ τὸν ἐλάττω τῷ αὐτῷ τούτῳ

CE: “Yes.”

101a

S: “Then you would not accept it if someone were to say that one person is larger than another on account of a head, and the smaller person is smaller on account of this same thing. Instead, you would affirm that you are only saying that everything which is larger than another is larger on account of nothing except largeness, and is larger because of this, because of largeness; and the smaller is smaller on account of nothing else but smallness, and is smaller because of this, because of smallness. I think you would be afraid in case some counter-argument might oppose you, if you were to state that someone is larger or smaller on account of a head: firstly, because you say the larger is larger and the smaller is smaller on account of the same thing; and secondly, because you say the larger is larger on account of the head which is small, and of course it is preposterous that anyone is large on account of something small. Would you not be afraid of these responses?”

ἐλάττω, ἀλλὰ διαμαρτύροιο ἂν ὅτι σὺ μὲν οὐδὲν ἄλλο λέγεις ἢ ὅτι τὸ μείζον πᾶν ἕτερον ἑτέρου οὐδενὶ ἄλλῳ μείζον ἐστίν ἢ μεγέθει, καὶ διὰ τοῦτο μείζον, διὰ τὸ μέγεθος, τὸ δὲ ἔλαττον οὐδενὶ ἄλλῳ ἔλαττον ἢ σμικρότητι, καὶ διὰ τοῦτο ἔλαττον, διὰ τὴν σμικρότητα, φοβούμενος οἶμαι μή τίς σοι ἐναντίος λόγος ἀπαντήσῃ, ἐὰν τῇ κεφαλῇ μείζονά τινα φῇς εἶναι καὶ ἐλάττω, πρῶτον μὲν τῷ αὐτῷ τὸ μείζον μείζον εἶναι καὶ τὸ ἔλαττον ἔλαττον, ἔπειτα τῇ κεφαλῇ σμικρᾷ οὔσῃ τὸν

101b

Cebes laughed and replied,

101b

CE: “I would, indeed.”

101b

S: “Would you not be afraid”, he said, “to state that ten is more than eight on account of two, and exceeds it because of this cause, rather than on account of quantity, and because of quantity? And that the two cubits are greater than the one cubit on account of half, and not on account of largeness? Yes, I presume you would have the same fear.”

μείζω μείζω εἶναι, καὶ τοῦτο δὴ τέρας εἶναι, τὸ σμικρῷ τινι μέγαν τινὰ εἶναι· ἢ οὐκ ἂν φοβοῖτο ταῦτα; καὶ ὁ Κέβης γελάσας, ἔγωγε, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν, ἢ δ' ὅς, τὰ δέκα τῶν ὀκτὼ δυοῖν πλείω εἶναι, καὶ διὰ ταύτην τὴν αἰτίαν ὑπερβάλλειν, φοβοῖτο ἂν λέγειν, ἀλλὰ μὴ πλήθει καὶ διὰ τὸ πλῆθος; καὶ τὸ δίπηχυ τοῦ πηχυαίου ἡμίσει μείζον εἶναι ἀλλ' οὐ μεγέθει; ὁ αὐτὸς γάρ που φόβος. πάννυ γ', ἔφη. τί δέ; ἐνὶ ἐνὸς προστεθέντος τὴν πρόσθεσιν αἰτίαν εἶναι

CE: “Very much so,” he replied.

101c

S: “What about this? Would you not beware of saying that if one is added to one, the cause of their becoming two is the addition, or in the case where it is divided, the division? Instead, you would shout loudly that you know no other way that each arises except by participating in the being particular to each of those in which it participates. And in the examples we are discussing, you know no other cause of becoming two except by participation in duality, and whatever is to be two must participate in this, and whatever is to be one must participate in unity. But those divisions and additions and other subtleties of that kind you would set aside, leaving it to those who are wiser than you are to give those answers. Instead, you would be afraid, as they say, of your own shadow and of your inexperience, and would adhere to that safe hypothesis and would answer based upon that.

τοῦ δύο γενέσθαι ἢ διασχισθέντος τὴν σχίσιν οὐκ εὐλαβοῖτο ἂν λέγειν; καὶ μέγα ἂν βοῶντις ὅτι οὐκ οἶσθα ἄλλως πως ἕκαστον γινόμενον ἢ

μετασχὸν τῆς ἰδίας οὐσίας ἐκάστου οὐ ἂν μετάσχη, καὶ ἐν τούτοις οὐκ ἔχεις ἄλλην τινὰ αἰτίαν τοῦ δύο γενέσθαι ἀλλ' ἢ τὴν τῆς δυάδος μετάσχεσιν, καὶ δεῖν τούτου μετασχεῖν τὰ μέλλοντα δύο ἔσεσθαι, καὶ μονάδος ὃ ἂν μέλλῃ ἐν ἔσεσθαι, τὰς δὲ σχίσεις ταύτας καὶ προσθέσεις καὶ τὰς ἄλλας τὰς τοιαύτας κομψείας ἐώης ἂν χαίρειν, παρεῖς ἀποκρίνασθαι τοῖς σεαυτοῦ σοφωτέροις· σὺ δὲ δεδιὼς ἅν, τὸ

101d

S: “Yet, if someone were to adhere to the hypothesis itself, you would ignore him and would not respond, until you had considered whether the consequences of that were, in your view, concordant or discordant with one another. And when you had to give an account of the hypothesis itself, you would do so in the same way, by proposing another further hypothesis which seems best of those which are higher, until you arrive at something adequate. But you would not confuse matters, as the disputatious people do, by discussing the principle, and the consequences of it at the same time, if you really wanted to discover any of the things that are. Indeed, these fellows do not have a single scruple or concern about this, for they are enabled by their wisdom to jumble everything together, and yet they are still able to be content with themselves. But you, if you really are among the lovers of wisdom, will, I believe, do as I suggest.”

λεγόμενον, τὴν σαυτοῦ σκιὰν καὶ τὴν ἀπειρίαν, ἐχόμενος ἐκείνου τοῦ ἀσφαλοῦς τῆς ὑποθέσεως, οὕτως ἀποκρίναιο ἅν. εἰ δέ τις αὐτῆς τῆς ὑποθέσεως ἔχοιτο, χαίρειν ἐώης ἂν καὶ οὐκ ἀποκρίναιο ἕως ἂν τὰ ἀπ' ἐκείνης ὀρμηθέντα σκέψαιο εἴ σοι ἀλλήλοις συμφωνεῖ ἢ διαφωνεῖ· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἐκείνης αὐτῆς δέοι σε διδόναι λόγον, ὡσαύτως ἂν διδοίης, ἄλλην αὖ ὑπόθεσιν ὑποθέμενος ἥτις τῶν ἄνωθεν βελτίστη φαίνοιτο, ἕως ἐπὶ τι ἱκανὸν ἔλθοις, ἅμα δὲ οὐκ ἂν φύριοι ὥσπερ οἱ ἀντιλογικοὶ περὶ τε τῆς ἀρχῆς διαλεγόμενος καὶ τῶν ἐξ ἐκείνης ὀρμημένων, εἴπερ βούλοιό τι τῶν ὄντων εὐρεῖν; ἐκείνοις μὲν γὰρ ἴσως οὐδὲ εἷς περὶ τούτου λόγος οὐδὲ φροντίς· ἱκανοὶ γὰρ ὑπὸ σοφίας ὁμοῦ πάντα κυκῶντες ὅμως δύνασθαι αὐτοὶ αὐτοῖς ἀρέσκειν· σὺ δ', εἴπερ εἶ τῶν φιλοσόφων,

102a

“What you are saying is completely true,” said Simmias and Cebes together.

102a

EC: By Zeus, Phaedo, of course Simmias and Cebes did. Indeed, I think he has explained this with extraordinary clarity to anyone with even a little intelligence.

PH: Yes, certainly, Echecrates, and everyone who was present thought so too.

EC: Yes, and so do those who were absent but are listening to you now. Well, what else was said after all this?

102a

PH: As I recall, when these points had been conceded to him and it was agreed that each of the forms is something and the other things have acquired the names of the forms themselves by partaking of them, he proceeded to ask the following:

οἶμαι ἂν ὡς ἐγὼ λέγω ποιοῖς. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀληθέστατα, ἔφη, λέγεις, ὃ τε Σιμμίας ἅμα καὶ ὁ Κέβης. ΕΧ. νῆ Δία, ὦ Φαίδων, εἰκότως γε· θαυμαστῶς γάρ μοι δοκεῖ ὡς ἐναργῶς τῷ καὶ σμικρὸν νοῦν ἔχοντι εἰπεῖν ἐκεῖνος ταῦτα. ΦΑΙΔ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, καὶ πᾶσι τοῖς παροῦσιν ἔδοξεν. ΕΧ. καὶ γὰρ ἡμῖν τοῖς ἀποῦσι, νῦν δὲ ἀκούουσιν. ἀλλὰ τίνα δὴ ἦν τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα λεχθέντα; ΦΑΙΔ. ὡς μὲν ἐγὼ οἶμαι, ἐπεὶ αὐτῷ ταῦτα συνεχωρήθη, καὶ ὠμολογεῖτο εἶναί τι ἕκαστον τῶν εἰδῶν καὶ τούτων τᾶλλα μεταλαμβάνοντα αὐτῶν τούτων τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν ἴσχειν, τὸ δὴ μετὰ ταῦτα ἡρώτα, εἰ δὴ, ἦ δ' ὅς, ταῦτα οὕτως λέγεις, ἄρ' οὐχ, ὅταν Σιμμίαν Σωκράτους φῆς μείζω εἶναι, Φαίδωνος δὲ ἐλάττω, λέγεις τότε εἶναι ἐν τῷ Σιμμίᾳ ἀμφοτέρω, καὶ μέγεθος καὶ σμικρότητα; ἔγωγε. ἀλλὰ γάρ, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὁμολογεῖς τὸ τὸν Σιμμίαν ὑπερέχειν Σωκράτους οὐχ ὡς τοῖς ῥήμασι λέγεται οὕτω καὶ τὸ ἀληθές

102b

S: “Now,” said Socrates to Cebes, “if you describe matters in this way and you say that Simmias is larger than Socrates and smaller than

Phaedo, are you not then saying that both largeness and smallness are in Simmias?”

CE: “I am, indeed.”

102b

S: “More to the point,” he said, “are you agreeing with the statement ‘Simmias is taller than Socrates’, when the words used do not actually express the truth? For presumably Simmias is not, by nature, taller than I am on account of being Simmias, but on account of the largeness he happens to possess. Nor, again, is he taller than Socrates because Socrates is Socrates, but because Socrates has smallness relative to Simmias’ largeness.”

CE: “True.”

102c

S: “Nor again, is he less tall than Phaedo because Phaedo is Phaedo, but rather because Phaedo has largeness relative to Simmias’ smallness.”

CE: “That is it.”

102c

S: “So in this way Simmias is referred to as being both large and small, as he is between both of them, allowing the smallness to be exceeded by the greatness of one person, and presenting to the other the greatness that exceeds that man’s smallness.”

ἔχειν· οὐ γάρ που πεφυκέναι Σιμμίαν ὑπερέχειν τούτῳ, τῷ Σιμμίαν εἶναι, ἀλλὰ τῷ μεγέθει ὃ τυγχάνει ἔχων· οὐδ’ αὖ Σωκράτους ὑπερέχειν ὅτι Σωκράτης ὁ Σωκράτης ἐστίν, ἀλλ’ ὅτι σμικρότητα ἔχει ὁ Σωκράτης πρὸς τὸ ἐκείνου μέγεθος· ἀληθῆ. οὐδέ γε αὖ ὑπὸ Φαίδωνος ὑπερέχεσθαι τῷ ὅτι Φαίδων ὁ Φαίδων ἐστίν, ἀλλ’ ὅτι μέγεθος ἔχει ὁ Φαίδων πρὸς τὴν Σιμμίου σμικρότητα· ἔστι ταῦτα. οὕτως ἄρα ὁ Σιμμίας ἐπωνυμίαν ἔχει σμικρὸς τε καὶ μέγας εἶναι, ἐν μέσῳ ὧν ἀμφοτέρων, τοῦ μὲν τῷ μεγέθει

102d

And he smiled at this and said,

102d

S: “I seem to be speaking like a legal document, but anyway the situation is certainly as I am describing it.”

Simmias agreed.

102d

S: “Now, I am saying this for the following reason, I want you to hold the same opinion as I do. For it appears to me not only that the large itself never consents to being large and small at the same time, but also that the large in us never admits the small, nor consents to being exceeded. Instead, there are two possible outcomes, either it departs and withdraws whenever its opposite, the small, approaches, or else it perishes once the small arrives. But it never consents to being different from the very thing that it is, by waiting about and admitting smallness. Just as I, having admitted and endured smallness, and still being just what I am, I, this same person, am small. But that large has never ventured to be small, and in like manner, the small that is in us never consents to become large or to be so, nor do any of the other opposites, while still being just what they are, also become and be opposite. No, in that circumstance they either depart or perish.”

υπερέχειν τὴν σμικρότητα ὑπέχων, τῷ δὲ τὸ μέγεθος τῆς σμικρότητος παρέχων ὑπερέχον. καὶ ἅμα μειδιάσας, ἔοικα, ἔφη, καὶ συγγραφικῶς ἔρεῖν, ἀλλ’ οὖν ἔχει γέ που ὡς λέγω. συνέφη. λέγω δὴ τοῦδ’ ἔνεκα, βουλόμενος δόξαι σοὶ ὅπερ ἐμοί. ἐμοὶ γὰρ φαίνεται οὐ μόνον αὐτὸ τὸ μέγεθος οὐδέποτε ἐθέλειν ἅμα μέγα καὶ σμικρὸν εἶναι, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸ ἐν ἡμῖν μέγεθος οὐδέποτε προσδέχεσθαι τὸ σμικρὸν οὐδ’ ἐθέλειν ὑπερέχεσθαι, ἀλλὰ δυοῖν τὸ ἕτερον, ἢ φεύγειν καὶ ὑπεκχωρεῖν ὅταν αὐτῷ προσίῃ τὸ ἐναντίον, τὸ σμικρὸν, ἢ προσελθόντος ἐκείνου ἀπολωλέναι· ὑπομένον δὲ καὶ δεξάμενον τὴν σμικρότητα οὐκ ἐθέλειν εἶναι ἕτερον ἢ ὅπερ ἦν. ὥσπερ ἐγὼ δεξάμενος καὶ ὑπομείνας τὴν σμικρότητα, καὶ ἔτι ὦν ὅσπερ εἰμί, οὗτος ὁ αὐτὸς σμικρὸς εἰμι· ἐκεῖνο δὲ οὐ τετόλμηκεν μέγα ὂν σμικρὸν εἶναι· ὡς δ’ αὐτως καὶ τὸ σμικρὸν τὸ ἐν ἡμῖν οὐκ ἐθέλει ποτὲ μέγα γίνεσθαι οὐδὲ εἶναι, οὐδ’ ἄλλο οὐδὲν τῶν ἐναντίων, ἔτι ὂν ὅπερ ἦν, ἅμα τὸναντίον γίγνεσθαί τε

103a

CE: “Entirely so,” said Cebes, “that is how it appears to me.”

103a

And having heard this, one of the company – I do not remember exactly who it was – said,

103a

“By the gods, in our earlier discussions, did we not agree the very opposite of what we are now saying? Did we not say that the greater arises from the lesser and the lesser from the greater, and in short, the actual generation of opposites is from opposites? But now I think we are saying that this would never happen.”

καὶ εἶναι, ἀλλ' ἤτοι ἀπέρχεται ἢ ἀπόλλυται ἐν τούτῳ τῷ παθήματι. ΦΑΙΔ. παντάπασιν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, οὕτω φαίνεται μοι. καὶ τις εἶπε τῶν παρόντων ἀκούσας — ὅστις δ' ἦν, οὐ σαφῶς μέμνημαι — πρὸς θεῶν, οὐκ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἡμῖν λόγοις αὐτὸ τὸ ἐναντίον τῶν νυνὶ λεγομένων ὠμολογεῖτο, ἐκ τοῦ ἐλάττονος τὸ μείζον γίνεσθαι καὶ ἐκ τοῦ μείζονος τὸ ἔλαττον, καὶ ἀτεχνῶς αὕτη εἶναι ἡ γένεσις τοῖς ἐναντίοις, ἐκ τῶν ἐναντίων; νῦν δέ μοι δοκεῖ λέγεσθαι ὅτι τοῦτο οὐκ ἂν ποτε γένοιτο. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης παραβαλὼν τὴν κεφαλὴν καὶ ἀκούσας,

103b

Having turned his head to listen, Socrates said,

103b

S: “You have been very brave to remind us. However, you are not recognising the difference between what we are saying now and what we said then. For we were saying then that the opposite thing arises from the opposite thing. Now, however, we are saying that the opposite itself, be it in us or in nature, would not ever become opposite to itself. For then, my friend, we were talking about whatever possessed the opposites, referring to them by the name of the appropriate opposites. Now, however, we are discussing the opposites themselves, whose name the objects bear because those opposites are within them. And we are saying that the opposites themselves would never be prepared to undergo conversion into one another.”

ἀνδρικῶς, ἔφη, ἀπεμνημόνευκας, οὐ μέντοι ἐννοεῖς τὸ διαφέρον τοῦ τε νῦν λεγομένου καὶ τοῦ τότε. τότε μὲν γὰρ ἐλέγετο ἐκ τοῦ ἐναντίου πράγματος τὸ ἐναντίον πράγμα γίγνεσθαι, νῦν δέ, ὅτι αὐτὸ τὸ ἐναντίον ἑαυτῷ ἐναντίον οὐκ ἂν ποτε γένοιτο, οὔτε τὸ ἐν ἡμῖν οὔτε τὸ ἐν τῇ φύσει. τότε μὲν γάρ, ὦ φίλε, περὶ τῶν ἐχόντων τὰ ἐναντία ἐλέγομεν, ἐπονομάζοντες αὐτὰ τῇ ἐκείνων ἐπωνυμίᾳ, νῦν δὲ περὶ ἐκείνων αὐτῶν ὧν ἐνόησαν ἔχει τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν τὰ ὀνομαζόμενα·

103c

And at that point he looked at Cebes, and said,

103c

S: “What about you, Cebes? I presume you were not bothered by any aspect of what our friend here said?”

CE: “No,” said Cebes, “that’s not how I feel just now, though I am not denying that there are numerous issues bothering me.”

103c

S: “So we have agreed without reservation,” said Socrates, “that the opposite will never be opposite to itself.”

αὐτὰ δ’ ἐκεῖνα οὐκ ἂν ποτέ φαμεν ἐθελῆσαι γένεσιν ἀλλήλων δέξασθαι. καὶ ἅμα βλέψας πρὸς τὸν Κέβητα εἶπεν, ἄρα μή που, ὦ Κέβης, ἔφη, καὶ σέ τι τούτων ἐτάραξεν ὧν ὅδε εἶπεν; οὐδ’ αὖ, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης, οὕτως ἔχω· καίτοι οὔτι λέγω ὡς οὐ πολλά με ταραττει. συνωμολογήκαμεν ἄρα, ἦ δ’ ὅς, ἀπλῶς τοῦτο, μηδέποτε ἐναντίον ἑαυτῷ τὸ ἐναντίον ἔσεσθαι. παντάπασιν, ἔφη. ἔτι δὴ μοι καὶ τόδε σκέψαι, ἔφη, εἰ ἄρα συνωμολογήσεις. θερμόν τι καλεῖς καὶ ψυχρόν; ἔγωγε. ἄρ’ ὅπερ χιόνα καὶ πῦρ;

CE: “Entirely so,” he replied.

103d

S: “Then consider whether you also agree with me about the following. Do you call something hot or cold?”

CE: “I do.”

S: “And are they identical with fire and snow?”

CE: “By Zeus, I do not think so.”

S: “Rather the hot is something different from fire, and the cold something different from snow.”

CE: “Yes.”

103d

S: “Then I presume you appreciate that, as we said earlier, being snow it will not ever admit heat and still be just what it is, snow, and also hot. Instead, at the approach of heat it either withdraws from it or perishes.”

μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ἀλλ' ἕτερόν τι πυρὸς τὸ θερμόν καὶ ἕτερόν τι χιόνος τὸ ψυχρόν; ναί. ἀλλὰ τόδε γ' οἶμαι δοκεῖ σοι, οὐδέποτε χιόνα γ' οὔσαν δεξαμένην τὸ θερμόν, ὥσπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐλέγομεν, ἔτι ἔσσεσθαι ὅπερ ἦν, χιόνα καὶ θερμόν, ἀλλὰ προσιόντος τοῦ θερμοῦ ἢ ὑπεκχωρήσειν αὐτῷ ἢ ἀπολεῖσθαι. πάνυ γε. καὶ τὸ πῦρ γε αὖ προσιόντος τοῦ ψυχροῦ αὐτῷ ἢ ὑπεξίεναι ἢ ἀπολεῖσθαι, οὐ μέντοι ποτὲ τολμήσειν δεξάμενον τὴν ψυχρότητα ἔτι εἶναι ὅπερ ἦν, πῦρ καὶ ψυχρόν.

CE: “Certainly.”

103e

S: “And fire also either slips away or perishes when cold approaches, but it will never venture to admit the coldness and still be just what it was, fire, and also cold.”

ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις. ἔστιν ἄρα, ἥ δ' ὅς, περὶ ἔνια τῶν τοιούτων, ὥστε μὴ μόνον αὐτὸ τὸ εἶδος ἀξιοῦσθαι τοῦ αὐτοῦ ὀνόματος εἰς τὸν αἰὲ χρόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἄλλο τι ὃ ἔστι μὲν οὐκ ἐκεῖνο, ἔχει δὲ τὴν ἐκείνου μορφήν αἰεῖ, ὅταν περ ἦ. ἔτι δὲ ἐν τῷδε ἴσως ἔσται σαφέστερον ὃ λέγω· τὸ γὰρ περιττὸν αἰεῖ που δεῖ τούτου τοῦ ὀνόματος τυγχάνειν ὅπερ νῦν λέγομεν· ἢ οὐ; πάνυ γε. ΦΑΙΔ. ἄρα μόνον τῶν ὄντων — τοῦτο γὰρ ἔρω τῷ — ἢ καὶ ἄλλο

CE: “What you are saying is true.”

104a

S: “Then,” he said, “in some cases like this, the position is that the form itself is not the only thing that always merits the same name forever, but there is also something else which is not that form but always possesses a feature of that form whenever it exists. But perhaps what I mean will be even clearer with this example, for presumably the odd must always be assigned this name which we are now using. Is this not so?”

CE: “Certainly.”

104a

S: “But is this the only thing that is assigned this name? That is my question. Or is there something else which is not identical with the odd, but which nevertheless must always be referred to by this name along with its own name, because by nature it is never devoid of the odd? I am referring, for instance, to how the number three and many others are characterised. Think about the number three. Does it not seem that you must always refer to it by its own name and by the name of the odd, although the odd is not identical with the number three? But nevertheless, three, five, and half of all numbers, although they are not identical with the odd, each of them is always odd. And furthermore, two, four, and all the other series of numbers, are nevertheless always even in each case, though they are not identical with the even. Do you agree or not?”

τι ὃ ἔστι μὲν οὐχ ὅπερ τὸ περιττόν, ὅμως δὲ δεῖ αὐτὸ μετὰ τοῦ ἑαυτοῦ ὀνόματος καὶ τοῦτο καλεῖν αἰεὶ διὰ τὸ οὕτω πεφυκέναι ὥστε τοῦ περιττοῦ μηδέποτε ἀπολείπεσθαι; λέγω δὲ αὐτὸ εἶναι οἶον καὶ ἡ τριάς πέπονθε καὶ ἄλλα πολλά. σκοπεῖ δὲ περὶ τῆς τριάδος. ἄρα οὐ δοκεῖ σοι τῷ τε αὐτῆς ὀνόματι αἰεὶ προσαγορευτέα εἶναι καὶ τῷ τοῦ περιττοῦ, ὄντος οὐχ ὅπερ τῆς τριάδος; ἀλλ' ὅμως οὕτως πέφυκε καὶ ἡ τριάς καὶ ἡ πεμπτάς καὶ ὁ ἥμισυς τοῦ ἀριθμοῦ ἅπας, ὥστε

104b

CE: “How could I disagree?” said Cebes.

104b

S: “Then take note of what I am trying to show you. It is as follows. It is evident, not only that those opposites do not admit one another, but also that whatever things are not opposite to one another, but always contain opposites, seem not to admit that form which is opposite to the form they contain. Rather, when it approaches, they either perish or withdraw. Or shall we deny that the number three would prefer to perish or suffer any other fate rather than wait about, still being three, and become even?”

οὐκ ὦν ὅπερ τὸ περιττὸν αἰεὶ ἕκαστος αὐτῶν ἐστὶ περιττός· καὶ αὖ τὰ δύο καὶ τὰ τέτταρα καὶ ἅπας ὁ ἕτερος αὖ στίχος τοῦ ἀριθμοῦ οὐκ ὦν ὅπερ τὸ ἄρτιον ὅμως ἕκαστος αὐτῶν ἄρτιός ἐστιν αἰεὶ· συγχωρεῖς ἢ οὐ; πῶς γὰρ οὐκ; ἔφη. ὃ τοίνυν, ἔφη, βούλομαι δηλῶσαι, ἄθρει. ἔστιν δὲ τόδε, ὅτι φαίνεται οὐ μόνον ἐκεῖνα τὰ ἐναντία ἄλληλα οὐ δεχόμενα, ἀλλὰ καὶ ὅσα οὐκ ὄντ’ ἀλλήλοις ἐναντία ἔχει αἰεὶ τάναντία, οὐδὲ ταῦτα ἔοικε δεχομένοις ἐκείνην τὴν ιδέαν ἢ ἂν τῇ ἐν αὐτοῖς οὔσῃ ἐναντία ἢ, ἀλλ’ ἐπιούσης αὐτῆς ἦτοι ἀπολλύμενα ἢ ὑπεκχωροῦντα. ἢ οὐ φήσομεν τὰ τρία καὶ ἀπολεῖσθαι πρότερον καὶ ἄλλο ὅτιοῦν πείσεσθαι, πρὶν ὑπομεῖναι ἔτι τρία ὄντα ἄρτια γενέσθαι; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης. οὐδὲ μὴν, ἢ δ’ ὅς, ἐναντίον γέ ἐστι δυὰς τριάδι. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. οὐκ ἄρα μόνον τὰ εἶδη τὰ ἐναντία οὐχ ὑπομένει ἐπιόντα ἄλληλα, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἄλλ’ ἅττα τὰ ἐναντία οὐχ ὑπομένει ἐπιόντα. ἀληθέστατα, ἔφη, λέγεις. βούλει οὖν, ἢ δ’ ὅς, ἐὰν οἰοί τ’ ὦμεν, ὀρισώμεθα ὅποια ταῦτά ἐστιν; πάνυ γε.

104c

CE: “It certainly will,” said Cebes.

S: “And yet, two,” he said, “is not the opposite of three.”

CE: “Definitely not.”

S: “So it is not only the opposite forms that do not wait about as they approach one another, but some other things also do not wait about as the opposites approach.”

CE: “What you are saying is very true.”

S: “Now, would you like us, if we are able, to define what sort these are?”

CE: “Very much so.”

104d

S: “Well, Cebes, would they be those which always compel whatever they take hold of to adopt not only their own form, but also the form of some additional opposite?”

ἄρ' οὖν, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, τάδε εἴη ἄν, ἃ ὅτι ἂν κατάσχη μὴ μόνον ἀναγκάζει τὴν αὐτοῦ ιδέαν αὐτὸ ἴσχειν, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐναντίου αὐτῷ αἰεί τινος; πῶς λέγεις; ὥσπερ ἄρτι ἐλέγομεν. οἴσθα γὰρ δήπου ὅτι ἃ ἂν ἡ τῶν τριῶν ιδέα κατάσχη, ἀνάγκη αὐτοῖς οὐ μόνον τρισὶν εἶναι ἀλλὰ καὶ περιττοῖς. πάνυ γε. ἐπὶ τὸ τοιοῦτον δὴ, φαμέν, ἡ ἐναντία ιδέα ἐκείνη τῇ μορφῇ ἣ ἂν τοῦτο ἀπεργάζεται οὐδέ ποτ' ἂν ἔλθοι. οὐ γάρ. εἰργάζετο δέ γε ἡ περιττή; ναί. ἐναντία δὲ ταύτῃ ἡ τοῦ ἁρτίου; ναί.

CE: “What do you mean?”

S: “Just what we were saying a moment ago, for you know of course, that whatever the form of three takes hold of, it must not only be three but also odd.”

CE: “Certainly.”

S: “Then we are saying that the opposite form to the form that produces this would never come to something of this sort.”

CE: “It would not.”

S: “Now, does oddness produce this property?”

CE: “Yes.”

S: “And is the form of the even the opposite of this?”

CE: “Yes.”

104e

S: “So the form of the even will never come to the number three.”

ἐπὶ τὰ τρία ἄρα ἢ τοῦ ἀρτίου ἰδέα οὐδέποτε ἦξει. οὐ δῆτα. ἄμοιρα δὲ τοῦ ἀρτίου τὰ τρία. ἄμοιρα. ἀνάρτιος ἄρα ἢ τριάς. ναί. ΦΑΙΔ. ὃ τοίνυν ἔλεγον ὀρίσασθαι, ποῖα οὐκ ἐναντία τινὶ ὄντα ὅμως οὐ δέχεται αὐτό, τὸ ἐναντίον — οἷον νῦν ἢ τριάς τῷ ἀρτίῳ οὐκ οὔσα ἐναντία οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον αὐτὸ δέχεται, τὸ γὰρ ἐναντίον ἀεὶ αὐτῷ ἐπιφέρει, καὶ ἡ δυὰς τῷ περιττῷ καὶ

CE: “Certainly not.”

S: “Then the number three has no share in the even.”

CE: “No share.”

S: “So the number three is uneven.”

CE: “Yes.”

105a

S: “Well, I said we were to define the sort of things which, although not opposite to something, nevertheless do not admit it, the opposite. For example, the number three, although it is not opposite to the even, does not admit the even to any extent, for three always imposes the opposite of the even, and two imposes the opposite of the odd, fire the opposite of cold, and there is a whole range of other instances. Now, decide whether they are defined in this way: not only does an opposite not admit an opposite, but there is also that which imposes some opposite upon whatever it approaches, and that imposer itself will never admit the opposite of that which it imposes. But let me remind you again, as it is not a bad idea to hear this very often. The number five will not admit the even, nor will its double, ten, admit the odd. Now, double itself is also the opposite of something, but nevertheless it will not admit the form of the odd, nor will one-and-a-half and other such numbers, like the half and the third, and all numbers of that sort, admit the form of the whole. Do you follow and do you agree that this is the case?”

τὸ πῦρ τῷ ψυχρῷ καὶ ἄλλα πάμπολλα — ἀλλ’ ὅρα δὴ εἰ οὕτως ὀρίζη, μὴ μόνον τὸ ἐναντίον τὸ ἐναντίον μὴ δέχεσθαι, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐκεῖνο, ὃ ἂν

ἐπιφέρει τι ἐναντίον ἐκείνῳ, ἐφ' ὅτι ἂν αὐτὸ ἦι, αὐτὸ τὸ ἐπιφέρων τὴν τοῦ ἐπιφερομένου ἐναντιότητα μηδέποτε δέξασθαι. πάλιν δὲ ἀναμιμνήσκου· οὐ γὰρ χειρὸν πολλάκις ἀκούειν. τὰ πέντε τὴν τοῦ ἀρτίου οὐ δέξεται, οὐδὲ τὰ δέκα τὴν τοῦ περιττοῦ, τὸ διπλάσιον. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν καὶ αὐτὸ ἄλλῳ ἐναντίον, ὅμως δὲ τὴν

105b

CE: “Yes, I agree most emphatically,” Cebes replied, “and I am following.”

105b

S: “Then recount this to me once more from the beginning,” he said. “And do not answer on the basis of my question, but by imitating what I am doing. I am saying that beyond the first answer I gave, the safe one, I see another safe answer emerging from the present discussion. For if you were to ask me, by the presence of what will the body be hot, I shall not give you the safe answer, the stupid one, that it is by the presence of heat, but a more subtle answer based on this discussion, that it is by the presence of fire. And if you should ask, by the presence of what will the body be ill, I shall not reply that it is by the presence of illness, but by the presence of fever. Nor would I say that a number is made odd by the presence of oddness, but by the presence of a unit, and so on for the other instances. But let us check at this stage whether you understand adequately what I mean.”

τοῦ περιττοῦ οὐ δέξεται· οὐδὲ δὴ τὸ ἡμιόλιον οὐδὲ τᾶλλα τὰ τοιαῦτα, τὸ ἥμισυ, τὴν τοῦ ὅλου, καὶ τριτημόριον αὖ καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα, εἴπερ ἔπη τε καὶ συνδοκεῖ σοι οὕτως. πάνυ σφόδρα καὶ συνδοκεῖ, ἔφη, καὶ ἔπομαι. πάλιν δὴ μοι, ἔφη, ἐξ ἀρχῆς λέγε. καὶ μή μοι ὃ ἂν ἐρωτῶ ἀποκρίνου, ἀλλὰ μιμούμενος ἐμέ. λέγω δὴ παρ' ἣν τὸ πρῶτον ἔλεγον ἀπόκρισιν, τὴν ἀσφαλῆ ἐκείνην, ἐκ τῶν νῦν λεγομένων ἄλλην ὁρῶν ἀσφάλειαν. εἰ γὰρ ἔροιό με ὥς ἂν τί ἐν τῷ σώματι ἐγγένηται θερμὸν ἔσται, οὐ τὴν ἀσφαλῆ σοι ἐρῶ ἀπόκρισιν ἐκείνην τὴν ἀμαθῆ, ὅτι ὥς ἂν θερμότης, ἀλλὰ κομψοτέραν ἐκ τῶν νῦν, ὅτι ὥς ἂν πῦρ· οὐδὲ ἂν ἔρη ὥς ἂν σώματι τί ἐγγένηται νοσήσει, οὐκ ἐρῶ ὅτι ὥς ἂν νόσος, ἀλλ' ὥς ἂν πυρετός· οὐδ' ὥς ἂν ἀριθμῷ τί ἐγγένηται περιττός ἔσται, οὐκ ἐρῶ ὥς ἂν

περιττότης, ἀλλ' ὧς ἂν μονάς, καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτως. ἀλλ' ὅρα εἰ ἤδη ἱκανῶς οἶσθ' ὅτι βούλομαι. ἀλλὰ πάνυ ἱκανῶς, ἔφη. ἀποκρίνου δὴ, ἢ δ' ὅς, ὧς ἂν τί ἐγγένηται σώματι ζῶν ἔσται; ὧς ἂν ψυχῇ, ἔφη.

105c

CE: “Very adequately,” Cebes said.

105c

S: “Then answer this question,” he said, “by the presence of what will the body be alive?”

CE: “By the presence of soul,” he replied.

105d

S: “Is this not always the case?”

οὐκοῦν ἀεὶ τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει; πῶς γὰρ οὐχί; ἢ δ' ὅς. ψυχὴ ἄρα ὅτι ἂν αὐτὴ κατὰσχη, ἀεὶ ἥκει ἐπ' ἐκεῖνο φέρουσα ζωὴν; ἥκει μέντοι, ἔφη. πότερον δ' ἔστι τι ζωῇ ἐναντίον ἢ οὐδέν; ἔστιν, ἔφη. τί; θάνατος. οὐκοῦν ψυχὴ τὸ ἐναντίον ὧς αὐτὴ ἐπιφέρει ἀεὶ οὐ μὴ ποτε δέξεται, ὥς ἐκ τῶν πρόσθεν ὠμολόγηται; καὶ μάλα σφόδρα, ἔφη ὁ Κέβης. τί οὖν; τὸ μὴ δεχόμενον τὴν τοῦ ἀρτίου ιδέαν τί νυνδὴ ὠνομάζομεν; ἀνάρτιον, ἔφη. τὸ δὲ δίκαιον μὴ δεχόμενον καὶ ὃ ἂν μουσικὸν μὴ δέχεται;

CE: “How could it be otherwise?” he said.

S: “Then soul, whatever it takes hold of, always arrives bringing life to it?”

CE: “Yes, that is how it arrives,” he said.

S: “And is there or is there not something opposite to life?”

CE: “There is,” he replied.

S: “What?”

CE: “Death.”

S: “Now, based on what we agreed earlier, is it not the case that soul will never admit the opposite of that which it imposes?”

CE: “It certainly will not,” said Cebes.

S: “Well then, what did we call that which does not admit the form of the even a moment ago?”

CE: “Uneven,” he said.

S: “And that which does not admit the just, and that which does not admit the musical?”

105e

CE: “Unmusical, and unjust,” he said.

ἄμουσον, ἔφη, τὸ δὲ ἄδικον. εἶεν· ὃ δ’ ἂν θάνατον μὴ δέχεται τί καλοῦμεν; ἀθάνατον, ἔφη. οὐκοῦν ψυχὴ οὐ δέχεται θάνατον; οὐ. ἀθάνατον ἄρα ψυχὴ. ἀθάνατον. εἶεν, ἔφη τοῦτο μὲν δὴ ἀποδεδείχθαι φῶμεν; ἢ πῶς δοκεῖ; καὶ μάλα γε ἱκανῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΦΑΙΔ. τί οὖν, ἢ δ’ ὅς, ὦ Κέβης; εἰ τῷ ἀναρτίῳ ἀναγκαῖον ἦν

S: “So be it. And what shall we call that which does not admit death?”

CE: “Immortal,” he said.

S: “Now, soul does not admit death, does it?”

CE: “No.”

S: “Then soul is immortal.”

CE: “Immortal.”

106a

S: “So be it,” he said. “Now, may we say that this has been proved? How does it seem to you?”

CE: “Yes, very adequately, Socrates.”

106a

S: “What about this, Cebes?” he asked. “If it were also necessary for the uneven to be imperishable, could the number three be anything other than imperishable?”

ἀνωλέθρῳ εἶναι, ἄλλο τι τὰ τρία ἢ ἀνώλεθρα ἂν ἦν; πῶς γὰρ οὐ; οὐκοῦν εἰ καὶ τὸ ἄθερμον ἀναγκαῖον ἦν ἀνώλεθρον εἶναι, ὅποτε τις ἐπὶ χιόνα θερμὸν ἐπάγοι, ὑπεξήκει ἂν ἡ χιὼν οὔσα σῶς καὶ ἄτηκτος; οὐ γὰρ ἂν

ἀπώλετό γε, οὐδ' αὖ ὑπομένουσα ἐδέξατο ἂν τὴν θερμότητα. ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις. ὥς δ' αὐτως οἶμαι καὶ εἰ τὸ ἄψυκτον ἀνώλεθρον ἦν, ὅποτε ἐπὶ τὸ πῦρ ψυχρόν τι ἐπήει, οὐποτ' ἂν ἀπεσβέννυτο οὐδ' ἀπώλλυτο, ἀλλὰ σὼν ἂν ἀπελθὼν ὥχετο. ἀνάγκη, ἔφη.

CE: “No, how could it be?”

106b

S: “And if it were also necessary for the ‘un-hot’ to be imperishable, whenever someone brought heat to bear upon snow, would not the snow withdraw, intact and un-melted? For it could not be destroyed, nor again could it wait about and admit the hotness?”

CE: “What you are saying is true.”

106b

S: “And in the very same way, I presume, if the un-coolable was indestructible, then whenever something cool approached fire, fire could never be extinguished, nor could it perish, but would depart intact and go away.”

οὐκοῦν καὶ ὧδε, ἔφη, ἀνάγκη περὶ τοῦ ἀθανάτου εἰπεῖν; εἰ μὲν τὸ ἀθάνατον καὶ ἀνώλεθρόν ἐστιν, ἀδύνατον ψυχῇ, ὅταν θάνατος ἐπ' αὐτὴν ἦ, ἀπόλλυσθαι· θάνατον μὲν γὰρ δὴ ἐκ τῶν προειρημένων οὐ δέξεται οὐδ' ἔσται τεθνηκυῖα, ὥσπερ τὰ τρία οὐκ ἔσται, ἔφαμεν, ἄρτιον, οὐδέ γ' αὖ τὸ περιττόν, οὐδὲ δὴ πῦρ ψυχρόν, οὐδέ γε ἡ ἐν τῷ πυρὶ θερμότης. ἀλλὰ τί κωλύει, φαίη ἄν τις, ἄρτιον μὲν τὸ περιττόν μὴ γίγνεσθαι ἐπionτος τοῦ ἄρτιου, ὥσπερ ὠμολόγηται,

CE: “It must,” he said.

106c

S: “And must we not also say the same thing about the immortal?” he asked. “If the immortal is also imperishable, it is impossible for soul to perish whenever death approaches her. For as we said earlier, it will not admit death nor will it be dead, just as we said the number three will not be even, nor for that matter, will the odd be even, nor will fire be cold, and neither will the heat within the fire. But someone might

say the odd does not become even at the approach of the even. We have agreed this, but why could it not perish and the even arise in place of the odd? To someone who says this, we would not be able to contend that it does not perish, for the uneven is not imperishable. Indeed, if this point were conceded to us, we could easily have contended that once the even approaches, the odd and the number three depart and are gone, and we could offer a similar contention about fire and heat and the other instances. Is this not so?"

ἀπολομένου δὲ αὐτοῦ ἀντ' ἐκείνου ἄρτιον γεγενῆσθαι; τῷ ταῦτα λέγοντι οὐκ ἂν ἔχοιμεν διαμαχέσασθαι ὅτι οὐκ ἀπόλλυται· τὸ γὰρ ἀνάρτιον οὐκ ἀνώλεθρόν ἐστιν· ἐπεὶ εἰ τοῦτο ὡμολόγητο ἡμῖν, ῥαδίως ἂν διεμαχόμεθα ὅτι ἐπελθόντος τοῦ ἀρτίου τὸ περιττὸν καὶ τὰ τρία οἴχεται ἀπιόντα· καὶ περὶ πυρὸς καὶ θερμοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων οὕτως ἂν διεμαχόμεθα. ἢ οὐ; πάνυ μὲν οὖν. οὐκοῦν καὶ νῦν περὶ τοῦ ἀθανάτου, εἰ μὲν ἡμῖν ὁμολογεῖται καὶ ἀνώλεθρον εἶναι, ψυχὴ ἂν εἴη πρὸς τῷ ἀθάνατος εἶναι

CE: "Yes, certainly."

106d

S: "And therefore, in the present discussion about the immortal, if it were conceded to us that it is also imperishable, then soul too would be imperishable as well as being immortal, but otherwise some other argument would be required."

106d

CE: "But no other argument is required for this purpose," he said, "for if the immortal, being everlasting, is going to admit destruction, nothing else could avoid admitting destruction at all."

106d

S: "Yes," said Socrates, "and I think it would be agreed by everyone that God, and the form of life itself and anything else that is immortal, will never perish."

καὶ ἀνώλεθρος· εἰ δὲ μή, ἄλλου ἂν δέοι λόγου. ἀλλ' οὐδὲν δεῖ, ἔφη, τούτου γε ἕνεκα· σχολῇ γὰρ ἂν τι ἄλλο φθορὰν μὴ δέχοιτο, εἰ τό γε

ἀθάνατον αἰδῖον ὃν φθορὰν δέξεται. ὁ δέ γε θεὸς οἶμαι, ἔφη ὁ Σωκράτης, καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ τῆς ζωῆς εἶδος καὶ εἴ τι ἄλλο ἀθάνατόν ἐστιν, παρὰ πάντων ἂν ὁμολογηθεῖη μηδέποτε ἀπόλλυσθαι. παρὰ πάντων μέντοι νῆ Δί', ἔφη, ἀνθρώπων τέ γε καὶ ἔτι μᾶλλον, ὥς ἐγώ μαι, παρὰ θεῶν.

CE: “Yes, by Zeus,” he said, “by every human being, and in my opinion, even more so by the gods.”

106e

S: “Now, since the immortal is also indestructible, wouldn’t the soul, if it happens to be immortal, be imperishable too?”

ὁπότε δὴ τὸ ἀθάνατον καὶ ἀδιάφθορόν ἐστιν, ἄλλο τι ψυχὴ ἢ, εἰ ἀθάνατος τυγχάνει οὕσα, καὶ ἀνώλεθρος ἂν εἴη; πολλὴ ἀνάγκη. ἐπιόντος ἄρα θανάτου ἐπὶ τὸν ἄνθρωπον τὸ μὲν θνητόν, ὥς ἔοικεν, αὐτοῦ ἀποθνήσκει, τὸ δ' ἀθάνατον σῶν καὶ ἀδιάφθορον οἴχεται ἀπὸν, ὑπεκχωρήσαν τῷ θανάτῳ. φαίνεται. ΦΑΙΔ. παντὸς μᾶλλον ἄρα, ἔφη, ὦ Κέβης, ψυχὴ ἀθάνατον καὶ

CE: “It simply must be.”

S: “So when death comes to a person, it seems that the mortal part dies, while the immortal departs and goes on its way intact and indestructible, giving way to death.”

CE: “So it appears.”

107a

S: “So we have all the more reason to accept, Cebes, that soul is immortal and imperishable, and, in truth, our souls will exist in Hades.”

107a

CE: “Well, Socrates,” he said, “I do not have anything else to say against these arguments, nor do I doubt them in any respect. But of course, if Simmias or anyone else here has anything to say he had better not remain silent. Because if someone wants to say or hear anything about

such matters, I do not know of any other occasion to which he can postpone the present opportunity.”

107a

Si: “And yet,” said Simmias, “I too have no further grounds for doubt on the basis of what is being said. However, on account of the vast subject that the arguments are dealing with, and being wary of human weakness, I am bound to harbour additional doubts within myself in relation to what has been said.”

ἀνώλεθρον, καὶ τῷ ὄντι ἔσονται ἡμῶν αἱ ψυχαὶ ἐν Ἄιδου. οὐκ οὐκ ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη, ἔχω παρὰ ταῦτα ἄλλο τι λέγειν οὐδέ πη ἀπιστεῖν τοῖς λόγοις. ἀλλ’ εἰ δὴ τι Σιμμίας ὅδε ἢ τις ἄλλος ἔχει λέγειν, εὖ ἔχει μὴ κατασιγῆσαι· ὥς οὐκ οἶδα εἰς ὅντινά τις ἄλλον καιρὸν ἀναβάλλοιτο ἢ τὸν νῦν παρόντα, περὶ τῶν τοιούτων βουλόμενος ἢ τι εἰπεῖν ἢ ἀκοῦσαι. ἀλλὰ μὲν, ἢ δ’ ὅς οἱ Σιμμίας, οὐδ’ αὐτὸς ἔχω ἔτι ὅπῃ ἀπιστῶ ἔκ γε τῶν λεγομένων· ὑπὸ μέντοι τοῦ μεγέθους περὶ

107b

S: “Not only are you right,” said Socrates, “to say that, Simmias, but you should examine the initial hypotheses in greater clarity in any case, even if you believe them yourselves. And if you analyse them properly, I think you will follow the argument to the greatest extent that anyone can follow it. And once this has become clear, you will seek nothing further.”

ὧν οἱ λόγοι εἰσὶν, καὶ τὴν ἀνθρωπίνην ἀσθένειαν ἀτιμάζων, ἀναγκάζομαι ἀπιστίαν ἔτι ἔχειν παρ’ ἐμαυτῷ περὶ τῶν εἰρημένων. οὐ μόνον γ’, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμίας, ὁ Σωκράτης, ἀλλὰ ταῦτά τε εὖ λέγεις καὶ τὰς γε ὑποθέσεις τὰς πρώτας, καὶ εἰ πιστὰ ὑμῖν εἰσιν, ὅμως ἐπισκεπτεῖται σαφέστερον· καὶ ἐὰν αὐτὰς ἱκανῶς διέλῃτε, ὥς ἐγώ μαι, ἀκολουθήσετε τῷ λόγῳ, καθ’ ὅσον δυνατόν· μάλιστα ἄνθρωπῳ ἐπακολουθήσαι· κἂν τοῦτο αὐτὸ σαφὲς γένηται, οὐδὲν ζητήσετε περαιτέρω. ἀληθῆ, ἔφη, λέγεις.

Si: “What you are saying is true,” he said.

107c

S: “But my friends,” he said, “it is right to bear in mind that if, in fact, the soul is immortal, it requires care, not only for the sake of the interval of time which we call ‘life’ but for the sake of all time, and, indeed, if anyone should neglect the soul the danger now seems to be terrible. For if death were an escape from everything, it would be a god-send for the wicked to die, and be freed from the body, and their own wickedness along with the soul. Now, however, since the soul turns out to be immortal, there would be no escape from evils or any salvation for it, apart from becoming as good and wise as possible. For the soul goes to Hades, possessing nothing else except its education and its nurture, which are indeed said to afford the greatest benefit or harm to the person who has died, at the very outset of the journey to that place.

ἀλλὰ τόδε γ', ἔφη, ὦ ἄνδρες, δίκαιον διανοηθῆναι, ὅτι, εἴπερ ἡ ψυχὴ ἀθάνατος, ἐπιμελείας δὴ δεῖται οὐχ ὑπὲρ τοῦ χρόνου τούτου μόνον ἐν ᾧ καλοῦμεν τὸ ζῆν, ἀλλ' ὑπὲρ τοῦ παντός, καὶ ὁ κίνδυνος νῦν δὴ καὶ δόξειεν ἂν δεινὸς εἶναι, εἴ τις αὐτῆς ἀμελήσει. εἰ μὲν γὰρ ἦν ὁ θάνατος τοῦ παντός ἀπαλλαγὴ, ἔρμαιον ἂν ἦν τοῖς κακοῖς ἀποθανοῦσι τοῦ τε σώματος ἅμ' ἀπηλλάχθαι καὶ τῆς αὐτῶν κακίας μετὰ τῆς ψυχῆς· νῦν δ' ἐπειδὴ ἀθάνατος φαίνεται οὐσα, οὐδεμία ἂν

107d

S: “And accordingly, it is said that when each person dies, the daimon of that person, which has been assigned throughout life, is responsible for leading them to some place where those who are gathered, having undergone judgement, must journey to Hades along with that guide who has been given the task of conducting people from this place to that place. But once they are there and have met what they needed to meet and have remained for as long as necessary, another guide brings them back here again over numerous lengthy cycles of time. So, the journey is not as Aeschylus’ *Telephos*²² describes it. For he says that a simple path leads to Hades, but to me it appears to be neither simple nor single. If it were simple, no guide would be required, for presumably no one could go wrong anywhere if there were only one

path. But it now seems that it has many forks and crossroads, and I think this is evident from the sacrifices and rituals which are offered in this world.

εἷη αὐτῇ ἄλλη ἀποφυγὴ κακῶν οὐδὲ σωτηρία πλὴν τοῦ ὡς βελτίστην τε καὶ φρονιμωτάτην γενέσθαι. οὐδὲν γὰρ ἄλλο ἔχουσα εἰς Ἄιδου ἢ ψυχὴ ἔρχεται πλὴν τῆς παιδείας τε καὶ τροφῆς, ἃ δὴ καὶ μέγιστα λέγεται ὠφελεῖν ἢ βλάπτειν τὸν τελευτήσαντα εὐθὺς ἐν ἀρχῇ τῆς ἐκεῖσε πορείας. λέγεται δὲ οὕτως, ὡς ἄρα τελευτήσαντα ἕκαστον ὁ ἐκάστου δαίμων, ὅσπερ ζῶντα εἰλήχει, οὗτος ἄγειν ἐπιχειρεῖ εἰς δὴ τινα τόπον, οἱ δὲ τοὺς συλλεγέντας διαδικασαμένους εἰς Ἄιδου πορεύεσθαι μετὰ ἡγεμόνος ἐκείνου ᾧ δὴ προστέτακται τοὺς ἐνθὲνδε ἐκεῖσε πορεύσαι· τυχόντας δὲ ἐκεῖ ὧν δὴ τυχεῖν καὶ μείναντας ὃν χρὴ χρόνον ἄλλος δεῦρο πάλιν ἡγεμῶν κομίζει ἐν πολλαῖς χρόνου καὶ μακραῖς περιόδοις. ΦΑΙΔ. ἔστι δὲ ἄρα ἡ πορεία οὐχ ὡς ὁ Αἰσχύλου Τήλεφος λέγει· ἐκεῖνος

108a

S: “Now, the orderly and wise soul follows the guide and is not unaware of its surroundings, while the soul which is possessed of desires of the body, as we said before, flutters around the body and about the visible region for a long time. After much resistance and a lot of affliction, the soul is led away forcibly and reluctantly by its appointed daimon and it departs. Now, the soul which is unpurified and has acted in that sort of manner, having engaged in unjust killings or other activities of the kind which are akin to these, and are the deeds of kindred souls, does arrive where the others are. But everyone shuns the soul and turns away from it, and has no desire to become its travelling companion or its guide. Instead the soul wanders in utter perplexity until certain periods of time have elapsed, and when these are over, it is borne by necessity to the abode appropriate to it. But each soul that has spent a life in purity and measure encounters gods as its travelling companions and guides, and inhabits the region appropriate to it.

μὲν γὰρ ἀπλὴν οἶμόν φησιν εἰς Ἄιδου φέρειν, ἡ δ' οὔτε ἀπλὴ οὔτε μία φαίνεται μοι εἶναι. οὐδὲ γὰρ ἂν ἡγεμόνων ἔδει· οὐ γὰρ πού τις ἂν διαμάρτοι οὐδαμῶσε μιᾶς ὁδοῦ οὔσης. νῦν δὲ ἔοικε σχίσεις τε καὶ τριόδους πολλὰς ἔχειν· ἀπὸ τῶν θυσιῶν τε καὶ νομίμων τῶν ἐνθάδε τεκμαιρόμενος λέγω. ἡ μὲν οὖν κοσμία τε καὶ φρόνιμος ψυχὴ ἔπεται τε καὶ οὐκ ἄγνοεῖ τὰ παρόντα· ἡ δ' ἐπιθυμητικῶς τοῦ σώματος ἔχουσα, ὅπερ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν εἶπον, περὶ ἐκεῖνο πολὺν χρόνον ἐπτοημένη καὶ περὶ τὸν ὁρατὸν τόπον, πολλὰ ἀντιτείνασα καὶ πολλὰ παθοῦσα, βία καὶ μόγισ ὑπὸ τοῦ προστεταγμένου δαίμονος οἴχεται ἀγομένη. ἀφικομένην δὲ ὅτιπερ αἱ ἄλλαι, τὴν μὲν ἀκάθαρτον καὶ τι πεποικυῖαν τοιοῦτον, ἡ φόνων ἀδίκων ἡμμένην ἢ ἄλλ' ἅττα τοιαῦτα εἰργασμένην, ἃ τούτων ἀδελφά τε καὶ ἀδελφῶν ψυχῶν ἔργα τυγχάνει ὄντα, ταύτην μὲν ἅπας φεύγει τε καὶ ὑπεκτρέπεται καὶ οὔτε συνέμπορος οὔτε ἡγεμὼν ἐθέλει γίγνεσθαι, αὕτη

108c

S: “Now, someone has convinced me that the regions of the earth are many and wondrous, and it has neither the qualities nor the extent presumed by those who usually describe it.”

δὲ πλανᾶται ἐν πάσῃ ἐχομένη ἀπορία ἕως ἂν δὴ τινες χρόνοι γένωνται, ὧν ἐλθόντων ὑπ' ἀνάγκης φέρεται εἰς τὴν αὐτὴν πρέπουσαν οἴκησιν· ἡ δὲ καθαρῶς τε καὶ μετρίως τὸν βίον διεξελοῦσα, καὶ συνεμπόρων καὶ ἡγεμόνων θεῶν τυχοῦσα, ᾤκησεν τὸν αὐτῇ ἐκάστη τόπον προσήκοντα. εἰσὶν δὲ πολλοὶ καὶ θαυμαστοὶ τῆς γῆς τόποι, καὶ αὕτη οὔτε οἷα οὔτε ὅση δοξάζεται ὑπὸ τῶν περὶ γῆς εἰωθότων λέγειν, ὥς ἐγὼ ὑπὸ τινος πέπεισμαι.

108d

SI: And Simmias asked, “What do you mean, Socrates? Of course I have heard a great deal about the earth myself, but not these descriptions which have convinced you. So I would love to hear them.”

108d

S: “Well, Simmias, I do not think the skill of Glaucus²³ is needed to describe, in detail, what they are. However, it appears to me that it is beyond even the skill of Glaucus to show that they are true, and what is

more, perhaps I might be unable to do it. And even if I had the knowledge, I do not think my own life is now long enough for such a lengthy discourse. Yet there is nothing to stop me from describing the form which I am convinced the earth has, and the regions it possesses.”

καὶ ὁ Σιμμίας, πῶς ταῦτα, ἔφη, λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; περὶ γάρ τοι γῆς καὶ αὐτὸς πολλὰ δὴ ἀκήκοα, οὐ μέντοι ταῦτα ἃ σὲ πείθει ἡδέως οὖν ἂν ἀκούσαιμι. ἀλλὰ μέντοι, ὦ Σιμμία, οὐχ ἡ Γλαύκου τέχνη γέ μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι διηγήσασθαι ἃ γ' ἐστίν· ὡς μέντοι ἀληθῆ, χαλεπώτερόν μοι φαίνεται ἢ κατὰ τὴν Γλαύκου τέχνην, καὶ ἅμα μὲν ἐγὼ ἴσως οὐδ' ἂν οἶός τε εἶην, ἅμα δέ, εἰ καὶ ἠπιστάμην, ὁ βίος μοι δοκεῖ ὁ ἐμός, ὦ Σιμμία, τῷ μήκει τοῦ λόγου οὐκ ἐξαρκεῖν. τὴν μέντοι ἰδέαν τῆς γῆς οἶαν

108e

Si: “But even that much is sufficient,” said Simmias.

108e

S: “Well,” he said, “I am convinced, firstly, that if the earth is in the centre of the universe and is round, it does not need anything to prevent it from falling, either air or any other constraint of that sort. Rather, the homogeneity of the universe itself with itself in every direction and the even balance of the earth itself are sufficient to hold it. For an evenly balanced object placed in the centre of something homogeneous will not be able to turn more in one direction than in another. Instead, being in a situation of homogeneity, it remains motionless. So that is the first thing I am convinced of,” he said.

πέπεισμαι εἶναι, καὶ τοὺς τόπους αὐτῆς οὐδέν με κωλύει λέγειν. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλ', ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, καὶ ταῦτα ἀρκεῖ. πέπεισμαι τοίνυν, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἐγὼ ὡς πρῶτον μὲν, εἰ ἔστιν ἐν μέσῳ τῷ οὐρανῷ περιφερῆς οὔσα, μηδὲν αὐτῇ δεῖν μήτε

109a

Si: “And rightly so,” said Simmias.

109a

S: “Now, the next point is that it is absolutely enormous, and we who dwell between the Pillars of Heracles and the river Phasis²⁴ inhabit a

tiny part of it, living around the sea like ants or frogs around a pool, while many others dwell elsewhere in lots of other regions of this sort, for there are numerous hollows all over the earth of various forms and sizes, into which water, mist, and air have gathered together. But the earth itself is pure and it rests in the pure region of the universe where the stars are situated, the region which most people who usually discuss such matters call the ether.

ἀέρος πρὸς τὸ μὴ πεσεῖν μήτε ἄλλης ἀνάγκης μηδεμιᾶς τοιαύτης, ἀλλὰ ἱκανὴν εἶναι αὐτὴν ἴσχειν τὴν ὁμοιότητα τοῦ οὐρανοῦ αὐτοῦ ἐαυτῷ πάντῃ καὶ τῆς γῆς αὐτῆς τὴν ἰσορροπίαν· ἰσόρροπον γὰρ πρᾶγμα ὁμοίου τινὸς ἐν μέσῳ τεθὲν οὐχ ἔξει μᾶλλον οὐδ' ἦττον οὐδαμῶσε κλιθῆναι, ὁμοίως δ' ἔχον ἀκλινὲς μενεῖ. πρῶτον μὲν τοίνυν, ἦ δ' ὅς, τοῦτο πέπεισμαι. καὶ ὀρθῶς γε, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας. ἔτι τοίνυν, ἔφη, πάμμεγά τι εἶναι αὐτό, καὶ ἡμᾶς οἰκεῖν τοὺς μέχρι Ἑρακλείων στηλῶν ἀπὸ Φάσιδος ἐν μικρῷ τινι μορίῳ, ὥσπερ περὶ τέλμα μύρμηκας ἢ βατράχους περὶ τὴν θάλατταν οἰκοῦντας, καὶ ἄλλους ἄλλοθι πολλοὺς ἐν πολλοῖσι τοιούτοις τόποις οἰκεῖν. εἶναι γὰρ πανταχῇ περὶ τὴν γῆν πολλὰ κοῖλα καὶ παντοδαπὰ καὶ τὰς ιδέας καὶ τὰ μεγέθη, εἰς ἃ συνερρηκέναι τό τε ὕδωρ καὶ τὴν ὁμίχλην καὶ τὸν ἀέρα αὐτὴν δὲ τὴν γῆν καθαρὰν ἐν καθαρῷ κεῖσθαι τῷ οὐρανῷ ἐν ᾧ πᾶρ ἐστι τὰ ἄστρα, ὃν δὴ αἰθέρα ὀνομάζειν

109c

S: “In fact, water, mist, and air are the sediment of ether, and they constantly flow together into the hollows of the earth. But we are unaware that we are living in its hollows and think we inhabit the upper surface of earth. It is as if someone living down in the depths of the ocean were to think he was living on the sea, and beholding the sun and the other stars through the water, believed that the sea was the sky. Due to his lethargy and weakness he would never get to the sea’s surface, nor would he behold how much purer and more beautiful is this region than that of his fellows by coming to the top of the water and popping out his head, nor would he hear about this from someone else who had seen it. Well, our predicament is the same as his, for we

inhabit some hollow of the earth and believe that we are dwelling on its surface, and we refer to the air as the heaven because the stars move through this as if it were a heaven.

τοὺς πολλοὺς τῶν περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα εἰωθότων λέγειν· οὗ δὴ ὑποστάθμην ταῦτα εἶναι καὶ συρρεῖν αἰεὶ εἰς τὰ κοῖλα τῆς γῆς. ἡμᾶς οὖν οἰκοῦντας ἐν τοῖς κοίλοις αὐτῆς λεληθέναι καὶ οἶεσθαι ἄνω ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς οἰκεῖν, ὥσπερ ἂν εἴ τις ἐν μέσῳ τῷ πυθμένι τοῦ πελάγους οἰκῶν οἴοιτό τε ἐπὶ τῆς θαλάττης οἰκεῖν καὶ διὰ τοῦ ὕδατος ὁρῶν τὸν ἥλιον καὶ τὰ ἄλλα ἄστρα τὴν θάλατταν ἡγοῖτο οὐρανὸν εἶναι, διὰ δὲ

109d

S: “But, in fact, due to our weakness and lethargy, we are unable to make our way to the furthest extremity of air. Yet if someone were to get to its upper limit, or became winged and flew there, he could stick his head up and have a look, and just as fishes who stick their heads out of the sea can behold whatever is in this region, he would likewise view whatever is in that region. And if his nature were up to the task of sustaining the observation, he would realise that this is the true heaven, the true light, and the true earth. For this earth here, and the stones and the entire region we are in are corrupted and eroded just as objects in the sea are affected by the brine, and nothing worthy of note grows in the sea, and almost nothing is perfect there. Rather, there are caverns and sand and huge amounts of mud and mire wherever there is any earth, and nothing at all is worthy of comparison with the beauties of our region. But those beauties would, in turn, prove to be superior to the beauties of our realm to an even greater extent. And now, if it is appropriate to tell a story, it is worth hearing, Simmias, what the things upon the earth, that is beneath the heaven, happen to be like.”

βραδυτῆτά τε καὶ ἀσθένειαν μηδεπώποτε ἐπὶ τὰ ἄκρα τῆς θαλάττης ἀφιγμένος μηδὲ ἑωρακώς εἶη, ἐκδὺς καὶ ἀνακύψας ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης εἰς τὸν ἐνθάδε τόπον, ὅσῳ καθαρώτερος καὶ καλλίων τυγχάνει ὢν τοῦ παρὰ σφίσι, μηδὲ ἄλλου ἀκηκοώς εἶη τοῦ ἑωρακότος, ταῦτόν δὲ τοῦτο

καὶ ἡμᾶς πεπονθέναι· οἰκοῦντας γὰρ ἔν τινι κοίλῳ τῆς γῆς οἷεσθαι ἐπάνω αὐτῆς οἰκεῖν, καὶ τὸν ἀέρα οὐρανὸν καλεῖν, ὡς διὰ τούτου οὐρανοῦ ὄντος τὰ ἄστρα χωροῦντα· τὸ δὲ εἶναι ταυτόν, ὑπ’ ἀσθενείας καὶ βραδυτήτος οὐχ οἷους τε εἶναι ἡμᾶς διεξελθεῖν ἐπ’ ἔσχατον τὸν ἀέρα· ἐπεὶ, εἴ τις αὐτοῦ ἐπ’ ἄκρα ἔλθοι ἢ πτηνὸς γενόμενος ἀνάπτοιτο, κατιδεῖν ἂν ἀνακύψαντα, ὥσπερ ἐνθάδε οἱ ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης ἰχθύες ἀνακύπτοντες ὁρῶσι τὰ ἐνθάδε, οὕτως ἂν τινα καὶ τὰ ἐκεῖ κατιδεῖν, καὶ εἰ ἡ φύσις ἰκανὴ εἴη ἀνασχέσθαι θεωροῦσα, γινῶναι ἂν ὅτι ἐκεῖνός ἐστιν ὁ ἀληθῶς οὐρανὸς καὶ τὸ ἀληθινὸν φῶς καὶ ἡ ὡς ἀληθῶς γῆ. ΦΑΙΔ. ἥδε μὲν γὰρ ἡ γῆ καὶ οἱ λίθοι καὶ ἅπας ὁ τόπος ὁ ἐνθάδε διεφθαρμένα ἐστὶν καὶ καταβεβρωμένα, ὥσπερ τὰ ἐν τῇ θαλάττῃ ὑπὸ τῆς ἄλμης, καὶ οὔτε φύεται ἄξιον λόγου οὐδὲν ἐν τῇ θαλάττῃ, οὔτε τέλειον ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν οὐδὲν ἐστι, σήραγγες δὲ καὶ ἄμμος καὶ πηλὸς ἀμήχανος καὶ βόρβοροι εἰσιν, ὅπου ἂν καὶ ἡ γῆ ᾗ, καὶ πρὸς τὰ παρ’ ἡμῖν κάλλι κρίνεσθαι οὐδ’ ὁπωστιοῦν ἄξια. ἐκεῖνα δὲ αὖ τῶν παρ’ ἡμῖν πολὺ ἂν ἔτι πλέον φανείη διαφέρειν·

110b

SI: “In that case, Socrates,” said Simmias, “we would be glad to hear this story.”

110b

S: “Well then, my friend, it is said, firstly, that if anyone views the earth itself from above, it looks just like those balls made from twelve pieces of leather, painted with distinct colours, of which the colours in our region are just like the samples used by painters. But in that place, the earth is entirely composed of such colours, and of colours that are much brighter and purer than those. For one part is purple and its beauty is wondrous, another is golden, and anything white is whiter than chalk or snow, and the earth is composed of other colours in the same way, colours even more numerous and more beautiful than all we have seen. What is more, those hollows themselves, being filled with water and air, exhibit a kind of colour, glistening amidst the variety of other colours, so that the earth appears as one continuous variegated surface.

εἰ γὰρ δὴ καὶ μῦθον λέγειν καλόν, ἄξιον ἀκοῦσαι, ὦ Σιμμία, οἷα τυγχάνει τὰ ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς ὑπὸ τῷ οὐρανῷ ὄντα. ἀλλὰ μήν, ἔφη ὁ Σιμμίας, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἡμεῖς γε τούτου τοῦ μύθου ἠδέως ἂν ἀκούσασθαιμεν. λέγεται τοίνυν, ἔφη, ὦ ἑταῖρε, πρῶτον μὲν εἶναι τοιαύτη ἡ γῆ αὐτὴ ἰδεῖν, εἴ τις ἄνωθεν θεῶτο, ὥσπερ αἱ δωδεκάσκυτοι σφαῖραι, ποικίλη, χρώμασιν διειλημμένη, ὣν καὶ τὰ ἐνθάδε εἶναι χρώματα ὥσπερ δείγματα, οἷς δὴ οἱ γραφῆς καταχρῶνται. ἐκεῖ δὲ πᾶσαν τὴν γῆν ἐκ τοιούτων εἶναι, καὶ πολὺ ἔτι ἐκ λαμπροτέρων καὶ καθαρωτέρων ἢ τούτων· τὴν μὲν γὰρ ἄλουργγὴ εἶναι καὶ θαυμαστήν τὸ κάλλος, τὴν δὲ χρυσοειδῆ, τὴν δὲ ὅση λευκὴ γύψου ἢ χιόνος λευκοτέραν, καὶ ἐκ τῶν ἄλλων χρωμάτων συγκεϊμένην ὡσαύτως, καὶ ἔτι πλειόνων καὶ καλλιόνων ἢ ὅσα ἡμεῖς ἑωράκαμεν. καὶ γὰρ αὐτὰ ταῦτα τὰ κοῖλα αὐτῆς, ὕδατός τε καὶ ἄερος ἔκπλεα

110d

S: “But since that is what this earth is like, whatever grows there grows in conformity with this principle, be they plants, flowers or fruits. And what is more, in like manner, mountains and stones, in conformity with the same principle, have smoothness and transparency and more beautiful colours, and the pebbles which are prized among us – sards, jaspers, emeralds and all the like – are fragments of those, but in that place there are no stones that are not like those and even more beautiful than those. And the reason for this is that the stones there are pure and have not been corroded and corrupted like ours by filth and brine, due to everything that flows into this place, influxes which bring deformity to stones, earth and the like, and diseases to plants and animals. But that earth itself has been adorned with all these beauties, and also with gold and silver and other materials of that sort, for these are naturally in evidence as they are plentiful, large, and they are everywhere upon the earth. Consequently, to behold that earth is a vision which is a blessing to those who look upon it. And there are many other creatures there, and humans too, some dwelling inland, others living close to the air, just as we live close to the sea, some on islands surrounded by air, and close to

the mainland. And in short, as we have recourse to water and the sea, so do they have recourse to air, and as we have recourse to air, so do they have recourse to the ether.

ὄντα, χρώματός τι εἶδος παρέχεσθαι στίλβοντα ἐν τῇ τῶν ἄλλων χρωμάτων ποικιλίᾳ, ὥστε ἐν τι αὐτῆς εἶδος συνεχές ποικίλον φαντάζεσθαι. ἐν δὲ ταύτῃ οὕσῃ τοιαύτῃ ἀνὰ λόγον τὰ φυόμενα φύεσθαι, δένδρα τε καὶ ἄνθη καὶ τοὺς καρπούς· καὶ αὖ τὰ ὄρη ὡσαύτως καὶ τοὺς λίθους ἔχειν ἀνὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον τὴν τε λειότητα καὶ τὴν διαφάνειαν καὶ τὰ χρώματα καλλίω· ὧν καὶ τὰ ἐνθάδε λιθίδια εἶναι ταῦτα τὰ ἀγαπώμενα μόρια, σάρδιά τε καὶ ἰάσπιδας καὶ σμαράγδους καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα· ἐκεῖ δὲ οὐδὲν ὅτι οὐ τοιοῦτον εἶναι καὶ ἔτι τούτων καλλίω. τὸ δ' αἴτιον τούτου εἶναι ὅτι ἐκεῖνοι οἱ λίθοι εἰσὶ καθαροὶ καὶ οὐ κατεδεδεσμένοι οὐδὲ διεφθαρμένοι ὥσπερ οἱ ἐνθάδε ὑπὸ σηπεδόνος καὶ ἄλμης ὑπὸ τῶν δεῦρο συνερρηκόντων, ἃ καὶ λίθοις καὶ γῇ καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ζώοις τε καὶ φυτοῖς αἴσχη τε καὶ νόσους παρέχει. ΦΑΙΔ. τὴν δὲ γῆν αὐτὴν κεκοσμησθαι τούτοις τε ἅπασι καὶ ἔτι χρυσῷ τε καὶ ἀργύρῳ καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις αὖ τοῖς τοιούτοις. ἐκφανῇ γὰρ αὐτὰ πεφυκέναι, ὄντα πολλὰ πλήθει καὶ μεγάλα καὶ πανταχοῦ τῆς γῆς, ὥστε αὐτὴν ἰδεῖν εἶναι θέαμα εὐδαιμόνων θεατῶν. ζῶα δ' ἐπ' αὐτῇ εἶναι ἄλλα τε πολλὰ καὶ ἀνθρώπους, τοὺς μὲν ἐν μεσογαίᾳ οἰκοῦντας, τοὺς δὲ περὶ τὸν ἀέρα ὥσπερ ἡμεῖς περὶ τὴν θάλατταν, τοὺς δ' ἐν νήσοις ἃς περιρρεῖν τὸν ἀέρα πρὸς τῇ ἡπείρῳ οὕσας· καὶ ἐνὶ λόγῳ, ὅπερ ἡμῖν τὸ ὕδωρ τε καὶ ἡ θάλαττά ἐστι πρὸς τὴν ἡμετέραν χρεῖαν, τοῦτο ἐκεῖ

111b

S: “Their seasons are so temperate that the people are free from disease, and their span of life is much longer than it is here, and in sight, and hearing, and wisdom, and in everything of that sort, they exceed us to the same extent that air exceeds water, and ether exceeds air, in respect of purity. And in fact, they have sacred groves and temples in which the gods really do reside, and utterances, prophecies, awareness of the gods, and any communion of that sort is conducted by them directly with the gods themselves. And the sun, moon, and stars

are seen by them just as they actually are, and their general blessedness is a consequence of these blessings.

τὸν ἀέρα, ὃ δὲ ἡμῖν ἀήρ, ἐκείνοις τὸν αἰθέρα. τὰς δὲ ὥρας αὐτοῖς κρᾶσιν ἔχειν τοιαύτην ὥστε ἐκείνους ἀνόσους εἶναι καὶ χρόνον τε ζῆν πολὺ πλείω τῶν ἐνθάδε, καὶ ὅψει καὶ ἀκοῇ καὶ φρονήσει καὶ πᾶσι τοῖς τοιούτοις ἡμῶν ἀφεστάναι τῇ αὐτῇ ἀποστάσει ἥπερ ἀήρ τε ὕδατος ἀφέστηκεν καὶ αἰθὴρ ἀέρος πρὸς καθαρότητα. καὶ δὴ καὶ θεῶν ἄλλη τε καὶ ἱερὰ αὐτοῖς εἶναι, ἐν οἷς τῷ ὄντι οἰκητὰς θεοὺς εἶναι, καὶ φήμας τε καὶ μαντείας καὶ αἰσθήσεις τῶν θεῶν καὶ τοιαύτας συνουσίας

111c

S: “Now, although the entire earth and the details thereof are thus by nature, there are in fact many regions within it corresponding to the hollows it has all around its entire surface. Some are deeper and wider than the place in which we are dwelling, others are deeper but they have a lesser expanse than our region, and there are others too which are shallower in depth and broader than ours. These are all interconnected beneath the earth in various ways, by channels, some narrow, some wider, and these have outlets from which lots of water pours from one region into the other, as if it were flowing into mixing bowls. And there are enormously large, ever-flowing rivers of both hot and cold water beneath the earth. And there is a great deal of fire and huge rivers of fire and of molten earth, some of which are even more filthy, like the rivers of mud which flow in front of the lava in Sicily, while others are purer, like the lava itself. And in fact, each of the regions is filled by these as the circular flow happens to arrive at each in turn. These all move upwards and downwards just like a kind of seesaw present within the earth. The nature of the oscillation itself is something like this: one of the chasms in the earth happens to be particularly large and it is bored right through the entire earth. This is the one Homer refers to when he says, ‘Far off in the lowest depth beneath the earth...’²⁵

γίγνεσθαι αὐτοῖς πρὸς αὐτούς· καὶ τὸν γε ἥλιον καὶ σελήνην καὶ ἄστρα ὁρᾶσθαι ὑπ' αὐτῶν οἷα τυγχάνει ὄντα, καὶ τὴν ἄλλην εὐδαιμονίαν τούτων ἀκόλουθον εἶναι. καὶ ὅλην μὲν δὴ τὴν γῆν οὕτω πεφυκέναι καὶ τὰ περὶ τὴν γῆν τόπους δ' ἐν αὐτῇ εἶναι κατὰ τὰ ἔγκοιλα αὐτῆς κύκλῳ περὶ ὅλην πολλούς, τοὺς μὲν βαθυτέρους καὶ ἀναπεπταμένους μᾶλλον ἢ ἐν ᾧ ἡμεῖς οἰκοῦμεν, τοὺς δὲ βαθυτέρους ὄντας τὸ χάσμα αὐτοὺς ἔλαττον ἔχειν τοῦ παρ' ἡμῖν τόπου, ἔστι δ' οὐς καὶ βραχυτέρους τῷ βάθει τοῦ ἐνθάδε εἶναι καὶ πλατυτέρους. τούτους δὲ πάντας ὑπὸ γῆν εἰς ἀλλήλους συντετρῆσθαι τε πολλαχῇ καὶ κατὰ στενότερα καὶ εὐρύτερα καὶ διεξόδους ἔχειν, ἥ πολὺ μὲν ὕδωρ ρεῖν ἐξ ἀλλήλων εἰς ἀλλήλους ὥσπερ εἰς κρατῆρας, καὶ ἀενάων ποταμῶν ἀμύχανα μεγέθη ὑπὸ τὴν γῆν καὶ θερμῶν ὑδάτων καὶ ψυχρῶν, πολὺ δὲ πῦρ καὶ πυρὸς μεγάλους ποταμούς, πολλούς δὲ ὑγροῦ πηλοῦ καὶ καθαρωτέρου καὶ βορβορωδεστέρου, ὥσπερ ἐν Σικελίᾳ οἱ πρὸ τοῦ ῥύακος πηλοῦ ῥέοντες ποταμοὶ καὶ αὐτὸς ὁ ῥύαξ· ὧν δὴ καὶ ἐκάστους τοὺς τόπους πληροῦσθαι, ὥς ἂν ἐκάστοις τύχῃ ἐκάστοτε ἡ περιρροὴ γιγνομένη. ταῦτα δὲ πάντα κινεῖν ἄνω καὶ κάτω ὥσπερ αἰώραν τινὰ ἐνοῦσαν ἐν τῇ γῇ· ἔστι δὲ ἄρα αὕτη ἡ αἰώρα διὰ φύσιν τοιάνδε τινά. ΦΑΙΔ. ἐν τι τῶν χασμάτων τῆς γῆς ἄλλως τε

112a

S: “And elsewhere, he and many other poets have named it Tartarus. For all of the rivers flow into this chasm and flow out again from this, and each becomes like the kind of earth through which they flow. But the reason why all the streams flow in and flow out of there is that this liquid has no bottom or base, so it oscillates and surges up and down, and the air and the wind associated with it do the same. For they follow the liquid whenever it gushes to the remote parts of the earth or to these parts. And just as those who are breathing continually inhale and exhale the flowing breath, so also does the wind there oscillate along with the liquid, giving rise to terrible and enormous gales as it goes in and goes out.

μέγιστον τυγχάνει ὄν καὶ διαμπερὲς τετρημένον δι' ὅλης τῆς γῆς, τοῦτο ὅπερ Ὅμηρος εἶπε, λέγων αὐτό τῆλε μάλ', ἥχι βάθιστον ὑπὸ χθονός ἐστι

βέρεθρον· ὁ καὶ ἄλλοθι καὶ ἐκεῖνος καὶ ἄλλοι πολλοὶ τῶν ποιητῶν
 Τάρταρον κεκλήκασιν. εἰς γὰρ τοῦτο τὸ χάσμα συρρέουσιν τε πάντες οἱ
 ποταμοὶ καὶ ἐκ τούτου πάλιν ἐκρέουσιν· γίνονται δὲ ἕκαστοι τοιοῦτοι
 δι' οἷας ἂν καὶ τῆς γῆς ῥέωσιν. ἡ δὲ

112b

S: “Now, whenever the water withdraws to the region which we call lower, it flows through the earth into the channels that are there and fills them as if it were being pumped. And whenever it leaves there again and surges back here, the streams here are filled once more, and once they have been filled they flow through the channels and through the earth, and when each arrives at the region to which it has been given passage, it makes seas, lakes, rivers and springs. And from there they dive beneath the earth, and when some have gone around the more numerous larger regions, and others have gone around the less numerous smaller regions, they discharge once more into Tartarus, some far below, others a little below where they were pumped out. But they all flow in below where they flowed out, although some flow in directly opposite to the point where they left, others below the same point. There are some that go around in a complete circle, coiling around the earth either once or even many times, like snakes, and having descended as low as possible, they discharge once more. It is possible to descend in either direction as far as the centre but no further, because to both streams the part on either side is uphill.

αἰτία ἐστὶν τοῦ ἐκρεῖν τε ἐντεῦθεν καὶ εἰσερεῖν πάντα τὰ ρεύματα, ὅτι
 πυθμένα οὐκ ἔχει οὐδὲ βάσιν τὸ ὑγρὸν τοῦτο. αἰωρεῖται δὴ καὶ κυμαίνει
 ἄνω καὶ κάτω, καὶ ὁ ἀήρ καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ περὶ αὐτὸ ταῦτόν ποιεῖ
 συνέπεται γὰρ αὐτῷ καὶ ὅταν εἰς τὸ ἐπ' ἐκεῖνα τῆς γῆς ὁρμήσῃ καὶ ὅταν
 εἰς τὸ ἐπὶ τάδε, καὶ ὥσπερ τῶν ἀναπνεόντων ἀεὶ ἐκπνεῖ τε καὶ ἀναπνεῖ
 ῥέον τὸ πνεῦμα, οὕτω καὶ ἐκεῖ συναιωρούμενον τῷ ὑγρῷ τὸ πνεῦμα
 δεινούς τινας ἀνέμους καὶ ἀμηχάνους παρέχεται καὶ εἰσιὸν καὶ ἐξιόν.
 ὅταν τε οὖν ὑποχωρήσῃ τὸ ὕδωρ εἰς τὸν τόπον τὸν δὴ κάτω
 καλούμενον, τοῖς κατ' ἐκεῖνα τὰ ρεύματα διὰ τῆς γῆς εἰσερεῖ τε καὶ

πληροῖ αὐτὰ ὥσπερ οἱ ἐπαντλοῦντες· ὅταν τε αὖ ἐκεῖθεν μὲν ἀπολίπη, δεῦρο δὲ ὁρμήσῃ, τὰ ἐνθάδε πληροῖ αὖθις, τὰ δὲ πληρωθέντα ῥεῖ διὰ τῶν ὀχετῶν καὶ διὰ τῆς γῆς, καὶ εἰς τοὺς τόπους ἕκαστα ἀφικνούμενα, εἰς οὓς ἐκάστοις ὠδοποιῆται, θαλάττας τε καὶ λίμνας καὶ ποταμούς καὶ κρήνας ποιεῖ· ἐντεῦθεν δὲ πάλιν δυόμενα κατὰ τῆς γῆς, τὰ μὲν μακροτέρους τόπους περιελθόντα καὶ πλείους, τὰ δὲ ἐλάττους καὶ βραχυτέρους, πάλιν εἰς τὸν Τάρταρον ἐμβάλλει, τὰ μὲν πολὺ κατωτέρω ἢ ἢ ἐπηντλεῖτο, τὰ δὲ ὀλίγον· πάντα δὲ ὑποκάτω εἰσρεῖ τῆς ἐκροῆς, καὶ ἔνια μὲν καταντικρὺ ἢ ἢ εἰσρεῖ ἐξέπεσεν, ἔνια δὲ κατὰ τὸ αὐτὸ μέρος· ἔστι δὲ ἅ παντάπασιν κύκλῳ περιελθόντα, ἢ ἅπαξ ἢ καὶ πλεονάκις περιελιχθέντα περὶ τὴν γῆν ὥσπερ οἱ ὄφεις, εἰς τὸ δυνατόν κάτω καθέντα πάλιν ἐμβάλλει.

112e

S: “Now, these streams are numerous, large and variegated, but among this multiplicity are four in particular and the largest and outermost of these, flowing around in a circle, is called Oceanus. Directly opposite to this, flowing in the opposite direction, is Acheron which flows through various desert places, but more significantly, it flows under the earth reaching the Acherusian lake where most souls of the dead arrive and abide for an allotted time, longer in some cases but shorter in others, and are sent back once more to be born as living creatures.

δυνατὸν δὲ ἐστὶν ἐκατέρωσε μέχρι τοῦ μέσου καθιέναι, πέρα δ’ οὐ· ἄνθρωποι γὰρ ἀμφοτέροις τοῖς ῥεύμασι τὸ ἐκατέρωθεν γίγνεται μέρος. ΦΑΙΔ. τὰ μὲν οὖν δὴ ἄλλα πολλὰ τε καὶ μεγάλα καὶ παντοδαπὰ ῥεύματ’ ἐστὶ· τυγχάνει δ’ ἄρα ὄντα ἐν τούτοις τοῖς πολλοῖς τέτταρ’ ἅττα ῥεύματα, ὧν τὸ μὲν μέγιστον καὶ ἐξωτάτω ῥέον περὶ κύκλῳ ὁ καλούμενος Ὠκεανός ἐστιν, τούτου δὲ καταντικρὺ καὶ ἐναντίως ῥέων Ἀχέρων, ὃς δι’ ἐρήμων τε τόπων ῥεῖ ἄλλων καὶ δὴ καὶ ὑπὸ γῆν ῥέων εἰς τὴν λίμνην ἀφικνεῖται τὴν Ἀχερουσιάδα, οὗ αἱ τῶν τετελευτηκότων ψυχαὶ τῶν πολλῶν ἀφικνοῦνται καὶ τινες εἰμαρμένους χρόνους μέναι, αἱ μὲν μακροτέρους, αἱ δὲ βραχυτέρους, πάλιν ἐκπέμπονται εἰς τὰς τῶν ζώων γενέσεις. τρίτος δὲ ποταμός τούτων κατὰ μέσον ἐκβάλλει, καὶ ἐγγὺς τῆς ἐκβολῆς ἐκπίπτει εἰς τόπον μέγαν πυρὶ πολλῷ

καόμενον, καὶ λίμνην ποιεῖ μείζω τῆς παρ' ἡμῖν θαλάττης, ζέουσαν ὕδατος καὶ πηλοῦ· ἐντεῦθεν δὲ

113b

S: “The third river issues forth midway between these two, and close to its point of exit it emerges into a vast region burning with a lot of fire, and it makes a lake of boiling water and mud larger than the sea in our region. It proceeds in a circle from there, foul and muddy, winding about through the earth in various places and arrives at the shores of the Acherusian lake without commingling with its waters. After many windings under the earth, it discharges beneath Tartarus and this is the river they refer to as Periphlegethon, and from this the lava streams shoot forth their branches from the earth in a random manner.

χωρεῖ κύκλῳ θολερὸς καὶ πηλώδης, περιελιττόμενος δὲ τῇ γῇ ἄλλοσέ τε ἀφικνεῖται καὶ παρ' ἔσχατα τῆς Ἀχερουσιάδος λίμνης, οὐ συμμειγνύμενος τῷ ὕδατι· περιελιχθεὶς δὲ πολλάκις ὑπὸ γῆς ἐμβάλλει κατωτέρω τοῦ Ταρτάρου· οὗτος δ' ἐστὶν ὃν ἐπονομάζουσιν Πυριφλεγέθοντα, οὗ καὶ οἱ ῥύακες ἀποσπάσματα ἀναφυσῶσιν ὅπῃ ἂν τύχῃσι τῆς γῆς. τούτου δὲ αὖ καταντικρὺ ὁ τέταρτος ἐκπίπτει εἰς τόπον πρῶτον δεινόν τε καὶ ἄγριον, ὡς λέγεται, χρώμα δ' ἔχοντα ὅλον οἶον ὁ

113c

S: “Directly opposite to this the fourth river issues forth, initially into a terrible and wild region which is said to be entirely coloured like lapis lazuli and is referred to as the Stygian region, and the lake made by the discharging river is the Styx. Now, once it has poured in there and has acquired formidable powers in the water, it dives beneath the earth and proceeds to circle about in the opposite direction to Periphlegethon and meets it in the Acherusian lake coming from the opposite side. Neither does it mingle with the waters of the lake, rather this river goes around in a circle and discharges into Tartarus opposite Periphlegethon. And the name of this, according to the poets, is Cocytus.²⁶

κυανός, ὃν δὴ ἐπονομάζουσι Στύγιον, καὶ τὴν λίμνην ἣν ποιεῖ ὁ ποταμὸς ἐμβάλλων, Στύγα· ὁ δ' ἐμπεσὼν ἐνταῦθα καὶ δεινὰς δυνάμεις λαβὼν ἐν τῷ ὕδατι, δὺς κατὰ τῆς γῆς, περιλιττόμενος χωρεῖ ἐναντίος τῷ Πυριφλεγέθοντι καὶ ἀπαντᾷ ἐν τῇ Ἀχερουσιᾷ λίμνῃ ἐξ ἐναντίας· καὶ οὐδὲ τὸ τούτου ὕδωρ οὐδενὶ μείγνυται, ἀλλὰ καὶ οὗτος κύκλῳ περιελθὼν ἐμβάλλει εἰς τὸν Τάρταρον ἐναντίος τῷ Πυριφλεγέθοντι· ὄνομα δὲ τούτῳ ἐστίν, ὥς οἱ ποιηταὶ λέγουσιν, κωκυτός.

113d

S: “This is the nature of these regions. Once those who have died arrive in the region to which the daimon guides each one, they first submit to judgement, some having lived in a noble and sacred manner, others not. Now, those who are judged to have lived middling lives, proceed to the Acheron, get on board vessels which are somehow provided for them, and arrive at the lake on these. There they dwell, and if anyone has done any injustice he is purified of the injustices, makes retribution and is freed from them. And they receive the rewards of their good deeds, each according to their deserts. But those who are judged incurable because of the magnitude of their transgressions, having carried out numerous and grave sacrilegious acts, or many unjust killings contrary to law, or any other deeds of that sort, these people the appropriate fate casts into Tartarus never to emerge again.

τούτων δὲ οὕτως πεφυκότων, ἐπειδὴν ἀφίκωνται οἱ τετελευτηκότες εἰς τὸν τόπον οἱ ὁ δαίμων ἕκαστον κομίζει, πρῶτον μὲν διεδικάσαντο οἱ τε καλῶς καὶ ὁσίως βιώσαντες καὶ οἱ μὴ. καὶ οἱ μὲν ἂν δόξωσι μέσως βεβιωκέναι, πορευθέντες ἐπὶ τὸν Ἀχέροντα, ἀναβάντες ἃ δὴ αὐτοῖς ὀχήματά ἐστιν, ἐπὶ τούτων ἀφικνουῦνται εἰς τὴν λίμνην, καὶ ἐκεῖ οἰκοῦσί τε καὶ καθαιρόμενοι τῶν τε ἀδικημάτων διδόντες δίκας ἀπολύονται, εἴ τις τι ἠδίκηκεν, τῶν τε εὐεργεσιῶν τιμὰς φέρονται κατὰ τὴν ἀξίαν ἕκαστος· οἱ δ' ἂν δόξωσιν ἀνιάτως ἔχειν διὰ τὰ μεγέθη τῶν ἁμαρτημάτων, ἢ ἱεροσυλίας πολλὰς καὶ μεγάλας ἢ φόνους ἀδίκους καὶ παρανόμους πολλοὺς ἐξειργασμένοι ἢ ἄλλα ὅσα τοιαῦτα τυγχάνει ὄντα, τούτους δὲ ἢ προσήκουσα μοῖρα ρίπτει εἰς τὸν Τάρταρον, ὅθεν οὐποτε

ἐκβαίνουσιν. ΦΑΙΔ. οἳ δ' ἂν ἰάσιμα μὲν μεγάλα δὲ δόξωσιν ἡμαρτηκέναι ἁμαρτήματα, οἷον πρὸς πατέρα ἢ μητέρα

114a

S: “But those who are judged curable, though they committed great transgressions such as doing some violence in anger to a father or mother, and living the rest of their lives in repentance, or being involved in homicides under similar circumstances, these people necessarily fall into Tartarus. Once they have fallen in and spent a year there, the surge sends forth the homicides along the Cocytus and those who have assaulted father or mother along the Periphlegethon. They are carried along, and whenever they get to the Acherusian lake they shout and cry out in that place to the people they have slain or the people they have assaulted. With their cries, they plead and beg that they be allowed to come out into the lake and to be accepted, and if they persuade these people, out they come and that is the end of their afflictions. But if they do not persuade them, they are carried again into Tartarus and from there they enter the rivers once more, and this happens to them unceasingly until they persuade the people they have wronged. For this particular penalty has been imposed upon them by the judges. But the people who are judged to have lived with exceptional holiness, are the ones who are set free from those places beneath the earth as though they are being released from prisons. They arrive above in the pure abode and they dwell upon the earth. Of these people, the ones who have purified themselves sufficiently through philosophy live thereafter without bodies for all time, and they arrive at dwellings even more beautiful than those, which are not easy to describe, nor is there enough time just now. But as a consequence of everything we have been discussing, Simmias, we must make all efforts to partake of virtue and wisdom in this life, for the reward is beautiful and the hope is great.

ὕπ' ὀργῆς βίαιόν τι πράξαντες, καὶ μεταμέλον αὐτοῖς τὸν ἄλλον βίον βιωσιν, ἢ ἀνδροφόνοι τοιούτῳ τινὶ ἄλλῳ τρόπῳ γένωνται, τούτους δὲ ἐμπεσεῖν μὲν εἰς τὸν Τάρταρον ἀνάγκη, ἐμπεσόντας δὲ αὐτοὺς καὶ

ἐνιαυτὸν ἐκεῖ γενομένους ἐκβάλλει τὸ κῦμα, τοὺς μὲν ἀνδροφόνους κατὰ τὸν Κωκυτὸν, τοὺς δὲ πατραλοίας καὶ μητραλοίας κατὰ τὸν Πυριφλεγέθοντα· ἐπειδὴν δὲ φερόμενοι γένωνται κατὰ τὴν λίμνην τὴν Ἀχερουσιάδα, ἐνταῦθα βοῶσί τε καὶ καλοῦσιν, οἱ μὲν οὕς ἀπέκτειναν, οἱ δὲ οὕς ὕβρισαν, καλέσαντες δ' ἰκετεύουσι καὶ δέονται ἑᾶσαι σφᾶς ἐκβῆναι εἰς τὴν λίμνην καὶ δέξασθαι, καὶ ἐὰν μὲν πείσωσιν, ἐκβαίνουσί τε καὶ λήγουσι τῶν κακῶν, εἰ δὲ μή, φέρονται αὐθις εἰς τὸν Τάρταρον καὶ ἐκεῖθεν πάλιν εἰς τοὺς ποταμούς, καὶ ταῦτα πάσχοντες οὐ πρότερον παύονται πρὶν ἂν πείσωσιν οὕς ἡδίκησαν· αὕτη γὰρ ἡ δίκη ὑπὸ τῶν δικαστῶν αὐτοῖς ἐτάχθη. οἱ δὲ δὴ ἂν δόξωσι διαφερόντως πρὸς τὸ ὁσίως βιῶναι, οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ τῶνδε μὲν τῶν τόπων τῶν ἐν τῇ γῇ ἐλευθερούμενοί τε καὶ ἀπαλλαττόμενοι ὥσπερ δεσμωτηρίων, ἄνω δὲ εἰς τὴν καθαρὰν οἴκησιν ἀφικνούμενοι καὶ ἐπὶ γῆς οἰκιζόμενοι. τούτων δὲ αὐτῶν οἱ φιλοσοφία ἱκανῶς καθηράμενοι ἄνευ τε σωμάτων ζῶσι τὸ παράπαν εἰς τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον, καὶ εἰς οἰκῆσεις ἔτι τούτων καλλίους ἀφικνοῦνται, ἃς οὔτε ῥάδιον δηλῶσαι οὔτε ὁ χρόνος ἱκανὸς ἐν τῷ παρόντι. ἀλλὰ τούτων δὴ ἔνεκα χρή ὧν διεληλύθαμεν, ὦ Σιμμία, πᾶν ποιεῖν ὥστε ἀρετῆς καὶ φρονήσεως ἐν τῷ βίῳ μετασχεῖν· καλὸν γὰρ τὸ ἄθλον καὶ ἡ ἐλπίς μεγάλη. τὸ μὲν οὖν ταῦτα διισχυρίσασθαι οὕτως ἔχειν ὡς ἐγὼ διελέλυθα, οὐ πρέπει νοῦν ἔχοντι ἀνδρὶ· ὅτι μέντοι ἢ ταῦτ' ἐστὶν ἢ τοιαῦτ' ἅττα περὶ τὰς ψυχὰς ἡμῶν καὶ τὰς οἰκῆσεις, ἐπεὶ περ ἀθάνατόν γε ἡ ψυχὴ φαίνεται οὕσα, τοῦτο καὶ πρέπει μοι δοκεῖ καὶ ἄξιον κινδυνεῦσαι οἰομένῳ οὕτως ἔχειν — καλὸς γὰρ ὁ κίνδυνος — καὶ χρή τὰ τοιαῦτα ὥσπερ ἐπάδειν ἑαυτῷ, διὸ δὴ ἔγωγε καὶ πάλαι μηκύνω τὸν μῦθον. ἀλλὰ τούτων δὴ ἔνεκα θαρρεῖν χρή περὶ τῇ ἑαυτοῦ ψυχῇ

114d

S: “Now, it would not be appropriate for a man of intelligence to insist that matters are as I have recounted them. But that these considerations, or something like them, are applicable to our souls and their dwelling places, in view of the fact that the soul turns out to be immortal, seems to me a hazard worth taking, for the hazard is beautiful and appropriate to someone who holds this view of the soul.

And he should chant to himself as though they were charms and that is why I have been lengthening the story just now.

114e

S: “So, these are the reasons why a man should be confident about his own soul once he has bidden farewell, in this life, to the various pleasures and adornments associated with the body because they are alien. And realising they are more inclined to have the opposite effect, has busied himself with learning and adorned the soul, not with an alien adornment but with its own, with sound-mindedness, justice, courage, freedom and truth. And in this condition he awaits the journey to Hades, ready to make that journey whenever destiny may call. Well, Simmias and Cebes,” he said, “you and the others will each in turn make the journey at some stage, but now, as someone in a tragedy might say, ‘Destiny is already calling me’, and it is almost time for me to make my way to the bath. Indeed, I think it best to drink the poison after bathing and not give to the women the task of washing a corpse.”

ἄνδρα ὅστις ἐν τῷ βίῳ τὰς μὲν ἄλλας ἡδονὰς τὰς περὶ τὸ σῶμα καὶ τοὺς κόσμους εἶασε χαίρειν, ὡς ἄλλοτρίους τε ὄντας, καὶ πλεον θάτερον ἡγησάμενος ἀπεργάζεσθαι, τὰς δὲ περὶ τὸ μανθάνειν ἐσπούδασέ τε καὶ κοσμήσας τὴν ψυχὴν οὐκ ἄλλοτρίῳ ἀλλὰ τῷ αὐτῆς κόσμῳ, σωφροσύνη τε καὶ δικαιοσύνη καὶ ἀνδρεία καὶ ἐλευθερία καὶ ἀληθεία, οὕτω περιμένει τὴν εἰς Ἄιδου πορείαν ὡς πορευσόμενος ὅταν ἡ εἰμαρμένη καλῇ. ΦΑΙΔ. ὑμεῖς μὲν οὖν, ἔφη, ὦ Σιμμία τε καὶ Κέβης καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι, εἰς αὐθις ἔν τινι χρόνῳ ἕκαστοι πορεύσεσθε· ἐμὲ δὲ νῦν ἤδη καλεῖ, φαίη ἂν ἀνὴρ τραγικός, ἡ εἰμαρμένη, καὶ σχεδόν τί μοι ὥρα τραπέσθαι πρὸς τὸ λουτρόν· δοκεῖ γὰρ δὴ βέλτιον εἶναι λουσάμενον πιεῖν τὸ φάρμακον καὶ μὴ πράγματα ταῖς γυναιξὶ παρέχειν νεκρὸν λούειν.

115b

CR: Well, once he had said all this, Crito said, “So be it, Socrates, but what directions do you have for these men or for me concerning either your children or anything else? What is the greatest service we could perform for you?”

115b

S: “I shall say what I always say, Crito, nothing new, that in caring for yourselves you will be doing a service to me and mine and to yourselves, whatever actions you may perform, even if you make no promises now. But if you do not care for yourselves, and are not prepared to live your life based upon the path which accords with the declarations we have made now and on previous occasions, even if you make a lot of fervent promises now, you will accomplish nothing.”

ταῦτα δὴ εἰπόντος αὐτοῦ ὁ Κρίτων, εἶεν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες· τί δὲ τούτοις ἢ ἐμοὶ ἐπιστέλλεις ἢ περὶ τῶν παίδων ἢ περὶ ἄλλου του, ὅτι ἂν σοι ποιοῦντες ἡμεῖς ἐν χάριτι μάλιστα ποιοῖμεν; ἅπερ ἀεὶ λέγω, ἔφη, ὦ Κρίτων, οὐδὲν καινότερον· ὅτι ὑμῶν αὐτῶν ἐπιμελούμενοι ὑμεῖς καὶ ἐμοὶ καὶ τοῖς ἐμοῖς καὶ ὑμῖν αὐτοῖς ἐν χάριτι ποιήσετε ἅτ’ ἂν ποιῇτε, καὶ μὴ νῦν ὁμολογήσητε· ἐὰν δὲ ὑμῶν μὲν αὐτῶν ἀμελῇτε καὶ μὴ θέλητε ὥσπερ κατ’ ἴχνη κατὰ τὰ νῦν τε εἰρημένα καὶ τὰ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν χρόνῳ ζῆν, οὐδὲ ἐὰν πολλὰ ὁμολογήσητε

115c

CR: “In that case,” he said, “we shall strive earnestly to do as you ask. But in what way should we bury you?”

ἐν τῷ παρόντι καὶ σφόδρα, οὐδὲν πλέον ποιήσετε. ταῦτα μὲν τοίνυν προθυμησόμεθα, ἔφη, οὕτω ποιεῖν· θάπτωμεν δέ σε τίνα τρόπον; ὅπως ἂν, ἔφη, βούλησθε, ἐάνπερ γε λάβητέ με καὶ μὴ ἐκφύγω ὑμᾶς. γελάσας δὲ ἅμα ἡσυχῇ καὶ πρὸς ἡμᾶς ἀποβλέψας εἶπεν· οὐ πείθω, ὦ ἄνδρες, Κρίτωνα, ὥς ἐγὼ εἰμι οὗτος Σωκράτης, ὁ νυνὶ διαλεγόμενος καὶ διατάττων ἕκαστον τῶν λεγομένων, ἀλλ’ οἴεται με ἐκεῖνον εἶναι

115d

S: “Any way you like,” he replied, “that is if you can catch me and I do not escape you.”

115d

With this he laughed gently, looked towards us and said,

115d

S: “Friends, I cannot persuade Crito that I am this Socrates who is conversing with you right now and arranging each topic of discussion.

Instead, he thinks I am the one he will see in a short time as a corpse, and he asks how he should bury me. I presented extensive arguments a while ago, that once I drink the poison I shall no longer remain with you, but shall depart and be gone to some delights of the blessed. But I think these have been spoken to him in vain, while consoling both yourselves and myself at the same time. Therefore, give an assurance about me to Crito,” he said, “the opposite assurance to the one he gave the jurors. For he assured them that I would remain but you must assure him that I shall not remain after I die but will depart and be gone, so that Crito may bear this more easily. And when he sees my body being burned or buried, he may not be troubled on my account as though I am being treated dreadfully, or say at the funeral that Socrates lies before us or is borne to the grave or buried. For mark my words well, excellent Crito, speaking improperly is not only wrong in itself, but it also engenders an evil in our souls. Instead, you must take heart and say that you are burying my body and bury it as you please and as you deem most appropriate.”

ὄν ὄψεται ὀλίγον ὕστερον νεκρόν, καὶ ἐρωτᾷ δὴ πῶς με θάπτει. ὅτι δὲ ἐγὼ πάλαι πολὺν λόγον πεποίημαι, ὥς, ἐπειδὴν πίω τὸ φάρμακον, οὐκέτι ὑμῖν παραμενῶ, ἀλλ' οἰχήσομαι ἀπὼν εἰς μακάρων δὴ τινὰς εὐδαιμονίας, ταῦτά μοι δοκῶ αὐτῷ ἄλλως λέγειν, παραμυθούμενος ἅμα μὲν ὑμᾶς, ἅμα δ' ἑμαυτόν. ἐγγυήσασθε οὖν με πρὸς Κρίτωνα, ἔφη, τὴν ἐναντίαν ἐγγύην ἢ ἣν οὗτος πρὸς τοὺς δικαστὰς ἡγγυᾶτο. οὗτος μὲν γὰρ ἢ μὴν παραμενεῖν· ὑμεῖς δὲ ἢ μὴν μὴ παραμενεῖν ἐγγυήσασθε ἐπειδὴν ἀποθάνω, ἀλλὰ οἰχήσεσθαι ἀπὼντα, ἵνα Κρίτων ῥᾶον φέρῃ, καὶ μὴ ὀρῶν μου τὸ σῶμα ἢ καόμενον ἢ κατορυττόμενον ἀγανακτῇ ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ ὥς δεινὰ πάσχοντος, μηδὲ λέγῃ ἐν τῇ ταφῇ ὥς ἢ προτίθεται Σωκράτῃ ἢ ἐκφέρει ἢ κατορύττει. εὖ γὰρ ἴσθι, ἢ δ' ὅς, ὦ ἄριστε Κρίτων, τὸ μὴ καλῶς λέγειν οὐ μόνον εἰς αὐτὸ τοῦτο πλημμελές, ἀλλὰ καὶ κακόν τι ἐμποιεῖ ταῖς ψυχαῖς. ΦΑΙΔ. ἀλλὰ θαρρεῖν τε χρὴ καὶ φάναι τοῦμὸν σῶμα θάπτειν, καὶ θάπτειν

Having said this, he got up and went to another room in order to bathe. Crito followed him but he told us to wait. So we waited conversing among ourselves about what had been said and considering it once more, and then we went on to recount the extent of the misfortune which had befallen us, literally believing that we had been deprived of a father and would spend the rest of our lives as orphans. Once he had bathed the children were brought to him, for he had two small sons and a big one, and the women of his household arrived and he conversed with them, in Crito's presence, and gave the instructions he wished to give. He then asked the women and children to depart and he himself returned to us.

οὕτως ὅπως ἂν σοι φίλον ἦ καὶ μάλιστα ἡγῇ νόμιμον εἶναι. ταῦτ' εἰπὼν ἐκεῖνος μὲν ἀνίστατο εἰς οἴκημά τι ὡς λουσόμενος, καὶ ὁ Κρίτων εἵπετο αὐτῷ, ἡμᾶς δ' ἐκέλευε περιμένειν. περιεμένομεν οὖν πρὸς ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς διαλεγόμενοι περὶ τῶν εἰρημένων καὶ ἀνασκοποῦντες, τοτὲ δ' αὖ περὶ τῆς συμφορᾶς διεξιόντες ὅση ἡμῖν γεγонуῖα εἴη, ἀτεχνῶς ἡγούμενοι ὥσπερ πατρὸς στερηθέντες διάξιν ὀρφανοὶ τὸν ἔπειτα βίον. ἐπειδὴ

116b

Now, at that stage the sun was almost setting for he had spent a lot of time within. When he came back after bathing he sat down, but not much was discussed after that, and the servant of The Eleven arrived, stood before him and said,

δὲ ἐλούσατο καὶ ἠνέχθη παρ' αὐτὸν τὰ παιδιά — δύο γὰρ αὐτῷ υἱεῖς μικροὶ ἦσαν, εἷς δὲ μέγας — καὶ αἱ οἰκεῖαι γυναῖκες ἀφίκοντο ἐκεῖναι, ἐναντίον τοῦ Κρίτωνος διαλεχθεῖς τε καὶ ἐπιστείλας ἅττα ἐβούλετο, τὰς μὲν γυναῖκας καὶ τὰ παιδιά ἀπιέναι ἐκέλευσεν, αὐτὸς δὲ ἦκε παρ' ἡμᾶς. καὶ ἦν ἤδη ἐγγὺς ἡλίου δυσμῶν· χρόνον γὰρ πολὺν διέτριψεν ἔνδον. ἐλθὼν δ' ἐκαθέζετο λελουμένος καὶ οὐ πολλὰ ἅττα μετὰ ταῦτα διελέχθη, καὶ ἦκεν ὁ τῶν ἑνδεκα ὑπηρέτης καὶ σταῖς

116c

WA: “Socrates, I shall not find in you the fault I find in others, whereby they are angry with me and curse me when, on the

instructions of the Archons, I order them to drink the poison. During your time here I have known you as the noblest, gentlest, most excellent man who ever arrived in this place. What is more, I know quite well that you are not angry with me now but with them, for you realise who is responsible. Now then, since you know what I have come to announce, fare you well and try to bear what must be as lightly as you can.”

παρ’ αὐτόν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔφη, οὐ καταγνώσομαί γε σοῦ ὅπερ ἄλλων καταγινώσκω, ὅτι μοι χαλεπαίνουσι καὶ καταρῶνται ἐπειδὴν αὐτοῖς παραγγείλω πίνειν τὸ φάρμακον ἀναγκαζόντων τῶν ἀρχόντων. σὲ δὲ ἐγὼ καὶ ἄλλως ἔγνωκα ἐν τούτῳ τῷ χρόνῳ γενναιότατον καὶ πραότατον καὶ ἄριστον ἄνδρα ὄντα τῶν πώποτε δεῦρο ἀφικομένων, καὶ δὴ καὶ νῦν εὖ οἶδ’ ὅτι οὐκ ἐμοὶ χαλεπαίνεις, γινώσκεις γὰρ τοὺς αἰτίους, ἀλλὰ ἐκείνοις. νῦν οὖν, οἶσθα γὰρ ἃ ἦλθον

116d

And with this he began to weep, turned away and departed. And Socrates looked toward him and said,

116d

S: “Fare you well too. We shall do as you ask.”

116d

Then he said to us,

116d

S: “What a courteous man! Throughout my time here he has visited me and conversed with me sometimes and has been the best of men, and now, see how genuinely he weeps for me. But come now, Crito, let us pay heed to him. Let someone bring the poison if it has been pressed and if not, the man should press it.”

ἀγγέλλων, χαῖρέ τε καὶ πειρῶ ὡς ῥᾶστα φέρειν τὰ ἀναγκαῖα. καὶ ἅμα δακρύσας μεταστρεφόμενος ἀπῆει. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης ἀναβλέψας πρὸς αὐτόν, καὶ σύ, ἔφη, χαῖρε, καὶ ἡμεῖς ταῦτα ποιήσομεν. καὶ ἅμα πρὸς ἡμᾶς, ὡς ἀστεῖος, ἔφη, ὁ ἄνθρωπος· καὶ παρὰ πάντα μοι τὸν χρόνον προσῆει καὶ διελέγετο ἐνίοτε καὶ ἦν ἀνδρῶν λῶστος, καὶ νῦν ὡς

γενναίως με ἀποδακρύνει. ἀλλ' ἄγε δὴ, ὦ Κρίτων, πειθώμεθα αὐτῷ, καὶ ἐνεγκάτω τις τὸ φάρμακον, εἰ τέτριπται· εἰ δὲ μή, τριψάτω ὁ ἄνθρωπος.

116e

CR: And Crito said, “Socrates, I think the sun is still upon the hills and has not yet set. What is more, I know that others have drunk the poison very late, whenever the announcement has been made to them. They have feasted and drunk quite a lot, some of them even fraternising with people they happen to enjoy. So do not rush, there is still time.”

116e

S: And Socrates replied, “Crito, it is quite reasonable for these people to do this, the people you describe, for they think there is benefit in doing so. And it will be reasonable for me not to do so, as I think there is no benefit in drinking the poison a little later, apart from becoming a figure of fun to myself by clinging to life and sparing what is already spent. So come on,” he said, “heed me and do not refuse me.”

καὶ ὁ Κρίτων, ἀλλ' οἶμαι, ἔφη, ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔτι ἥλιον εἶναι ἐπὶ τοῖς ὄρεσιν καὶ οὐπω δεδυκέναι. καὶ ἅμα ἐγὼ οἶδα καὶ ἄλλους πάνυ ὀψὲ πίνοντας, ἐπειδὴν παραγγεληὶ αὐτοῖς, δειπνήσαντάς τε καὶ πίνοντας εὖ μάλα, καὶ συγγενομένους γ' ἐνίους ὧν ἂν τύχωσιν ἐπιθυμοῦντες. ἀλλὰ μηδὲν ἐπείγου· ἔτι γὰρ ἐγχωρεῖ. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ ὁ Σωκράτης, εἰκότως γε, ἔφη, ὦ Κρίτων, ἐκεῖνοί τε ταῦτα ποιοῦσιν, οὓς σὺ λέγεις — οἶονται γὰρ κερδαίνειν ταῦτα ποιήσαντες — καὶ ἔγωγε ταῦτα εἰκότως οὐ ποιήσω· οὐδὲν γὰρ

117a

And when Crito heard this he nodded to his servant who was standing nearby and the boy went out, was gone for quite some time, and returned bringing the man who was going to administer the poison, carrying it already pressed in a cup. When Socrates saw the man, he said,

117a

S: “So be it, best of men, since you are knowledgeable about these matters, what should I do?”

οἶμαι κερδανεῖν ὀλίγον ὕστερον πιών ἄλλο γε ἢ γέλωτα ὀφλήσειν παρ’ ἐμαυτῷ, γλιχόμενος τοῦ ζῆν καὶ φειδόμενος οὐδενὸς ἔτι ἐνόντος. ἀλλ’ ἴθι, ἔφη, πείθου καὶ μὴ ἄλλως ποίει. καὶ ὁ Κρίτων ἀκούσας ἔνευσε τῷ παιδὶ πλησίον ἐστῶτι. καὶ ὁ παῖς ἐξελθὼν καὶ συχνὸν χρόνον διατρίψας ἤκεν ἄγων τὸν μέλλοντα δώσειν τὸ φάρμακον, ἐν κύλικι φέροντα τετριμμένον. ἰδὼν δὲ ὁ Σωκράτης τὸν ἄνθρωπον, εἶεν, ἔφη, ὦ βέλτιστε, σὺ γὰρ τούτων ἐπιστήμων, τί χρὴ ποιεῖν; οὐδὲν ἄλλο, ἔφη, ἢ πίνοντα περιέναι, ἕως ἄν σου βάρος

117b

PN: “Nothing,” he said, “except drink this and walk about until your legs become heavy, then lie down and in this way the poison will act by itself.”

117b

And as he said this he held out the cup to Socrates. And having taken it most graciously, Echecrates, without fear or any change of colour or expression, but looking at the man wide-eyed, as usual, he said,

117b

S: “What do you say about pouring a libation to someone from this cup? Is that permitted or not?”

117b

PN: “Socrates,” he replied, “we only press the amount we think you need to drink.”

ἐν τοῖς σκέλεσι γένηται, ἔπειτα κατακεῖσθαι καὶ οὕτως αὐτὸ ποιήσει. καὶ ἅμα ὥρεξε τὴν κύλικα τῷ Σωκράτει. καὶ ὃς λαβὼν καὶ μάλα ἴλεως, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, οὐδὲν τρέσας οὐδὲ διαφθείρας οὔτε τοῦ χρώματος οὔτε τοῦ προσώπου, ἀλλ’ ὥσπερ εἰώθει ταυρηδὸν ὑποβλέψας πρὸς τὸν ἄνθρωπον, τί λέγεις, ἔφη, περὶ τοῦδε τοῦ σώματος πρὸς τὸ ἀποσπεῖσθαί τινι; ἔξεστιν ἢ οὐ; τοσοῦτον, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, τρίβομεν ὅσον οἰόμεθα μέτριον εἶναι πιεῖν.

117c

S: “I understand,” he said, “but it is permitted and indeed necessary to pray to the gods that my change of abode from here to there be graced with good fortune, and so I pray that this may be so.”

117c

And as he said this, he put the cup to his lips and very calmly and without flinching, he drank it down. Up to then most of us were able to restrain our tears fairly well, but when we saw him drinking and saw that he had drunk it, we could do so no longer. In spite of myself, my own tears flowed in a torrent, and so I hid my face, weeping not for him but for myself and my own misfortune at being deprived of such a companion. And even before that, when Crito was unable to restrain his tears, he had moved away. But Apollodorus, who had been weeping incessantly before then, broke out at this stage into such wailing and grieving that none of the company could help breaking down, except Socrates himself.

μανθάνω, ἥ δ' ὅς· ἀλλ' εὐχεσθαί γε που τοῖς θεοῖς ἔξεστί τε καὶ χρή, τὴν μετοίκησιν τὴν ἐνθένδε ἐκεῖσε εὐτυχῇ γενέσθαι· ἃ δὴ καὶ ἐγὼ εὐχομαί τε καὶ γένοιτο ταύτη. καὶ ἅμ' εἰπὼν ταῦτα ἐπισχόμενος καὶ μάλα εὐχερῶς καὶ εὐκόλως ἐξέπιεν. καὶ ἡμῶν οἱ πολλοὶ τέως μὲν ἐπεικῶς οἴοι τε ἦσαν κατέχειν τὸ μὴ δακρύειν, ὥς δὲ εἶδομεν πίνοντά τε καὶ πεπωκότα, οὐκέτι, ἀλλ' ἐμοῦ γε βία καὶ αὐτοῦ ἀστακτὶ ἐχώρει τὰ δάκρυα, ὥστε ἐγκαλυψάμενος ἀπέκλαον ἐμαυτόν — οὐ γὰρ δὴ ἐκεῖνόν γε, ἀλλὰ τὴν ἐμαυτοῦ τύχην, οἷου ἀνδρὸς

117d

S: “Strange men,” he said, “what a way to behave! I sent the women away mainly so that they would not cause such a tumult, for I have also heard that it is necessary to die in reverent silence. So keep quiet and endure.”

ἐταίρου ἐστερημένος εἶην. ὁ δὲ Κρίτων ἔτι πρότερος ἐμοῦ, ἐπειδὴ οὐχ οἷός τ' ἦν κατέχειν τὰ δάκρυα, ἐξανέστη. Ἀπολλόδωρος δὲ καὶ ἐν τῷ ἔμπροσθεν χρόνῳ οὐδὲν ἐπαύετο δακρύων, καὶ δὴ καὶ τότε ἀναβρυχησάμενος κλάων καὶ ἀγανακτῶν οὐδένα ὄντινα οὐ κατέκλασε

τῶν παρόντων πλὴν γε αὐτοῦ Σωκράτους. ἐκεῖνος δέ, οἷα, ἔφη, ποιεῖτε, ὦ θαυμάσιοι. ἐγὼ μέντοι οὐχ ἥκιστα τούτου ἔνεκα τὰς γυναῖκας ἀπέπεμψα, ἵνα μὴ

117e

And when we had heard this we felt ashamed and refrained from weeping. He walked around until he said that his legs were becoming heavy, then he lay flat on his back as the man had instructed, and this man who had administered the poison began examining him, and when some time had passed he probed his feet and legs and then he pinched his foot hard and asked if he could feel it. He said, “No.” And after this the man felt his shin once more, and working upwards in this way he showed us that he was going cold and stiff. And again, he touched him and said that when it reached the heart, he would then be gone.

τοιαῦτα πλημμελοῖεν· καὶ γὰρ ἀκήκοα ὅτι ἐν εὐφημίᾳ χρή τελευτᾶν. ἀλλ’ ἡσυχίαν τε ἄγετε καὶ καρτερεῖτε. καὶ ἡμεῖς ἀκούσαντες ἡσχύνθημέν τε καὶ ἐπέσχομεν τοῦ δακρύνειν. ὁ δὲ περιελθὼν, ἐπειδὴ οἱ βαρύνεσθαι ἔφη τὰ σκέλη, κατεκλίνει ὕπτιος — οὕτω γὰρ ἐκέλευεν ὁ ἄνθρωπος — καὶ ἅμα ἐφαπτόμενος αὐτοῦ οὗτος ὁ δοὺς τὸ φάρμακον, διαλιπὼν χρόνον ἐπεσκόπει τοὺς πόδας καὶ τὰ σκέλη, κᾷπειτα σφόδρα πύσσας αὐτοῦ τὸν πόδα ἤρετο εἰ αἰσθάνοιτο,

118a

Now, once the coldness was somewhere in the region of his groin he uncovered his face, for it had been covered, and said, and this was his final utterance,

118a

S: “Crito, we owe a cock to Asclepius,²⁷ so pay the debt without fail.”

118a

CR: “Yes, it shall be done,” said Crito, “but see if you have something else to ask for.”

118a

To this question he did not even reply. After a short time he shuddered and the man uncovered him, and his eyes were fixed. And when Crito saw this he closed the mouth and the eyes.

118a

PH: Such was the end, Echecrates, of our companion, a man whom we would say was the best, the wisest too, and the most just of any we have ever known.

ὁ δ' οὐκ ἔφη. ΦΑΙΔ. καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο αὐθις τὰς κνήμας· καὶ ἐπανιών οὕτως ἡμῖν ἐπεδείκνυτο ὅτι ψύχοιτό τε καὶ πῆγνυτο. καὶ αὐτὸς ἤπτετο καὶ εἶπεν ὅτι, ἐπειδὴν πρὸς τῇ καρδίᾳ γένηται αὐτῷ, τότε οἰχήσεται. ἤδη οὖν σχεδόν τι αὐτοῦ ἦν τὰ περὶ τὸ ἥτρον ψυχόμενα, καὶ ἐκκαλυψάμενος — ἐνεκεκάλυπτο γάρ — εἶπεν — ὁ δὴ τελευταῖον ἐφθέγγετο — ὦ Κρίτων, ἔφη, τῷ Ἀσκληπιῷ ὀφείλομεν ἀλεκτρυόνα· ἀλλὰ ἀπόδοτε καὶ μὴ ἀμελήσητε. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα, ἔφη, ἔσται, ὁ Κρίτων· ἀλλ' ὅρα εἴ τι ἄλλο λέγεις. ταῦτα ἐρομένου αὐτοῦ οὐδὲν ἔτι ἀπεκρίνατο, ἀλλ' ὀλίγον χρόνον διαλιπὼν ἐκινήθη τε καὶ ὁ ἄνθρωπος ἐξεκάλυψε αὐτόν, καὶ ὅς τὰ ὄμματα ἔστησεν· ἰδὼν δὲ ὁ Κρίτων συνέλαβε τὸ στόμα καὶ τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς. ἦδε ἡ τελευτή, ὦ Ἐχέκρατες, τοῦ ἐταίρου ἡμῖν ἐγένετο, ἄνδρός, ὡς ἡμεῖς φαῖμεν ἄν, τῶν τότε ὧν ἐπειράθημεν ἀρίστου καὶ ἄλλως φρονιμωτάτου καὶ δικαιοτάτου.

Notes

¹ Phaedo was a close associate of Socrates, and eventually set up a philosophical school in Elis.

² Echecrates was a Pythagorean philosopher from Phlius, near Corinth.

³ According to legend, King Minos required the Athenians to send fourteen youths each year to his kingdom on the island of Crete to be sacrificed to the Minotaur. Theseus is reputed to have saved the youths and slain the monster, thus freeing the Athenians from this annual tribute.

⁴ The nine men listed here from Athens and the surrounding area were part of Socrates' inner circle. A few of them appear in other of Plato's dialogues:

Apollodorus appears in Plato's *Symposium*; Crito, the father of Critobulus, lends his name to Plato's *Crito*; Hermogenes is the main interlocutor in Plato's *Cratylus*; Ctesippus is mentioned in both Plato's *Lysis* and *Euthydemus*; Menexenus has a small part in Plato's *Lysis* and has a dialogue named after him. Epigenes and Aeschines are both mentioned in Plato's *Apology* as having been present at the trial of Socrates; the latter was a writer of Socratic dialogues. Antisthenes is regarded as the founder of the Cynic school of philosophy.

⁵ Simmias, Cebes and Phaidondes were Pythagoreans from Thebes, north of Athens; Euclides and Terpsion were from Megara, a city west of Athens. The first two are mentioned in Plato's *Crito* as having raised enough money to secure Socrates' escape. Euclides was also a writer of Socratic dialogues, and founder of the Megarian school of philosophy.

⁶ Cleombrotus was a young follower of Socrates who was reputed to have taken his own life after reading the *Phaedo*. Aristippus was the founder of the Cyrenaic school of philosophy.

⁷ Among the 700 magistrates of Athens appointed by lot, eleven men, simply called 'the Eleven', were in charge of prisons and executions.

⁸ Xanthippe was Socrates' wife. They had three children, two who were young men and a third still young enough to be carried by his mother.

⁹ Aesop was a legendary storyteller to whom a collection of fables was attributed.

¹⁰ Evenus of Paros was a late 5th-century sophist and teacher. He is also mentioned in Plato's *Apology* (20b-c) and *Phaedrus* (267a).

¹¹ Philolaus was an influential Pythagorean philosopher from southern Italy. He spent some time in Thebes, where he met Simmias and Cebes.

¹² The mysteries and rites of initiation referred to here are those that were associated with Orpheus.

¹³ This quote contrasts the true worshippers of Dionysus, the Bacchae, with those who merely carry the outward symbols of such worship, i.e. the thyrsus, a giant fennel stalk covered with ivy.

¹⁴ Endymion was a beautiful mortal who was granted eternal youth by Zeus, who put him into an everlasting sleep, all at the request of Selene.

¹⁵ Anaxagoras was a natural philosopher from Clazomenae in Ionia, who lived a generation before Socrates. His influence upon Socrates is described later in the dialogue.

¹⁶ Penelope was the wife of Odysseus. She had promised to marry one of her suitors once she finished weaving a shroud for her father-in-law. In order to deceive the suitors, she wove by day and undid each day's work by night. Thus, her task of weaving was endless. *Odyssey* ii.92-105.

¹⁷ The men of Argos swore an oath not to let their hair grow until they had defeated the Spartans in battle.

¹⁸ Iolaus was the nephew of Heracles, who assisted his uncle in some of his Labours.

¹⁹ *Odyssey* xx.17-18

²⁰ Cadmus was the legendary founder of Thebes, and his wife was Harmonia, daughter of Ares and Aphrodite. Socrates plays here upon their reciprocal relationship.

²¹ Atlas was a Titan who was condemned to hold up the sky for all eternity after the Titans were defeated in their war against the Olympians.

²² Aeschylus' work *Telephos* no longer survives.

²³ A common adage of uncertain origin.

²⁴ The Pillars of Heracles refers to promontories that frame the entrance to the Strait of Gibraltar. The River Phasis is situated in modern-day Georgia and flows into the Black Sea.

²⁵ *Iliad* viii.14, 481.

²⁶ The geography of the underworld is drawn from Homer's *Iliad* and *Odyssey*, especially *Odyssey* x.511 ff, xi.157.

²⁷ Asclepius, the son of Apollo, born a mortal but deified after his death, was the god of healing. Sick people who slept in his sanctuary, having been cured, would often sacrifice a cock to him.